

CLAUDIAN

WITH AN ENGLISH TRANSLATION BY
MAURICE PLATNAUER

SOMETIME HONORARY SCHOLAR OF NEW COLLEGE, OXFORD
ASSISTANT MASTER AT WINCHESTER COLLEGE

IN TWO VOLUMES

II



CAMBRIDGE, MASSACHUSETTS
HARVARD UNIVERSITY PRESS
LONDON
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[i]

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CLAUDIAN

II

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CLAUDIAN

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**CLAUDII CLAUDIANI
CARMINA**

**DE CONSULATU
STILICHONIS**

LIBER SECUNDUS

(XXII.)

**THE POEMS OF
CLAUDIAN**

**ON STILICHO'S
CONSULSHIP**

BOOK II

(XXII.)

Thus far the warrior's praise! Now
let my gentler Muse relax the strings
and tell by what virtues he governs
the world, tempering fear with love,
say what counsel moved him at last
to assume those consular robes that
cried out to him, and bestowed on
our annals a year named after
himself.

In the beginning Love^[1] was the
guardian of this vast universe, she
who dwelt in the sphere of Jove, who
attempts the sky 'twixt cold and
heat, who is eldest of the immortals.
For Love, pitying the elemental
confusion, first disentangled Chaos;
with a smile she scattered the
darkness and bathed the world in
light. She dwelleth now not in
temples nor by altars warm with
incense but in thy heart wherein she
has made her home. Taught by her
thou accountest it cruel and

Hactenus armatae laudes: nunc
qualibus orbem
moribus et quanto frenet
metuendus amore,
quo tandem flexus trabeas
auctore rogantes
induerit fastisque suum
concesserit annum,
mitior incipiat fidibus iam Musa
remissis. 5

Principio magni custos
dementia mundi,
quae Iovis incoluit zonam, quae
temperat aethram
frigoris et flammae medio, quae
maxima natu
caelicolum. nam prima chaos
Clementia solvit
congeriem miserata rudem
vultuque sereno 10
discussis tenebris in lucem
saecula fudit.
haec dea pro templis et ture
calentibus aris
te fruitur posuitque suas hoc
pectore sedes.
haec docet ut poenis hominum
vel sanguine pasci
turpe ferumque putes; ut
ferrum, Marte cruentum,
16
siccum pace feras; ut non
infensus alendis

barbarous to batten on suffering and
human slaughter; the sword that
drips blood in war thou wearest
unstained in peace;

[1] Claudian seems to have in his mind partly the Epicurean doctrine of ἔρως and partly the personification of the *Clementia Caesaris*, well known as a legend on so many Roman coins. See, also, for *Clementia* as a goddess, Claud. xvii. 166, and Stat. *Theb.* xii. 481 et sqq.

though angered thou feedest with no fuel the flame of hatred; thou forgivest the guilty even before they ask, thou layest aside thy wrath more readily than thou art moved to wrath, thou never turnest a deaf ear to prayers, all who oppose thee thou overthrowest, but deignest not to touch them when overthrown, like a lion who lusts to rend in pieces the fierce bull, but passes by the cowering prey. At her bidding thou extendest pardon to the conquered; at her prayer thou refrainest the dread fires of thine anger and those threats, not the less terrible for being unfulfilled; it is enough for thee to inspire awe, even as the heavenly Father who, shaking the world with his loud thunder, hurls the bolts of the Cyclops upon rocks and sea-monsters and, sparing the blood of man, expends his lightnings on the forests of Oeta.

Good Faith too, Love's sister, has made her shrine in thy heart and joins herself to all thine actions. She has taught thee to practise no hypocrisy, never to speak falsehood, never to postpone the fulfilment of thy promises; to hate openly those thou hatest, and not to hide the poison of resentment in thy heart nor let a false smile mask treachery but to make thy countenance the sure

materiem praestes odiis; ut
sontibus ultro
ignovisse velis, deponas ocus
iram
quam moveas, precibus
numquam implacabilis
obstes,
obvia prosternas prostrataque
more leonum 20
despicias, alacres ardent qui
frangere tauros,
transiliunt praedas humiles. hac
ipse magistra
das veniam victis, hac exorante
calores
horrificos et quae, numquam
nocitura, timentur
iurgia contentus solo terrore
coerces 25
aetherii patris exemplo, qui
cuncta sonoro
concutiens tonitru Cyclopum
spicula differt
in scopulos et monstra maris
nostrique cruoris
parcus in Oetaeis exercet
fulmina silvis.
Huic divae germana Fides
eademque sorori 30
corde tuo delubra tenens sese
omnibus actis
inserit. haec docuit nullo
livescere fuco,
numquam falsa loqui, numquam
promissa morari;
invisos odisse palam, non virus
in alto
condere, non laetam speciem

mirror of thy mind. She gainsayeth
secret vengeance but encourageth
secret benefits. She strengthens
friendships also, that grow more firm
by lapse of time and binds them with
chains of lasting adamant; not hers is
the fickle change of mood, nor does
she permit close ties to be broken by
the rumour of some petty injury, nor
is she lured to scorn the old friend
when a new one comes. Mindful of
past benefits, quick to forget wrongs,
she remembers services alike small
or great and strives to outdo

condere, non laetam speciem
praemittere^[6] fraudi, 35
sed certum mentique parem
componere vultum;
occulto saevire vetat, prodesse
remittit.
haec et amicitias longo plus
tempore firmat
mansuroque adamante ligat; nec
mobile mutat
ingenium, parvae strepitu nec
vincula noxae 40
dissolvi patitur, nec fastidire
priorem
inlicitur veniente novo.
benefacta tenere,
respuere offensas facilis,
pariterque minoris
officii magnique memor
superare laborat

[7]

them, overcoming friends with devotion as an enemy with arms. She safeguards the absent and is the sole protector of those far away; she opens not a greedy ear to rumours, so that never does the stealthy whisper that would injure some unsuspecting client estrange thy sympathies.

Nor does the love that clings to the living forget the dead, and the gratitude a father earned is paid to his children. This kept thee loyal to Theodosius while yet he wielded the sceptre, loyal, too, after his death; nor carest thou more for thine own offspring than for the sons he entrusted to thy guidance and protection. Just and most faithful does Fame account those, who, though they might deny a trust, have chosen rather to fulfil it, unpolluted by greed of gain; but it is not riches, not a huge heritage of gold that Stilicho holds in trust for the young heirs, but two hemispheres and all that is embraced within the sun's fiery orbit. What wouldst thou not fearlessly entrust to him to whom a kingdom is entrusted safely?

Defended by this buckler Honorius did not mourn his noble sire, and on life's very threshold, ne'er scorned by any, he dictates laws to conquered races and sees his triumphs increase

utque hostes armis, meritis sic
vincit amicos. 45
haec fovet absentes, haec longe
sola remotis
consulit, haec nullis avidam
rumoribus aurem
pandit, ut ignarum numquam
laesura clientem
insidiosa tuos alienent murmura
sensus.

Nec vivis adnexus amor
meminisse sepultos 50
desinit; in prolem transcurrit
gratia patrum.
hac tu Theodosium, tenuit dum
sceptra, colebas,
hac etiam post fata colis; nec
pignora curas
plus tua quam natos, dederat
quos ille monendos
tutandosque tibi. iustos
nimiumque fideles 55
fama putat, qui, cum possint
commissa negare,
maluerint nullo violati reddere
quaestu:
at Stilicho non divitias aurique
relictum
pondus, sed geminos axes
tantumque reservat
depositum teneris, quantum sol
igneus ambit. 60
quid non intrepidus credas, cui
regia tuto
creditur?

Hoc clipeo munitus
Honorius altum
non genuit patrem vitaeque et

with his years. Him thou dost seek to
shape as with kindly so with severe
mind; neither to sloth dost thou
deliver him by a ready yielding to all
his wishes, nor by opposing dost
thou crush his eager spirit: as a youth
thou teachest him in secret a king's
lesson—his duty to his people; as a
reverend senior thou payest him
honour and governest the empire at a
father's bidding; to thy lord thou
givest humble worship; thou guidest
thy master with obedience, thy sire

non genuit patrem vitaeque et
 lucis in ipso
 limine, contemptus numquam,
 dat iura subactis
 gentibus et secum sentit
 crevisse triumphos. 65
 quem tu sic placida formas, sic
 mente severa,
 ut neque desidia tradas, dum
 pronus ad omne
 quod libet obsequeris, nec
 contra nixus ovanthem
 confringas animum: secreto
 consona regno
 ceu iuvenem doceas, moles
 quid publica poscat: 70
 ceu sanctum venerere senem
 patriisque gubernes
 imperium monitis; dominum
 summissus adores;
 obsequiis moderere ducem,
 pietate parentem.

[9]

with love. Hence it was that he knew
 not passion before matrimony and
 preferred to vindicate his manhood
 not in a youth of debauchery, but in
 the chaste bonds of legal wedlock.
 Blessed art thou in having an
 emperor for a son-in-law; more
 blessed he with thee for father.

Care no less tender watched over
 Honorius' brother, Arcadius. Rightly
 thou ascribest not to that youth the
 outrages of the feeble, vicious mob
 that seeks to screen its own mad
 folly behind the name of a king. Nay,
 even when discord raged never did
 Stilicho so burn with anger, though
 oft assailed by insult, oft attacked
 with the sword, that he sought to
 avenge the frenzy he endured by
 unholy war and give a handle to civil
 strife; stayed on his loyalty, mid all
 the factions of a court, the hallowed
 friendship of those brothers stood
 inviolate. Nay more, thou dividedst
 equally with him Sidonian cloaks,
 belts studded with pearls, jewelled
 togas, breastplates thick with green
 emeralds, helmets flashing with
 sapphires, swords with gleaming
 handles thy sire had wielded, crowns
 bright with the glint of manifold
 jewels, that both might be equal
 heirs of their imperial sire's rich
 furniture and apparel. Thou didst
 send soldiers to Byzantium also,

hinc fuit ut primos in coniuge
 disceret ignes
ordirique virum non luxuriante
 iuventa, 75
sed cum lege tori, casto cum
 foedere vellet.
principe tu felix genero: felicior
 ille
te socero.

 Fratrem levior nec
 cura tuetur
Arcadium; nec, si quid iners
 atque impia turba
praetendens proprio nomen
 regale furori 80
audeat, adscribis iuveni.
 discordia quippe
cum fremeret, numquam
 Stilicho sic canduit ira,
saepe laccessitus probris
 gladiisque petitus,
ut bello furias ultum, quas
 pertulit, iret
inlicito causamque daret
 civilibus armis: 85
cuius fulta fide mediis
 dissensibus aulae
intemeratorum stabat reverentia
 fratrum.
quin et Sidonias chlamydes et
 cingula bacis
aspera gemmatasque togas
 viridesque smaragdo
loricas galeasque redundantes
 hyacinthis 90
gestatosque patri capulis
 radiantibus enses
et vario lapidum distinctas igne

though civil strife was already
raising its head. Rather wouldst thou
reinforce a foe than fail thy pledge;
all that he fairly asks thou grantest
and refusest only that the
withholding of which he himself will
shortly approve, and that to obtain
which were shameful.

Moreover, all the virtues whose pure
aspect puts all wickedness to flight
live conjoined in thee and, dwelling
within thine heart, aid thee in the

et vario lapidum distinctas igne
coronas^[10]

dividis ex aequo, ne non
augusta supellex
ornatusque pares geminis
heredibus essent.
mittitur et miles, quamvis
certamine partes 95
iam tumeant. hostem muniri
robore mavis
quam peccare fidem: permittis
iusta petenti
idque negas solum, cuius mox
ipse repulsa
gaudeat et quidquid fuerat
deforme mereri.
Omnes praeterea, puro quae
crimina pellunt 100
ore, deae iunxere choros
unoque receptae

[11]

manifold businesses of life. Justice teaches thee to prefer the right to the useful, to obey the general laws of mankind and never to enrich thy friends at other's cost. Patience strengthens thy body so that it seeks never to yield to toil. Temperance guides thee to chaste desires. Prudence will have thee do nought without forethought, Constancy nought without decision and firm purpose. The deadly vices which Tartarus sends up from his monstrous abyss fly far from thee; but first and foremost thou banishest Avarice, mother of crimes, greedy for more the more she possesses, searching ever open-mouthed for gold; with her thou drivest out her most foul nurse, Ambition, who watches at the gate of the powerful and haunts their dwelling-places, cherishing the sale of honours for gold. This age's more turbid stream of corruption has not drawn thee to follow its examples—corruption which had with lapse of time established crime and turned the custom of rapine into a law. Beneath thy rule the rich tremble not for the safety of ancestral lands or houses; no informer stalks the world set on making no matter whom his victim. Virtue suffers no eclipse by poverty. Thou exaltest men of all countries, asking what are their merits not their

pectore diversos tecum
cinguntur in usus.
Iustitia utilibus rectum
praeponere suadet
communesque sequi leges
iniustaque numquam
largiri sociis. durum Patientia
corpus 105
instruit, ut nulli cupiat cessisse
labori;
Temperies, ut casta petas;
Prudentia, ne quid
inconsultus agas; Constantia,
futile ne quid
infirmumque geras. procul
importuna fugantur
numina, monstriferis quae
Tartarus edidit antris: 110
ac primam scelerum matrem,
quae semper habendo
plus sitiens patulis rimatur
faucibus aurum,
trudis Avaritiam; cuius
foedissima nutrix
Ambitio, quae vestibulis
foribusque potentum
excubat et pretiis commercia
pascit honorum, 115
pulsa simul. nec te gurgis
corruptior aevi
traxit ad exemplum, qui iam
firmaverat annis
crimen et in legem rapiendi
verterat usum.
denique non dives sub te pro
rure paterno
vel laribus pallet; non insidiator
oberrat 120

place of birth, what their character
not whence their origin. A generous
prince takes note of our life; rewards
allure into the ways of virtue. Hence
it comes that the arts of old flourish
once more; the path to fortune is
open to genius, while poesy again
raises her despised head. Rich and
poor strive with equal zeal towards
their ends, for both see that, as
poverty cannot depress merit, so
riches cannot elevate incapacity.

Fair-fronted wantonness deceives
thee not, wantonness,

luxuries, praedulce malum,
 quae dedita semper
corporis arbitriis hebetat
 caligine sensus
membraque Circaeis effeminat
 acrius herbis,
blanda quidem vultus, sed qua
 non taetrius ulla 135
interius: fucata genas et amicta
 dolosis
inlecebris torvos auro
 circumlinit hydros.
illa voluptatum multos innexuit
 hamis:
te numquam conata capit. non
 prava libido
stupris advigilat; non tempora
 somnus agendi 140
frustratur; nullo citharae
 convivia cantu,
non pueri lasciva sonant. quis
 cernere curis
te vacuum potuit? quis tota
 mente remissum
aut indulgentem dapibus, ni
 causa iuberet
laetitiae? non indecores aeraria
 lassant 145
expensae; parvo non improba
 littera libro
absentum condonat opes. a
 milite parcus
diligetis; neque enim neglectas
 pace cohortes
tunc ditas, cum bella fremunt.
 scis nulla placere
munera, quae metuens illis,
 quos speraverat, offert 150

board and addresst each by his
name, mindful of all the brave deeds
ever done by each beneath thy
banners. To thy gifts thou addest
praises that will ever be
remembered, whereby the grace of
your close bond is doubled.

When bountiful thou dost not also
turn the bounty into a reproach, nor
dost thou address those whom thou
hast advanced with the language of
disdainful patronage; nor yet does
prosperity make thee

^{quos sperare, uti, uti, uti}
[2] I retain Birt's *serps et incassum servati* (V² and the other MSS.) is very tempting
serps et incassum servati
prodigus auri.

antevenis tempus non
expectantibus ultro
munificus mensaeque adhibes
et nomine quemque
compellas clari, sub te quod
gesserat olim,
admonitum facti, figendaque
sensibus addis 155
verba, quibus magni geminatur
gratia nodi. [2]

Nec, si quid tribuas, iactatum
saepius idem
exprobrare soles nec, quos
promoveris, alto
turgidus adloqueris fastu nec
prospera flatus

puffed up. Nay, pride itself is far removed from thee, pride, a vice so familiar in success, ungracious attendant on the virtues. All, no matter when or where, may meet and address thee. Talk over the wine is not watched, but each guest, at liberty to say just what he pleases, mingles grave converse with gay and fears not for his words. Each marvels to find an equal in the emperor's father-in-law and the father of his country, when one so powerful acts the citizen so graciously. With the learned thou discourest of antiquity, with the aged of experience, with the soldier of valiant deeds, and dost mingle thy talk with such pleasant wit that none would rather hear the strains whereby Amphion built the walls of Thebes or Orpheu's lute drew the woods to follow him.

Hence all love thee, all anxiously pray heaven for thee with no feigned intercession, all shout applause at the mention of thy name and reproduce thy form in gilded statues. What anvil should not ring, what forge be idle, from what vast furnaces should bronze not flow that is to shape thine image? What corner of the world, what region so remote but should worship thy beloved countenance as divine,—hadst thou not always refused such honour? Nay, let him

attollunt nimios. quin ipsa
 Superbia longe 160
discessit, vitium rebus sollemne
 secundis
virtutumque ingrata comes.
 contingere passim
adfarique licet. non inter pocula
 sermo
captatur, pura sed libertate
 loquendi
seria quisque iocis nulla
 formidine miscet. 165
quem videt Augusti socerum
 regnique parentem,
miratur conviva parem, cum
 tanta potestas
civem lenis agat. te doctus
 prisca loquentem,
te matura senex audit, te fortia
 miles 169
adpersis salibus, quibus haud
 Amphiona quisquam
praeferat Aonios meditantem
 carmine muros
nec velit Orpheo migrantes
 pectine silvas.
 Hinc amor, hinc veris et non
 fallacibus omnes
pro te solliciti votis; hinc
 nomen ubique
plausibus, auratis celebrant hinc
 ora figuris. 175
quae non incudes streperent,
 quae flamma vacaret
fabrilis, quantis fluerent
 fornacibus aera
effigies ductura tuas, quis
 devisus esset

snatch at such glory whom hollow
gifts inspired by fear can beguile and
who despairs of a people's love. He
who in truth deserves can alone
afford to despise them.

Embassies arrive from every quarter
and in the presence of thy son-in-law
pray for a hundred voices to herald
thy renown. The Gallic envoy gives
thee thanks for that, safe from attack
though no legion guards his frontier,
and fearing no hostile

angulus aut regio^[16] quae non pro
 numine vultus
 dilectos coleret, talem ni
 semper honorem 180
 respueres? decus hoc rapiat,
 quem falsa timentum
 munera decipiunt, qui se diffidit
 amari.
 hoc solus sprevisse potest, qui
 iure meretur.
 Undique legati properant
 generique sub ore
 in tua centenas optant praeconia
 voces. 185
 grates Gallus agit, quod limite
 tutus inermi
 et metuens hostile nihil nova
 culmina totis

[17]

incursion, he builds new dwelling-
 places along the banks of the Rhine
 and fringes the river, famed once for
 the savagery of its tribes, with
 houses as pleasant as those by
 Tiber's stream. Here Carthaginians
 crown thy praise, because they
 possess their lands delivered from
 the tyrant's rule; there the
 Pannonian, freed from the blockade,
 and he who drinks the Save, grateful
 because he now dare throw open the
 gates of cities closed for so many
 years. Such sharpen once more upon
 the whetstone their sickles dark with
 rust and cause their mattocks, foul
 with want of use, to shine as of old.
 Each sees again his well-
 remembered cottage, kisses his
 native hills, and can scarce believe
 real the furrows cut by his heavy
 plough. He hews down the forests
 and renders again fit for cultivation
 fields which generations had let run
 wild. Once more he covers the banks
 of the Danube with vineyards and
 rejoices to pay the taxes his
 forefathers paid, for it was bloodshed
 that brought immunity. While thou
 art safe, heaven allows the harassed
 body of our distracted empire to
 regain its youthful vigour. Thou dost
 restore all that we have lost of old
 under so many princes. Only when
 Stilicho's hand brings remedy can
 grow a scar to hide Roman wounds,

aedificat ripis et saevum
gentibus amnem
Thybridis in morem domibus
praevelat amoenis.
hinc Poeni cumulant laudes,
quod rura tyranno 190
libera possideant; hinc
obsidione solutus
Pannonius potorque Savi, quod
clausa tot annis
oppida laxatis ausus iam
pandere portis
rursum cote novat nigras
rubigine falces
exesosque situ cogit splendere
ligones 195
agnoscitque casas et collibus
oscula notis
figit et impresso glaebis non
credit aratro,
exsectis, [3] inculta dabant quas
saecula, silvis
restituit terras et opacum vitibus
Histrum
conserit et patrium vectigal
solvere gaudet, 200
inmunis qui clade fuit. te
sospite fas est
vexatum laceri corpus
iuvenescere regni.
sub tot principibus quaecumque
amisimus olim,
tu reddis. solo poterit Stilichone
medente
crescere Romanum vulnus
tectura cicatrix; 205
inque suos tandem fines

and when at last the husbandman of
Illyria returns to his farms the
treasury will again be enriched with
Illyrian tribute.

But heaven's judgement is not a whit
behind man's favour. The gods unite
for thine especial protection and
deliver thine enemy into thy hands
upon the sea shore or hinder his
flight by the ocean's immense barrier
or make him turn his arms madly
against himself; and so, a second
Pentheus, he is hewn in

^[3] *Birt suggests exsecusque.*
Illyricis iterum ditabitur aula
tributis.

Nec tamen humano cedit
caeleste favori
iudicium: cingunt superi
concordibus unum
praesidiis hostesque tuos aut
litore produnt 210
aut totum oppositi claudunt
fugientibus aequor
aut in se vertunt furiis aut
militis ense

pieces by his own soldier's frenzied blades. The gods discover for thee plots against thy life and lead thee to the very lair of treason, even as Molossan hounds guide the huntsman with their subtle scent. They show forth the future by omens or by birds or they deign to give thee clear warning in dreams.

For which thing's sake countless lands in rivalry have sought for thee the consul's robe, but thou thyself didst oppose their desire, and thy mind, so ready to grant favour to another, so rigorous a critic of itself, kindling with the torch of modesty, with bashful pleading deprecates that late reward. And so, anxious to see accomplished the hopes, vainly conceived through so many years, of seeing in thee their new consul, they hasten to the gates of royal Rome, determined, should she not listen to their entreaties, to constrain her hesitation, and prepared to sweep away all hindrances that delay their prayer. They meet at the temple of the goddess that shines bright upon the Palatine.^[4] First to speak was Spain, her head crowned with a grey-leaved garland from Minerva's olive and golden Tagus woven into her shining robe: "Everything that I have ever asked of Stilicho he has granted me, and has begrudged only

bacchati laniant Pentheo
corpora ritu;
insidias retegunt et in ipsa
cubilia fraudum
ducunt ceu tenera venantem
nare Molossi. 215
ominibus ventura notant aut
alite monstrant
aut monitos certa dignantur
imagine somnos.
Pro quibus innumerae
trabearum insignia
terrae
certatim petiere tibi.
poscentibus ipse
restiteras et mens, aliorum
prona favori, 220
iudex dura sui, facibus succensa
pudoris
tarda verecundis excusat
praemia causis.
ergo avidae tantosque novi spe
consulis annos
elusae dominae pergunt ad
limina Romae,
si minus adnuerit precibus, vel
cogere certae 225
cunctantem votoque moras
auferre paratae.
conveniunt ad tecta deae, quae
candida lucent
monte Palatino. glaucis tum
prima Minervae
nexa comam foliis fulvaeque
intexta micantem
veste Tagum tales profert
Hispania voces: 230
“Cuncta mihi semper

honour for himself. Once he found it in his heart to refuse the consulship at the hands of an emperor, his father-in-law; he now refuses it also from his son-in-law. If not as a guardian from the world he rules, at least let him receive it as a kinsman from his emperor. Counts he it a small thing that, taking my offspring to his arms, he so upholds my grandsons^[5] in their undisturbed rule, that the purple ennobles their native Baetis? That by means of fair Maria he dowers

[4] The temple, that is, of the goddess Roma.

[5] Arcadius and Honorius who, as sons of Theodosius, the Spaniard, are grandsons of Spain.

Cuncta mihi semper
Stilicho,^[20] quaecumque
poposci,
concessit tantumque suos
invidit honores.
Augusti potuit soceri
contemnere fasces:
iam negat et genero. si non ut
ductor ab orbe
quem regit, accipiat saltem
cognatus ab aula. 235
exiguumne putat, quod sic
amplexus Hiberam
progeniem nostros inmoto iure
nepotes
sustinet, ut patrium commendet
purpura Baetim?
quod pulchro Mariae fecundat
germine regnum?

[21]

Rome with a dynasty? That he is
looked to as the ancestor of kings?"

Then warlike Gaul, her hair combed
back, a rich necklace about her neck,
and javelins twain in her hands, thus
spake with kindling heart: "Why is
his title not yet read in the annals of
Rome, who by his own might
o'ercame for me the Germans and
the Franks? Why is the page of
history still ignorant of a name that
by now should have been inscribed
therein so often? Is, then, bringing
peace to the Rhine so light a title to
fame?"

Next spake Britain clothed in the
skin of some Caledonian beast, her
cheeks tattooed, and an azure cloak,
rivalling the swell of ocean,
sweeping to her feet: "Stilicho gave
aid to me also when at the mercy of
neighbouring tribes, what time the
Scots roused all Hibernia against me
and the sea foamed to the beat of
hostile oars. Thanks to his care I had
no need to fear the Scottish arms or
tremble at the Pict, or keep watch
along all my coasts for the Saxon
who would come whatever wind
might blow."

Then up spake Africa, her hair gay
with wheat ears and an ivory comb
and her face all sun-burned: "I hoped
that after Gildo's death no obstacle

quod dominis speratur avus?”

240

Tum

flava repexo

Gallia crine ferox evinctaque
torque decoro

binaque gaesa tenens animoso
pectore fatur:

“qui mihi Germanos solus
Francosque subegit,
cur nondum legitur fastis? cur
pagina tantum
nescit adhuc nomen, quod iam
numerare decebat? 245
usque adeone levis pacati gloria
Rheni?”

Inde Caledonio velata
Britannia monstro,
ferro picta genas, cuius vestigia
verrit

caerulus Oceanique aestum
mentitur amictus:
“me quoque vicinis pereuntem
gentibus” inquit 250

“munivit Stilicho, totam cum
Scottus Hivernen
movit et infesto spumavit
remige Tethys.
illius effectum curis, ne tela
timerem

Scottica, ne Pictum tremere,
ne litore toto
prospicerem dubiis venturum
Saxona ventis.” 255

Tum spicis et dente comas
inlustris eburno
et calido rubicunda die sic
Africa fatur:

could prevent Stilicho’s acceptance of the consulship. Does he even yet refuse and hesitate to honour with the fasces so great a triumph—he who has enabled me utterly to forget the tearful name of Moor?”

After these came Italy, pliant vine and ivy interlacing on her head, pressing the wine from plentiful ripe grapes. Said she: “If you are thus eager that Stilicho should augment the dignity of the curule chair, you to whom the mere report can bring delight, how much more rightly does a longing

AMICA LATUI.

“sperabam nullas^[22] trabeis
Gildone perempto
nasci posse moras. etiam nunc
ille repugnat
et tanto dubitat fasces praebere
triumpho, 260
qui mihi Maurorum penitus
lacrimabile nomen
ignorare dedit?”

Post has
Oenotria lentis
vitibus intorquens hederas et
palmite largo
vina fluens: “si vos adeo
Stilichone curules
augeri flagratis” ait “quas sola
iuvare 265
fama potest, quanto me dignius
incitat ardor,

[23]

inspire me to enjoy his presence, to attend him as he mounts his seat and to salute his opening of the new year’s course?”

One after another they pour forth these entreaties and beg Rome to approach Stilicho in the name of them all. Right swiftly she obeyed their behest and seizing at once her arms winged her way quicker than a shooting star through the clouds of heaven. Over Etruria she flew, grazed the Apennines in her flight, and lit Eridanu’s wave with the reflexion of her shield. She stood before the general, imposing as mighty Pallas, terrible as Mars. The palace trembled at the glitter of her aegis and her helmet plumes brushed the pannelled ceiling. Then as he stood astonished she first addressed him with flattering reproaches: “I acknowledge, revered Stilicho, that thou hast saved but not yet brought honour to the curule chair. Of what avail to have rid the year of the brand of slavery? Dost thou defend a dignity thou shunnest? scorn what with all thy might thou madest? reject when offered what thou didst save when falling? Why dost thou hold back? Why disappoint my prayers? No danger threatens from the north, the south is quiet; the Moors have been subdued, Germany

ut praesente fruar
 conscendentemque
 tribunal
 prosequar atque anni
 pandentem claustra
 salutem?"
 Talibus alternant studiis
 Romamque precantes,
 pro cunctis, hortantur, eat. nec
 segnius illa 270
 paruit officio, raptis sed
 protinus armis
 ocior excusso per nubila sidere
 tendit.
 transvehitur Tuscos
 Appenninusque volatu
 stringitur. Eridanus clipei iam
 fulgurat umbra;
 constitit ante ducem tetrica nec
 Pallade vultum 275
 deterior nec Marte minor. tremit
 orbe corusco
 iam domus et summae tangunt
 laquearia cristae:
 tum prior attonitum gratis
 adfata querellis:
 "Servatas, Stilicho, per te,
 venerande, curules,
 ornatas necdum fateor. quid
 profuit anni 280
 servilem pepulisse notam?
 defendis honorem
 quem fugis, et spernis tota
 quem mole tueris?
 respuis oblatum, pro quo
 labente resistis?
 quae iam causa morae? quo me
 cunctabere rursus

has yielded, profound peace holds
 fast the doors of Janu's temple. Am I
 not yet worthy to have thee for my
 consul? Can we believe that office
 unimportant and of slender dignity to
 hold which emperors think
 themselves honoured, that office by
 means of which I have caused
 conquered peoples and captive kings
 to pass beneath the yoke?

"If nature by her portents
 foreshadow coming ills I am not
 besmirched therewith. Nay, that thou

ingenio? nullus ^[24] Boreae metus,
omnis et Austri 285
ora silet: cecidit Maurus,
Germania cessit
et Ianum pax alta ligat. te
consule necdum
digna feror? titulumne levem
parvique nitoris
credimus, Augusti quo se
decorare fatentur,
sub iuga quo gentes captivis
regibus egi? 290
“Non, si prodigiis casus
natura futuros
signat, polluimur macula. quod
reris, Eois

[25]
countest ill omen was for the East.
Yet no facts confirm the tale I have
heard; Rumour's self scarce smiled
at such a tale of guilt. [Z] The disgrace
has no proof; no letter came to
divulge the wicked secret. In this lies
thine especial virtue, that, while
consulting the senate on every
question, thou hast not mentioned
this portent. No decree for the
suppression of this scandal has
impaired the dignity of this august
assembly, nor has that ill-omened
name been heard in my senate. To
have hesitated would have been to
share his guilt. All letters telling of
this profanation that came from the
far East were destroyed e'er they
could cross the sea, that fortune's
shameful turn should not offend the
chaste ears of Italy. That infatuation
of a people was best rewarded with
silence—and how strenuous were
thine endeavours that it should so be!
Joy should be his who needs no
longer pen the annals of the East.
Our Latin story knows no such blot:
let others take pains to conceal their
own disgrace. Why should I applaud
the downfall of one of whose
elevation I never heard nor knew?
'Tis for the guilty to repent; we have
never even believed.

“Yet had the guilt of all been one and
this pollution stained *our* axes, all

omen erat. quamquam nullis
 mihi cognita rebus
fabula; vix tanto risit de crimine
 rumor.
opprobrii stat nulla fides nec
 littera venit 295
vulgatura nefas: in quo vel
 maxima virtus
est tua quod, nostros qui
 consulis omnia patres,
de monstris taceas. pellendi
 denique nulla
dedecoris sanctum violant
 oracula coetum
nec mea funestum versavit curia
 nomen. 300
pars sceleris dubitasse fuit:
 quaecumque profana
pagina de primo venisset limine
 Phoebi,
ante fretum deleta mihi, ne
 turpia castis
auribus Italiae fatorum^[6]
 exempla nocerent.
publicus ille furor, quantum tua
 cura peregit, 305
secretum meruit. laetetur
 quisquis Eoos
scribere desierit fastos: portenta
 Gabinos
ista latent; propriam labem
 texisse laborent.
cur ego, quem numquam didici
 sensive creatum,
gratuler exemptum? delicti
 paenitet illos: 310
nos nec credidimus.

“Thou shalt

the more shouldst thou have taken
the high office thou dost shun lest
that ancient dignity—ever the goal
of all dignities—should be
destroyed. No consul, save Stilicho
alone, can repair that ruin. With what
foreknowledge had thy soul delayed
the hour: once it would have added
lustre unto thee, now thou dost add
lustre unto it. Do thou as consul wipe
out the insult offered to all consuls
that have been and yet shall be. Give
thy name to the year that posterity

^[7] Claudian is referring to the
consulship of Eutropius.

[6] *Birt prints factorum (EII), the other MSS. have omnibus unusque factorum (in the sense of "effeminate").*
crimen et ad nostras manaverit
usque secures:
plus ideo sumenda tibi fastigia
vitas,
ne pereat tam priscus honos, qui
portus honorum
semper erat. nullo sarciri
consule damnum 315
excepto Stilichone potest. bene
praescia tempus
mens tua distulerat; titulo tunc
crescere posses,
nunc per te titulus. consul
succurre gravatis
consulibus, quicumque fuit,
quicumque futurus;
annum redde tuum, quem iam
secura sequatur 320

may dwell thereafter securely, and that antiquity, thus vindicated, may cease from her complaints. Brutus was the founder of the office, let Stilicho be its avenger. Brutus, the first consul, won liberty for the Roman people by means of the consular fasces: Stilicho banished the taint of slavery from those fasces. Brutus instituted this supreme dignity; Stilicho saved it; and it is greater to preserve what already is than to create that which is not. Why do thy blushes grant so tardy an acceptance of our prayers? Why does the accustomed flush o'erspread thy brow? World-conqueror, conquer now thine own diffidence.

“Full well I know that no gift can seduce thee, yet be pleased to admire and receive this cloak, woven for thee on no mortal loom by Minerva and myself. Twice together have we dipped the thread that goes to make the cloth in purple dye and interwoven therewith that same gold of which Lachesis has woven the golden centuries that are to be mine beneath thy rule. See here I have prefigured thy destined progeny, those thy children for whom the world prays; soon shalt thou confess me a true prophet and coming fate prove that my embroidery is true.”

posteritas nec iam doleat
defensa vetustas.
sic trabeis ultor Stilicho
Brutusque repertor.
libertas populi primo tunc
consule Bruto
reddita per fasces; hic fascibus
expulit ipsis
servitium. instituit sublimem
Brutus honorem; 325
adseruit Stilicho. plus est
servasse repertum,
quam quaesisse novum. quid
tardius ore rubenti
adnuis et solitus frontem
circumfluit ignis?
tandem vince tuum, vincis qui
cuncta, pudorem.
“Hos etiam, quamvis
corrumpi munere nullo
330
te certum est, mirare libens ac
suscipe cinctus,
quos tibi divino mecum Tritonia
duxit
pectine: tincta simul repetito
murice fila
contulimus pensis et eodem
nevimus auro,
aurea quo Lachesis sub te mihi
saecula texit. 335
hic ego promissam subolem
sperataque mundo
pignora praelusi. veram mox
ipse probabis
me vatem nostraeque fidem
venientia telae
fata dabunt ”

She spake and drew from her bosom
the gift, a consul's cloak, stiff and
heavy with gold. The glorious woof
breathes Minerva's skill. Here is
depicted a palace with columns of
red marble and Maria's sacred
travail. Lucina eases her labour. On a
splendid couch lies the young
mother, by her side sits her own
mother, pale with anxiety yet happy
withal. The flower-crowned Nymphs
take up the babe and wash him in a
golden basin. Almost could one hear
rising from the embroidery the little
child's mingled laughter and wailing.
And now the babe

data uadunt.

Dixit^[28] gremioque
regentia profert
dona, graves auro trabeas.
insigne Minervam 340
spirat opus, rutilis hic pingitur
aula columnis
et sacri Mariae partus; Lucina
dolores
solatur; residet fulgente
puerpera lecto;
sollicitae iuxta pallescunt
gaudia matris.
susceptum puerum redimitae
tempora Nymphae 345
auri fonte lavant: teneros de
stamine risus
vagusque audire putes. iam
creverat infans

[29]

had grown up, recalling his father in countenance; Stilicho, riper in years, teaches his grandson, the emperor that is to be, the science of war. In another part Eucherius, the dawn of early manhood on his cheeks, rode his horse that flecked its silken reins with bloody foam. Woven himself of gold he smites with javelin or arrow the purple stags that raise their golden horns. Here Venus, borne in her dove-drawn chariot, unites for the third time the hero's family with the princely house^[8] and the winged Loves throng the affianced bride, daughter and sister of an emperor. Eucherius now lifts the veil from the bashful maiden's face; Thermantia smiles upon her brother's joy. This house now seeks the crown in the person of either sex, it gives birth to queens and the husbands of queens.

Such are the gifts wherewith the goddess sought to win Stilicho, handing to him at the same time the ivory staff.^[9] She shook the urn to obtain the customary signs and confirmed the beginning of his task by favourable auspices. Then she clothed with the vesture of Romulus those shoulders better accustomed to armour. The garb of Latium covers his breast and the toga graces what erstwhile the cuirass protected. Thus Mars, returning victorious from the

ore ferens patrem: Stilicho
 maturior aevi
 Martia recturo tradit praecepta
 nepoti.
 parte alia spumis fucantem
 Serica frena 350
 sanguineis primae signatus flore
 iuventae
 Eucherius flectebat equum
 iaculisque vel areu
 aurea purpureos tollentes
 cornua cervos
 aureus ipse ferit. Venus hic
 invecta columbis
 tertia regali iungit conubia
 nexus, 355
 pennatique nurum
 circumstipantur Amores
 progenitam Augustis
 Augustorumque
 sororem.
 Eucherius trepido iam flammea
 sublevat ore
 virginis; adridet retro
 Thermantia fratri.
 iam domus haec utroque petit
 diademata sexu 360
 reginasque parit reginarumque
 maritos.
 Talibus invitat donis
 dextraque gerendum
 diva simul porrexit ebur;
 sollemnibus urnam
 commovet auspiciis avibusque
 incepta secundat.
 tunc habiles armisumeros iam
 vestibus ambit 365
 Romuleis: Latii cederunt

Danube or the Scythian clime, a god
 of peace now his shield is laid aside,
 enters the city wearing the consul's
 cloak and in a chariot drawn by
 white horses; Quirinus directs the
 ample reins and Bellona marches
 before her father's car holding aloft
 the bloody oak-branch decked with
 the spoils won in single combat; Fear
 and his brother Terror are the lictors
 and cast chains of iron on the necks
 of captive

[8] Claudian seems to refer to the
 marriages (1) of Stilicho and Serena;
 (2) of Honorius and Maria (both, of
 course, accomplished facts); and (3) of
 Eucherius, son of Stilicho, and Placidia
 (the "nurus"), sister of Honorius. As a
 matter of fact Placidia subsequently
 married Ataulf, brother-in-law of
 Alaric.

[9] One of the insignia of the
 consulship.

ROMULUS, LAM. SECTUM

pectore^[30] cultus

loricaeque locum decuit toga.

talīs ab Histro

vel Scythico victor rediens

Gradivus ab axe

deposito mitis clipeo

candentibus urbem

ingreditur trabeatus equis;

spatiosa Quirinus 370

frena regit currumque patris

Bellona cruentum

ditibus exuviis tendens ad

sidera quercum

praecedit, lictorque Metus cum

fratre Pavore

barbara ferratis innectunt colla

catenis

[31]

barbarians, their helmets wreathed
with laurel, while Panic, her robe
upgirt, walks by the yoke-horses,
brandishing a mighty battle-axe.

When Rome saw herself possessed
of the consul for whom she had
prayed, "Now," she said, "fain would
I hasten to the fields and woods of
Elysium to bear the news of this
wondrous answer to our universal
prayer to the Curii and Fabricii who
have wept for the dignity of the
consul's toga so lately outraged. Let
them now tread the meads in joyous
dance and the austere Catos not
blush to join their sport. Let the elder
Brutus hear the news and the
Scipios, terror of Carthage, learn that
by one man's help I have been
rescued from a double danger and
have recovered both Libya and the
fasces. One thing only is left, and do
thou, brave consul, add it to my
prayers—bestow awhile that
presence she entreats upon the city
which thou hast rescued from war
and famine, and restored to the
overlordship of the world. Let our
famous rostrum welcome a second
Camillus and our citizens look upon
their avenger and saviour, ay, and the
common people whom thou, their
leader, lovest, the people to whom
Africa, because of thee, offers her
harvests and the Rhone her crops till

velati galeas lauro, propiusque
iugales 375
formido ingentem vibrat
succincta securim.
Vidit ut optato se consule
Roma potitam:
“nunc” ait “Elysii lucos
inrumpere campi,
nunc libet, ut tanti Curiis
miracula voti
Fabriciisque feram, famae qui
vulnere nuper 380
calcatam Severe togam: iam
prata choreis
pulsent nec rigidos pudeat
luisse Catones.
audiat hoc senior Brutus
Poenisque tremendi
Scipiadae, geminis tandem
quod libera damnis
unius auxilio fasces Libyamque
recepi. 385
quod superest unum precibus,
fortissime consul,
adde meis, urbique tuum largire
parumper,
quem rogat, adventum, quam tu
belloque fameque
depulsa terris iterum regnare
dedisti.
splendida suscipiant alium te
rostra Camillum, 390
ultorem videant servatoremque
Quirites
et populus quem ductor ames:
quibus Africa per te
nec prius auditas Rhodanus iam
donat aristas

now unheard of, whereby Libyan
fields and Gallic abundance are at
my service and now the rainy south-
wind and now the north wafts grain
to my shores and my granaries are
full whatever breeze may blow.

“What thousands will then throng
the Flaminian Way! How often will
the deceptive dust disappoint the
loving expectation of those who trust
to see thee arrive every minute!
Anxiously our mothers watch for
thee; every road will be strewn with
flowers

uoniat anstias,
 ut mihi vel Massyla Ceres vel
 Gallica prosit
 fertilitas messesque vehat nunc
 umidus Auster, 395
 nunc Aquilo, cunctis ditescant
 horrea ventis.
 “Quae tunc Flaminiam
 stipabunt milia vulgi!
 fallax o quotiens pulvis deludet
 amorem
 suspensum, veniens omni dum
 crederis hora!
 spectabunt cupidae matres,
 spargentur et omnes 400
 flore viae, superet cum Pincia
 culmina consul

[33]

while the consul, true image of
 Rome's ancient senate, climbs the
 steep summit of the Pincian hill.
 What applause from the theatre of
 Pompey! How often will the
 Murcian valley raise to heaven thy
 name re-echoed by Aventine and
 Palatine! Leave the camp and let me
 behold thee now, soon to see thee,
 consul for a second time, along with
 thy son-in-law.”

While Rome so spake, Fame, on
 wings of rumour, flies over the sea
 and with her thousand tongues bids
 the chiefs speed to the capital. Not
 one can age hold back, nor the long
 journey, nor the Alp's wintry blasts;
 Love wins the victory. Veterans
 whom the fasces ennobled long since
 hasten to greet the year of their
 colleague and avenger. So when by
 that birth in death the Phoenix
 renews its youth and gathers its
 father's ashes and carries them
 lovingly in its talons, winging its
 way, sole of its kind, from the
 extreme east to Nile's coasts, the
 eagles gather together and all the
 fowls from every quarter to marvel
 at the bird of the sun; afar its living
 plumage shines, itself redolent of the
 spices of its father's fragrant pyre.

There is like joy in heaven: the two
 Theodosii and thine own protecting
 deities are glad; the Sun himself,

arduus, antiqui species Romana
senatus.

Pompeiana dabunt quantos
proscenia plausus!
ad caelum quotiens vallis tibi
Murcia ducet
nomen Aventino Pallanteoque
recussum! 405
nunc te conspiciam castris,
permittite, relictis
mox et cum genero trabeis
visura secundis.”

Haec dum Roma refert, iam
Fama loquacibus alis
pervolat Oceanum, linguis et
mille citatos
festinare iubet proceres,
nullique senectus, 410
non iter hibernis obstant nec
flatibus Alpes:
vincit amor. meriti pridem
clarique vetustis
fascibus ad socii properant et
vindictis annum.
sic ubi fecunda reparavit morte
iuventam
et patrios idem cineres
collectaque portat 415
unguibus ossa piis Nilique ad
litora tendens
unicus extremo Phoenix
procedit ab Euro:
conveniunt aquilae cunctaeque
ex orbe volucres,
ut Solis mirentur avem; procul
ignea lucet
ales, odorati redolent cui
cinnama busti 420

decking his chariot with spring
flowers, prepares a year worthy of
thee.

Far away, all unknown, beyond the
range of mortal minds, scarce to be
approached by the gods, is a cavern
of immense age, hoary mother of the
years, her vast breast at once the
cradle and the tomb of time. A
serpent^[10] surrounds this cave,
engulfing everything with slow but
all-devouring jaws; never ceases the
glint of his green scales. His mouth
devours the back-bending tail as
with silent movement he traces his
own beginning. Before

^[10] Eternity, in the sense of endless
time, was pictured by the Egyptians as
a snake devouring its own tail; *cf.* Plut.
De Is. et Osir. i. 2, p. 5.

Nec minor in ^[34]caelo chorus
 est; exultat uterque
 Theodosius divique tui; Sol ipse
 quadrigis
 vere coronatis dignum tibi
 praeparat annum.
 Est ignota procul nostraeque
 impervia menti,
 vix adeunda deis, annorum
 squalida mater, 425
 inmensi spelunca aevi, quae
 tempora vasto
 suppeditat revocatque sinu.
 complectitur antrum,
 omnia qui placido consumit
 numine, serpens
 perpetuumque viret squamis
 caudamque reductam
 ore vorat tacito relegens exordia
 lapsu. 430

the entrance sits Nature, guardian of the threshold, of age immense yet ever lovely, around whom throng and flit spirits on every side. A venerable old man writes down immutable laws: he fixes the number of stars in each constellation and causes these to move and those to be at rest, whereby everything lives or dies by pre-ordained laws. 'Tis he decides Mar's uncertain orbit, Jupiter's fixed course through the heaven, the swift path of the moon, and the slow march of Saturn; he limits the wanderings of Venu's bright chariot and of Mercury, Phoebu's companion.

When the Sun rested upon the spacious threshold of this cavern dame Nature ran to meet him and the old man bent a hoary head before his proud rays. The adamantine door swung open of its own accord and revealed the vast interior, displaying the house and the secrets of Time. Here in their appointed places dwell the ages, their aspect marked by varying metals: there are piled those of brass; here those of iron stand stiff; there the silver ones gleam bright. In a fairer part of the cave, shy of contact with the earth, stood the group of golden years; of these Phoebus chooses the one of richest substance to be marked with the

vestibuli custos vultu longaeva
decoro
ante fores Natura sedet,
cunctisque volantes
dependent membris animae.
mansura verendus
scribit iura senex, numeros qui
dividit astris
et cursus stabilesque moras,
quibus omnia vivunt 435
ac pereunt fixis cum legibus.
ille recenset,
incertum quid Martis iter
certumque Tonantis
prospiciat mundo; quid velox
semita Lunae
pigraque Saturni; quantum
Cytherea sereno
curriculo Phoebique comes
Cyllenius erret. 440
Illius ut magno Sol limine
constitit antri,
occurrit Natura potens
seniorque superbis
canitiem inclinat radiis. tum
sponte reclusus
laxavit postes adamas, penetrabile
profundum
panditur et sedes aevique arcana
patescunt. 445
hic habitant vario facies
distincta metallo
saecula certa locis: illic
glomerantur aena,
hic ferrata rigent, illic argentea
candent.
eximia regione domus,
contingere terris

name of Stilicho. Then, bidding the rest follow behind him, he addresses them thus as they pass. "Lo! the consul is at hand for whom we have delayed an age of nobler ore. Go ye, years long prayed for by man, bring back virtue; let genius flourish once more; may Bacchus give you joy and fruitful Ceres bless you. Let not the constellation of the Serpent breathe forth too icy an air from between the two Ploughing Oxen nor the Bear vent his excessive

CONINGERE TENIS
 difficilis, rutili stabat grex
 non toto tremat ore Leo, nec
 quorum praecipuum pretioso
 urat atrox aestas, madidae nec
 signandum Stilichone legit;
 semina praerupto dissolvat
 pone sequi dictisque simul
 Phrixus roseo producat fertile
 cornu
 “En, cui distulimus melioris
 ver Aries, pingues nec grandine
 consul adest, ite optati
 mortalibus anni
 deducite virtutes; hominum
 lenior et gravioris addatet Sirius
 ingeniis, hilares Baccho
 frugumque feraces
 non inter gminos Anguis
 ingreditur valemque suam,
 sibilet, immodico nec frigore
 rivus et murgis largum iubar
 ingerit herbis,
 quas Solis pascuntur equi;
 flagrantibus inde
 caesariem sertis et lutea lora
 iubasque
 subligat alipedum. gelidas hinc
 Lucifer ornat,
 hinc Aurora comas iuxtaque
 adludit habenis
 aureus et nomen praetendit
 consulis Annus:
 inque novos iterum revoluto
 cardine cursus
 scribunt aetheriis Stilichonem
 sidera fastis.

[37]

cold; let not the Lion rage with his
 gaping maw nor pitiless summer
 inflame the claws of Cancer. Let not
 Aquarius, too prodigal of his rainy
 urn, flood the young seedlings with
 sudden storms. Let Phrixu's ram, his
 horns twined with roses, extend the
 fertile spring and let not the Scorpion
 beat down the ripe olives with his
 hail. Let the Virgin mature the fruits
 of Autumn and the Dog-star, more
 gentle than his wont, refrain from
 barking at the heavy grape-clusters."

So saying he entered his garden
 starred with fiery dew, the valley
 round which runs a river of flame
 feeding with its bounteous rays the
 dripping weeds whereon the horses
 of the sun do pasture. Here he
 gathers fragrant flowers wherewith
 he decks the heads, the golden reins,
 and manes of his steeds. With leaves
 from hence Lucifer and Aurora
 entwine their oozy locks. Hard by
 the golden year, displaying the
 consul's name, smiles upon his
 chariot, and the stars, recommencing
 their courses, inscribe the name of
 Stilicho in the annals of the sky.

[\[11\]](#) ore Π ; the other MSS. give igne.
But ore better corresponds with
brachia.

DE CONSULATU STILICHONIS

LIBER TERTIUS PRAEFATIO

(XXIII.)

ON STILICHO'S CONSULSHIP

BOOK III PREFACE

(XXIII.)

The elder Scipio, who single-handed turned the Punic wars back from Italy's coasts to their own home, fought not his battles unmindful of the Muse's art; poets were ever the hero's special care. For valour is always fain to seek alliance with the Muses that they may bear witness to her deeds; he loves song whose exploits deserve the meed of song. Therefore, whether to avenge his sire's^[12] death the young warrior brought into subjection the Spanish seas or embarked upon the Libyan wave his dreadful standards, resolved to break with sure spear the strength of Carthage, the poet Ennius was ever at his side and in all his campaigns followed the trumpet's call into the midst of the fray. Him after the battle the soldiers loved to hear sing, and the trooper, still dripping with blood, would applaud his verses. When Scipio had triumphed over either Carthage—over the one to avenge his sire, over the other his fatherland—and when at last, after the

Maior Scipiades, Italis qui solus
ab oris
in proprium vertit Punica
bella caput,
non sine Pieriis exercuit artibus
arma:
semper erat vatū maxima
cura duci.
gaudet enim virtus testes sibi
iungere Musas; 5
carmen amat quisquis
carmine digna gerit.
ergo seu patriis primaevus
manibus ultor
subderet Hispanum legibus
Oceanum,
seu Tyrias certa fracturus
cuspidē vires
inferret Libyco signa
tremenda mari, 10
haerebat doctus lateri castrisque
solebat
omnibus in medias Ennius ire
tubas,
illi post lituos pedites favere
canenti
laudavitque nova caede
cruentus eques.
cumque triumpharet gemina
Carthagine victa 15
(hanc vindex patri vicerat,
hanc patriae),

[12] P. Cornelius Scipio (cos. 218 B.C.) was defeated and killed by Hasdrubal in Spain in 211 B.C. The famous P. Cornelius Scipio Africanus was the younger of his two sons.

[40]

cum longi Libyam tandem post
 funera belli
 ante suas maestam cogeret ire
 rotas:
advexit reduces secum Victoria
 Musas
 et sertum vati Martia laurus
 erat. 20
Noster Scipiates Stilicho,
 quo concidit alter
Hannibal antiquo saevior
 Hannibale,
te mihi post quintos annorum
 Roma recursus
reddidit et votis iussit adesse
 suis.

[41]

disasters of a long war, he drove
weeping Libya a captive before his
chariot wheel, Victory brought back
the Muses in her train and Mar's
laurel crowned the poet's brow.

Thee, Stilicho, our new Scipio,
conqueror of a second Hannibal
more terrible than the first,—thee
after five long years Rome has given
back to me and bidden me celebrate
the completion of her vows.

LIBER TERTIUS

(XXIV.)

BOOK III

(XXIV.)

Behold, O Rome, the hero whose presence the cries of thy people and the voice of thy nobles has long demanded. Cease now to count the stages of his long journey and to rise as though to greet him at the sight of every storm of dust; no further shall uncertainty torment thee. Full before thine eye is he who was long before thy mind, greater than thy hopes, more glorious than his fame. Honour thou the consul who has restored its dignity to the consulship; grasp the hand which has made the Carthaginians pass once more under the Roman yoke. Welcome the noble heart that directs the reins of empire and secures by its providence the equipoise of the world. Look with joy upon the sacred face thou worshippest cast in bronze and adorest in gold. Behold the warrior successful in every field, the defender of Africa, the conqueror of Rhine and Danube.

Should he wish in accordance with ancient custom to display the picture of his labours and show to the people the tribes he has subdued, crowns of laurel from north and south would contend in equally matched rivalry.

Quem populi plausu, procerum
 quem voce petebas,
adspice, Roma, virum. iam
 tempora desine longae
dinumerare viae visoque
 adsurgere semper
pulvere: non dubiis ultra
 torquebere votis.
totus adest oculis, aderat qui
 mentibus olim, 5
spe maior, fama melior.
 venerare curulem,
quae tibi restituit fasces;
 complectere dextram,
sub iuga quae Poenos iterum
 Romana redegit.
excipe magnanimum pectus,
 quo frena reguntur
imperii, cuius libratur sensibus
 orbis. 10
os sacrum, quod in aere colis,
 miraris in auro,
cerne libens: hic est felix
 bellator ubique,
defensor Libyae, Rheni pacator
 et Histri.
Ostentare suos prisco si more
 labores
et gentes cuperet vulgo
 monstrare subactas, 15
certassent utroque pares a
 cardine laurus:
haec Alamannorum spoliis,
 Australibus illa
ditior exuviis; illinc flavente
 Sygambri

Here is a triumph rich with the spoils
of the Germans, there with those of
the South; here would pass the
Sygambri with their yellow

locks, there the black-haired Moors. He himself would be drawn in a laurel-decked chariot by white horses, and followed by his soldiers chanting their festive songs. Some would lead captive kings, others carry conquered towns wrought in bronze or mountains or rivers. Here would go in sad procession the river-gods of Libya, their horns broken, there Germany and the Rhine god in chains. Yet is not thy consul, O Rome, an unbridled boaster of his own prowess. 'Tis not the rewards of toil but the toil itself that he loves. He scorns empty applause and celebrates a happier triumph in the hearts of his fellow-citizens.

Of a surety the citadel of Rome has never welcomed home any of her generals with greater magnificence, no, not even Fabricius when he returned after the surrender of Pyrrhus, nor Aemilius Paulus, conqueror of Pella's king, when he ascended the Capitol in his chariot. No such triumph as this threw open the gates of Rome to Marius after his conquest of Numidia or to Pompey after his victories in the East. Each of these suffered from a rival faction that murmured uneasily against their success, and envy pursued their actions, no matter how noble, with spiteful stings. Stilicho alone was

caesarie, nigris hinc Mauri
 crinibus irent.
ipse albis veheretur equis
 currumque secutus 20
laurigerum festo fremuisset
 carmine miles.
hi famulos traherent reges; hi
 facta metallo
oppida vel montes captivaque
 flumina ferrent.
hinc Libyci fractis lugerent
 cornibus amnes;
inde catenato gemeret
 Germania Rheno. 25
sed non inmodicus proprii
 iactator honoris
consul, Roma, tuus. non illum
 praemia tantum
quam labor ipse iuvat; strepitus
 fastidit inanes
inque animis hominum pompa
 meliore triumphat.
Non alium certe Romanae
 clarius arces 30
suscepere ducem, nec cum
 cedente rediret
Fabricius Pyrrho nec cum
 Capitolia curru
Pellaeae domitor Paullus
 conscenderet aulae.
nec similis Latias patefecit
 gloria portas
post Numidas Mario, post
 classica Martis Eoi 35
Pompeio. nulli pars aemula
 defuit umquam,
quae gravis obstreperet laudi,
 stimulisque malis

raised above the range of envy and the measure of mankind. For who could be jealous of the star's eternity, of Jove's ancient rule in heaven, of Phoebu's omniscience^[13]? There are some merits so transcendent that furious envy's bounds cannot contain them. Moreover, those other heroes owed a divided allegiance: one gained the favour of the nobles, but was hated of the people, one, supported by the suffrage of the commons, enjoyed but faintly the favour of the

[13] Phoebus is said to "know everything" because, as the sun, he is the all-beholding (πανόπτης).

summi^[46]que manibus
 facta sequebatur quamvis
 ingentia livor:
 solus hic invidiae fines virtute
 reliquit
 humanumque modum. quis
 enim livescere possit, 40
 quod numquam pereant stellae?
 quod Iuppiter olim
 possideat caelum? quod noverit
 omnia Phoebus?
 est aliquod meriti spatium, quod
 nulla furentis
 invidiae mensura capit.
 ductoribus illis
 praeterea diversus erat favor:
 aequior ille 45
 patribus invisus plebi;
 popularibus illi
 munito studiis languebat gratia
 patrum.

[47]

senate. In Stilicho's case alone class rivalry has not raised its head: the knights welcome him with joy, the senate with enthusiasm, while the people's prayers rival the goodwill of the nobles.

Blessed mortal, whom the Rome that thou hast saved calls her father; darling of the world to whose banner flocks the whole of Gaul, whom Spain connects by marriage with the imperial house, for whose advent the citizens cried with ceaseless prayer, and whose presence the senate owed to thine illustrious son-in-law. Not such a girl's delight in flowers, not such the desire of the crops for rain, or of weary sailors for a prosperous breeze as is the longing of thy people for the sight of thee. Under no such influence as this do the prophetic laurels wave on Delo's coast when the brightness of Apollo's bow announces the deity's approach. Never did Pactolus' golden wave so swell in pride when Bacchus from conquered Ind visited his banks. Markest thou not how the roads cannot be seen for the people, the roofs for the matrons? Thanks to thy victories, Stilicho, salvation has dawned on all beyond their hopes. Look round on Rome's seven hills whose sheen of gold rivals the very sun's rays; see the arches decked

omnis in hoc uno variis
discordia cessit
ordinibus; laetatur eques
plauditque senator
votaque patricio certant plebeia
favori. 50

O felix servata vocat quem
Roma parentem!
o mundi communis amor, cui
militat omnis
Gallia, quem regum thalamis
Hispania nectit,
cuius et adventum crebris
petiere Quirites
vocibus et genero meruit
praestante senatus! 55
non sic virginibus flores, non
frugibus imbres,
prospera non fessis optantur
flamina nautis,
ut tuus adspectus populo. quae
numine tanto
litora fatidicas attollunt Delia
laurus,
venturi quotiens adfulsit
Apollinis arcus? 60
quae sic aurifero Pactoli fonte
tumescit
Lydia, cum domitis adparuit
Euhius Indis?
nonne vides et plebe vias et
tectata latere
matribus? his, Stilicho, cunctis
inopina reluxit
te victore salus! septem
circumspice montes, 65
qui solis radios auri fulgore
laccunt

with spoil, the temples towering to
the sky, and all the buildings that
celebrate this signal triumph. Let
thine astonished glance measure the
magnitude of the city thou hast saved
and the immensity of thy services.
All this would live but in the
memory were the African still master
of the south.

It was the custom in campaigns of
olden time to crown with oak the
brow of him who by his valour had
put the enemy to flight and
succeeded in rescuing a fellow-
citizen from imminent death.

^[48]
indutosque arcus spoliis
 aequataque templa
nubibus et quidquid tanti
 struxere triumpho.
quantum profueris, quantam
 servaveris urbem,
attonitis metire oculis. haec
 fabula certe 70
cuncta forent, si Poenus adhuc
 incumberet Austro.
Mos erat in veterum castris,
 ut tempora quercu
velaret, validis fuso qui viribus
 hoste
casurum potuit morti subducere
 civem.

[49]

But to thee what civic crown can we
give for the salvation of so many
cities? Or what honours can
recompense thy deeds? Nor is it only
for her people's life that Rome owns
herself a debtor to thine arms, but
that so she might have sweeter
enjoyment of this glorious dawn she
has won back her ancient burden of
renown, her lost strength and her
conquered kingdoms. No longer do
her ambassadors kneel suppliant
before the proud East and beg that
Libya may be given back to her;
gone the shameful spectacle of our
city a suitor to her own slaves. No,
relying now on her native Latin
vigour, Rome under thy leadership
fights her own battles with Roman
spirit. She herself bids the standards
advance; the toga-clad consul directs
the future conqueror, and the eagles
wait upon the orders of the senate.
Of her own free choice hath Rome
bestowed on thee the consul's robe,
offered thee, her avenger, the curule
chair and compelled thee to adorn
her annals.

Nothing of her ancient dignity hath
she lost, no regret has she for the age
of republican freedom, since it is she
who bestows the consular honour,
she who gives the order for battle.
Nay, she sees the growth of her
power. Whose memory can recall a

at tibi quae poterit pro tantis
 civica reddi 75
moenibus? aut quantae
 pensabunt facta
 coronae?
nec solam populi vitam debere
 fatetur
armis Roma tuis; sed, quo
 iucundior esset
lucis honoratae fructus,
 venerabile famae
pondus et amissas vires et regna
 recepit. 80
iam non praetumidi supplex
 Orientis ademptam
legatis poscit Libyam
 famulosve precatur
(dictu turpe) suos: sed robore
 freta Gabino
te duce Romana tandem se
 vindicat ira.
ipsa iubet signis bellaturoque
 togatus 85
imperat et spectant aquilae
 decreta senatus.
ipsa tibi trabeas ultro dedit, ipsa
 curulem
obtulit ultori fastosque ornare
 coëgit.
 Nil perdit decoris prisci nec
 libera quaerit
saecula, cum donet fasces, cum
 proelia mandet; 90
seque etiam crevisse videt. quis
 Gallica rura,
quis meminit Latio Senonum
 servisse ligones?
aut quibus exemplis fecunda

time when the fields of Gaul and the
hoes of the Senones were at our
service? Has it ever happened before
that Tiber's wave has carried grain
from the fertile north over the
ploughing of whose fields the
Lingones have toiled? Such a harvest
not only fulfilled Rome's needs but
also demonstrated the greatness of
her power; it reminded the peoples
who was their mistress and brought
in triumph from those chill climes a
tribute never before paid.

This, too, augments the majesty of
Rome that the

aut quibus exemplis recunda

Thybris^[50] ab Arcto

vexit Lingonico sudatas vomere
messes?

illa seges non auxilium modo
praebuit urbi, 95

sed fuit indicio, quantum tibi,
Roma, liceret:

admonuit dominae gentes
instarque tropaei

rettulit ignotum gelidis vectigal
ab oris.

Hoc quoque maiestas
augescit plena Quirini,

[51]

chiefs of Libya tremble before the judgement-throne of our people, and that, his office ended, each governor must account under pain of death for all the corn the Carthaginian farmer has brought in, all that the rainy south-wind has dispatched to Rome. Those who of late uttered their proud judgements to broad domains here are cowed and tremble; those whom Africa held in dread Rome's forum sees accused.

Stilicho gives scope for the virtues of a bygone age and rouses a people, forgetful of their former glory, to resume their accustomed sovereignty, to make themselves feared, to tread powerful magistrates beneath their heel, to mete out to crime its due reward, to show mercy towards the erring, favour to the innocent, punishment to the guilty, and to exercise once more their native virtue of clemency.

He errs who thinks that submission to a noble prince is slavery; never does liberty show more fair than beneath a good king. Those he himself appoints to rule he in turn brings before the judgement-seat of people and senate, and gladly yields whether they claim reward for merit or seek for punishment. Now the purple lays aside its pride and disdains not to have judgement

rectores Libyae populo quod
iudice pallent 100
et post emeritas moderator
quisque secures
discrimen letale subit, quid
Poenus arator
intulerit, madidus quantum
transmiserit Auster.
ardua qui late terris responsa
dedere,
hic trepidant humiles; tremuit
quos Africa nuper, 105
cernunt rostra reos. cani
virtutibus aevi
materiam pandit Stilicho
populumque vetusti
culminis inmemorem
dominandi rursus in
usum
excitat, ut magnos calcet
metuendus honores,
pendat iustitia crimen, pietate
remittat 110
errorem purosque probet
damnetque nocentes
et patrias iterum clemens
exerceat artes.
Fallitur egregio quisquis sub
principe credit
servitium. numquam libertas
gratior extat
quam sub rege pio. quos
praeficit ipse regendis
115
rebus, ad arbitrium plebis
patrumque reducit
conceditque libens, meritis seu
praemia noscant

passed upon itself. Such were the principles of rule taught by Stilicho to his son-in-law, Honorius; 'twas thus he guided his youth with the reins of prudence, and with precepts such as these directed his tender years, a truer father to the emperor than Theodosius, his stay in war, his adviser in peace. Thanks to him dishonour is banished and our age blossoms with Rome's ancient virtues; thanks to him power, long degraded and all but transferred, [\[14\]](#) no longer, forgetful

[\[14\]](#) i.e. (apparently) to Constantinople. Throughout this confused passage Claudian seems to be labouring the point that now the capital of the West (Rome) is restored to an equal importance with that of the East (Constantinople).

praemia poscant
seu punire velint.^[52] posito iam
purpura fastu
de se iudicium non indignatur
haberi.
sic docuit regnare socer, sic
cauta iuventae 120
frena dedit, teneros sic moribus
induit annos
verior Augusti genitor, fiducia
belli,
pacis consilium: per quem
squalore remoto
pristina Romuleis infloruit
artibus aetas,
per quem fracta diu translataque
paene potestas 125

[53]

of itself, is exiled in lands of servitude but, returned to its rightful home, restores to Italy its victorious destiny, enjoys the promised auspices of its foundation and gives back its scattered limbs to the head of the empire.

Consul, all but peer of the gods, protector of a city greater than any that upon earth the air encompasseth, whose amplitude no eye can measure, whose beauty no imagination can picture, whose praise no voice can sound, who raises a golden head amid the neighbouring stars and with her seven hills imitates the seven regions of heaven, mother of arms and of law, who extends her sway o'er all the earth and was the earliest cradle of justice, this is the city which, sprung from humble beginnings, has stretched to either pole, and from one small place extended its power so as to be co-terminous with the sun's light. Open to the blows of fate while at one and the same time she fought a thousand battles, conquered Spain, laid siege to the cities of Sicily, subdued Gaul by land and Carthage by sea, never did she yield to her losses nor show fear at any blow, but rose to greater heights of courage after the disasters of Cannae and Trebia, and, while the enemy's

non oblita sui servilibus exulat
arvis,
in proprium sed ducta larem
victricia reddit
fata solo fruiturque iterum,
quibus haeserat olim,
auspiciis capitique errantia
membra reponit.
Proxime dis consul, tantae
qui prospicis urbi, 130
qua nihil in terris complectitur
altius aether,
cuius nec spatium visus nec
corda decorem
nec laudem vox ulla capit; quae
luce metalli
aemula vicinis fastigia conserit
astris;
quae septem scopulis zonas
imitatur Olympi; 135
armorum legumque parens quae
fundit in omnes
imperium primique dedit
cunabula iuris.
haec est exiguis quae finibus
orta tetendit
in geminos axes parvaeque a
sede profecta
dispersit cum sole manus. haec
obvia fatis 140
innumeras uno gereret cum
tempore pugas,
Hispanas caperet, Siculas
obsideret urbes
et Gallum terris prosterneret,
aequore Poenum,
numquam succubuit damnis et
territa nullo

fire threatened her, and her foe^[15]
smote upon her walls, sent an army
against the furthest Iberians. Nor did
Ocean bar her way; launching upon
the deep, she sought in another
world for Britons to be vanquished.
'Tis she alone who has received the
conquered into her bosom and like a
mother, not an empress, protected
the human race with a common
name, summoning those whom she
has defeated to share her citizenship
and drawing together distant races
with bonds of

[15] Hannibal.

vulnere post Cannas maior
 Trebiamque fremebat
 145
 et, cum iam premerent flammae
 murumque feriret
 hostis, in extremos aciem
 mittebat Hiberos
 nec stetit Oceano remisque
 ingressa profundum
 vincendos alio quaesivit in orbe
 Britannos.
 haec est in gremium victos quae
 sola recepit 150
 humanumque genus communi
 nomine fovit
 matris, non dominae ritu,
 civesque vocavit
 quos domuit nexuque pio
 longinqua revinxit.

[55]

affection. To her rule of peace we
 owe it that the world is our home,
 that we can live where we please,
 and that to visit Thule and explore its
 once dreaded wilds is but a sport;
 thanks to her all and sundry may
 drink the waters of the Rhone and
 quaff Orontes' stream, thanks to her
 we are all one people. Nor will there
 ever be a limit to the empire of
 Rome, for luxury and its attendant
 vices, and pride with sequent hate
 have brought to ruin all kingdoms
 else. 'Twas thus that Sparta laid low
 the foolish pride of Athens but to fall
 herself a victim to Thebes; thus that
 the Mede deprived the Assyrian of
 empire and the Persian the Mede.
 Macedonia subdued Persia and was
 herself to yield to Rome. But Rome
 found her strength in the oracles of
 the Sibyl, her vigour in the hallowed
 laws of Numa. For her Jove
 brandishes his thunderbolts; 'tis she
 to whom Minerva offers the full
 protection of her shield; to her Vesta
 brought her sacred flame, Bacchus
 his rites, and the turret-crowned
 mother of the gods her Phrygian
 lions. Hither to keep disease at bay
 came, gliding with steady motion,
 the snake whose home was
 Epidaurus, and Tiber's isle gave
 shelter to the Paeonian^[17] serpent
 from beyond the sea.

huius pacificis debemus
 moribus omnes,
 quod veluti patriis regionibus
 utitur hospes; 155
 quod sedem mutare licet; quod
 cernere Thylen
 lusus et horrendos quondam
 penetrare recessus;
 quod bibimus passim
 Rhodanum, potamus
 Orontem;
 quod cuncti gens una sumus.
 nec terminus umquam
 Romanae ditionis erit, nam
 cetera regna 160
 luxuries vitiis odiisque superbia
 vertit:
 sic male sublimes fregit
 Spartanus Athenas
 atque idem Thebis cecidit; sic
 Medus ademit
 Assyrio Medoque tulit
 moderamina Perses;
 subiecit Persen Macedo,
 cessurus et ipse 165
 Romanis. haec auguriis firmata
 Sibyllae,
 haec sacris animata Numae.
 huic^[16] fulmina vibrat
 Iuppiter; hanc tota Tritonia
 Gorgone velat.
 arcanas huc Vesta faces, huc
 orgia Bacchus
 transtulit et Phrygios genetrix
 turrita leones; 170
 huc defensurus morbos
 Epidaurius hospes
 contrivit aleas, trocha-

This is the city whom thou, Stilicho,
 and heaven guard, her thou
 protectest, mother of kings and
 generals, mother, above all, of thee.
 Here Eucherius first beheld the light,
 here the queen his mother showed
 the babe to his imperial grandsire
 who rejoiced to lift a grandson upon
 his knee and to let him crawl upon
 his purple robes. Rome had
 foreknowledge of his destined glory
 and was glad, for so dear a pledge
 would keep thee ever her faithful
 citizen.

But think not this people ungrateful
 nor such as

[\[17\]](#) i.e. Aesculapius. "Paeonian" from
 the Greek Παιών, the Healer.

repay, diacium, uacu
[16] Birt keeps the line of the better
MSS., coniectumque persundas
seu Roma tonat huic c
insula Paenium texit Tiberina

draconem.

Hanc tu cum superis, Stilicho
praeclare, tueris,
protegis hanc clipeo patriam
regumque ducumque 175
praecipueque tuam. dedit haec
exordia lucis
Eucherio puerumque ferens hic
regia mater
Augusto monstravit avo;
laetatus at ille
sustulit in Tyria reptantem veste
nepotem,
Romaque venturi gaudebat
praescia fati, 180
quod te iam tanto meruisset
pignore civem.
Nec tamen ingratum nec, qui
benefacta referre

knows not how to repay benefits. Turn but the pages of history and thou wilt find how often it has faced war for an ally's sake, how often bestowed as a gift on friendly monarchs lands won at the expense of Italian blood. Yet never were public thanks poured forth with such consent. For what prince has not sought with every blandishment to be called lord and father—titles which the amphitheatres echo back to thee day after day? Hail, consul, to thy new titles! Mars' people calls thee lord and Brutus gainsays them not; what till now no terror could compel Rome's free citizens to endure, they freely offered to their love for Stilicho. Wheresoever thy shining form is seen they haste to greet thee and raise to heaven thy name; nor is their wandering gaze ever sated with looking upon thee whom they love when thou interest the Circus in thy shining robes of gold or art present at the games or, seated on thine ivory throne, dispensest justice in the forum or, with thine attendant lictors, mountest the rostrum thronged with the dense and surging crowd.

But what were the acclamations of the great, how unfeigned their rejoicings when Victory, soaring aloft with outspread wings, herself

nesciat, hunc credas populum.
 si volvere priscos
annales libeat: quotiens hic
 proelia sumpsit
pro sociis! quotiens dono
 concessit amicis 185
regibus Ausonio quaesitas
 sanguine terras!
publica sed numquam tanto se
 gratia fudit
adsensu: quis enim princeps
 non omnibus egit
obsequiis dominum sese
 patremque vocari,
quod tibi continuis resonant
 convexa diebus? 190
macte novis consul titulis!
 Mavortia plebes
te dominum Bruto non
 indignante fatetur
et, quod adhuc nullo potuit
 terrore coacta
libertas Romana pati,
 Stilichonis amor
detulit. exultant avidi,
 quocumque decorus 195
conspiciare loco, nomenque ad
 sidera tollunt
nec vaga dilecto satiantur
 lumina vultu:
seu circum trabeis fulgentibus
 aureus intres,
seu celebres ludos, solio seu
 fultus eburno
cingas iure forum, denso seu
 turbine vulgi 200
circumfusa tuae consendant
 rostra secures

threw open her holy temple to the
hero? Maiden that lovest the green
bay, thou that art decked in robes of
triumph, guardian of our empire,
sole healer of our wounds, that
makest our toils as though they were
not, whether it pleaseth thee to dwell
amid the stars of Ariadne's crown or
nearer to the fervid Lion, whether
thou art seated on the lofty sceptre of
Jove or Pallas' shield or callest the
sighs of weary Mars, be ever present
to Latium and grant, goddess, the
prayers of thy senate. May Stilicho
often crown thy portals

IOSUA SECURES.

Quae vero procerum voces,
[58]
quam certa fuere
gaudia, cum totis exurgens
ardua pennis
ipsa duci sacras Victoria
panderet aedes!
o palma viridi gaudens et amica
tropaeis 205
custos imperii virgo, quae sola
mederis
vulneribus nullumque doces
sentire laborem,
seu tibi Dictaeae placuerunt
astra Coronae
seu magis aestivo sedes vicina
Leoni,
seu sceptrum sublime Iovis seu
Palladis ambis 210
aegida, seu fessi mulces
suspiria Martis,
adsis perpetuum Latio votisque
senatus
adnue, diva, tui. Stilicho tua
saepius ornet

[59]

and bear thee back with him to his armies. Accompany and bless him in war and give him back in robes of peace to our council-chambers. Always has he brought thee home in a spirit of mercy and kept thee kindly to the vanquished nor ever stained thy laurels with cruelty. He neither looks with disdain on his fellow-citizens nor harries the anxious city with his legionaries; but true consul now that the war is ended he comes accompanied only by his lictors nor seeks the useless protection of the sword, guarded only by a people's love.

Handling his great wealth in no niggard spirit he does not hesitate to double his lavish expenses and after giving wondrous games in honour of his soldiery and of Honorius reserves yet greater for Rome. They say that Jove at Minerva's birth showered gold upon lucky Rhodes; that while Bacchus forced an egress from his father's thigh Hermus grew pale and turned to that same metal; that Midas, fated to suffer hunger as a punishment for his greed, converted to shining gold everything that he touched. Be these stories true or false thy liberality exceeds the waters of Hermus, the touch of Midas, the Thunderer's shower. Thy hands, as prodigal of gifts as of

limina teque simul rediens in
castra reducat.
hunc bellis comitare favens,
hunc redde togatum 215
consiliis. semper placidis te
moribus egit
servavitque piam victis nec
polluit umquam
laurum saevitia. cives nec
fronte superba
despicit aut trepidam vexat
legionibus urbem;
sed verus patriae consul
cessantibus armis 220
contentus lictore venit nec
inutile quaerit
ferri praesidium solo munitus
amore.

Magnarum nec parcus opum
geminare profundas
distulit impensas, sed post
miracula castris
edita vel genero Romae maiora
reservat. 225
auratos Rhodiis imbres nascente
Minerva
indulsisse Iovem perhibent,
Bacchoque paternum
iam pulsante femur mutatus
palluit Hermus
in pretium, votique famem
passurus avari
ditabat rutilo quidquid Mida
tangeret auro; 230
fabula seu verum canitur: tua
copia vicit
fontem Hermi tactumque Midae
pluviamque Tonantis

daring deeds, o'ershadow the past
and will o'ershadow the future.
Should fire have melted the
countless mass of silver thou
bestowest as though it were the
cheapest of metals, lakes and rivers
of silver might have been formed.

Thou too, Latonia, queen alike of the
woods and of the stars, art moved by
no small care for Stilicho; thou
toilest to distinguish our spectacles
with the forest's noblest denizens,
and on the dizzy summits of Alpine
rocks layest aside thy bow and
summonest

privianque Romanus.
 obscurat veteres^[60] obscurabitque
 futuros
 par donis armisque manus: si
 solveret ignis
 quot dedit inmanes vili pro
 pondere massas 235
 argenti, potuere lacus et flumina
 fundi.
 Nec tibi, quae pariter silvis
 dominaris et astris,
 exiguam Stilicho movit,
 Latonia, curam:
 tu quoque nobilibus spectacula
 nostra laboras
 inlustrare feris summoque in
 vertice rupis 240
 Alpinae socias arcu cessante
 pudicas

[61]

thy virgin companions and the chaste
 band of thy quiver-bearing followers.
 Thither they come, their shoulders
 and arms bare, spears in their hands
 and arrows slung across their backs,
 beautiful though unadorned; red their
 cheeks, dusty and suffused with
 sweat; their fierce virginity betrays
 not their sex; disordered their hair;
 girdles twain prevent their dresses
 from flowing down below their
 knees. Golden-haired Leontodame
 precedes her comrades, Nebrophone,
 foster child of Mount Lycaeus,
 follows her, and Thero whose arrows
 hold Maenalus in subjection. Fiery
 Britomartis hastens from Cretan Ida
 and Lycaste, peer of the western
 winds in flight. There join them the
 twin sisters Hecaërge, terror of
 beasts, and Opis, deity beloved of
 hunters, Scythian maids; their
 preference for Delos^[18] over the
 frosts of the north made them
 goddesses and queens of the woods.
 These were the seven chiefs who
 came; there followed them a second
 band of Nymphs, Diana's lovely
 company, a hundred from Taygetus,
 a hundred from Cynthus' summit, a
 hundred more whose first home was
 beside the chaste waters of Ladon.
 When she saw these gathered
 together Delia thus began:

et pharetratarum comitum
 inviolabile cogis
 concilium. veniunt umeros et
 brachia nudae
 armataeque manus iaculis et
 terga sagittis,
 incomptae pulchraeque tamen;
 sudoribus ora 245
 pulverulenta rubent, sexum nec
 cruda fatetur
 virginitas; sine lege comae; duo
 cingula vestem
 crure tenus pendere vetant.
 praecedit amicas
 flava Leontodame, sequitur
 nutrita Lycaeο
 Nebrophone telisque domat
 quae Maenala Thero. 250
 ignea Cretaea properat
 Britomartis ab Ida
 et cursu Zephyris numquam
 cessura Lycaste.
 iungunt se geminae metuenda
 feris Hecaerge
 et soror, optatum numen
 venantibus, Opis
 progenitae Scythia: divas
 nemorumque potentes
 255
 fecit Hyperboreis Delos
 praelata pruinis.
 hae septem venere duces;
 exercitus alter
 Nympharum incedunt, acies
 formosa Dianae,
 centum Taygeti, centum de
 vertice Cynthi
 et totidem casto genuit quae

“Friends who hate the rites of
 wedlock even as I hate them, who
 scour the snowy mountains in virgin
 companies, mark you how the gods
 with unanimous favour glorify this
 year for Latium? How many herds of
 horses Neptune provides from every
 quarter of the world? How that none
 of my brother Apollo’s lyres can
 refrain from sounding the praises of
 Stilicho? From us too let Stilicho
 receive the favour we justly owe
 him; the task needs no javelin; let
 our arrows remain bloodless in our
 unopened quivers. Let every bow
 refrain from its

[18] *i.e.* they became goddesses
 through association with Diana whose
 chosen island was Delos.

et totidem casto genant quas
flumine^[62] Ladon. 260

has ubi collectas vidit, sic Delia
coepit:

“O sociae, mecum thalami
quae iura perosae
virgineo gelidos percurritis
agmine montes,
cernitis ut Latio superi
communibus orment
hunc annum studiis? quantos
Neptunus equorum 265
donet ab orbe greges? laudi
quod nulla canendae
fratris plectra vacent? nostram
quoque sentiat idem
quam meritis debemus opem.
non spicula poscit
iste labor; maneant clausis nunc
sicca pharetris,
omnis et a solitis noster
venatibus arcus 270

[63]

wanted hunting and the blood of our prey be spilled but in the arena. Not for now their death; close the glades with net and cages and lead the beasts captive; withhold your impatient arrows; spare the monsters of the forest whose death shall win applause for our consul. Divide and haste in every direction; my breathless course is towards the Syrtes; do you, Cretan Lycaste and Opis, bear me company. My purpose is to traverse the unfruitful desert; Mauretania has given ere now her animals to other consuls as a gift, to this consul alone she owes them as a conquered land owes tribute. While we track out the dread progeny of Libya do you hunt the glades and rocks of Europe. Let joy banish fear from the shepherd's breast and his pipe hymn Stilicho in the dreadless forests. As his laws have given peace to the cities so let his shows give peace to the mountains.”

She spake and straightway is borne from the leafy Alps across the sea. Hinds bow their necks to her chariot's yoke, hinds whom the dewy moon conceived in her fertile caverns beneath the threshold of the morning sky to be the glory of the goddess. White their skins as driven snow; gold marks their foreheads whence spring branching golden

temperet; in solam cruor hic
servetur harenam.
retibus et clatris dilata morte
tenendae
ducendaeque ferae. cupidas
arcete sagittas;
consulis in plausum casuris
parcite monstris.
acceleret divisa manus: mihi
cursus anhelas 275
tenditur ad Syrtes, mecum
Dictynna Lycaste
et comes Opis eat; steriles iuvat
ire per aestus:
namque feras aliis tellus
Maurusia donum
praebuit, huic soli debet sed
victa tributum.
dum nos horribiles Libyae
scrutamur alumnos, 280
Europae vos interea perquirite
saltus
et scopulos. posita ludat
formidine pastor
securisque canat Stilichonem
fistula silvis.
pacet muneribus montes qui
legibus urbes.”
Dixit et extemplo frondosa
fertur ab Alpe 285
trans pelagus; cervi currum
subiere iugales,
quos decus esse deae primi sub
limine caeli
roscida fecundis concepit Luna
cavernis:
par nitor intactis nivibus; frons
discolor auro

horns lofty as the tallest beech-trees.
Opis holds the reins. Lycaste carries
the fine-wrought nets and golden
snares, and deathless Molossian
hounds run barking about the chariot
amid the clouds. Five others thus
equipped (such were Diana’s orders)
hasten this way and that, each at the
head of her own company; there
follow them dogs of various shape,
breed and character; some whose
heavy jowls fit them for big game,
some swift of foot,

DISCOLOR AUTO
 germinat et spatib[64] summas
 aequantia fagos 290
 cornua ramoso surgunt procera
 metallo.
 Opis frena tenet, fert retia rara
 Lycaste
 auratasque plagas,
 immortalesque Molossi
 latrantes mediis circum iuga
 nubibus ibant.
 quinque aliae paribus (Phoebe
 sic iusserat) armis 295
 diversa regione ruunt ducitque
 cohortem
 quaeque suam. variae formis et
 gente sequuntur
 ingenioque canes. illae
 gravioribus aptae
 morsibus, hae pedibus celeres,
 hae nare sagaces,

[65]

some keen of scent; shaggy Cretans
 bay, slender Spartans, and Britons
 that can break the backs of mighty
 bulls. Britomartis scours the woods
 of Dalmatia and the precipitous
 ridges of Pindus, her hair flying in
 the wind. Thou, Leontodame,
 surroundest the glades of Gaul and
 huntest the marshes of Germany,
 tracking out any huge boar, his tusks
 flexed with age, that may have taken
 shelter among the sedges that flank
 the Rhine. Swift Hecaërges tires the
 cloud-capped Alps, the valleys of the
 Apennines, and the snows of
 Garganus. Thero with her dogs
 explores the caves of Spain and from
 their recesses ousts the horrid bears
 of whose bloody jaws full oft Tagus'
 flood has failed to quench the thirst,
 and whose bodies, numbed with
 cold, the holm-oak of the Pyrenees
 o'ershadows with its leaves. The
 manlike maiden Nebrophone hunts
 the mountains of Corsica and Sicily
 and captures deer and other harmless
 beasts, beasts that are the joy of the
 rich amphitheatre and the glory of
 the woods.

Whatsoever inspires fear with its
 teeth, wonder with its mane, awe
 with its horns and bristling coat—all
 the beauty, all the terror of the forest
 is taken. Guile protects them not;
 neither strength nor weight avails

hirsutaeque fremunt Cressae tenuesque; their speed saves not the fleet
 Lacenae 300 of foot. Some roar enmeshed in
 magnaue taurorum fracturae colla snares; some are thrust into wooden
 Britannae. cages and carried off. There are not
 Dalmatiae lucos abruptaque brachia carpenters enough to fashion the
 Pindi wood; leafy prisons are constructed
 sparsa comam Britomartis agit. tu of unhewn beech and elm. Boats
 Gallica cingis laden with some of the animals
 lustra, Leontodame, Germanorumque traverse seas and rivers; bloodless
 paludes from terror the rower's hand is
 eruis et si quis defensus harundine stayed, for the sailor fears the
 305 merchandise he carries. Others are
 vastus aper nimio dentes curvaverat transported over land in wagons that
 aevo. block the roads with the long
 nubiferas Alpes Appenninique recessus procession,
 Garganice nives Hecaerge prompta
 fatigat.
 speluncas canibus Thero rimatur Hiberas
 informesque cavis ursos detrudit ab
 antris, 310
 quorum saepe Tagus manantes sanguine
 rictus
 non satiavit aquis et quos iam frigore
 segnes
 Pyrenaea tegit latebrosis frondibus ilex.
 Cynaëis Siculisque iugis venata virago
 Nebrophone cervos aliasque in vincula
 cogit 315
 non saevas pecudes, sed luxuriantis
 harenae
 delicias, pompam nemorum.
 Quodcumque
 tremendum
 dentibus aut insigne iubis aut nobile
 cornu
 aut rigidum saetis, capitur decus omne
 timorque
 silvarum non cauta latent non mole

silvarum. non cauta latent, non more

resistant^[66] 320

fortia, non volucris fugiunt pernicia
cursu.

haec laqueis innexa gemunt; haec claustra
feruntur

ilignis domibus. fabri nec tigna polire
sufficiunt; rudibus fagis texuntur et
frondentes caveae. ratibus pars ibat

onustis 325

per freta vel fluvios: exanguis dextera
torpet

remigis et propriam metuebat navita
mercem.

per terram pars ducta rotis, longoque
morantur

[67]

bearing the spoils of the mountains.

The wild beast is borne a captive by

those troubled cattle on whom in
times past he sated his hunger, and

each time that the oxen turned and

drook at their burden they pull away

in terror from the pole.

By now Phoebus' sister had
wandered o'er the torrid plains of
Libya and chosen out superb lions
who had often put the Hesperides to
flight, filled Atlas with alarm at their
wind-tossed manes, and plundered
far and wide the flocks of Ethiopia,
lions whose terrible cries had never
struck upon the herdsmen's ears but
as heralding their destruction. To
catch them had been used no blazing
torches, no twigs strewn over turf
undermined; the voice of a tethered
kid had not allured their hunger nor
had a diggèd pit ensnared them: of
their own free will they gave
themselves up to capture and
rejoiced at being seen the prey of so
great a goddess. At length the
countryside breathes again and the
Moorish farmers unbar their now
safe huts. Then Latonia collected
grey-spotted^[19] leopards and other
marvels of the south and huge ivory
tusks which, carved with iron into
plaques and inlaid with gold to form
the glistening inscription of the
consul's name, should pass in

ordine plastra vias montanis
plena triumphis
et fera sollicitis vehitur captiva
iuuencis, 330
explebat quibus ante famem,
quotiensque reflexi
conspexere boves, pavidum
temone recedunt.
Iamque pererratis Libyae
flagrantibus oris
legerat eximios Phoebi germana
leones,
Hesperidas qui saepe fugant
ventoque citatis 335
terrificant Atlanta iubis
armentaue longe
vastant Aethiopum quorumque
impune fragosa
murmura pastorum numquam
venere per aures.
non illos taedae ardentes, non
strata superne
lapsuro virgulta solo, non
vocibus haedi 340
pendentis stimulata fames, non
fossa fefellit;
ultro se voluere capi
gaudentque videri
tantae praeda deae. respirant
pascua tandem;
agricolae reserant iam tuta
mapalia Mauri,
tum virides pardos et cetera
colligit Austri 345
prodigia inmanesque simul
Latonia dentes,
qui secti ferro in tabulas
auroque micantes

procession among lords and
commons. All India stood in
speechless amaze to see many an
elephant go shorn of the glory of his
tusks. Seated upon their black necks
despite their cries the goddess shook
the fixed ivory and tearing it up from
its bloody roots disarmed the
monstrous mouths. Nay, she fain
would have brought the elephants
themselves as a spectacle but feared
that their vast weight would retard
the ships.

Fiercely o'er the Tyrrhene wave
echoes the fleet

[19] Literally "green." Latin (and
Greek) colour epithets are often
strangely at variance with ours.

atroxque incantes
 inscripti rutilum^[68] caelato consule
 classis torva^[20] sonat,
 per proceres et vulgus cant
 caudamque in puppe
 stupor omnibus Indis
 retorquens
 plurimus ereptis elephas
 ad prostrant faetet usque leo: vix
 inglorius errat³⁵⁰
 subleuat unum
 dentibus: insedit nigra cervice
 tarda rursus: nemitus stagnis
 gementum
 et fixum dea quassat ebur
 cunctaque prominent cetera
 penitusque Nereus³⁶⁰
 stirpibus avulsis patulos
 effert monstris rursus et non
 aequat fatetur:
 insos quin etiam nobis miracula
 aequola sic victor quotiens per
 velle
 rubra Lyaeus
 ducere, sed pigra cunctari mole
 navigat, iniquaet clavum
 serotus³⁵⁵ et acres
 Tyrrhenas fetus Libycos
 adsudant tonsis Satyr
 amplexa per undas
 cunctaque pulsa
 Baccharum Bromios invitant
 tympana remos: 365
 transtra ligant hederæ, malum
 circumflua vestit
 pampinus, antennis inlabitur
 ebria serpens,
 perque mero madidos currunt
 saliuntque rudentes
 lynces et insolitæ mirantur
 carbasa tigres.

[20] torva Birt; MSS. have turba.

[69]

that holds the Libyan breed, and, as
 he coils his tail upon the stern, a lion
 stretches to the prow; that single
 beast the labouring bark can scarce
 uplift; deep down below the waters
 is heard the roaring. Out rushes the
 leviathan. Neptune compares these
 land prodigies to his and admits that
 his are not their equal. So whene'er
 victorious Bacchus ploughs the Red
 Sea's waves, Silenus sways the
 helm, the urgent Satyrs sweat upon
 their oars and the oxhide drums,
 smitten by the Bacchants, summon
 the rowers of Bromius to toil at the
 thwarts; ivy-wreaths deck the
 benches, the pliant vine entwines the
 mast; a drunken snake glides out
 upon the yardarms; lynxes run and
 leap along the sheets that drip with
 wine, and unaccustomed tigers stare
 in amaze at the canvas.

**PANEGYRICUS DE SEXTO
CONSULATU HONORII
AUGUSTI**

PRAEFATIO

(XXVII.)

**PANEGYRIC ON THE
SIXTH CONSULSHIP OF
THE EMPEROR HONORIUS
(A.D. 404)**

PREFACE

(XXVII.)

All things that with waking sense
desire ponders kindly repose brings
back to the slumbering mind. The
hunter stretches his weary limbs
upon the couch, yet his mind ever
returns to the woods where his
quarry lurks. The judge dreams of
law-suits, the charioteer of his
chariot the nightly steeds of which
he guides past a shadowy turning-
point. The lover repeats love's
mysteries, the merchant makes
exchange of goods, the miser still
watchfully grasps at elusive riches,
and to thirsty sufferers all-pervading
sleep offers from a cooling spring
idly alluring draughts.

I am a lover of the Muses and in the
silent night I too am haunted by that
my accustomed task. For meseemed
I stood upon the very summit of the
starry sky and laid my songs at
Jove's feet, and, in the flattery of
sleep, the gods and all the sacred
band gathered about Jove's throne

Omnia, quae sensu volvuntur
vota diurno,
pectore sopito reddit amica
quies.
venator defessa toro cum
membra reponit,
mens tamen ad silvas et sua
lustra redit.
iudicibus lites, aurigae somnia
currus 5
vanaque nocturnis meta
cavetur equis.
furto gaudet amans, permutat
navita merces
et vigil elapsas quaerit avarus
opes,
blandaue largitur frustra
sitientibus aegris
inriguus gelido pocula fonte
sopor. 10
Me quoque Musarum
studium sub nocte
silenti
artibus adsuetis sollicitare
solet.
namque poli media stellantis in
arce videbar
ante pedes summi carmina
ferre Iovis;
utque favet somnus, plaudebant
numina dictis 15
et circumfusi sacra corona
chori.
Enceladus mihi carmen erat
victusque Typhoeus:
hic subit Inarimen, hunc
gravis Aetna domat.

gave applause to my words. I sang of
Enceladus and conquered Typhoeus,
the first a prisoner beneath Inarime,
the second oppressed by the weight
of Etna. How

[72]

quam laetum post bella Iovem
susceperat aether
Phlegraeae referens praemia
militiae! 20
Additur ecce fides nec me
mea lusit imago,
inrita nec falsum somnia
misit ebur.
en princeps, en orbis apex
aequatus Olympo!
en quales memini, turba
verenda, deos!
fingere nil maius potuit sopor,
altaque vati 25
conventum caelo praebuit
aula parem.

[73]

joyous was that Jove whom, after the
war with the giants, heaven
welcomed, enriched with the spoils
from Phlegra's field!

My dream has come true; 'twas no
vain imagining; nor did the false
ivory gate^[21] send forth an
unaccomplished dream. Behold our
lord, behold earth towering to
heaven's height! Here before me are
gods such as I then saw, gods worthy
of all reverence. Nought greater
could dreams have fancied; this
noble assembly offers the poet an
audience like to that of heaven.

^[21] A reference to the famous epilogue
of Verg. *Aen.* vi. (ll. 893-96). Dreams
which come through the ivory gate are
false, those which issue from the gate
of horn, true.

PANEGYRICUS

(XXVIII.)

THE PANEGYRIC

(XXVIII.)

If our ancestors vowed temples to “Home-bringing Fortune” in honour of the return of their generals, never would this goddess more worthily claim for her services a noble temple than when their proper majesty is restored alike to the consulship and to Rome. The annual election in the Campus Martius is not the accustomed farce, nor see we a consul of other race than his electors nor a foreigner claiming pretended rights.^[22] The palace now our own wears a native dress, and while Quirinus associates the people with the armies of Italy, Mars gives back to his own Field its imperial suffrage. What will the year be like for mortals that is ushered in by omens on the Palatine Hill so favourable to true sons of Rome and inaugurated on the banks of the Tiber? ’Tis true that years marked by thy name have ever been rich in omens of success and that victory has always accompanied thy consulship, yet by its wondrous dawn is this year set before all years, blessed by the twofold deity of Rome and of her Emperor. For as Babylonian lore gives assurance that

light by a low position in the sky; so the Standard-bearer of the Latin palace^[23] at *his* zenith gives hope of a brighter future for Italy in placing the star of our empire in its true position. Omens that have their origin in Rome's victorious soil are the more sure of fulfilment.

When fair Apollo leaves Delphi's shrine and visits the altars of the north, Castalia's waters differ in no wise from those of any common stream, nor the laurel from any common tree; sad and silent is the cave and the shrine without a worshipper. But if Phoebus is there, Phoebus returned from Scythian climes to his Delphic tripod, guiding thither his yoked griffins, the woods, the caves regain their voice, the streams their life; the sacred ripple revisits the face of the waters, a clearer echo resounds from the shrine and the now inspired rocks tremble to the voice of prophecy. Now the Palatine Mount is exalted with honour and rejoices in the return of its native deity; far and wide among the suppliant peoples it spreads oracles surer even than those of Delphi and bids its laurels grow green again to deck the standards of Rome.

Of a truth no other city could fitly be the home of the world's rulers; on

cardine nec radios humili
statione recondunt:
haud aliter Latiae sublimis
Signifer aulae,
imperii sidus propria cum sede
locavit,
auget spes Italas; et certius
omina surgunt
victrici concepta solo.

Cum

pulcher Apollo 25
lustrat Hyperboreas Delphis
cessantibus aras,
nil tum Castaliae rivis
communibus undae
dissimiles, vili nec discrepat
arbore laurus,
antraque maesta silent
inconsultique recessus.
at si Phoebus adest et frenis
grypha iugalem 30
Riphaeo tripodas repetens
detorsit ab axe,
tunc silvae, tunc antra loqui,
tunc vivere fontes,
tunc sacer horror aquis
adytisque effunditur
Echo
clarior et doctae spirant
praesagia rupes.
ecce Palatino crevit reverentia
monti 35
exultatque habitante deo
potioraque Delphis
supplicibus late populis oracula
pandit
atque suas ad signa iubet
revirescere laurus

this hill is majesty most herself, and knows the height of her supreme sway; the palace, raising its head above the forum that lies at its feet, sees around it so many temples and is surrounded by so many protecting deities. See below the Thunderer's temple the Giants suspended from the Tarpeian rock, behold the sculptured doors, the cloud-capped statues, the sky-towering temples, the brazen prows of many a vessel welded on to lofty columns, the temples built on massy crags where the

[23] *i.e.* the Emperor. *Signifer* also means the zodiac. Claudian puns on the ambiguity.

REVIRESCERE LAURUS.

Non alium certe decuit
[78]
rectoribus orbis
esse larem, nulloque magis se
colle potestas 40
aestimat et summi sentit fastigia
iuris;
attollens apicem subiectis regia
rostris
tot circum delubra videt
tantisque deorum
cingitur excubiis! iuvat infra
tectata Tonantis
cernere Tarpeia pendentes rupe
Gigantas 45
caelatasque fores mediisque
volantia signa
nubibus et densum stipantibus
aethera templis
aeraque vestitis numerosa
puppe columnis
consita subnixasque iugis
inmanibus aedes,

[79]

hand of man has added to the work of nature, the countless triumphal arches glittering with spoils. The eyes are dazed by the blaze of metal and blink outwearied by the surrounding gold.

Adored Prince, dost thou recognize thy house? 'Tis the same that thy loving sire showed to thy wondering eyes while yet thou wert a boy of tender years. Never in all his life did Theodosius, best of all the gods, better deserve our love than when, triumphant over all his foes, he came with thee to Rome to sojourn within its walls, and there, following the example of the noblest emperors, lived as a simple citizen, not seeking to inspire terror by his name but condescending to exchange banter and harmless raillery with the people and as ready to lay aside his rank and visit the homes of the poor as to enter the palaces of the noble. 'Tis thus the public love is kindled when with just humanity modesty bids royal state stoop to the people. And thee, while still but a boy, though the crown had not yet encircled thy head, thy father took to share his honours, [24] cherishing thee in his royal bosom, giving thy youth its first taste of triumphs and teaching it the prelude of its mighty destiny. Peoples of every tongue and Persian

naturam cumulante manu,
 spoliisque micantes 50
 innumeros arcus. acies stupet
 igne metalli
 et circumfuso trepidans
 obtunditur auro.
 Agnoscisne tuos, princeps
 venerande, penates?
 haec sunt, quae primis olim
 miratus in annis
 patre pio monstrante puer. nil
 optimus ille 55
 divorum toto meruit felicius
 aevo,
 quam quod Romuleis victor sub
 moenibus egit
 te consorte dies, cum se
 melioribus addens
 exemplis civem gereret terrore
 remoto,
 alternos cum plebe iocos
 dilectaque passus 60
 iurgia patriciasque domos
 privataque passim
 visere deposito dignatus limina
 fastu.
 publicus hinc ardescit amor,
 cum moribus aequis
 inclinat populo regale modestia
 culmen.
 teque rudem vitae, quamvis
 diademate necdum 65
 cingebare comas, socium
 sumebat honorum
 purpureo fotum gremio,
 parvumque triumphis
 imbuat et magnis docuit
 praeludere fatigis

chiefs sent to solicit alliance in
 Rome^[25] once saw thee seated with
 thy father in this very palace and
 bowing the knee laid their crowns at
 thy feet. Thou wert at his side when
 he summoned the tribes to receive a
 bounteous largess: with thee he
 entered the hallowed portals of the
 assembled senate clad in the consul's
 robe, right glad to introduce his son
 to the goodwill of the Roman
 Fathers, that so his youthful heir
 might grow familiar with empire.

^[24] Honorius was made Augustus
 Nov. 20, 393, shortly after his ninth
 birthday.

^[25] The Persians seem to have sent
 embassies to Rome both in 387 and
 389 (Themistius, *Orat.* xix. p. 227).

praetendere laus.
 et linguis varia^[80]e gentes
 missique rogatum
 foedera Persarum proceres cum
 patre sedentem 70
 hac quondam videre domo
 positoque tiaram
 summisere genu. tecum
 praelarga vocavit
 ditandas ad dona tribus;
 fulgentia tecum
 collecti trabeatus adit delubra
 senatus
 Romano puerum gaudens
 offerre favori, 75
 ut novus imperio iam tunc
 adsuesceret heres.

[81]

Hence taking firmer root the love of
 Rome clung to thee more closely and
 grew strong, deep-planted in all thy
 heart. As thou grewest the affection
 which thou hadst found in childhood
 for the city grew too; nor was
 Bosporus, whose cherished town
 was thy nurse, able on thy return to
 seduce thee from that love. Every
 time that thy sire in sport gave thee
 thy choice of whatsoever cities thou
 didst prefer to govern as thy share of
 empire, thou didst leave to thy
 brother Arcadius the throne and
 riches of the East and the lands
 which by inheritance should be his.
 "Let him rule over the servile
 Assyrians," thou saidst, "let Nile, the
 river of Egypt, and the Tigris be his;
 let me have my beloved Rome." Thy
 wishes have been fulfilled. Fortune
 set up a new tyrant only to ensure for
 thee the governance of Latium. So
 soon as ever the war was brought to
 a successful conclusion thou wert
 summoned from the court of
 Byzantium to undertake the rule of
 Italy twice conquered by thy father's
 arms. Serena herself left the East and
 accompanied thee in thy journey
 across Illyria: fearless in face of
 danger she bestowed a mother's care
 on thee who wert to be lord of
 Latium and her own son-in-law after
 Theodosius' translation to the sky.
 She kept careful guard over the child

Hinc tibi concreta radice
tenacius haesit
et penitus totis inolevit Roma
medullis,
dilectaeque urbis tenero
conceptus ab ungue
tecum crevit amor. nec te
mutare reversum 80
evaluit propria nutritor
Bosphorus arce.
et quotiens optare tibi quae
moenia malles
adludens genitor regni pro parte
dedisset,
divitis Aurorae solium
sortemque paratam
sponte remittebas fratri: “regat
ille volentes 85
Assyrios; habeat Pharium cum
Tigride Nilum;
contingat mea Roma mihi.” nec
vota fefellit
eventus. Fortuna novum molita
tyrannum
iam tibi quaerebat Latium
belloque secundo
protinus Eoa velox accitus ab
aula 90
suscipis Hesperiam patrio bis
Marte receptam.
ipsa per Illyricas urbes Oriente
relicto
ire Serena comes nullo deterrita
casu,
materna te mente fovens
Latioque futurum
rectorem generumque sibi
seniore supernas ac

entrusted to her protection through
the dangers of that critical time and
brought thee safe to her uncle’s
throne and her husband’s army.
Stilicho and Serena vied in love
toward thee and what Serena’s care
had brought safe home Stilicho’s
affection welcomed there.

Happy father to enter heaven with no
fears for the future; he knew that
thou wert to succeed him. With what
joy he looks down from above and
sees his glory enhanced by thine
exploits! Europe and

semper superas 95
iam repetente ^[82]plagas. illo sub
cardine rerum
sedula servatum per tot
discrimina pignus
restituit sceptris patrui
castrisque mariti.
certavit pietate domus, fidaeque
reductum
coniugis officio Stilichonis cura
recepit. 100
Felix ille parens, qui te
securus Olympum
succedente petit! quam laetus
ab aethere cernit
se factis crevisse tuis! duo
namque fuere

[83]

Africa were alike threatened by foes:
from Mount Atlas came fierce Gildo;
Alaric from Peuce's savage isle.
Often had both with impious daring
set at nought the commands of thy
sire. When he came from the lands
of Thrace Alaric closed against him
the waters of the Danube; Gildo
scorned his command and, refusing
assistance for a neighbouring war,
had seized on the fields of Libya he
had long forsworn. Theodosius
recalls the anger he then justly felt
and rejoices to witness their
discomfiture, proud to have his son
for his avenger. Orestes' sword took
vengeance on the son of
Thyestes^[27]; but guilt was blent with
piety, and the sword-stroke brings
doubtful glory when honour is
balanced by a mother's murder;
Augustus sated the shade of Caesar
with his enemies' blood, but he made
a false advertisement of piety when,
to the grief of his fatherland, he
offered the blood of citizens to his
father's ghost. But for thee thy sire's
cause, linked as it is with the general
safety, doubles thy warlike fame; the
same victory that has avenged thy
sire has restored peace to the world.

My lyre inspired by the Muses of
Pieria has long since sung of the
defeat and capture of the Moor; but
of late, too, in Stilicho's presence I

Europae Libyaeque hostes:
 Maurusius Atlas
 Gildonis Furiis, Alaricum
 barbara Peuce 105
 nutrierat, qui saepe tuum
 sprevere profana
 mente patrem. Thracum
 venienti e^[26] finibus
 alter
 Hebraei clausit aquas; alter
 praecepta vocantis
 respuit auxiliisque ad proxima
 bella negatis
 abiurata palam Libyae
 possederat arva: 110
 quorum nunc meritam repetens
 non inmemor iram
 suppliciiis fruitur natoque ultore
 triumphat.
 ense Thyestiadae poenas exegit
 Orestes,
 sed mixtum pietate nefas
 dubitandaque caedis
 gloria, materno laudem cum
 crimine pensat; 115
 pavit Iuleos invisio sanguine
 manes
 Augustus, sed falsa pii
 praeconia sumpsit
 in luctum patriae civili strage
 parentans:
 at tibi causa patris rerum
 coniuncta saluti
 bellorum duplicat laurus,
 isdemque tropaeis 120
 reddita libertas orbi, vindicta
 parenti.

Sed mihi iam videtur centum

have celebrated in verse the wars
 against the Getae. To-day I would
 fain sing the glories of thy home-
 coming and, ceasing to tell of wars,
 would prelude a theme of
 thankfulness.

Alaric, his hopes ruined by his
 bloody defeat at Pollentia, though
 policy dictated that his life should be
 spared, was nevertheless deserted by
 all his allies and bereft of all his
 resources. He was forced to leave
 Latium and to retrace his steps in
 ruin and

^[27] Aegisthus.

[26] ~~269. Iam Pollentini tenuatus~~
 of A and B. ~~270. Maurum~~ Maurum veniens
 of A and B. ~~271. Pieris egit fidibus Chelys, arma~~
 MSS. I have adopted Heinsius
 emendation. ~~272. Getarum~~
 nuper apud socerum plectro
 celebrata recenti.
 adventus nunc sacra tui libet
 edere Musis 125
 grataque patratis exordia
 sumere bellis.
 Iam Pollentini tenuatus
 funere campi
 concessaque sibi (rerum sic
 admonet usus)
 luce, tot amissis sociis atque
 omnibus una
 direptis opibus, Latio discedere
 iussus 130

disgrace; such was the complete reversal of his fortune.^[28] As when a pirate ship, the terror of every sea, laden with the spoils of violence and the booty taken from many a captured merchantman, falls in with a great man-of-war and hopes to secure it for its prey as vessels heretofore, then indeed crippled by the slaughter of its oarsmen and the rending of its sails, deprived of its rudder and all but destroyed by the breaking of its yardarms, it is driven this way and that at the mercy of wind and wave and at last pays the penalty for its piracy; even so Alaric turned backwards his vain threatenings, fleeing from Italy that, once so easy for his advance, was now so difficult for his retreat. His fear makes him believe every road barred, and rivers, erstwhile left behind in scorn, fill him with alarm on his return.

Meanwhile, as it fell out, father Eridanus in his watery home beneath the crystal caverns, ignorant as yet of what had happened, was pondering weighty cares. What, he wondered, would be the outcome of the war: would Jove approve empire and law and Rome's days of peace, or would he, abhorring order, condemn future ages to the primal ways of brute beasts? As he anxiously ponders

hostis et immensi revolutus
culmine fati
turpe rexit iter. qualis piratica
puppis,
quae cunctis infensa fretis
scelerumque referta
divitiis multasque diu populata
carinas
incidit in magnam
bellatricemque triremim,
135

dum praedam de more putat;
viduataque caesis
remigibus, scissis velorum
debilis alis,
orba gubernaculis, antennis
saucia fractis
ludibrium pelagi vento iactatur
et unda,
vastato tandem poenas luitura
profundo: 140
talis ab urbe minas retro
flectebat inanes
Italiam fugiens, et quae
venientibus ante
prona fuit, iam difficilis, iam
dura reversis.
clausa putat sibi cuncta pavor,
retroque relictos
quos modo temnebat, rediens
exhorruit amnes. 145

Undosa tum forte domo
vitreisque sub antris
rerum ignarus adhuc ingentes
pectore curas
volvebat pater Eridanus: quis
bella maneret
exitus? imperiumque Iovi

such things one of the Naiads with
hair unbound came and embraced
her sire and said, "Alaric is other
now than once we saw him in his
hour of triumph: thou wilt wonder at
the pallor of his countenance. Joy it
will be to reckon up his army and
number the remains of so great a
host. Frown no more nor complain;
let my sister nymphs once more
enjoy their dances."

So spake she and he lifted his
gracious head above the gliding
stream and on his dripping forehead

[28] Claudian did not live to see the
next "reversal of fortune," Alaric's
capture of Rome six years later.

aurea roranti micuerunt cornua
 vultu.
 non illi madidum vulgaris
 harundine crinem
 velat honos; rami caput
 umbravere virentes
 Heliadum totisque fluunt electra
 capillis.
 palla tegit latos umeros,
 curruque paterno 165
 intextus Phaëthon glaucos
 incendit amictus.
 fultaque sub gremio caelatis
 nobilis astris
 aetherium probat urna decus.
 namque omnia luctus
 argumenta sui Titan signavit
 Olympo:
 mutatumque senem plumis et
 fronde sorores 170
 et fluvium, nati qui vulnera lavit
 anheli;
 stat gelidis Auriga plagis;
 vestigia fratris
 germanae servant Hyades,
 Cygnique sodalis
 lacteus extentas adspergit
 circulus alas;
 stelliger Eridanus sinuatis
 flexibus errans 175
 clara Noti convexa rigat
 gladioque tremendum
 gurgite sidereo subterluit
 Oriona.
 Hoc deus effulgens habitu
 prospexit euntes
 deiecta cervice Getas; tunc talia
 fatur.

soon of the coasts of Italy? Feedest
 thou not thy horses on Tiber's grassy
 bank as thou thoughtest to do?
 Drivest not the plough on Etruria's
 hills? Fit object of all the
 punishments of Hell, thinkest thou to
 attack the city of the gods with a
 Giant's rage? If none other, was not
 my Phaëthon a warning to thee,
 Phaëthon fall'n from heaven to
 quench his flames in my waters,
 what time he

[29] The poplar.

[30] Eridanus was a mythical river of the far West, generally identified with the Latin Padus (mod. Po). Phaëthon is said to have fallen into it when he attempted to drive the horses of his father, the sun. After this Eridanus, the river god, became a constellation—hence Eridanus is said to “wet” the southern sky.

iatui.
 “sicine mutatis^[88] properas,
 Alarice, reverti 180
 consiliis? Italiae sic te iam
 paenitet orae?
 nec iam cornipedem Thybrino
 gramine pascis,
 ut rebare, tuum? Tuscis nec
 figis aratrum
 collibus? o cunctis Erebi
 dignissime poenis,
 tune Giganteis urbem temptare
 deorum 185
 adgressus furiis? nec te meus,
 improbe, saltem
 terruit exemplo Phaëthon, qui
 fulmina praeceps
 in nostris efflavit aquis, dum
 flammea caeli

[89]

sought with mortal hand to hold the fiery reins of the sky and hoped to spread day’s brilliance from a mortal countenance? ’Tis the same mad crime, I tell thee, whosoever aspires to spoil Rome or drive the sun’s chariot.”

So spake he, and rising yet farther out of the stream he loudly summoned the rivers of Liguria and Venetia. These raise their dripping heads from among their leafy banks, fair Ticinus, blue Addua, swift Athesis, slow Mincius, and Timavus with his nine mouths. All mock at the fugitive and recall the happy flocks to the now peaceful meadows; Lycaean Pan is bidden to return and the Dryads and Fauns, gods of the countryside.

Thou too, Verona,^[31] didst add no small makeweight to Rome’s victory over the Getae; not even Pollentia nor the walls of avenging Hasta did more for the salvation of Italy. Here, as once again he breaks his bond, and driven by his losses risks all in the attempt to change his present fortune, Alaric learned that his mad treachery availed him nothing and that change of place changes not destiny. The vultures fed on the countless bodies of his slain, and Athesis, carrying down the corpses of Rome’s enemies in its stream,

flectere terrenis meditatur frena
lacertis
mortalique diem sperat
diffundere vultu? 190
crede mihi, simili bacchatur
crimine, quisquis
adspirat Romae spoliis aut Solis
habenis.”
Sic fatus Ligures Venetosque
erectior amnes
magna voce ciet. frondentibus
umida ripis
colla levant: pulcher Ticinus et
Addua visu 195
caerulus et velox Athesis
tardusque meatu
Mincius inque novem
consurgens ora Timavus.
insultant omnes profugo
pacataque laetum
invitant ad prata pecus; iam
Pana Lycaeum,
iam Dryadas revocant et rustica
numina Faunos. 200
Tu quoque non parvum
Getico, Verona,
triumpho
adiungis cumulum, nec plus
Pollentia rebus
contulit Ausoniis aut moenia
vindicis Hastae.
hic, rursus dum pacta movet
damnisque coactus
extremo mutare parat praesentia
casu, 205
nil sibi periurum sensit prodesse
furorem
converti nec fata loco

turned the waters of the Ionian sea
into blood.

The treaty violated, Stilicho with all
eagerness grasped at the conflict
proffered where Rome was now far
away from danger and Padus flowed
between witnessing the strife. He
rejoices that now opportune
treachery has broken out in
rebellious risings and, setting an
example of endurance, he shirks
neither fiery sun nor scorching dust.
Himself he is everywhere with
dreadful arm; he stations troops

[31] The chroniclers do not mention
this battle. It is probably to be
attributed to the summer of 403.

CONVERTI NEC IATA LOCO,
multisque^[90] suorum
diras pavit aves, inimicaque
corpora volvens
Ionios Athesis mutavit sanguine
fluctus.
Oblatum Stilicho violato
foedere Martem 210
omnibus adripuit votis, ubi
Roma periclo
iam procul et belli medio Padus
arbiter ibat.
iamque opportunam motu
strepuisse rebelli
gaudet perfidiam praebensque
exempla labori
sustinet accensos aestivo
pulvere soles. 215
ipse manu metuendus adest
inopinaque cunctis

[91]

at every point, even where the enemy little expected them, and hastens in any and every direction to the succour of him who needs it. If the soldiers flag with wearied ranks he throws the auxiliaries into the line heedless of their loss; thus he cunningly weakens the savage tribes of the Danube by opposing one tribe to another and with twofold gain joins battle that turns barbarians against themselves to perish in either army for our sake. Thee too, Alaric, he had captured and delivered over to death had not the hasty zeal of the rash Alan chief upset his carefully laid scheme. All but a prisoner thou dost lash thy panting steed, nor do we regret that escape. Rather get thee gone, thou last remnant of thy race, sole survivor of so many Danubian tribes; get thee gone, the living witness of Rome's triumph.

Yet was his^[32] fierce spirit not cast down by these great reverses; he still attempted to discover an unknown path across the mountains, hoping that over their rocky summits he might fall suddenly on the peoples of Raetia and Gaul. But Stilicho's more soldierly vigilance put a stop to his projects. Who indeed could hope to deceive that unsleeping brain, those godlike eyes that watched o'er Italy? Never did an enemy succeed in

instruit arma locis et qua vocat
 usus ab omni
parte venit. fesso si deficit
 agmine miles,
utitur auxiliis damni securus, et
 astu
debilitat saevum cognatis
 viribus Histri 220
et duplici lucro committens
 proelia vertit
in se barbariem nobis utrimque
 cadentem.
ipsum te caperet letoque,
 Alarice, dedisset,
ni calor incauti male festinatus
 Alani
dispositum turbasset opus;
 prope captus anhelum
225
verbere cogis equum, nec te
 vitasse dolemus.
i potius genti reliquus tantisque
 superstes
Danuvii populis, i, nostrum vive
 tropaeum.
Non tamen ingenium tantis se
 cladibus atrox
deicit: occulto temptabat
 tramite montes, 230
si qua per scopulos subitas
 exquirere posset
in Raetos Gallosque vias. sed
 fortior obstat
cura ducis. quis enim divinum
 fallere pectus
possit et excubiis vigilantia
 lumina regni?
cuius consilium non umquam

discovering Stilicho's plans or had power to conceal his own. Before they knew them themselves the secrets of the Getae were known to Stilicho, whose generalship was quick to meet their every ruse.

Baulked in every attempt Alaric camped panic-stricken on a single hill. Though the horses, feeding on bitter leaves, gnawed even the tree-bark, though pestilence raged, brought on by foul food and

[32] i.e. Alaric's.

curas consumam non unquam
repperit^[92] hostis 235
nec potuit texisse suum. secreta
Getarum
nosse prior celerique dolis
occurrere sensu.
Omnibus exclusus coeptis
consedit in uno
colle tremens; frondesque licet
depastus amaras
arboreo figat sonipes in cortice
morsus 240
et taetris collecta cibis annique
vapore

[93]

aggravated by the season's heat, though the soldiers arrogantly heaped abuse on their beleaguered leader and reminded him of their captured children; yet neither the ravages of disease nor famine that teaches men to face all dangers, nor grief for spoils lost, nor the voice of shame nor anger at bitter gibes could tempt him to brave the perils of a hand-to-hand fight, tried so often before and with such ill success. What triumph more complete than that of extorting from a conquered foe the admission that he is conquered? And now numbers of deserters began to weaken his already reduced strength and day by day his forces were diminished. Sedition was not now the hidden work of a few but meant the open defection of whole sections and squadrons. Their general rides after them and with angry curses and vain clamour seeks to hold them back, waging war now on his own troops. He weeps, calls the men by name, recalls them with prayers and supplications; he reminds them of past campaigns and all to no purpose offers his throat to their reluctant hands. His mind a prey to melancholy he sees his forces desert him, his army melt away, even as an old bee-master of Hybla, beating Cybele's gong, tries, by means of

saeviat aucta lues et miles
 probra superbus
ingerat obsesso captivaque
 pignora monstret:
non tamen aut morbi tabes aut
 omne periculum
docta subire fames aut praedae
 luctus ademptae 245
aut pudor aut dictis movere
 procacibus irae,
ut male temptato totiens se
 credere campo
comminus auderet. nulla est
 victoria maior,
quam quae confessos animo
 quoque subiugat hostes.
iamque frequens rarum
 decerpere transfuga
 robur 250
coeperat inque dies numerus
 decrescere castris,
nec iam deditio paucis occulta
 parari,
sed cunei totaeque palam
 discedere turmae.
consequitur vanoque fremens
 clamore retentat
cumque suis iam bella gerit;
 mox nomina supplex 255
cum fletu precibusque ciet
 veterumque laborum
admonet et frustra iugulum
 parentibus offert,
defixoque malis animo sua
 membra suasque
cernit abire manus: qualis
 Cybeleia quassans
Hyblaens procul aera senex

that noise, to recall his scattered bees
who have wantonly left their combs
and fled the hive, till, himself
wearied of the useless sound, he
weeps the loss of his store of honey
and cries out upon the faithless
swarm that has forgotten its
accustomed home and left its cells
empty.

And so when grief loosed the string
of his tongue that had long been
mute he looked with tear-dimmed
eyes upon the well-known Alps and
pondered upon his present retreat,
attended by a fate so different

Hydriacus proci acia senex
revocare^[94] fugaces 260

tinnitu conatur apes, quae
sponte relictis
descivere favis, sonituque
exhaustus inani
raptas mellis opes solitaeque
oblita latebrae
perfida deplorat vacuis examina
ceris.

Ergo ubi praeclusae voci
laxata remisit 265
frena dolor, notas oculis
umentibus Alpes
adspicit et nimium diversi
stamine fati

[95]

from that which had prospered his advance. Then with a single whisper he made war, with an outstretched spear lightly overthrew walls, making a mock of precipices; now deserted and in despair he offered a just spectacle to the mountains he had so scornfully crossed. Then looking up at the sky of Italy he said: "Land of death for the Getae, trod by me with such omens of disaster, let thy wrath be now appeased by the sacrifice of so many of the guilty; let my sufferings at last excite thy compassion. Behold me, once lord of the world, the friend of fortune till I invaded thee; now, like an exile or an adjudged criminal, I feel upon my back the nearer breath of my pursuers. Alas! which of my disasters shall I lament first, which last? Not thou, Pollentia, nor ye, my captured treasures, have thus tortured me; be that destiny's harsh lot or the chance of war. I had not then lost all my forces; with troops still at my back, with my cavalry intact, I retired with the remnant of my army to the hills they call the Apennines. Its inhabitants told me that this mountain stretched from the confines of Liguria as far as the promontory of Pelorus in Sicily and embraced all the peoples of Italy, dividing with its unbroken chain the two seas that wash their country's

praesentes reditus fortunatosque
 revolvit
ingressus: solo peragens tum
 murmure bellum
protento leviter frangebatur
 moenia conto 270
inridens scopulos; nunc
 desolatus et expes
debita pulsato reddit spectacula
 monti.
tunc sic Ausonium respectans
 aethera fatur:
 “Heu regio funesta Getis, heu
 terra sinistris
auguriis calcata mihi, satiare
 nocentum 275
cladibus et tandem nostris
 inflectere poenis!
en ego, qui toto sublimior orbe
 ferebar
ante tuum felix aditum, ceu
 legibus exul
addictusque reus flatu propiore
 sequentum
terga premor. quae prima miser,
 quae funera dictis
posteriora querar? non me
 Pollentia tantum 281
nec captae cruciastis opes; hoc
 aspera fati
sors tulerit Martisque vices. non
 funditus armis
concideram; stipatus adhuc
 equitumque catervis
integer ad montes reliquo cum
 robore cessi, 285
quos Appenninum perhibent.
 hunc esse ferebat

two coasts. If I had pursued the plan that anger first dictated to me and had in my desperation continued my march along its crest, what lay beyond? Giving everything to the flames I might have died with loftier fame. Ay, and my dying eyes had beheld thee, Rome, from not so far away, and my very death would have cost the victor dear as he pursued me over the well-tilled cornfields. But Rome held my

incola, qui Siculū porrectus
 ad usque Pelorum
 finibus ab Ligurum populos
 complectitur omnes
 Italiae geminumque latus
 stringentia longe
 utraque perpetuo discriminat
 aequora tractu. 290
 haec ego continuum si per iuga
 tendere cursum,
 ut prior iratae fuerat sententia
 menti,
 iam desperata voluissem luce,
 quid ultra?
 omnibus oppeterem fama
 maiore perustis!
 et certe moriens propius te,
 Roma, viderem, 295
 ipsaque per cultas segetes mors
 nostra secuto
 victori damnosa foret. sed
 pignora nobis

[97]

children captive, my wives, my
 wealth—yet, freed from such
 hindrances, my advance had been the
 more rapid.

“With what cunning, with what skill,
 did Stilicho, that ever fatal enemy,
 ensnare me! His pretended mercy
 did but blunt my warlike spirit, and
 availed him to shift the war
 backwards across the Po. A curse on
 that armistice, more damaging than
 the yoke of slavery. ’Twas then the
 cause of the Getae was undone, then
 that I signed my own death-warrant.
 More rudely than any weapon did
 mercy destroy our people, beneath
 that semblance of peace lay the
 deadliest form of war, and I myself
 fell into the snare I had laid for
 others. I am weary of it all; where
 shall I find comfort or counsel? I
 fear my friends more than my foes.

“Would God I had lost them all on
 that field. He is ever mine that has
 fallen in hard conflict. Better all had
 perished by the sword; less bitter had
 been my grief for losses inflicted by
 a victorious foe than for those
 brought upon me by treachery. Is
 there not left one faithful follower?
 My comrades have turned against
 me, my friends hate me. My life is a
 burden; why prolong it? Where hide
 the remnants of my shipwrecked
 fortunes? To what land shall I flee

Romanus carasque nurus
 praedamque tenebat.
 hoc magis exertum raperem
 succinctior agmen.
 “Heu, quibus insidiis, qua me
 circumdedit arte 300
 fatalis semper Stilicho! dum
 parcere fingit,
 rettudit^[33] hostiles animos
 bellumque remenso
 evaluit transferre Pado. pro
 foedera saevo
 deteriora iugo! tunc vis extincta
 Getarum;
 tunc mihi, tunc letum pepigi.
 violentior armis 305
 omnibus expugnat nostram
 clementia gentem,
 Mars gravior sub pace latet,
 capiorque vicissim
 fraudibus ipse meis. quis iam
 solacia fesso
 consiliumve dabit? socius
 suspectior hoste.
 “Atque utinam cunctos
 licuisset perdere bello!
 310
 nam quisquis duro cecidit
 certamine, numquam
 desinit esse meus. melius
 mucrone perirent,
 auferretque mihi luctu leviores
 sodales
 victa manus quam laesa fides.
 nullusne clientum
 permanet? offensi comites,
 odere propinqui. 315
 quid moror inimicam hanc? quis

where the names of Stilicho and all
 too powerful Italy shall not sound for
 ever in mine ears?”

So spake he, and with Stilicho
 pressing hard upon him fled in terror
 before our eagles. With him goes
 Pallor, black Hunger, Despair with
 bloodless, wounded countenance and
 a hellish company of shrieking
 Diseases. Then the learned priest
 whirls around the sick body^[34] the
 torch of purification

^[34] i.e. the sick body of Italy which
 has to be purified after the polluting
 presence of Alaric. With “rore pio
 spargens” cf. Verg. *Aen.* vi. 230, and for
 the throwing over the head of the
 purificatory instrument see Verg. *Ec.*
 viii. 102.

quod moror hylisam lucem? qua
155 rettulit Isengr. mg., Birt "reus"
rettulit, ~~sedere~~ ~~condam~~

naufragii fragmenta mei?
 quaeve arva requiram,
in quibus haud umquam
 Stilicho nimiumque
 potentis
Italiae nomen nostras
 circumsonet aures?"
Haec memorans instante
 fugam Stilichone
 tetendit
expertas horrens aquilas;
 comitatur euntem 321
Pallor et atra Fames et saucia
 lividus ora
Luctus et inferno stridentes
 agmine Morbi.
lustralem tum rite facem, cui
 lumen odorum

with its smoky, odorous flame of blue sulphur and black bitumen; he sprinkles the limbs with holy water and with herbs that banish evil influences and, praying to Jove the Purifier and to Diana, with back-turned hands throws over his head towards the South the torches which are to carry off with them the spells cast over the sick.

Meanwhile the ardent desire of both senate and people to behold their emperor demands his often denied return. Not with such consent, our grandsires report, were public vows eagerly offered throughout the city when warlike Trajan had broken the power of Dacia and reduced the indignant north once more to subjection, what time the Scythian river Hypanis beheld the Roman axes and Lake Maeotis looked in amaze on a Roman court administering Roman law. It was a lesser enthusiasm which recalled the gentle Marcus Aurelius to give thanks in Rome's temples for Fortune's deliverance of Italy from a similar pressure of surrounding nations. Then 'twas no thanks to the generals: one man his scorched courser bore trembling on its smoking back; another sank down beneath his fire-wasted helmet; spears glowed molten by lightning

sulphure caeruleo nigroque
bitumine fumat, 325
circum membra rotat doctus
purganda sacerdos
rore pio spargens, et dira
fugantibus herbis
numina purificumque Iovem
Triviamque precatus
trans caput aversis manibus
iaculatur in Austrum
secum rapturas cantata piacula
taedas. 330
Acrior interea visendi
principis ardor
accendit cum plebe patres et
saepe negatum
flagitat adventum; nec tali
publica vota
consensu tradunt atavi caluisse
per urbem,
Dacica bellipotens cum fregerat
Ulpus arma 335
atque indignantes in iura
redegerat Arctos,
cum fasces cinxere Hypanin
mirataque leges
Romanum stupuit Maeotia terra
tribunal.
nec tantis patriae studiis ad
templa vocatus,
clemens Marce, redis, cum
gentibus undique
cinctam
exuit Hesperiam paribus
Fortuna periclis. 341
laus ibi nulla ducum; nam
flammeus imber in
hostem

and swords vanished suddenly into smoke. Heaven it was that fought that battle with no mortal weapons, whether it was that Chaldean seers^[35] had by their magic spells won over the gods to our side or, as I rather think, that Marcus' blameless life had power to win the Thunder's homage. To-day, also, assuredly Heaven's favour would not be wanting to Latium should our own hand fail, but a beneficent providence has

^[35] Claudian refers to the famous legend of the "Thundering" legion, saved from dying of lack of water by a miraculous rain-storm. This miracle occurred during M. Aurelius' war against the Marcomanni (*circ.* A.D. 175) and is attributed (1) to the prayers of the Christians; (2) to an Egyptian magician on Marcus' staff (Dio Cassius lxxi. 8. 10); (3) to the emperor's own prayers.

¹⁰⁰¹
 decidit; hunc dorso trepidum
 fumante ferebat
 ambustus sonipes; hic
 tabescente solutus
 subsedit galea liquefactaque
 fulgure cuspis 345
 conduit et subitis fluxere
 vaporibus enses.
 tum contenta polo mortalis
 nescia teli
 pugna fuit: Chaldaea mago seu
 carmina ritu
 armavere deos, seu, quod reor,
 omne Tonantis
 obsequium Marci mores
 potuere mereri. 350
 nunc quoque praesidium Latio
 non deesset Olympi,
 deficeret si nostra manus; sed
 providus aether

[101]

shown itself unwilling to rob human endeavour of its honour or to let the lightning win the crown of laurel which the efforts of thy father-in-law, Stilicho, have secured for thy brows.

Full often had the nobles, sent to urge thy return, brought back the answer that as yet thou couldst not come, until Rome herself, unable to bear any longer the frustration of her citizens' common prayer, came forth from the depths of her sanctuary and, openly displaying her radiant face, urged the hesitating emperor with complaints of her own. "Too long, my emperor, have I, thy mother, borne in silence the hurt thy refusal to return hath done me. How long shall favoured Liguria possess that for which I desire? How long shall the Rubicon, separating me from the object of my prayers by so narrow a space, torture the Tiber by the all-but-presence of that divine being whose nearer sojourn it is not allowed to enjoy? Was it not enough to have scorned me once when Africa, again at war, mocked the city with hopes of its emperor's coming, nor could we move thine obstinate ears with all our prayers? Yet did I harness for thee two steeds whiter than snow to draw the chariot wherein thou shouldst ride; already

noluit humano titulos auferre
 labori,
ne tibi iam, princeps, soceri
 sudore paratam,
quam meruit virtus, ambirent
 fulmina laurum. 355
Iam totiens missi proceres
 responsa morandi
rettulerant, donec differri
 longius urbis
communes non passa preces
 penetralibus altis
prosiluit vultusque palam
 confessa coruscos
impulit ipsa suis cunctantem
 Roma querellis: 360
“Dissimulata diu tristes in
 amore repulsas
vestra parens, Auguste, queror.
 quonam usque tenebit
praelatus mea vota Ligus?
 vetitumque propinqua
luce frui, spatiis discernens
 gaudia parvis,
torquebit Rubicon vicino
 nomine Thybrim? 365
nonne semel sprevisse satis,
 cum reddita bellis
Africa venturi lusit spe principis
 urbem
nec duras tantis precibus
 permovimus aures?
ast ego frenabam geminos,
 quibus altior ires,
electi candoris equos et nominis
 arcum 370
iam molita tui, per quem
 radiante decoris

had I builded in thy name a
triumphal arch through the which
thou shouldst pass clad in the garb of
victory, and I was dedicating it as a
memorial of the war with an
inscription to be the undying witness
of the salvation of Libya. Even then
were being prepared for Jove to see
from the Tarpeian rock models for
the coming triumph: a fleet of ships
was cast in metal, ships whose oar-
blades smote the golden sea; the
cities of Africa were made to go
before thy chariot and

radiante decorus
ingrederere toga, pugnae^[102]
monumenta dicabam
defensam titulo Libyam testata
perenni.
iamque parabantur pompae
simulacra futurae
Tarpeio spectanda Iovi: caelata
metalloy³⁷⁵
classis ut auratum sulcaret
remige fluctum,
ut Massyla tuos anteirent
oppida currus

[103]

Triton, with his conquered waters
and his head crowned with
Minerva's sacred reeds; crowds of
slaves with upgirt dresses bore a
figure of trembling Atlas cast in
bronze; Gildo himself, destined to
undergo in prison the punishment
once meted out to Jugurtha, offered
his stubborn neck to the yoke, Gildo
fallen a captive to the arms of Rome,
not to the treachery of a Bocchus and
a Sulla.^[36]

"But I pass over what has been. Can
the present triumph, too, of the Getic
war escape me? Does any spot give
ampler room to so great renown?
The very blessings thou hast
bestowed beg thee not to delay, and
thy generosity, constrained by its
own fair deeds, must needs love
those whom it has saved. Now for a
hundred summers the reaper's sickle
has gathered the yellow harvest of
Gargarus; already the consul has
introduced the games that occur but
once in a century and upon which no
man looks twice. During these years
which number twice ten lustres, I
have but thrice^[37] seen an emperor
enter my walls in triumph; all at
different times but for the same
reason—civil war. Did they come in
their pride that I should see their
chariots stained with Italy's blood?
Can any think a mother finds joy in

Palladiaque comas innexus
harundine Triton
edomitis veheretur aquis et in
aere trementem
succinctae famulum ferrent
Atlanta cohortes, 380
ipse Iugurthinam subiturus
carcere poenam
praeberet fera colla iugo, vi
captus et armis,
non Bocchi Syllaeque dolis.

“Sed

prima remitto.
num praesens etiam Getici me
laurea belli
declinare potest? sedesve
capacior ulla 385
tantae laudis erit? tua te
benefacta morantem
conveniunt, meritisque suis
obnoxia virtus
quod servavit amat. iam
flavescentia centum
messibus aestivae detondent
Gargara falces,
spectatosque iterum nulli
celebrantia ludos 390
circumflexa rapit centenus
saecula consul:
his annis, qui lustra mihi bis
dena recensent,
nostra ter Augustos intra
pomera vidi,
temporibus variis; eadem sed
causa tropaei
civilis dissensus erat. venere
superbi, 395
scilicet ut Latia respersos

the tears of her offspring? The tyrants were slain, but even they were my children. Caesar boasted him of his victories over the Gauls; he said nought about Pharsalia. Where the two sides bear the same standards and are of one blood, as defeat is ever shameful so victory brings no honour. See thou to it that now a truer glory crown our arms; give me back the joy, long a stranger to me, of honest

[36] Bocchus, king of Mauretania, treacherously delivered up his kinsman Jugurtha to Marius. Sulla acted as the agent of the Roman general in this matter.

[37] In a century so replete with civil war as the fourth it is hard to say which particular three instances Claudian has in mind. One is no doubt Constantine's defeat of Maxentius, after which we know that he entered Rome in triumph; the other two may refer to Theodosius' victories over Eugenius and Maximus.

desuetam iam redde mihi
iustisque furoris 405
externi spoliis soutes absolve
triumphos.

“Quem, precor, ad finem
laribus seiuncta potestas
exulat imperiumque suis a
sedibus errat?
cur mea quae cunctis tribuere
palatia nomen
neglecto squalent senio? nec
creditur orbis 410
illinc posse regi? medium non
deserit umquam
caeli Phoebus iter, radiis tamen
omnia lustrat.

segnius an veteres Histria
Rhenumque tenebant,
qui nostram coluere domum?
leviusve timebant
Tigris et Euphrates, cum
foedera Medus et Indus
415

hinc peteret pacemque mea
speraret ab arce?
hic illi mansere viri, quos mutua
virtus

legit et in nomen Romanis
rebus adoptans
iudicio pulchram seriem, non
sanguine duxit;
hic proles atavum deducens
Aelia Nervam 420
tranquillique Pii bellatoresque
Severi.

hunc civis dignare chorum
conspectaque dudum
ora refer, pompam recolens ut

While yet she entreated the emperor
reassured her with these words:
“Never shalt thou complain that I
have been deaf to thine entreaties; I
could not thwart thee, goddess, who
art the mother of our laws. Bring no
railing accusation against thy sons.
Did I disregard my country’s call
after the African war? Nay, I sent
thee Stilicho to sit in the curule chair
to take my place, a consul instead of
an emperor, a father- instead of a
son-in-law. In him thy

oia rerū, pompam recedens ut
 mente ^[106] priorem,
 quem tenero patris comitem
 suscepserat aevo, 424
 nunc duce cum socero iuvenem
 te Thybris adoret.”
 Orantem medio princeps
 sermone refovit:
 “numquam aliquid frustra per
 me voluisse dolebis,
 o dea, nec legum fas est
 occurrere matri.
 sed nec post Libyam (falsis ne
 perge querellis
 incusare tuos) patriae mandata
 vocantis 430
 sprevimus: advectae misso
 Stilichone curules,
 ut nostras tibi, Roma, vices pro
 principe consul
 impleret generoque socer.
 vidistis in illo

[107]

citizens saw also myself; so my love
 believes, for it has found that not
 blood alone but rather glorious deeds
 can show a parent. Had I a hundred
 tongues I could not touch on all the
 benefits he has bestowed upon me
 and upon the empire; one deed alone
 of them all will I recount to thee,
 goddess, if so be it is as yet unknown
 to thee, a deed of which I was the
 spectator or the cause.

“Alaric had laid waste Greece and
 the coasts of Thrace and in the mad
 pride of his many victories and the
 arrogance inspired by his crossing of
 the Alps had laid siege to the
 trembling cities of Liguria with
 winter as his ally—a season that
 favours a race accustomed to
 inclement skies; he then threatened
 to break down my defences and to
 lay strait siege to me also, bolstering
 up his hopes with the thought that, at
 the terror of his name and in fear of
 having none to aid me, I should
 come to terms with him on any
 conditions he chose. But I felt no
 fear, for I relied on the advance of
 Stilicho, and was mindful, O
 goddess, of those thy leaders who,
 even in face of death, never through
 base love of life made terms at the
 cost of honour. It was night;
 where’er I looked I saw the
 watchfires of the enemy shining like

me quoque; sic credit pietas non
sanguine solo,
sed claris potius factis experta
parentem. 435
cuncta quidem centum nequeam
perstringere linguis,
quae pro me mundoque gerit; sed ab
omnibus unum,
si fama necdum patuit, te, Roma,
docebo
subiectum nostris oculis et cuius
agendi
spectator vel causa fui. 440

Achivae
Bistoniaeque plagae, crebris
successibus amens
et ruptas animis spirans inmanibus
Alpes
iam Ligurum trepidis admoverat
agmina muris
tutior auxilio brumae (quo gentibus
illis
sidere consueti favet inclementia
caeli) 445
meque minabatur calcato obsidere
vallo
spem vano terrore fovens, si forte,
remotis
praesidiis, urgente metu, qua vellet
obire
condicione fidem; nec me timor
impulit ullus
et duce venturo fretum memoremque
tuorum, 450
Roma, ducum, quibus haud umquam
vel morte parata
foedus lucis amor peniguit dispendia

stars. The bugle had already
summoned the soldiers to the first
watch when glorious Stilicho arrived
from the frozen north. But the enemy
held the road between my father-in-
law and myself, and the bridge
whose obstructing piers churn turbid
Addua to yet fuller foam. What was
Stilicho to do? Halt? My danger
forbade the least delay. Break
through the enemy's line? His force
was too small. In hastening to my aid
he had left behind him many
auxiliaries and legionary troops.
Placed in this dilemma he

locus iactis amor pepigit aspenda
famae.^[108]

[109]

nox erat et late stellarum more
videbam
barbaricos ardere focos; iam classica
primos
excierant vigiles, gelida cum pulcher
ab Arcto 455
adventat Stilicho. medius sed
clauserat hostis
inter me socerumque viam pontemque
tenebat,
Addua quo scissas spumiosior incitat
undas.

quid faceret? differret iter? discrimina
nullas
nostra dabant adeunda moras.
perrumperet agmen?
sed paucis comitatus erat; nam
plurima retro, 461
dum nobis properat succurrere,
liquerat arma
extera vel nostras acies. hoc ille
locatus

thought it long and tedious to wait
for reinforcements and, putting aside
his own peril, was eager only to
deliver me from mine; inspired by
the courage that is born of love,
heedless of his own danger, he broke
through the enemy's midst and,
sword in hand, cutting down all who
sought to bar his passage, he passed
like lightning through the barbarians'
camp.

"Now let poets' songs praise me the
son of Tydeus because, relying on
Odysseus' help when the way was
opened by Dolon's wiles and all was
sunk in feasting and slumber, he
broke into the Thracian camp of
Rhesus and brought back to the
Greek lines his captured steeds,
which—if we may trust the too
generous Muses—surpassed the
winds in speed, the snows in
whiteness. Here was a man who,
with no treachery 'mid silent
slumber, clave a path for himself
with his sword in the open light of
day and arrived within our lines
covered with blood, thus surpassing
the brave deeds of Diomedes by as
much as day surpasses night and
open battle ambush. Alaric's
position, moreover, on the river bank
was a stronger one, and he himself a
warrior with whom Rhesus, even
when awake, could not be compared.

ancipiti, longum socias
tardumque putavit
expectasse manus et nostra
pericula tendit 465
posthabitis pulsare suis
mediumque per hostem
flammatum virtute pia
propriaeque salutis
inmemor et stricto prosternens
obvia ferro
barbara fulmineo secuit tentoria
cursu.

“Nunc mihi Tydiden attollant
carmina vatum, 470
quod iuncto fidens Ithaco
patefacta Dolonis
indicio dapibusque simul
religataque somno
Thracia sopiti penetraverit
agmina Rhesi
Graiaque rettulerit captos ad
castra iugales,
quorum, si qua fides audentibus
omnia Musis, 475
impetus excessit Zephyros
candorque pruinas.
ecce virum, taciti nulla qui
fraude soporis
ense palam sibi pandit iter
remeatque cruentus
et Diomedes tantum praeclarius
ausis,
quantum lux tenebris
manifestaque proelia
furtis! 480
adde quod et ripis steterat
munitior hostis
et cui nec vigilem fas est

Rhesus was king, Alaric the conqueror, of Thrace. Neither weapons nor the river's bar could stop Stilicho. So Horatius, standing on the falling bridge, drove back the threatening hosts of Etruria and then swam the Tiber, still carrying the shield wherewith to the amazement of Tarquin he had defended Rome, and from mid stream looked back with scornful gaze upon Porsenna. 'Twas the swift Addua my father breasted; but, as he swam the flood, Horatius turned his back upon the Etruscans, Stilicho faced the barbarian foe.

et cui nec vigiliis las est

[110] componere Rhesum:

Thrax erat, hic Thracum
domitor. non tela
retardant,
obice non haesit fluvii. sic ille
minacem
Tyrrenam labente manum pro
ponte repellens 485
traiecit clipeo Thybrim, quo
texerat urbem,
Tarquinio mirante Cocles
mediisque superbus
Porsennam respexit aquis. celer
Addua nostro
sulcatus socero: sed, cum
transnaret, Etruscis
ille dabat tergum, Geticis hic
pectora bellis. 490

[111]

“Now, O Rome, lead forth the chorus that shall hymn a contest of such high renown and let thy best genius with all its eloquence voice the well-merited praises of my foster parent.”

So spake he and, issuing from the walls of old Ravenna, advanced his standards. He crossed the mouths of the Po and left behind him that river harbour^[38] where, in fixed succession, in flows the foaming main and bears up the vessels that ride there at anchor on forward and backward flowing stream, and again deserts the waveless shore, like moon-led tides upon the marge of Ocean. Next he comes to the old city of Fortune's Temple that bids him glad welcome and from its height looks down upon Metaurus threading its rocky valley where an arch, tunnelled through the living rock, affords a path through the mountain's very heart, rising above the temple of Jove and the dizzy altars set up by the shepherds of the Apennines. 'Twas thy good pleasure, too, to visit Clitumnus' wave,^[39] beloved of them that triumph, for thence do victors get them white-coated animals for sacrifice at Rome. Thou markest well also the stream's strange property, flowing gently on when one approaches with silent step, but swirling and eddying

“Exere nunc doctos tantae
 certamina laudis,
 Roma, choros et, quanta tuis
 facundia pollet
 ingeniis, nostrum digno sonet
 ore parentem.”
 Dixit et antiquae muros
 egressa Ravennae
 signa movet; iamque ora Padi
 portusque relinquit 495
 flumineos, certis ubi legibus
 advena Nereus
 aestuat et pronas puppes nunc
 amne secundo,
 nunc redeunte vehit nudataque
 litora fluctu
 deserit, Oceani lunaribus
 aemula damnis.
 laetior hinc Fano recipit Fortuna
 vetusto, 500
 despiciturque vagus praerupta
 valle Metaurus,
 qua mons arte patens vivo se
 perforat arcu
 admisitque viam sectae per
 viscera rupis,
 exuperans delubra Iovis
 saxoque minantes
 Appenninigenis cultas
 pastoribus aras. 505
 quin et Clitumni sacras
 victoribus undas,
 candida quae Latiis praebent
 armenta triumphis,
 visere cura fuit; nec te miracula
 fontis
 praetereunt, tacito passu quem
 si quis adiret

should one hasten with louder
 utterance; and while it is the
 common nature of water to mirror
 the exact image of the body it alone
 boasts the strange power that it
 mimics not human form but human
 character. Next thy royal charger
 treads the streets of Narnia, looking
 out from its eminence upon the plain
 below: not far therefrom flows the
 strange-coloured stream which gives
 the town its name, its sulphurous
 waters

[38] Classis Portus, a harbour formed
 by means of the Fossa Augusta which
 led the southern arm of the Po to
 Ravenna. It was in existence in 38 B.C.
 (App. *B.C.* v. 78, 80) and held 250
 ships (Jordanes, *Get.* 150; cf. Pliny,
H.N. iii. 119; Sid. Apol. *Epp.* i. 5. 5).

[39] For a description of the Clitumnus
 see Pliny, *Epp.* viii. 8.

si quis auctor,
lentus erat; si voce gradum^[112]
maiore citasset, 510
commixtis fervebat aquis;
cumque omnibus una
sit natura vadis, similes ut
corporis undas
ostendant, haec sola novam
iactantia sortem
humanos properant imitari
flumina mores.
celsa dehinc patulum
prospectans Narnia
campum 515
regali calcatur equo, rarique
coloris
non procul amnis abest, urbi qui
nominis auctor:
ilice sub densa silvis artatus
opacis

[113]

flowing in tortuous course between
opposed mountains through dense
forests of holm-oak. Then when in
greeting to Father Tiber thou hast
poured a libation of his waters thou
art welcomed by Rome's arches and
all the magnificent buildings which
line the roads of that noble city's
suburbs.

And as a careful mother at the
approach of her daughter's lover
does all that trembling hand can do
to enhance the charms that are to win
a husband, oft readjusts dress and
girdle, confines her breast with
bands of green jasper, gathers up her
hair with jewels, sets a necklace
about her neck, and hangs glistening
pearls from her ears, so Rome, in
order to be pleasing in thy sight,
offers herself to thy admiring gaze
more glorious and with hills made
higher and herself greater than thou
hadst known her. Still fairer than of
old she seemed by reason of those
new walls that the rumour of the
Getae's approach had just caused to
be built; fear was the architect of that
beauteous work and, by a strange
freak of fortune, war put an end to
the decay that peace had brought.
For fear it was that caused the
sudden upspringing of all those
towers and renewed the youth of
Rome's seven hills by enclosing

inter utrumque iugum tortis
 anfractibus albet.
inde salutato libatis Thybride
 lymphis 520
excipiunt arcus operosaque
 semita vastis
molibus et quidquid tantae
 praemittitur urbi.
 Ac velut officiis trepidantibus
 ora puellae
spe propiore tori mater
 sollertior ornat
adveniente proco vestesque et
 cingula comit 525
saepe manu viridique angustat
 iaspide pectus
substringitque comam gemmis
 et colla monili
circuit et baxis onerat
 candentibus aures:
sic oculis placitura tuis
 insignior auctis
collibus et nota maior se Roma
 videndam 530
obtulit. addebant pulchrum
 nova moenia vultum
audito perfecta recens rumore
 Getarum,
profecitque opifex decori timor,
 et vice mira,
quam pax intulerat, bello
 discussa senectus
erexit subitas turres cunctosque
 coëgit 535
septem continuo colles
 iuvenescere muro.
ipse favens votis solitoque
 decentior aër

them all within one long wall. Even the weather listened favourably to our prayers and was finer than its wont, although continuous rain had spoiled the preceding night; but the clouds melted away before the glory of the sun and the emperor. All the days before had the south wind troubled with rain and dimmed the moon's young disc that heaven might know it was for thee that the sunshine waited.

One huge crowd filled all the slope between the Palatine hill and the Mulvian bridge and as far up

decedit aet,
quamvis adsiduo noctem^[114]
foedaverat imbre,
principis et solis radiis deterosa
removit
nubila; namque ideo pluviis
turbaverat omnes 540
ante dies lunamque rudem
madefecerat Auster,
ut tibi servatum scirent convexa
serenum.
Omne Palatino quod pons a
colle recedit
Mulvius et quantum licuit
consurgere tectis,

[115]

as it was possible to go on the house roofs; the ground seethed with men, the lofty buildings were aglow with women. Those who are young rejoice in an emperor of their own age, the old cease to belaud the past and count their destiny happy that they have lived to see such a day, blessing the kindly times when a prince so easy of access, so singular in courtesy, forbade the senators of Rome to march before his chariot, even though Eucherius, in whose veins ran regal blood on father's and on mother's side, and his own sister did honour to his triumph like simple soldiers. Such has been the teaching of that stern but loving parent who showed no more favour to his children than to himself, and refused a son honours he granted to nobles. Bent age and upstanding youth alike are loud in his praises and, comparing the new with the ancient rule, recognize in Honorius a true citizen, in his predecessors tyrants.

The women of Rome never tire of gazing at those blooming cheeks, those crowned locks, those limbs clothed in the consul's jasper-studded robes, those mighty shoulders, and that neck, beauteous as Bacchus' own, with its necklace of Red Sea emeralds. Many an innocent maid, while simple

una replet turbae facies: undare
videres 545
ima viris, altas effulgere
matribus aedes.
exultant iuvenes aequaevi
principis annis;
temnunt prisca senes et in hunc
sibi prospera fati
gratantur durasse diem
moderataque laudant
tempora, quod clemens aditu,
quod pectore solus 550
Romanos vetuit currum
praecedere patres:
cum tamen Eucherius, cui
regius undique sanguis,
atque Augusta soror fratri
praeberet ovanti
militis obsequium; sic illum
dura parentis
instituit pietas in se vel pignora
parci 555
quique neget nato, procerum
quod praestat honori.
haec sibi curva^[40] senum
maturaque comprobat
aetas
idque inter veteris speciem
praesentis et aulae
iudicat: hunc civem, dominos
venisse priores.
Conspicuas tum flore genas,
diademate crinem 560
membraque gemmato trabeae
viridantia cinctu
et fortes umeros et certatura
Lyaeo
inter Eurythoeae surgentis colla

modesty blushes in her cheek, would
bend her gaze o'er all and inquire of
her aged nurse the meaning of the
dragons on the colours. "Do they,"
she would ask, "but wave in the air
or is theirs a veritable hiss, uttered as
they are about to seize an enemy in
their jaws?" When she sees the mail-
clad knights and brazen-armoured
horses she would fain know whence
that iron race of men is sprung and
what land it is gives birth to steeds of
bronze. "Has the god of Lemnos,"

inter Erythraeos surgentia colla
[46] curva Birt, codd. cur.

smaragdos

mirari sine fine nurus;

ignaraque virgo,

cui simplex calet ore pudor, per

singula cernens 565

nutricem consultat anum: quid

fixa draconum

ora velint? ventis fluitent an

vera minentur

sibila suspensum rapturi

faucibus hostem?

ut chalybe indutos equites et in

aere latentes

vidit cornipedes: “quanam de

gente” rogabat 570

“ferrati venere viri? quae terra

metallo

nascentes informat equos? num

Lemnius auctor

she would ask, “bestowed on metal the power to neigh, and forged living statues for the fight?” Joy and fear fill her mind; she points with her finger how Juno’s bird decks the gay crests upon their helmets, or how, beneath the golden armour on their horses’ backs, the red silk waves and ripples over the strong shoulders.

Then it was, Stilicho, that Fortune repaid thee for the labour of so many years when, mounted in the same chariot, thou sawest thy son-in-law in his prime pass in triumph through the streets of Rome, and didst recall that day when in troubled terror mid uncertain fortune the dying father entrusted his son to thy care. Now thy many virtues have found their meet reward: loyalty that has kept safe that which was confided to it, singleness of purpose that made a boy the master of the world, affection that has bestowed such loving care on an adopted son. This is the boy who to-day summons Rome’s citizens to the place of meeting and from his father’s ivory throne tells to the fathers the causes and the issues of his acts, and, following ancient precedent, directs the deeds of empire at the judgement-seat of the Senate. He piles up no words, for confidence has nothing to conceal; his mind,

indidit hinnitum ferro
 simulacraque belli
 viva dedit?" gaudet metuens et
 pollice monstrat.
 quod picturatas galeae Iunonia
 cristas 575
 ornet avis vel quod rigidos
 vibrata per armos
 rubra sub aurato crispentur
 serica dorso.
 Tunc tibi magnorum mercem
 Fortuna laborum
 persolvit, Stilicho, curru cum
 vectus eodem
 urbe triumphantem generum
 florente iuventa 580
 conspiceres illumque diem sub
 corde referres,
 quo tibi confusa dubiis
 formidine rebus
 infantem genitor moriens
 commisit alendum.
 virtutes variae fructus sensere
 receptos;
 depositum servasse, fides;
 constantia, parvum 585
 praefecisse orbi; pietas, fovisse
 propinquum.
 hic est ille puer, qui nunc ad
 rostra Quirites
 evocat et solio fultus genitoris
 eburno
 gestarum patribus causas ex
 ordine rerum
 eventusque refert veterumque
 exempla secutus 590
 digerit imperii sub iudice facta
 sanatu

conscious of true worth, refuses the aid of artificial speech. The senators learn to know him; their chief wears the Gabine^[41] garb, and thronged with generals in the rôle of peace the Senate-house prepares for service under the auspices of the warlike court. Winged victory herself, Rome's faithful guardian, was in her temple;^[42] her golden pinions stretched in protection over the holy sanctuary where the fathers meet together, and she herself, a tireless

^[41] See note on vii. 3.

^[42] A reference to the statue of Victory in the Senate House. Ambrose had persuaded Gratian to turn it out (A.D. 384) but Honorius had had it replaced (cf. [xxiii.](#) 19 and Paulinus, *Vita S. Ambr.* viii. § 26).

senatu.
nil cumulat verbis^[118] quae nil
fiducia celat;
fucati sermonis opem mens
conscia laudis
abnuit. agnoscunt proceres;
habituque Gabino
principis et ducibus
circumstipata togatis 595
iure paludatae iam curia militat
aulae.
adfuit ipsa suis ales Victoria
templis
Romanae tutela togae: quae
divite penna
patricii reverenda fovet sacraria
coetus

[119]

attendant on thine armies, now at last
has had her wish granted and is able
to promise that for all time to come
thou shalt be Rome's guardian and
she thine.

Hence the Sacred Way (now truly
named) brings thee back to thy
home. Eagerly breaks out the world's
one-hearted welcome, that thou dost
not woo with lure of scattered gold;
nor for thee does the treasury,
seeking to corrupt good faith, court
venal applause; to worth
unpurchased love is offered by a
pure heart. For life that is dearer than
any gift makes all thy debtors. Away
with wooing of applause! He can ask
no payment who owes his life to
love.

Oh what mysterious power over the
people does the Empire's guardian-
genius bring! What majesty bows to
majesty as the prince, clad in
imperial scarlet, returns the
salutations of the people that crowd
the tiers of the Circus! The shouts of
the adoring populace rising from that
immense circle thunder to the sky,
while the echoes of Rome's seven
hills repeat as with one voice the
name of Honorius. Nor does the
Circus display only horse-races; its
floor, whereon chariots were wont to
drive, is surrounded by a palisade,
and in this new amphitheatre, so far,

castrorumque eadem comes
 indefessa tuorum 600
nunc tandem fruitur votis atque
 omne futurum
te Romae seseque tibi promittit
 in aevum.

 Hinc te iam patriis laribus via
 nomine vero
sacra refert. flagrat studiis
 concordia vulgi,
quam non inlecebris dispersi
 colligis auri; 605
nec tibi venales captant aeraria
 plausus
corruptura fidem: meritis
 offertur inemptus
pura mente favor. nam munere
 carior omni
obstringit sua quemque salus.
 procul ambitus erret!
non quaerit pretium, vitam qui
 debet amori. 610

 O quantum populo secreti
 numinis addit
imperii praesens genius!
 quantamque rependit
maiestas alterna vicem, cum
 regia circi
conexum gradibus veneratur
 purpura vulgus,
adsensuque cavae sublatus in
 aethera vallis 615
plebis adoratae reboat fragor,
 unaque totis
intonat Augustum septenis
 arcibus Echo!
nec solis hic cursus equis:
 adnata quadrigis

so different, from their native valleys, Libyan lions shed their blood. This is the scene, too, of a military display; here we often see armed bands advancing and retiring in mazèd movements that are nevertheless executed according to a fixed plan; we watch them wheel in perfect order, extend with disciplined precision, affording us the pleasing spectacle of mimic warfare. The leader cracks his whip and a thousand bodies execute in unison

auspicia quadrigis
cingunt arva trabes, subitaeque
adspectus harenae
diffundit Libycos aliena valle
cruores. 620
haec et belligeros exercuit area
lusus,
armatos haec saepe choros,
certaque vagandi
textas lege fugas inconfusosque
recursus
et pulchras errorum artes
iucundaque Martis
cernimus. insonuit cum verberare
signa magister, 625

[121]

their new movements; now they clap their bucklers to their sides, now they brandish them above their heads; deeply sound the clashing shields, sharply ring the engaging swords, and, to the rhythm of beaten targes, the echoing song of steel is punctuated by the interclash of weapons. Suddenly the whole phalanx falls on its knees before thee and a thousand helmets bow down in reverence. Then the companies separate, wheeling and counter-wheeling with ordered skill, following a course more tortuous than the corridors of the Minotaur's Cretan palace or the reaches of Meander's wandering stream. Then wheeling apart they form with circular masses, and Janus, [\[43\]](#) imprisoning war behind his ever unopening doors, after a happy mimicry of battle bestows on peace the innocent rewards of combat.

And now, his double head crowned with laurel, Janus opens the new year with auspicious calendar; now Tiber sees united in Honorius Brutus' consular robe and Romulus' kingly sceptre. The Palatine hill rejoices after many generations again to look upon a consul; the rostra learn to know the curule chair famed of old among our forefathers, and royal lictors, a long unwonted sight,

mutatos edunt pariter tot
 pectora motus
 in latus adlisis clipeis aut rursus
 in altum
 vibratis; grave parma sonat,
 mucronis acutum
 murmur, et umbonum pulsu
 modulante resultans
 ferreus alterno concentus
 clauditur ense. 630
 una omnis summissa phalanx
 tantaque salutant
 te, princeps, galeae. partitis inde
 catervis
 in varios docto discurritur
 ordine gyros,
 quos neque semiviri Gortynia
 tectata iuveni
 flumina nec crebro vincant
 Maeandria flexu. 635
 discreto revoluta gradu
 torquentur in orbes
 agmina, perpetuisque inmoto
 cardine claustris
 Ianus bella premens laeta sub
 immagine pugnae
 armorum innocuos paci largitur
 honores.
 Iamque novum fastis aperit
 felicibus annum 640
 ore coronatus gemino; iam
 Thybris in uno
 et Bruti cernit trabeas et sceptrum
 Quirini.
 consule laetatur post plurima
 saecula viso
 Pallanteus apex; agnoscunt
 rostra curules

encircle with their golden fasces the
 Forum of Trajan; while Honorius,
 wreathing with Getic laurels the axes
 borne for the sixth time before him,
 places a conqueror's foot upon the
 neck of subdued Danube. Let this
 year springing from its true source
 go forth among the nations more
 glorious than any—a year the consul
 inaugurated, not a stranger in a
 strange land, whose cradle the
 Senate-house guarded, that Roman
 citizens first beheld, that Victory, all
 wars o'ercome, auspiciously

[\[43\]](#) Mentioned, no doubt, as
 symbolical of the New Year.

auditas quondam proavis,
 hunc et desuetaque lingit 645
 regius avaris fontibus omnis
 et, quos Ulpius pater genitor
 et sextas Grotius praevelans
 diversis frondere secutis, ceu
 colla triumphata precat
 hunc et Honorius Histri. quos
 exeat in populos cunctos
 post alios, Augustus, volat. licet
 natus fontis suo, quos non
 consul eas, magno avaris 650
 induit hospes, peris, cuius
 nomine praeterea fuit
 curia, quoniam primum tandem. 660
 videre Quirites,
 quem domitis auspex peperit
 Victoria bellis!

brought to birth. Years in which mere
 commoners held the consulship, and
 ye years when Theodosius and his
 predecessors graced that office in
 Rome or elsewhere, count your
 honours as nought and worship this
 present year. Ay, you five previous
 consulships of Honorius, even you
 that our emperor shall hold in Rome
 in the days to come, give place to
 this one. Wert thou, Honorius, to be
 consul every year, yet is this thy
 sixth to be magnified above all thy
 consulships, excelling all that are
 past and model of all that are to
 come.

DE BELLO GOTHICO**PRAEFATIO**

(XXV.)

THE GOTHIC WAR**PREFACE**

(XXV.)

After years of sloth my Muse, as if startled from long slumber, rejoices to sing a Roman song to Roman ears. Once more the same halls bring the gathering I longed for, and Apollo's temple echoes to the voice of a familiar bard. 'Twas here I sang of the consular fasces and of the winning back of Libya and here must I sing of the war that overthrew the Getae.

But my former success won for me a brazen statue^[44] and the Fathers set up my likeness in my honour; at the Senate's prayer the Emperor allowed the claim—bethink thee, Muse, how strict a judgement thou dost face! Wit wins less favour when too soon rewarded, and so great a gift refuses indulgence for my song. Now that my name is read and my features are known in the forum my Muse labours for a sterner critic than before.

Yet my theme itself brings cheer and, as I begin to speak, eagerly lightens much of my accustomed fear. A gracious and more devoted hearing

Post resides annos longo velut
excita somno
Romanis fruitur nostra Thalia
choris.
optatos renovant eadem mihi
culmina coetus,
personat et noto Pythia vate
domus:
consulis hic fasces cecini
Libyamque receptam, 5
hic mihi prostratis bella
canenda Getis.
Sed prior effigiem tribuit
successus aënam,
oraeque patricius nostra
dicavit honos;
adnuat his princeps titulum
poscente senatu;
respice iudicium quam grave,
Musa, subis! 10
ingenio minuit merces
properata favorem:
carminibus veniam praemia
tanta negant;
et magis intento studium
censore laborat,
quod legimur medio
conspicimurque foro.
Materies tamen ipsa iuvat
solitumque timorem 15
dicturo magna sedula parte
levat.
nam mihi conciliat gratas
impensius aures
vel meritum belli vel
Stilichonis amor.

is secured for me, be it by the war's
deserving or be it by Stilicho's love.

[44] For Claudian's statue see
Introduction, p. xii. For a similar
honour conceded to Sidonius *cf.* Sid.
Apol. *Epp.* ix. 16. 3; *Carm.* viii. 8.

(XXVI.)

(XXVI.)

When the intrepid Argo, passing
 between the clashing rocks that
 guarded its entrance, burst through
 the portals of the unfurrowed sea
 making for Colchis where Aeëtes
 ruled, it is said that, when all were
 panic-stricken by the nearing danger,
 Tiphys alone—with heaven's help—
 kept safe the almost uninjured bark.
 'Twas thanks to him that the Argo
 escaped the cliffs threatening ruin
 and came out victorious into the
 open sea, cunningly eluding the
 meeting shock of the floating rocks.
 Amazed were the proud
 Symplegades thus subdued by the
 hero's skill, and, submitting to the
 novel laws of the fixed earth, offer
 unmoved an easy passage to all ships
 since once they have learned defeat.
 But if the merit of saving a single
 vessel from ruin won, and rightly
 won, for Tiphys such meed of
 honour, what praises shall suffice for
 thee, Stilicho, who hast freed so
 great an empire from destruction?
 Poets may exaggerate the story; they
 may boast that Minerva toiled with
 her own hands to hew the Argo's
 beams, and that she fitted together
 no senseless timber from a dumb
 forest, but felled the augural grove of
 Tomarian^[45] Jove and with those

Intacti cum claustra freti,
 coëuntibus aequor
 armatum scopulis, audax
 inrumperet Argo
 Aetam Colchosque petens,
 propiore periclo
 omnibus attonitis, solus post
 numina Tiphys
 incolumem tenui damno
 servasse carinam 5
 fertur et ancipitem montis
 vitasse ruinam
 deceptoque vagae concursu
 rupis in altum
 victricem duxisse ratem;
 stupuere superbae
 arte viri domitae Symplegades
 et nova passae
 iura soli cunctis faciles iam
 puppibus haerent, 10
 ut vinci didicere semel. quodsi
 ardua Tiphyn
 navis ob innocuae meritum sic
 gloria vexit,
 quae tibi pro tanti pulso
 discrimine regni
 sufficient laudes, Stilicho? licet
 omnia vates
 in maius celebrata ferant
 ipsamque secandis 15
 Argois trabibus iactent sudasse
 Minervam
 nec nemoris muti iunxisse
 carentia sensu
 robora, sed caeso Tomari Iovis
 augure luco
 arbore praesaga tabulas
 animasse loquaces

prophetic trees quickened its planks
 to speech. But though they burden
 their recital with the story of
 countless prodigies to captivate the
 mind of the unlettered

[45] A reference to the “talking oaks”
 of Dodona, Tomarus (or Tmarus) being
 a mountain in Epirus near Dodona.

ammassate roquaces.
[128]
plurima sed quamvis variis
miracula monstribus 20
ingeminant, teneras victuri
carminibus mentes,

[129]

young, though they tell of fierce Harpies, of the dragon whose unsleeping length lay curled in protecting folds about the golden fleece, of yoked bulls afire with flickering flames, of a springing crop of helmets, a field from out whose furrows grew a Martian race, of seeds of war whose increase yielded a harvest, too, of war, yet do these fictions fall short of the truth. Is it a nobler title to fame to have driven off the greedy Harpies and banished them from the table of a single man than to have had the strength to beat back those countless Getic maws that thirsted for the spoil of Latium? Am I to look with more admiration upon those earth-born warriors struck down in the very furrows from which they sprang, born and dying in a single day, than upon the slaughtered ranks of Getae whom the goddess of war reared on so many spoils and whose martial life came to grey hairs, passed ever beneath helmets?

Thou and thou alone, Stilicho, hast dispersed the darkness that enshrouded our empire and hast restored its glory; thanks to thee civilization, all but vanished, has been freed from the gloomy prison and can again advance. The old order of justice now makes distinction

Harpyiasque truces insopitisque
refusum
tractibus aurati custodem
velleris anguem
et iuga taurorum rapidis
ambusta favillis
et virides galeis sulcos fetasque
novalis 25
Martis et in segetem crescentis
semina belli:
nil veris aequale dabunt.
prohibere rapaces
scilicet Harpyias unaque
excludere mensa
nobilior titulus, quam tot
potuisse paratas
in Latii praedam Geticas
avertere fauces? 30
anne ego terrigenas potius
mirabor in ipsis
procubuisse satis, vitae quibus
attulit idem
principium finemque dies,
quam caesa Getarum
agmina, quos tantis aluit
Bellona tropaeis
totaque sub galeis Mavortia
canuit aetas? 35
Per te namque unum mediis
exuta tenebris
imperio sua forma redit,
claustrisque solutae
tristibus exangues audent
procedere leges.
iamque potestates priscus
discriminat ordo
iustitiae, quas ante pares
effecerat una 40

between magistracies which fear had
made equal in a common gloom. Thy
right hand has snatched us from
impending death and restored to
their homes and lands peoples whom
fate sentenced and thy valour saved.
No longer, herded together like
sheep by reason of our fears, do we
watch from the ramparts our fields
ablaze with the enemy's fire, no
longer measure the depth of rivers
which we feebly hope will retard our
destruction nor ask the streams and
flying clouds to

nube timor. tua^[130] nos urgenti
 dextera leto
 eripuit, tectisque suis redduntur
 et agris
 damnati fato populi, virtute
 renati.
 iam non in pecorum morem
 formidine clausi
 prospicimus saevos campis
 ardentibus ignes 45
 alta nec incertis metimur
 flumina votis
 excidio latura moram nec
 poscimus amnes

keep the promise of their waters or
 complain that the sunshine conspires
 against us with its splendour.

Thou, too, Rome, so long vexed with
 internal discord, lift up thy hills at
 last more peacefully in safety. Arise,
 honoured mother, be sure that God's
 favour is with thee; banish the lowly
 timorousness of age. City that art
 coëval with the world, inexorable
 Lachesis shall not exercise against
 thee her rights of destruction until
 Nature has so changed the
 immutable laws of the universe that
 Tanais turn his course and water
 Egypt, Nile flow into Lake Maeotis,
 Eurys blow from the west, Zephyr
 from India, and the south wind rage
 in tempest o'er the summit of
 Caucasus, while that of the north
 binds the deserts of Africa with its
 frost.

Thus far came the fatal hordes; now
 their threats, whereof so many
 omens warned us, have vanished
 away. Heaven's self was not always
 at peace: they tell how even Jove
 trembled (if one may dare to say so)
 when Typhoeus attacked him,
 arming his hundred hands with a
 hundred mountains and touching the
 astonished constellation of the Bear
 with his towering snaky coils. What
 wonder if trouble harasses mortal
 realms when cruel Aloeus' two sons

undosam servare fidem
 nubesque fugaces
 aut coniuratum querimur
 splendere serenum.
 Ipsa quoque internis furiis
 exercita plebis 50
 securas iam Roma leva
 tranquillior arces;
 surge, precor, veneranda parens,
 et certa secundis
 fide deis, humilemque metum
 depone senectae.
 urbs aequaeva polo, tum
 demum ferrea sumet
 ius in te Lachesis, cum sic
 mutaverit axem 55
 foederibus natura novis, ut
 flumine verso
 inriget Aegyptum Tanais,
 Maeotida Nilus,
 Eurus ab occasu, Zephyrus se
 promat ab Indis
 Caucasiisque iugis calido
 nigrantibus Austro
 Gaetulas Aquilo glacie
 constringat harenas. 60
 Fatales hucusque manus,
 crebrisque notatae
 prodigiis abiere minae. nec
 sidera pacem
 semper habent, ipsumque
 Iovem turbante
 Typhoeo,
 si fas est, tremuisse ferunt, cum
 brachia centum
 montibus armaret totidem
 spiramque retorquens 65
 lamheret attonitas erectis

cast Mars in chains and attempted to
 build that forbidden road to the stars
 so that the universe almost ceased to
 move, what time the three rocks^[46]
 were uprooted in the war of heaven?
 But their blind fury was of no effect;
 wicked hopes never exult for long.
 Aloeus' children never reached
 man's estate; Otus, attempting to
 uproot Pelion, was stricken down by
 Phoebus, and Ephialtes as he died
 wearily let Ossa fall athwart his side.

^[46] *i.e.* the mountains Pelion, Ossa
 and Olympus.

iamdederat altissimas cecus

anguibus^[132] Arctos.

quid mirum, si regna labor

mortalia vexat,

cum gemini fratres, genuit quos

asper Aloeus,

Martem subdiderint vinclis et in

astra negatas

temptarint munire vias

steteritque revulsis 70

paene tribus scopulis caelesti

machina bello?

sed caret eventu nimius furor;

improba numquam

spes laetata diu, nec pervenere

iuventae

robur Aloidae, dum vellere

Pelion Otus

nititur, occubuit Phoebo,

moriensque Ephialtes 75

in latus obliquam proiecit

languidus Ossam.

[133]

Lift up thy head, Rome, and behold thine enemy; see how, leading back in dishonour a shattered host, he is cast forth from Italy. How different is he from what he was when he swore that everything should yield to his onset and took an oath by Danube whom he and his fathers worshipped that he would never unbuckle his breastplate until he had marched in triumph through the Forum. How strange are the changes Fate brings about! He who destined the women of Rome as victims of his lust has seen his own wives and children led away captive; he who in imagination had drained the countless wealth of our city became himself his victor's easy prey; he who once sought to corrupt the loyalty of our troops has been deserted by his own people and has returned to his country beggared of men and arms.

Then too if, laying hatred aside, thou shouldest weigh the cause that won them pardon from their doom, surely to spare a fallen foe is itself a triumph and to see him on his knees punishment enough. What vengeance so satisfying as when terror makes pride stoop, and want bows down him who before bore spoils? But our clemency was in part due to another cause, for we thought

Adspice, Roma, tuum iam
 vertice celsior hostem,
adspice quam rarum referens
 inglorius agmen
Italia detrusus eat quantumque
 priori
dissimilis, qui cuncta sibi
 cessura ruenti 80
pollicitus patrii numen iuraverat
 Histri
non nisi calcatis loricam ponere
 rostris.
o rerum fatigue vices! qui foeda
 parabat
Romanas ad stupra nurus, sua
 pignora vidit
coniugibus permixta trahi; qui
 mente profundas 85
hauserat urbis opes, ultro
 victoribus ipse
praeda fuit; nostri quondam qui
 militis auro
adgressus temptare fidem,
 desertus ab omni
gente sua manibusque redit
 truncatus et armis.
Hoc quoque, quod veniam
 leti valere mereri, 90
si positis pendas odiis,
 ignoscere pulchrum
iam misero poenaeque genus
 vidisse precantem.
quae vindicta prior quam cum
 formido superbos
flectit et adsuetum spoliis
 adfligit egestas?
sed magis ex aliis fluxit
 dementia causis 95

of thee, O Rome. Concern for thee constrained us to offer a way of escape to the beleaguered foe lest, with the fear of death before their eyes, their rage should grow the more terrible for being confined. An enemy before thy very walls would have been too heavy a price to pay for the destruction of the race and name of the Getae. May Jove from on high forbid that the barbarian should outrage even with a glance Numa's shrine or Romulus' temple, or discover aught of the secrets of our empire.

Quamquam, si veterum
 certamina rite recordor,
 tunc etiam, pulchra cum
 libertate vigerent 105
 et proprio late florerent milite
 patres,
 semper ab his famae petiere
 insignia bellis,
 quae diversa procul tuto trans
 aequora vires
 exercere dabant: currus
 regumque catenae
 inter abundantis fati ludibria
 ductae. 110
 at vero Italiam quotiens
 circumstetit atrox
 tempestas ipsumque caput
 laesura pendit,
 non illis vani ratio ventosa
 furoris,
 sed graviter spectata salus
 ductorque placebat,
 non qui praecipiti traheret semel
 omnia casu, 115
 sed qui maturo vel laeta vel
 aspera rerum
 consilio momenta regens, nec
 tristibus impar
 nec pro successu nimius,
 spatiumque morandi
 vincendique modum mutatis
 nosset habenis.
 cautius ingentes morbos et
 proxima cordi 120
 ulcera Paeoniae tractat sollertia
 curae
 parcendoque secat, ferro ne
 largius acta

Proud assuredly is the strain in which bards of old sing of Curius who drove Pyrrhus, son of Aeacus, from the shores of Italy; [47] not more resplendent were the triumphs of Paulus and of Marius who dragged captive kings behind their white-horsed chariots. The expulsion of Pyrrhus is more praised than the capture of Jugurtha; and although Curius drove out a prince whose spirit had already been broken by two reverses, at the hands of Decius and of the blameless Fabricius whom neither bribes

[47] After his defeat by Curius Dentatus near Beneventum in 277 B.C. Pyrrhus, king of Epirus, was forced to evacuate Italy. Claudian, in this section, is at pains tactfully to justify Stilicho's *expulsion* of Alaric from Italy, as opposed to his *capture*.

inrevocandus eat^[136] sectis vitalibus
 error.
 Sublimi certe Curium canit
 ore vetustas,
 Aeaciden Italo pepulit qui litore
 Pyrrhum, 125
 nec magis insignis Pauli
 Mariique triumphus,
 qui captos niveis reges egere
 quadrigis;
 plus fuga laudatur Pyrrhi quam
 vincla Iugurthae;
 et, quamvis gemina fessum iam
 clade fugavit,
 post Decii lituos et nulli pervia
 culpae 130
 pectora Fabricii, donis invicta
 vel armis,

[137]

nor arms could overcome, yet the
 whole glory of that expulsion is
 given to him. But how much greater
 the task we see fulfilled by Stilicho
 alone! He has conquered not
 Chaones or Molossi, Epirot tribes,
 nor yet the armies of Dodona that
 idly boast their prophetic grove, but
 a mighty people whose home lies in
 those snowy regions beneath the icy
 constellation of the Bear.

Fabius was the first to stay by his
 slow struggles Hannibal's lightning
 rush; then Marcellus, meeting him in
 the open field, taught him defeat, but
 it was the valour of Scipio that drove
 him from the shores of Italy. In the
 case of our latest foe Stilicho
 succeeded in combining in himself
 the diverse skill of all these three; he
 broke their frenzy by delaying,
 vanquished them in battle and drove
 the vanquished host from Italy.

And all this in so short a time. Full
 five years did Italy mourn beneath
 the scattered fires of Pyrrhus, for
 well-nigh eighteen years did the
 African steeds of the Carthaginians
 tread down and devastate our
 harvests, and it was a second
 generation, born after the outbreak of
 the war, that, exacting a tardy
 vengeance for the first, with
 difficulty drove an aged Hannibal
 back to his own country. Stilicho

plena datur Curio pulsi victoria
Pyrrhi.
quanto maius opus solo
Stilichone peractum
cernimus! his validam gentem,
quam dura nivosis
educat Ursa plagis, non
Chaonas atque
Molossos, 135
quos Epirus alit, nec Dodonaea
subegit
agmina fatidicam frustra
iactantia quercum.
Primus fulmineum lento
luctamine Poenum
compressit Fabius, campo post
ausus aperto
Marcellus vinci docuit, sed
tertia virtus 140
Scipiadae Latiis tandem
deterruit oris.
unus in hoc Stilicho diversis
artibus hoste
tris potuit complere duces
fregitque furem
cunctando vicitque manu
victumque relegat.
Atque haec tanta brevi.
miscentem incendia
Pyrrhum
sustinuit toto maerens Oenotria
lustro, 146
et prope ter senas Itali per
graminis herbas
Massylus Poeno sonipes
vastante cucurrit
Hannibalemque senem vix ad
sua repulit arva

acted more quickly: he saw to it that
the winter of our distress should last
but one winter^[49] but that spring in
its earliest months should bring back
fair weather alike to heaven and to
fatherland.

Why should I make mention of the
wars waged all those weary years
against Hannibal and Pyrrhus when
that vile gladiator Spartacus,
ravaging all the countryside with fire
and sword, oft engaged the consuls
in open war and, driving out its
feeble masters

^[49] The winter of 401-402.

[48] ^{sua Pyrrhumque} ^{codd. belloque; Birt suggests}
vindex sera patrum post bellum
^{regnoque, Postquam patriaeque.}

nata iuventus. 150
his celer effecit, bruma ne
longior una
esset hiems rerum, primis sed
mensibus aestas
temperiem caelo pariter
patriaeque [48] referret.
Sed quid ego Hannibalem
contra Pyrrhumque tot
annis
certatum memorem, vilis cum
Spartacus omne 155
per latus Italiae ferro bacchatus
et igni
consulibusque palam totiens
congressus inertes
exuerit castris dominos et strage
pudenda

from the Roman camp, put to rout the unwarlike eagles defeated with shameful carnage by a band of slaves? We, unused to war's alarms, an age enervated with luxury, grumble and give up in despair if a ploughing ox is looted or our harvest so much as touched. It was no slaves' prison that loosed on us the Getic hordes; these were not a crowd of rebellious gladiators. Thrace, Haemus and Moesia can tell you what manner of foe Stilicho expelled. Thrice ten times has chill winter cast her snowy mantle over leafless Haemus; as oft has spring, when those snows were melted, renewed the mountain's verdant cloak since the Getic race, forgetful of its native stars and once having crossed the Danube, set destructive foot on Thracian soil. Whether fate led them or the heavy anger of the gods planning disaster upon disaster, from that day, whithersoever the Furies have driven those errant bands, they have poured pell-mell over remote lands, over every obstacle, like a storm of hail or a pestilence. No streams or rocks availed to defend their country. Neither Rhodope nor huge Athos nor Hebrus could save Thrace; the Bessi cursed the Strymon crossed with scornful ease and the Haliacmon that flowed swiftly and to no purpose.

fuderit imbelles aquilas
servilibus armis?
nos terrorum expers et luxu
mollior aetas 160
deficimus queruli, si bos
abductus aratro,
si libata seges. non hanc
ergastula nobis
inmisere manum nec
coniurantis harenae
turba fuit; qualem Stilicho
deiecerit hostem,
Thraces et Haemonii poterunt
Moesique fateri. 165
Frigida ter decies nudatum
frondibus Haemum
tendit hiems vestire gelu
totiensque solutis
ver nivibus viridem monti
reparavit amictum,
ex quo iam patrios gens haec
oblita Triones
atque Histrum transvecta semel
vestigia fixit 170
Threicio funesta solo. seu fata
vocabant
seu gravis ira deum, seriem
meditata ruinis,
ex illo, quocumque vagos
impegit Erinys,
grandinis aut morbi ritu per
devia rerum,
praecipites per clausa ruunt, nec
contigit ullis 175
amnibus aut scopulis proprias
defendere terras.
nil Rhodope, nil vastus Athos,
nil profuit Haemus

The Macedonians in amaze saw
Olympus, too high even for clouds,
trodden by them as it had been a
plain. Thessaly bewails the
uselessness of Tempe and conquered
Oeta's ridges made a mock.
Sperchius and Enipeus, loved of
maidens, served to wash the
barbarians' hair. The barrier of
Pindus could not save the Dryopes
nor cloud-capped Leucates the coasts
of Actium. Thermopylae itself that
had once more boldly withstood the
Persians yielded a passage

in proat nebus
 Odrysiis; facili^[140] contemptum
 Strymona saltu
 et frustra rapidum damnant
 Haliacmona Bessi.
 nubibus intactum Macedo
 miratur Olympum 180
 more pererratum campi; gemit
 inrita Tempe
 Thessalus et domitis inrisam
 cautibus Oeten.
 Sperchiusque et virginibus
 dilectus Enipeus
 barbaricas lavere comas. non
 obice Pindi
 servati Dryopes nec nubifer
 Actia texit 185
 litora Leucates; ipsae, quae
 durius olim
 restiterant Medis, primo
 conamine ruptae

[141]

at the first onset. Sciron's cliffs
 protected by the waves, the wall that
 joins sea to sea across the Isthmus of
 Corinth, the narrow pass of
 Lechaeum, all lay open to their
 approach. Thou, Erymanthus,
 couldst not protect the people of
 Arcadia with thy leafy ridges and
 thou, Amyclae, didst tremble to see
 the enemy's cavalry on the heights of
 Taygetus.

At last, however, the Alps avenged
 on the Getae the disgrace of all
 mountains else and victorious
 Eridanus that of all other rivers. The
 event has proved that deep hidden
 are the ways of destiny. Who would
 have believed that, once a passage
 had been forced over the Alps, so
 much as the shadow of Italy's name
 would survive? Did not the awful
 report of Rome's fall cross the sea
 and spread beyond Gaul and over the
 Pyrenees? Did not Rumour, her sable
 wing sped on with panic, sweeping
 all before her in her flight, affright
 Ocean from Britain's coast to Gades'
 city and far away from our world
 make distant Thule tremble with the
 unaccustomed echoes of war?

And shall we fling to the South-
 wind's blasts all the terrors we
 endured, lest mid feasting sadness
 trouble our ears? Or rather does such
 memory delight and does precursive

Thermopylae; vallata mari
Scironia rupes
et duo continuo conectens
aequora muro
Isthmos et angusti patuerunt
claustra Lechaei: 190
nec tibi Parrhasios licuit munire
colonos
frondosis, Erymanthe, iugis,
equitataque summi
culmina Taygeti trepidae
vidistis Amyclae.
Tandem supplicium cunctis
pro montibus Alpes
exegere Getas; tandem tot
flumina victor 195
vindicat Eridanus. docuit nunc
exitus alte
fatorum secreta regi.
quisquamne reclusis
Alpibus ulterius Latii fore
credidit umbram?
nonne velut capta rumor
miserabilis urbe
trans freta, trans Gallos
Pyrenaeumque cucurrit?
200
Famaque nigrantes succincta
pavoribus alas
secum cuncta trahens a Gadibus
usque Britannum
terruit Oceanum et nostro
procul axe remotam
insolito belli tremefecit
murmure Thylen?
Mandemusne Noti flabris
quoscumque timores 205
perterritum, festae doleant ne

pain ever changefully heighten
unexpected joy? Even as to sailors
storm-tossed at the Pleiads' setting
the rudeness of the sea commends
the harbour's calm, so to me does
Stilicho appear greater when I
compare happiness with hazard and
all those troubles come again before
my mind.

Did not our steel-girt walls seem to
fall at the enemy's attack, feeble as
the towers that crowned them, and
our doors of iron to open of their
own accord to give him entry? It
seemed as though

periculis, testae uideant ne
tristibus^[142] aures?

an potius meminisse iuvat
semperque vicissim
gaudia praemissi cumulant
inopina dolores?
utque sub occidua iactatis
Pleiade nautis
commendat placidum maris
inclementia portum, 210
sic mihi tunc maior Stilicho,
cum laeta periclis
metior atque illi redeunt in
corda tumultus.

Nonne videbantur, quamvis
adamante rigentes,
turribus invalidis fragiles
procumbere muri
ferrataeque Getis ultro se
pandere portae? 215

[143]

no rampart nor palisade were stout enough to withstand his cavalry's wind-swift onset. Even now they^[50] make ready to go aboard their ships, to dwell in Sardinia's creeks and Corsica's rocky, inhospitable coast, and to guard their lives behind the foaming main. Sicily herself, mistrusting the narrow strait, would fain retreat, did but Nature permit, and open a wider passage for the Ionian waves by withdrawing Pelorus. The rich, setting no store by their fretted golden ceilings, would rather have lived in greater security in an Aeolian cave. Soon, too, wealth was considered a burden, and greed of gain was curbed at last by reason of anxieties more overwhelming. Then—for that fear is by nature a babbler and allows all sorts of tales to be invented and believed—dreams, portents, and omens of ill were discussed on all sides. What, men asked, did that flight of birds portend, what message would heaven fain deliver to mortals by the thunderbolt, what did those prophetic books demand that guard the destiny of Rome? Constant eclipses of the moon alarmed us and night after night throughout the cities of Italy sounded wailings and the beating of brazen gongs to scare the shadow from off her darkened face.

nec vallum densaeque sudes
 arcere volantes
cornipedum saltus? iamiam
 conscendere puppes
Sardoniosque habitare sinus et
 inhospita Cyni
saxa parant vitamque freto
 spumante tueri.
ipsa etiam diffisa brevi
 Trinacria ponto, 220
si rerum natura sinat, discedere
 longe
optat et Ionium refugo laxare
 Peloro.
fultaque despiciens auro
 laquearia dives
tutior Aeoliis mallet vixisse
 cavernis;
iamque oneri creduntur opes
 tandemque libido 225
haesit avaritiae gravioribus
 obruta curis.
utque est ingenioque loquax et
 plurima fingi
permittens credique timor, tunc
 somnia vulgo
narrari, tunc monstra deum
 monitusque sinistri:
quid meditentur aves, quid cum
 mortalibus aether
fulmineo velit igne loqui, quid
 carmine poscat 231
fatidico custos Romani carbasus
 aevi.
territat adsiduus lunae labor
 atraque Phoebe
noctibus aerisonas crebris
 ululata per urbes

Men would not believe that the moon had been defrauded of her brother the sun, forbidden to give light by the interposition of the earth; they thought that Thessalian witches, accompanying the barbarian armies, were darkening her rays with their country's magic spells. Then with these new portents their troubled minds link the signs of the past year and any omens that perchance peaceful days had neglected—showers of stones, bees swarming in strange places, furious

[50] *i.e.* the inhabitants of Italy.

audata per ardes.
nec credunt vetito^[144] fraudatam
 Sole sororem 235
telluris subeunte globo, sed
 castra secutas
barbara Thessalidas patriis
 lunare venenis
incestare iubar. tunc anni signa
 prioris
et si quod fortasse quies
 neglexerat omen,
addit cura novis: lapidosos
 grandinis ictus 240
molitasque examen apes
 passimque crematas

[145]

fires destroying houses from no known cause, a comet—ne'er seen in heaven without disaster—which first rose where Phoebus lifts his rosy morning beam and old Cepheus shines together with starry Andromeda, his spouse; then it withdrew little by little to the constellation of Lycaon's daughter^[51] and with its errant tail dimmed the stars of the Getic Wain until at last its dying fires grew feeble and vanished.

But what terrified men's minds still more was the portent of the two slaughtered wolves. Ay, before the Emperor's face as he practised his cavalry upon the plain two wolves savagely attacked his escort. Slain by darts they disclosed a horrid portent and a wondrous sign of what was to be. In each animal, on its being cut open, was found a human hand, in the stomach of one a left hand, in that of the other a right was discovered, both still twitching, the fingers stretched out and suffused with living blood. Wouldest thou search out the truth, the beast as messenger of Mars foretold that the foe would fall before the emperor's eyes. As the hands were found to be living when the stomachs were cut open, so, when the Alps had been broken through, the might of Rome

perbacchata domos nullis
 incendia causis
 et numquam caelo spectatum
 impune cometem,
 qui primum roseo Phoebi
 prolatus ab ortu,
 qua micat astrigera senior cum
 coniuge Cepheus; 245
 inde Lycaoniam paulatim
 expulsus ad Arcton
 crine vago Getici foedavit
 sidera Plaustri,
 donec in exiguum moriens
 vanesceret ignem.
 Sed gravius mentes caesorum
 ostenta luporum
 horrificant. duo quippe lupi sub
 principis ora, 250
 dum campis exercet equos,
 violenter adorti
 agmen et excepti telis inmane
 relatu
 prodigium miramque notam
 duxere futuri.
 nam simul humano geminas de
 corpore palmas
 utraque perfossis emisit belua
 costis: 255
 illo laeva tremens, hoc dextera
 ventre latebat
 intentis ambae digitis et
 sanguine vivo.
 scrutari si vera velis, fera nuntia
 Martis
 ora sub Augusti casurum
 prodidit hostem,
 utque manus utero virides
 naturae resecta, 260

was to be discovered unimpaired.
 But fear, ever a poor interpreter, read
 disaster in the portent; severed
 hands, 'twas said, and nursing wolf
 threatened destruction on Rome and
 her empire. Then they reckoned up
 the years and, cutting off the flight of
 the twelfth vulture, tried to shorten
 the centuries of Rome's existence by
 hastening the end. [\[52\]](#)

'Twas Stilicho alone who by his
 courage assured despairing Rome the
 promise of a better fate; at

[\[51\]](#) i.e. The Great Bear.

[\[52\]](#) The twelve vultures seen by Romulus (Livy i. 7. 1) were interpreted as twelve centuries of Roman power. Taking the traditional date of the founding of the city (754 B.C.) more than eleven centuries had already passed.

pater electio, 200
 Romula post ruptas virtus sic^[146]
 emicat Alpes.
 sed malus interpret rerum
 metus omne trahebat
 augurium peiore via,
 truncataque membra
 nutricemque lupam Romae
 regnoque minari.
 tunc reputant annos
 interceptoque volatu 265
 vulturis incidunt properatis
 saecula metis.
 Solus erat Stilicho, qui
 desperantibus augur
 sponderet meliora manu,
 dubiaeque salutis

[147]

this crisis he showed himself by his courage at once general and seer. “A little patience,” said he; “away with womanly repinings: let us bear with fortitude whatever fate lays upon us. What good do the sailors’ cries do to the storm-driven vessel? Neither waves nor winds will abate their fury for coward tears or useless prayer. Now for the general safety it befits us to use every effort, to struggle with all our strength—to attend to the sails, work the pumps, manage the various ropes, and obey every order of the skilful captain. Because the Getae have broken through, seizing by treachery the hour for striking home, what time Raetia claimed our attention and our regiments were busied with another war—not for that is all hope lost. Marvel indeed I might, if by some new guile, some discovered path, the barbarian ignorantly marched over the unexplored Alps; now, however, the successive defeats of the two tyrants^[53] have made the road notorious, nor has the foeman missed the well-known track that was built for him by our civil strife. They have come a well-known way and Roman discord has opened the approach to barbaric war.

“Past generations have known a like fate. Full often, we know, has Italy

eyes on Gaul? Would you leave Latium and establish on the banks of the Saône a camp of refugees? Is Rome to be ceded to Arctic tribes, our empire to settle on the Rhone, and shall the trunk survive the head? If the thought of your children has any weight with you, remember that I too am not unaffected by similar feelings of nature; my heart is not so hard that I do not nor will not recognize the sacred ties that bind son to father-in-law, wife to husband and children to sire. But never, forgetting honour, shall cowardly affection seek refuge in ignominious flight. Nor do I give you bold advice, more careful for myself alone; here is my family, my wife, and her father whom I love more than life itself; not one of my relations is beyond the reach of this tempest. O land of Italy, know that my heart is set on bearing with thee whatsoever ills thou art called on to bear. Romans, hold your walls but for a short while till I return, bringing back to the sound of trumpets the flower of your host."

With these words he instilled courage into the fearful hearts of the citizens and checked any inclination towards flight in the Court. The dark shadow fled and Italy dared raise her head once more seeing her emperor ready to share her perils, and stood

respicitis Latioque libet post
terga relicto
longinquum profugis Ararim
praecingere castris?
scilicet Arctois concessa
gentibus urbe
considet regnum Rhodano
capitique superstes 300
truncus erit? vestros stimulant si
pignora sensus,
me quoque non impar naturae
cura remordet,
nec ferro sic corda rigent ut
nosse recusem
quam sanctum soceri nomen,
quam dulce mariti,
quantus prolis amor. sed
numquam oblita decoris
obscaenam latebram pietas
ignava requiret. 306
nec vobis fortis monitor, mihi
cautior uni:
hic coniunx, hic progenies, hic
carior omni
luce gener; pars nulla mei
subducta procellae.
accipe tu nostrae, tellus
Oenotria, mentis 310
vincula communes tecum
subeuntia casus,
exiguamque moram muris
impende tuendis,
dum redeo lectum referens in
classica robur.”

His dictis pavidi firmavit
inertia vulgi
pectora migrantisque fugam
compescuit aulæ. 315

her ground with such a hostage for
fortune. Where Larius clothes his
banks with shady olive-trees and
with his fresh water imitates the
sea's salt waves, Stilicho crossed the
lake with all speed in a small boat.
Next he ascended those mountains,
inaccessible in winter, with no
thought for the season or the
weather. Even so a lion, leaving his
starving cubs within the

compescunt aquae, sis
ausaque tum ^[150]primum tenebris
emergere pulsus
Hesperia, ut secum iunxisse
pericula vidit
Augustum, tantoque sui stetit
obside fati.
protinus, umbrosa vestit qua
litus oliva
Larius et dulci mentitur Nerea
fluctu, 320
parva puppe lacum praetervolat;
ocius inde
scandit inaccessos brumali
sidere montes
nil hiemis caelive memor. sic
ille relinquens
ieiunos antro catulos inmanior
exit

[151]

cave, issues forth hunger-maddened
some winter night and with silent
tread goes out across the deep snow
with murder in his heart, his mane
frozen about his shoulders, and
icicles clinging to his tawny coat;
nought recks he of death nor cares
for snow nor frost if only he can
procure food for his little ones.

Near to the Hercynian forest the
uplands of Raetia stretch out towards
the north, Raetia, proud parent of
Danube and Rhine, twain rivers that
she sets to guard the empire of
Rome. Small are their streams at
first, but soon they grow in depth
and like kings compel the lesser
waters to pass with tributary wave
beneath their name. The Cimbric
ocean receives Rhine's flood
outpoured through his two mouths;
the Thracian wave swallows that of
Ister flowing out through five
channels. Both rivers are navigable
though both bear at times the marks
of chariot-wheels upon their frozen
surface; stout allies both of the north
wind and the god of war. But on the
side where Raetia marches with Italy
precipitous mountains touch the sky,
scarce even in summer offering an
awful path. Many a man has there
been frozen to death as though he
had looked on the Gorgon's head;
many have been engulfed beneath

hiberna sub nocte leo tacitusque per vast masses of snow, and often are
 altas 325 carts and the oxen that draw them
 incedit furiale nives; stant colla plunged into the white depths of the
 pruinis crevasse. Sometimes the mountain
 aspera; flavescentes adstringit stiria plunges downwards in an avalanche
 saetas; of ice, loosening neath a warmer sky
 nec meminit leti nimbosve aut foundations that trust vainly in the
 frigora curat, precipitous slope.
 dum natis alimenta parat.

in Arcton Sublimis Such was the country over which
 prominet Hercyniae confinis Raetia Stilicho passed in mid winter. No
 silvae, 330 wine was there; Ceres' gifts were
 quae se Danuvii iactat Rhenique sparing; 'twas enough to snatch a
 parentem hurried meal, eaten sword in hand,
 utraque Romuleo praetendens while, burdened with rain-drenched

flumina regno:
 primo fonte breves, alto mox
 gurgite regnant
 et fluvios cogunt unda coeunte
 minores
 in nomen transire suum. te
 Cimbrica Tethys 335
 divisum bifido consumit, Rhene,
 meatu;
 Thracia quinque vadis Histria
 vorat Amphitrite:
 ambo habiles remis, ambo glacialia
 secti
 terga rotis, ambo Boreae Martique
 sodales.
 sed latus, Hesperiae quo Raetia
 iungitur orae, 340
 praeruptis ferit astra iugis panditque
 tremendam
 vix aestate viam. multi ceu Gorgone
 visa
 obriquere gelu: multos hausere

conguere gelu, multos hausere
profundae^[152]

vasta mole nives, cumque ipsis
saepe iuvenis
naufraga candenti merguntur
plaustra barathro. 345
interdum subitam glacie labente
ruinam
mons dedit et tepidis fundamina
subruit astris
pendenti male fida solo.

Per talia
tendit
frigoribus mediis Stilicho loca.
nulla Lyaei
pocula; rara Ceres; raptos contentus
in armis 350
delibasse cibos madidoque oneratus
amictu

[153]

cloak, he urged on his half-frozen steed. No soft bed received his weary limbs. If the darkness forced him to halt in his advance he would either enter some dreadful beast's den or sleep in some shepherd's hut, his head pillowed upon his shield. The shepherd stands pale at the sight of his stately guest, and ignorant of his name the rustic mother points out to her squalid infant the glory of his face. It was those hard couches beneath the rough pines, those nights amid the snow, all that care and anxious toil, that won this peace for the world, this tranquillity it had despaired of for the empire. From out those Alpine huts, Rome, came thy salvation.

Now had the peoples broken their treaties and, encouraged by the news of Latium's trouble, had seized upon the glades of Vindelicia and the fields of Noricum. Like slaves whom news of their master's death lures into luxury with an idle tale, if mid the debauch and while wild licence riots with wine and dance some unexpected chance bring back their lord, then they stand panic-stricken and, abhorring liberty, servile terror shakes their guilty souls; so all the rebels were struck with terror at the sight of the general and in one man the Emperor, Latium and all Rome

algentem pulsabat equum. nec
 mollia fesso
strata dedere torum; tenebris si
 caeca repressit
nox iter, aut spelaea subit
 metuenda ferarum
aut pastorali iacuit sub culmine
 fultus 355
cervicem clipeo. stat pallidus
 hospite magno
pastor et ignoto praeclarum
 nomine vultum
rustica sordenti genetrix
 ostendit alumno.
illa sub horrendis praedura
 cubilia silvis,
illi sub nivibus somni curaeque
 laborque 360
pervigil hanc requiem terris,
 haec otia rebus
insperata dabant; illae tibi,
 Roma, salutem
Alpinae peperere casae.

Iam

 foedera gentes
exuerant Latiiue audita clade
 feroces
Vindelicos saltus et Norica rura
 tenebant. 365
ac veluti famuli, mendax quos
 mortis erilis
nuntius in luxum falso rumore
 resolvit,
dum marcent epulis atque inter
 vina chorosque
persultat vacuis effrena licentia
 tectis,
si reducem dominum sors

blazed before their eyes. Joy sat not upon his countenance nor excess of gloom nor yet dejection by reason of Rome's reverses but nobility and indignation mixed, such as filled Hercules at Eurystheus' inhuman orders, or such as dims the face of heaven when at Jove's frown the troubled sky is gathered into a murky cloud.

"Put ye such faith," he cried, "in Getic arms? Is it they that swell your hearts with empty pride? Fate has not brought Rome's name so low that she

SI REDUCEM DOMINUM SOLIS

[154]
improvisa revexit, 370

haerent attoniti libertatemque
perosus

conscia servilis praecordia
concutit horror:

sic ducis adspectu cuncti
stupuere rebelles,
inque uno princeps Latiumque
et tota refulsit

Roma viro. frons laeta parum,
non tristior aequo,
non deiecta malis, mixta sed
nobilis ira: 376

qualis in Herculeo, quotiens
infanda iubebat

Eurystheus, fuit ore dolor vel
qualis in atram

sollicitus nubem maesto Iove
cogitur aether.

“Tantane vos” inquit “Getici
fiducia belli 380

erigit? hinc animo frustra
tumuistis inani?

non ita Romanum fati violentia
nomen

[155]

cannot punish your rebellion with but a handful of her forces. Not to delay you with foreign tales, hear this example from your deeds of old. When warlike Hannibal was spreading destruction throughout the cities of Italy, and Cannae had doubled Trebia's cruel losses, a vain hope drove Philip of Macedon to turn his feeble sword against a people which, as he thought, was in difficulties. The monstrous insult roused the Roman Fathers, although more pressing dangers were crowding upon them, and they took it ill that, while two great cities were disputing the mastery of the world, a lesser race should be insolent. They determine upon instant vengeance and command Laevinus, even while he conducts the war with Carthage, to do battle also with the king of Macedonia. The consul obeyed his orders, and Philip, intruding his feeble arms between mighty nations, was routed by a passing band and learned that it does not do to tempt the anger of powerful peoples even when they are in distress.”

With this warning Stilicho alike checked the threatened war and won new allies for war, enrolling them at their entreaty and setting such number to their forces as should best

opprimit, ut vestros nequeat
 punire tumultus
parte sui. ne vos longe sermone
 petito
demorer, exemplum veteris
 cognoscite facti: 385
cum ferus Ausonias perfringeret
 Hannibal arces
et Trebiam saevo geminassent
 funere Cannae,
nequiquam Emathium pepulit
 spes vana Philippum,
ut velut adflictos ferro temptaret
 inerti.
Romanos commovit atrox
 iniuria patres, 390
urgerent maiora licet,
 graviterque tulere,
urbibus inter se claris de
 culmine rerum
congressis, aliquid gentes
 audere minores.
nec poenam differre placet, sed
 bella gerenti
Punica Laevino regis quoque
 proelia mandant. 395
paruit imperiis consul, fususque
 Philippus,
vilia dum gravibus populis
 interserit arma,
praetereunte manu didicit non
 esse potentum
temptandas, mediis quamvis in
 luctibus, iras.”
Hoc monitu pariter nascentia
 bella repressit 400
et bello quaesivit opes legitque
 precantes

suit—neither a burden to Italy nor a
terror to its lord.

Then, indeed, at the news of his
return, the legions, such love they
bore their general, hastened together
from every side, and at the sight of
Stilicho their courage revived and
they broke out into sobbings and
tears of joy. So when a herd of cattle
has been scattered throughout some
vast forest by the storm’s violence
the beasts eagerly make for the
sound of the ox-herd’s well-known
song or whistle and

precant
auxilio mensus^[156] numerum, qui
congruus esset
nec gravis Italiae
formidandusve regenti.
Nec minus accepto nostrae
rumore cohortes
(sic ducis urget amor)
properantibus undique
signis
conveniunt, visoque animi
Stilichone recepti 406
singultus varios lacrimosaque
gaudia miscent:
sic armenta boum, vastis quae
turbida silvis
sparsit hiems, cantus ac sibila
nota magistri

[157]

the pasture of their native vale,
guiding their steps in answer to his
voice and glad faithfully to reply
with lowing, while, wherever his
tones fall upon their ear, horns show
themselves here and there through
the dark foliage. First hasten up the
neighbouring troops, their loyalty
attested by their defence of Raetia
and their mass of spoil from
Vindelicia; next the legion that had
been left to guard Britain,^[54] the
legion that kept the fierce Scots in
check, whose men had scanned the
strange devices tattooed on the faces
of the dying Picts. Even the legions
that faced the flaxen-haired
Sygambri, and those who held the
Chatti and wild Cherusci in
subjection hither turned their
threatening arms, leaving the Rhine,
whose garrison they had formed,
defended by but one thing—the fear
of Rome. Will any posterity credit
the tale? Germany, once the home of
peoples so proud and fierce that
former emperors could scarce keep
them in check with the whole weight
of their armies, now offers herself so
willing a follower of Stilicho's
guiding hand that she neither
attempts an invasion of the territory
exposed to her attack by the removal
of its frontier troops nor crosses the

certatim repetunt et avitae
 pascua vallis 410
 inque vicem se voce regunt
 gaudentque fideles
 reddere mugitus et, qua sonus
 attigit aurem,
 rara per obscuras adparent
 cornua frondes.
 adcurrit vicina manus, quam
 Raetia nuper
 Vandalicis auctam spoliis
 defensa probavit; 415
 venit et extremis legio praetenta
 Britannis,
 quae Scotto dat frena truci
 ferroque notatas
 perlegit exanimis Picto
 moriente figuras;
 agmina quin etiam flavis
 obiecta Sygambri
 quaeque domant Chattos
 inmansuetosque
 Cheruscos,
 huc omnes vertere minas
 tutumque remotis 421
 excubiis Rhenum solo terrore
 relinquunt.
 ullane posteritas credet?
 Germania quondam
 illa ferox populis, quae vix
 instantibus olim
 principibus tota poterat cum
 mole teneri, 425
 iam sese placidam praebet
 Stilichonis habenis,
 ut nec praesidiis nudato limite
 temptet
 expositum calcare solum nec

stream, too timid to approach an undefended bank.

Greater art thou, Stilicho, than all;
 thine only rival is Camillus, whose
 arms broke the rash power of
 Brennus as thine have broken that of
 Alaric. At a time of dire peril ye both
 gave the aid of gods; but he too late
 avenged a captured Rome, thou one
 still safe. What a reversal of fortune
 did thy return bring about! A new
 vigour returned to every part of our
 empire alike, and the glow of health
 came back to our suffering cities. A

[\[54\]](#) Legio II. Augusta. The legion
 referred to in l. 414 is probably III.
 Italica.

expositum calcare solum nec

transeat ^[158]amnem,

incustoditam metuens attingere
ripam.

Celsior o cunctis unique
aequande Camillo! 430
vestris namque armis Alarici
fracta quievit
ac Brenni rabies; confusis rebus
uterque
divinam tribuistis opem, sed
tardior ille
iam captae vindex patriae, tu
sospitis ultor.
o quantum mutata tuo fortuna
regressu! 435
ut sese pariter diffudit in omnia
regni
membra vigor vivusque redit
color urbibus aegris!

[159]

woman, so the story goes, who died to save the life of a loved husband, was recalled to the upper world by the might of Hercules. Diana with the help of Circe's magic herbs restored to life Hippolytus whom the scorned passion of a stepmother had caused to be torn in pieces. Crete, if the fable be true, saw Glaucus, son of Minos, issue living from the tomb; his body was discovered by the cries of birds to Polyidus, the aged seer, who restored him to life by means of simples; strange indeed was the ruling of fate which apportioned sweet honey as the cause of his death and a hideous serpent as the restorer of his life. ^[55] But thy return, Stilicho, recalled not one body from the shades but countless peoples sunk in a common death, and snatched whole towns from the jaws of Hell.

That very day Rome rang with the report (though none ever knew its author) that the hero had arrived, and the citizens, assured of Stilicho's protection, applauded this augury of certain victory. Who could tell of the Emperor's joy, who of the courtiers' eager greetings? From the lofty battlements we sight a distant cloud of dust and know not whether its obscurity conceals friend or foe. Suspense keeps us all in silence.

creditur Herculeis lucem
 renovasse lacertis
 femina dilecti fatis impensa
 mariti;
 et iuvenem spretae laniatum
 fraude novercae 440
 non sine Circaeis Latonia
 reddidit herbis.
 Cretaque, si verax narratur
 fabula, vidit
 Minoum rupto puerum prodire
 sepulchro,
 quem senior vates avium
 clangore repertum
 gramine restituit: mirae nam
 munere sortis 445
 dulcia mella necem, vitam dedit
 horridus anguis.
 at tuus adventus non unum
 corpus ab umbris,
 sed tot communi populos sub
 morte iacentes
 totaque Tartareis e faucibus
 oppida traxit.
 Ipso Roma die (nec adhuc
 ostenditur auctor) 450
 personuit venisse ducem,
 laetisque Quirites
 vocibus auspicium certi
 plausere triumphi,
 muniti Stilichone suo. quis
 gaudia vero
 principis, amplexus alacris quis
 disserat aulae?
 pulveris ambiguam nubem
 speculamur ab altis 455
 turribus, incerti socios adportet
 an hostes

Then suddenly from that dusty cloud
 emerged the helm of Stilicho,
 glittering like a star, and we
 recognized his gleaming white hair.
 Up rose the happy shout from the
 walls: "'Tis he." Safe at last the
 crowd surges out through the gates
 to meet and greet the army's return.
 Gone for ever are our wretched
 impressed levies; no longer

[\[55\]](#) Glaucus, son of Minos, fell into a
 vat of honey and was drowned.
 Polyidus, the seer, led by an oracle,
 discovered the body, and was, at
 Minos' command, immured with it in a
 tomb until he should find a means of
 restoring it to life. Two snakes
 approached the corpse, one of which
 Polyidus slew. Observing the other
 bring its dead companion to life by
 placing a certain herb in its mouth,
 Polyidus applied the same method with
 success to the resuscitation of Glaucus
 (Hyginus, *Fab.* 136. Both Sophocles
 and Euripides wrote tragedies on the
 subject; see Soph. *Frag.* ed. Pearson,
 vol. ii. pp. 56 *sqq.*).

an hostes
[160]
ille globus. mentem suspensa
 silentia librant,
donec pulvereo sub turbine
 sideris instar
emicuit Stilichonis apex et
 cognita fulsit
canities. gavis repens per
 moenia clamor 460
tollitur "ipse venit." portas
 secura per omnes
turba salutatis effunditur obvia
 signis.
non iam dilectus miseri nec
 falce per agros

[161]

does the reaper, laying aside his sickle, try to hurl the impotent javelin, nor Ceres lay aside her harrow and, to the amusement of Bellona, essay the buckler. Stilled are the noisy wrangles of untried leaders; here is Rome's true strength, her true leader, Mars in human form.

The more happy hopes grew in our hearts the more they deserted the Getae, who, touching the stars with their heads, after crossing the Alps accounted all their own and deemed nothing left to do. But when they saw all our glorious youth, all the quickly levied infantry, all the squadrons of horse, a countryside protected by so many rivers and fortresses, and themselves caught in a snare, a trouble they dared not voice seized their hearts and a regret that they had invaded Italy with too forward eagerness; and Rome they hoped within their grasp seemed far away. Weariness of their mighty undertaking steals over them. Yet Alaric's face conceals his fear; he bids to the council of war those whose age or prowess had gained them the dignity of leadership. There sat the senate of long-haired, skin-clad Getic leaders. Many a scar received in battle adorned their faces, spears guide their tottering steps and, instead of a staff, old age,

deposita iaculum vibrans
ignobile messor
nec temptat^[56] clipeum
proiectis sumere rastris
465
Bellona ridente Ceres
humilisque novorum
seditio clamosa ducum: sed
vera iuventus,
verus ductor adest et vivida
Martis imago.
Prospera sed quantum
nostrae spes addita
menti,
tantum exempta Getis, qui
vertice proximus astris
post Alpes iam cuncta sibi
promisit apertas 471
nil superesse ratus, postquam
tot lumina pubis,
tot subitos pedites, equitum tot
conspicit alas
cinctaque fluminibus crebris ac
moenibus arva
seque velut clausum laqueis,
sub pectore furtim 475
aestuatur et nimium prono fervore
petitae
iam piget Italiae, sperataque
Roma teneri
visa procul. magni subeunt iam
taedia coepta.
occultat tamen ore metum
primosque suorum
consultare iubet bellis annisque
verendos. 480
crinigeri sedere patres, pellita
Catonum

refusing to disarm, supports itself on
their tall shafts. Then arose one older
than the rest, trusted for his counsel
and advice, who, fixing his gaze
upon the ground, shaking his hoary
locks and leaning on his ivory hilt,
thus spake: "If I miscount not the
years this is well-nigh the thirtieth
winter since we swam across the
swift Ister. All that time we have
escaped defeat at the hands of Rome.
Yet never, Alaric, has Mars brought
your fortunes to such

[56] ^{temptat eodd., Birt temptans.}
curia, quos plagis decorat
numerosa cicatrix
et tremulos regit hasta gradus et
nititur altis
pro baculo contis non exarmata
senectus.
hic aliquis gravior natu, cui
plurima dictis 485
consiliisque fides, defixus
lumina terrae
concutiensque comam
capuloque adclinis
eburno:
“Si numero non fallor” ait
“tricesima currit
bruma fere, rapidum postquam
transnavimus Histrum,
Romanamque manum tantis
eludimus annis. 490
sed numquam Mavors adeo
constrinxit in artum

straits. Take the advice of an old man who has been through countless fights, one who like a father was wont to give thee in thine earliest youth little quivers to sling across thy back and to fit short bows to thy young shoulders. Often did I urge in vain that thou should'st observe the treaty and remain safe at home in Emathia. But if the fire of hot youth hurried thee into war, now at least, I beg thee, make good thine escape from out this net if thou hast any love left for thy people. The enemy's forces are far away; thou hast the chance; flee headlong from Italy's lands lest, in thy desire for fresh spoils, thou lose even what thou hast got and like a wolf pay the penalty of former depredations to the shepherd by being killed within the sheepfold. Why dost thou have ever on thy lips the richness of Tuscan vineyards and some Rome or other with its Tiber? If our parents speak sooth, never has any who has assailed that city in mad war returned to boast that he has done her violence. The gods desert not their own home; thunderbolts, they tell, are hurled from afar upon her foes and unearthly fires flash before her walls, whether 'tis heaven or Rome that thunders. If thou fearest not the gods beware the might of Stilicho; fortune is ever on his side against assaulting enemies.

res, Alarice, tuas. per tot
certamina docto
crede seni, qui te tenero vice
patris ab aevo
gestatum parva solitus donare
pharetra
atque aptare breves umeris
puerilibus arcus: 495
saepe quidem frustra monui,
servator ut icti
foederis Emathia tutus tellure
maneres;
sed quoniam calidae rapuit te
flamma iuventae,
nunc saltem, si cura tibi manet
ulla tuorum,
his claustris evade, precor,
dumque agmina longe,
dum licet, Hesperiiis praeceps
elabere terris, 501
ne nova praedari cupiens et
parta reponas
pastorique lupus scelerum
delicta priorum
intra saepta luas. quid palmitis
uber Etrusci,
quid mihi nescioquam proprio
cum Thybride Romam
semper in ore geris? referunt si
vera parentes, 506
hanc urbem insano nullus qui
Marte petivit
laetatus violasse redit; nec
numina sedem
destituunt: iactata procul
dicuntur in hostem
fulmina divinique volant pro
moenibus ignes 510

Thou thyself knowest how high with
bones he piled our funeral pyres in
Arcadia, and with what vast
outpourings of our blood he made
the rivers of Greece run warm; and
thou hadst been killed had not
treason in the guise of law and the
goodwill of the Emperor of the East
protected thee.”

While the elder spake thus Alaric,
eyeing him

obliquisque tuens oculis non
pertulit ultra,
sed rupit rabidas accensa
superbia voces: 520
“Si non mentis inops
fraudataque sensibus
aetas
praeberet veniam, numquam
haec opprobria linguae
turpia Danuvius me sospite
ferret inultus.
anne, tot Augustos Hebro qui
teste fugavi,
te patiar suadente fugam, cum
cesserit omnis 525
obsequiis natura meis?
subsidere nostris
sub pedibus montes, arescere
vidimus amnes.
non ita di Getici faxint
manesque parentum,
ut mea converso relegam
vestigia cursu.
hanc ego vel victor regno vel
morte tenebo 530
victus humum. per tot populos
urbesque cucurri,
fregi Alpes galeisque Padum
victricibus hausi:
quid restat nisi Roma mihi?
gens robore nostra
tum quoque pollebat, nullis cum
fideret armis.
at nunc Illyrici postquam mihi
tradita iura 535
meque suum fecere ducem, tot
tela, tot enses,
tot galeas multo Thracum

year by year, has become my slave.
'Tis she has supplied me with arms;
her own metal has glowed in the
furnace, artfully molten and
fashioned for her own undoing by
reluctant smiths. The gods, too, urge
me on. Not for me are dreams or
birds but the clear cry uttered openly
from the sacred grove: 'Away with
delay, Alaric; boldly cross the Italian
Alps this year and thou shalt reach
the city.' Thus far the

tot galeas multo Timacum

sudore^[166] paravi

inque meos usus vectigal

vertere ferri

oppida legitimo iussu Romana

coëgi.

sic me fata foveant; ipsi, quos

omnibus annis 540

vastabam, servire dati: nocitura

gementes

arma dabant flammisque diu

mollitus et arte

in sua damna chalybs fabro

ludente rubebat.

hortantes his adde deos. non

somnia nobis

nec volucres, sed clara palam

vox edita luco: 545

‘rumpe omnes, Alarice, moras;

hoc impiger anno

Alpibus Italiae ruptis penetrabis

ad urbem.’

[167]

path is mine. Who so cowardly as to dally after this encouragement or to hesitate to obey the call of Heaven?”

So he spake and made ready his army to take the road, exhorting them to combat. Prophecy serves to augment his vain pride. Ah! for the grudging oracles ever dumb with mystic utterance; ’tis the event alone that (too late) discloses the true meaning which the seers themselves could not read. Alaric reached the farthest confines of Liguria where flows a river with the strange name of the City.^[57] There he suffered defeat and even then scarcely realized (though that defeat made it clear) that fate had tricked him with an ambiguous word.

Stilicho, too, fails not: at full speed he advanced his army clamorous for battle and spurs their march with these words: “Friends of Rome, the time has now come for you to exact vengeance for outraged Italy. Wipe out the disgrace which the investment of your emperor by his foes has brought upon you, and let your swords end the shame which the defeat on the Timavus^[58] and the enemy’s passage of the Alps has caused to Rome. This is the foe whom ye so often put to flight on the plains of Greece, whom not their

huc iter usque datur. quis iam
post talia segnis
ambigat aut caelo dubitet parere
vocanti?"

Sic ait hortatusque suos
belloque viaeque 550
instruit. attollunt vanos oracula
fastus.

o semper tacita sortes ambage
malignae
eventuque patens et nescia
vatibus ipsis
veri sera fides! Ligurum regione
suprema

pervenit ad fluvium miri
cognominis "Urbem,"
555

atque illic domitus vix tandem
interprete casu
agnovit dubiis inlusa vocabula
fatis.

Nec non et Stilicho pugnam
poscentia movit
pleno castra gradu dictisque
instigat euntes:
"nunc nunc, o socii, temeratae
sumite tandem 560
Italiae poenas, obsessi principis
armis
excusate nefas deploratumque
Timavo
vulnus et Alpinum gladiis
abolete pudorem.
hic est, quem totiens campis
fudistis Achivis,
quem discors odiisque anceps
civilibus orbis, 565
non sua vis tutata diu. dum

own valour but a world torn by civil
strife has kept safe thus far, as they
treacherously mock at treaties and
traffic in perjury now with the West,
now the East. Reflect that all the
fierce peoples of Britain and the
tribes who dwell on Danube's and
Rhine's banks are watching and
stand ready. Win a victory now and
so be conquerors in many an
unfought war. Restore Rome to her
former glory; the frame of empire is
tottering; let your shoulders support
it. A

[57] The river on whose banks
Pollentia stood. Sozomenes (ix. 6)
mentions the oracle.

[58] Little is known of this battle. It is
to be attributed presumably to (?)
November 401 and is doubtless
connected with Alaric's attempt on
Aquileia (Jerome, *Contra Ruf.* iii. 21).

non sua vis tutata tui, cum

foedera fallax

ludit et alternae periuria

venditat aulae.

credite nunc omnes, quas dira

Britannia gentes,

quas Hister, quas Rhenus alit,

pendere paratas

in speculis: uno tot proelia

vincite bello. 570

Romanum reparate decus

molemque labantis

imperii fulcite umeris; hic

omnia campus

[169]

single battle and all will be well; but one victory and the world's peace will be assured. We fight not on the slopes of Thracian Haemus nor await our foe where Maenalus throws his shadow across the banks of Alpheus. We defend not Tegea nor Argos. No: as ye see, the scene of war is the very centre and heart of Italy. Protect Father Tiber with your shields." Thus spake Stilicho to foot and horse.

Orders were at the same time sent to the auxiliary troops. The Alans, now subject to Roman rule, followed our trumpets' call, taught by their chief to lay down their lives in the cause of Italy. Small was his stature but great his soul and fierce anger blazed from his eyes. Covered with wounds was he and with a visage rendered the more glorious and the more proud by reason of the scar some spear-thrust had left. At Stilicho's command he hastened up with his cavalry, fated to bite the soil of Italy in death. Happy warrior, worthy of the Elysian fields and of my meed of song, who wast eager even at the cost of life to cleanse thy loyalty from stain! The sword that spilled thy generous blood, it was thy judge, acquitting thee of that most unjust charge of treachery. Thrown into confusion by the hero's death his

vindicat, haec mundo pacem
victoria sancit.
non in Threiciis Haemi
decernimus oris
nec super Alpheas umbrantia
Maenala ripas 575
constitimus; non hic Tegean
Argosque tuemur:
visceribus mediis ipsoque in
corde videtis
bella geri. patrem clipeis
defendite Thybrim.”
taliam nunc pediti, turmae nunc
mixtus equestri
dicta dabat.

Simul externis
praecepta ferebat 580
auxiliis. ibat patiens ditionis
Alanus,
qua nostrae iussere tubae,
mortemque petendam
pro Latio docuit gentis
praefectus Alanae,
cui natura breves animis
ingentibus artus
finxerat inmanique oculos
infecerat ira; 585
vulneribus pars nulla vacat
rescissaque contis
gloria foedati splendet
iactantior oris.
ille tamen mandante procul
Stilichone citatis
acceleravit equis Italique
momordit harenam.
felix Elysiisque plagis et
carmine dignus, 590
qui mala suspectam nobis

horsemen turned rein and, its flank
thus exposed, the whole host would
have reeled had not Stilicho quickly
gathered a legion and hastening to
the spot rallied the cavalry to the
fight with infantry support.

What poet, were he inspired by the
Muses or even by Apollo himself,
could relate the blessings showered
that day by Mars upon the city
whose founder he himself was?
Never was the sword of Rome
plunged so deep in the Scythians’
throat;

qui male suspectam nobis
impensius^[170] arsit
vel leto purgare fidem; qui
iudice ferro
diluit inmerito laudato
sanguine crimen!
morte viri turbatus eques
flectebat habenas
totaque praeciso nutassent
agmina cornu, 595
ni celer instructa Stilicho
legione secutus
subsidiis peditum pugnam
instaurasset equestrem.
Quis Musis ipsoque licet
Paeane recepto
enarrare queat, quantum
Gradivus in illa
luce suae dederit fundator
originis urbi? 600
altius haud umquam toto
descendimus ense
in iugulum Scythiae, tanta nec
clade superbum

[171]

never was Tanais' pride abased by such a crushing defeat nor the horns of Ister so broken. Thirsting to drink the enemy's hateful blood our soldiers passed by rich and varied raiment, carts laden with gold, heaps of silver, and, eager for the foe's destruction, spurned his wealth. They held blood of more account than gold; none of them would stoop to pick up the fortune that lay at their feet but drew their swords and sated their wild fury. The crafty foe threw in the path of our advancing troops the robes of scarlet dye, and other spoils reft from Valens^[59] who perished in the flames, heavy mixing-bowls looted from unhappy Argos and lifelike statues rescued from burning Corinth—all in vain, for this ill-omened booty, so far from delaying our men, reminded them of past reverses and so the more inflamed their righteous indignation.

The crowd of prisoners is loosed from its fetters and all the peoples of different tongue whom the Getae had led away captive. Freed at last by the slaughter of their captors they plant thankful kisses on the bloody hands of their deliverers and hasten back to their long-lost homes and their dear children. At each his household looks in wonder as they tell the story

contudimus Tanain vel cornua
fregimus Histri.
invisum miles sitiens haurire
cruorem
per varias vestes onerataque
plaustra metallo 605
transit et argenti cumulos et
caedis avarus
contemptas proculcat opes;
pretiosior auro
sanguis erat; passim neglecti
prodiga lucri
turba furens strictis odium
mucronibus explet.
purpureos cultus absumptique
igne Valentis 610
exuvias miserisque graves
crateras ab Argis
raptaque flagranti spirantia
signa Corintho
callidus ante pedes venientibus
obicit hostis
incassum; neque enim feralis
praeda moratur,
sed iustos praebent stimulos
monumenta doloris. 615
Adseritur ferro captivum
vulgus, et omnes
diversae vocis populi, quos
traxerat hostis
servitio, tandem dominorum
strage redempti
blanda cruentatis adfigunt
oscula dextris
desertosque lares et pignora
laeta revisunt. 620
miratur sua quemque domus
cladesque renarrant

of their woes and then recount the
marvel of welcome victory.

What must then have been thy
despair, Alaric, when ruin
overwhelmed thy wealth and all that
gear that years of robbing had won
thee, when there struck thine ear the
cries of that wife of thine who, too
confident in her long unconquered
husband, demanded in her madness
the jewelled necklaces of Italian
matrons for her proud neck and
Roman girls for her tire-women! The
fair girls

[59] At Adrianople, Aug. 9, 378; see
Introduction, p. vii.

cunctasque tenentem
 ordine; tum grati^[172] referunt
 miracula belli.
 Quis tibi tunc, Alarice, dolor,
 cum Marte perirent
 divitiae spoliisque diu quaesita
 supellex
 pulsaretque tuas ululatus
 coniugis aures, 625
 coniugis, invicto dudum quae
 freta marito
 demens Ausonidum gemmata
 monilia matrum
 Romanasque alta famulas
 cervice petebat!

[173]

of Greece from Corinth and Sparta
 were, forsooth, not good enough
 now for so great a lady. But
 Nemesis, the goddess worshipped at
 Rhamnus, she whose pleasure it is to
 check unbridled desire, was wroth
 and turned her wheel; harsh poverty
 overwhelms the vanquished, and in
 one day Rome's arm requites all that
 we have lost in thirty years.

Thy glory, Pollentia, shall live for
 ever; worthy is thy name to be
 celebrated by my song, a fit theme
 for rejoicing and for triumph. Fate
 pre-ordained thee to be the scene of
 our victory and the burial-place of
 the barbarians. Full often have thy
 fields and plains seen ample
 vengeance exacted for aggression
 against the descendants of Romulus.
 'Twas there, in that same
 countryside, that the Cimbric hordes,
 bearing down upon Rome from
 Ocean's farthest shore and crossing
 the Alps by another pass, suffered
 their final defeat. The coming
 generation should mingle the bones
 of these two races and engrave with
 this one inscription the monument
 which records our double victory:
 "Here beneath the soil of Italy lie the
 bodies of brave Cimbri and Getae:
 their death they owed to our famous
 generals Marius and Stilicho. Learn,

scilicet Argolicas
 Ephyreidasque puellas
coeperat et pulchras iam
 fastidire Lacaenas. 630
sed dea quae nimiis obstat
 Rhamnusiae votis
ingemuit flexitque rotam:
 domat aspera victos
pauperies, unoque die Romana
 rependit
quidquid ter denis acies
 amisimus annis.
 O celebranda mihi cunctis
 Pollentia saeculis! 635
o meritum nomen! felicibus
 apta triumphis!
virtutis fatale solum,
 memorabile bustum
barbariae! nam saepe locis ac
 finibus illis
plena lacescito rediit vindicta
 Quirino.
illic Oceani stagnis excita
 supremis 640
Cimbrica tempestas alias
 emissa per Alpes
isdem procubuit campis. iam
 protinus aetas
adveniens geminae gentis
 permisceat ossa
et duplices signet titulos
 commune tropaeum:
“hic Cimbros fortesque Getas,
 Stilichone peremptos
et Mario claris ducibus, tegit
 Italia tellus. 646
discite vesanae Romam non
 temperare gentes.”

presumptuous peoples, not to despise
Rome.”

CARMINUM MINORUM CORPUSCULUM

I. (XIII.)

Ad Stilichonem.

Solitas galea fulgere comas,
Stilicho, molli necte corona.
cessent litui saevumque procul
Martem felix taeda releget.
tractus ab aula rursus in aulam 5
redeat sanguis. patris officii
iunge potenti pignora dextra.
gener Augusti pridem fueras,
nunc rursus eris socer Augusti.
quae iam rabies livoris erit? 10
vel quis dabitur color invidiae?
Stilicho socer est, pater est
Stilicho.

II. (LXXXV.)

Descriptio portus Smyrnensis.

Urbs in conspectu montana
cacumina velat
tranquillo praetenta mari.
ducentia portum
cornua pacatas removent
Aquilonibus undas.
hic exarmatum terris
cingentibus aequor
clauditur et placidam discit
servare quietem. 5

SHORTER POEMS

I. (XIII.)

To Stilicho.

Crown with a wreath of flowers,
Stilicho, that head more often graced
with the shining helmet. Bid cease
the trumpets and let the happy
marriage-torch banish fierce war
afar. Let the blood derived from a
kingly race flow on through royal
veins. Do a father's duty and
establish the firm bond of wedlock
between thy daughter and adoptive
son. Thou wert an emperor's son-in-
law; now an emperor will be thine.
What cause is there now for envy,
what excuse for jealousy? Stilicho is
at once father and father-in-law.

II. (LXXXV.)

Description of the harbour at Smyrna.

The city that meets our gaze veils the
mountain peaks, fronting a tranquil
sea. The two headlands that enclose
the harbour protect the quiet water
from the north wind. Here the sea is
disarmed by the encircling land and
learns to lie in undisturbed
tranquillity.

III. (LXXXI.)

Ad Aeternalem.

Quidquid Castalio de gurgite
 Phoebus anhelat,
 quidquid fatidico mugit cortina
 recessu,
 carmina sunt; sed verba negant
 communia Musae.
 carmina sola loquor: sic me
 meus implet Apollo.

IV. (LIV.)

Descriptio armenti.

III. (LXXXI.)

To Aeternalis. [\[61\]](#)

Phoebus' every breath from the
 Castalian spring, the tripod's every
 moan within the shrine of prophecy
 —all these are poetry. Of prose the
 Muses will have none. In poetry only
 can I express myself, so wholly does
 my patron, Apollo, possess me.

IV. (LIV.)

Description of a Herd.

Not such were the beauteous herds
 that the land once ruled over by
 triple Geryon produced. Not such the
 bulls thou bathest, Clitumnus, in thy
 stream for pious vows to offer duly
 to Tarpeian Jove. Not such the steer
 that, they say, scattered the sand of
 Tyre [\[62\]](#) what time he brought home
 his well-loved burden. Not the fields
 of Crete, nor Gnosso that knew of
 passion for a bull, nor Ida could have
 pastured the like. Even he whose
 monstrous figure united ill-assorted
 limbs, the Cretan child [\[63\]](#) who by
 his strange form revealed his
 mother's shame—even he could
 scarce have shown a shape so fair
 had *all* his rough limbs resembled
 those of his sire.

Non tales quondam species tulit
armentorum
tellus tergemino subdita
Geryoni.
non tales, Clitumne, lavas in
gurgite tauros,
Tarpeio referunt quos pia
vota Iovi.
non talis Tyrias sparsisse
iuvencus harenas 5
dicitur, optatum quando
revexit onus.
non Cretaeus ager nec amati
conscia tauri
Gnosos nec similes paverit
Ida feros.
ipse et dispariles monstro
commissus in artus
qui crimen matris prodidit^[60]
ore novo 10
Cres puer haud talem potuisset
reddere formam,
portassent totum si fera
membra patrem.

^[60] prodidit *cod. Med. (and Cuiacius)*.
Birt condidit.

^[61] Aeternalis was proconsul of Asia in 396 (*Cod. Theod.* iv. 4. 3, xi. 39. 12).

^[62] Tyrias, because Europa was the daughter of Phoenix, eponymous king of Phoenicia. Ovid depicts her as being carried away from Tyre (*Fasti* v. 605; *Met.* ii. 845).

^[63] *i.e.* the Minotaur.

V. (LXXXVI.)

Est in conspectu longe locus.

Est procul ingenti regio
 summota recessu,
 insula qua resides fluctus
 mitescere cogit
 in longum producta latus,
 fractasque per undas
 ardua tranquillo curvantur
 brachia portu.

VI. (LXXVIII.)

Rimanti telum ira facit.

In iaculum, quodcumque gerit,
 dementia mutat.
 omnibus armatur rabies. pro
 cuspidē ferri
 cuncta volant, dum dextra ferox
 in vulnera saevit.
 pro telo geritur quidquid
 suggererit ira.

VII. (LXXXVII.)

De quadriga marmorea.

V. (LXXXVI.)

A distant Scene.

There is a place deep buried in a
 huge bay where an island, stretching
 far out into the sea, stills the rough
 waves to quiet, and steep cliffs,
 jutting out into the broken water,
 curve themselves into a peaceful
 harbourage.

VI. (LXXVIII.)^[64]

*Anger affords a weapon to him who
 seeks one.*

Whate'er it carries, that rage
 converts into a weapon. Wrath
 supplies all with arms. When an
 angry man thirsts for blood anything
 will serve him for a spear. Fury turns
 a stick into a cudgel.

VII. (LXXXVII.)

Statue of a Chariot.

1. Who had the skill to fashion so
 many figures out of one block of
 marble? The chariot melts into the
 charioteer; the horses with one
 common accord obey the same reins.
 These are distinguishable by their
 various forms but made from one
 and the same material without
 distinction.

1. Quis dedit innumeros uno de
 marmore vultus?
surgit in aurigam currus,
 paribusque lupatis
unanimi frenantur equi: quos
 forma diremit,
materies cognata tenet
 discrimine nullo.

2. Vir redit in currum; ducuntur
 ab axe iugales;
ex alio se quisque facit. quae
 tanta potestas?
una silex tot membra ligat
 ductusque per artem
mons patiens ferri varios
 mutatur in artus.

2. The driver is of one piece with the car: to this are attached the steeds, each joined to, and proceeding out of, another. How admirable the artist's skill! A single block combines within itself all these bodies: one mass of marble by submitting to the chisel has grown into all these various shapes.

[64] See Introduction, p. xviii, note 2.

VIII. (LXIX.)

De Polycaste et Perdicca.

Quid non saevus Amor
 flammaram numine
 cogat?
 sanguinis en fetum mater
 amare timet.
 pectore dum niveo miserum
 tenet anxia nutrix,
 inlicitos ignes iam foveat ipsa
 parens.
 ultrices pharetras tandem
 depone, Cupido. 5
 consule iam Venerem: forsan
 et ipsa dolet.

IX. (XLV.)

De hystrice.

VIII. (LXIX.)

Of Polycaste and Perdiccas. [\[65\]](#)

To what deeds of cruelty will the
 flames of love not inspire mankind?
 Here is a mother who dares not love
 her child, the fruit of her body.
 Holding the unhappy boy to her
 snowy breast and wishing to give
 him suck, she conceives for him,
 though she is his mother, a shameful
 passion. Cupid, thou goest too far;
 put down thy cruel quiver. Consult
 Venus; mayhap she feels like pangs.

IX. (XLV.)

The Porcupine.

I had heard the strange tale,
 Stymphalus, that the birds that
 haunted thy marshes let fall from
 them arrows of death in their flight,
 and for long I could not bring myself
 to believe this story of iron feathers.
 But here is proof: the porcupine who
 is surely related to those birds of
 Hercules is their warrant.

His long snout is like that of a swine.
 Stiff bristles like horns stand up from
 his forehead. Red and fierce are his
 fiery eyes. Under his bristly back are
 short legs like those of a small dog.
 Small as this animal is, nevertheless
 Nature has seen fit to dower him

Audieram memorande tuas
Stymphale volucres
spicula vulnifico quondam
sparsisse volatu,
nec mihi credibilis ferratae
fabula pinnae
visa diu. datur ecce fides et
cognitus hystrix
Herculeas adfirmat aves.

Os

longius illi 5
adsimulat porcum. mentitae
cornua saetae
summa fronte rigent. oculis
rubit igneus ardor.
parva sub hirsuto catuli vestigia
dorso.
hanc tamen exiguum miro
natura tueri
praesidio dignata feram: stat
corpore toto 10
silva minax, iaculisque rigens in
proelia crescit
picturata seges; quorum cute
fixa tenaci

with a wonderful means of defence.
All over the body grows a
threatening thicket: a harvest of
brightly coloured spears bristles up
ready

[65] Perdiccas, the young hunter, is
said to have fallen in love with his
mother Polycaste (or Polycarpe)=the
Earth (see *Mythogr. Lat.* ii. 130).
Claudian inverts the story. For details
see Höfer in Roscher's lexicon, art.
"Perdix," col. 1953.

for battle. The roots of these weapons are white and are firmly fixed in the animal's skin. The quills are themselves parti-coloured with black bands and come to a stiff quill-like point, diminishing in diameter towards the tip which is smooth and sharp.

But his armoury is not fixed like that of the woodland hedgehog. He can take the offensive and also protect himself at a distance by the frequent discharge of these darts of his, hurling through the air the flying missiles which his own back supplies. At times like the flying Parthian he wounds his pursuers; at times he entrenches himself and strikes his foe by the discharge of a storm of these terrible weapons which bristle on his shoulders out of which they grow. He fights with his whole body, and his back, as it moves, emits a raucous sound. You would think it was the trumpet's note stirring an army to close with the foe and fight. Small is the animal but great the din. Besides his arms he displays cunning and a cold, calculated fury that never wastes its weapons but cautiously contents itself with threats, for he never expends a dart but in defence of his life. His aim is sure; the blow, such is his skill, unerring, nor can distance

alba subit radix, alternantesque
colorum
tincta vices, spatiis
internigrantibus, exit
in solidae speciem pinnae,
tenuataque furtim 15
levis in extremum sese producit
acumen.
Sed non haec acies ritu
silvestris echini
fixa manet. crebris propugnat
iactibus ultro
et longe sua membra tegit,
tortumque per auras
evolat excusso nativum missile
tergo. 20
interdum fugiens Parthorum
more sequentem
vulnerat; interdum positus velut
ordine castris
terrificum densa mucronum
verberat unda
et consanguineis hastilibus
asperat armos:
militat omne ferae corpus
vibrataque rauco 25
terga fragore sonant. stimulis
accensa tubarum
agmina conlatis credas
confligere signis:
tantus in angusto strepitus furit.
additur armis
calliditas parcusque sui tumor
iraque numquam
prodiga telorum, caute contenta
minari 30
nec nisi servandae iactus
impendere vitae

delude his range. The motion of his skin in the act of discharging ensures the speed, and accurately directs the flight, of the weapon.

Has human endeavour, with reason to guide it, ever done the like? Men rob of their horns the wild goats of Crete, then they force them to become pliant over the fire^[66]; they use the guts of cattle to string their bows; they tip their arrows with iron and wing them with feathers. But here is a small animal whose arms are contained in his own body

^[66] In the making of bows.

impendere vitae.
 error abest: certum^[184] sollertia
 externae defensionis opem; fert
 nil spatium fallere uno.
 se pharetra, sepe iaculo, sese
 mota cunctis utroque regit
 unum animalia natus bellorum
 Quid labor humanus tantum
 Quod ratione sagax
 proficit? pulchrum inducitur vitae
 fluxit ab exemplis, quid
 cornua; subiectis eadem hostem,
 hinc reor inventum, hinc
 ignibus, interdu Cythrae
 bellandi Parthosque retro
 instruit diuinae ferociae
 prima sagittae de pectore
 ecce brevis propriis securis
 bestia telis 40

X. (XCII.)

De birro castoreo.

Nominis umbra manet veteris;
 nam dicere birrum,
 si Castor iuret, castoreum
 nequeo.
 sex emptus solidis! quid sit, iam
 scire potestis:
 si mihi nulla fides, credite vel
 pretio.

XI. (XCI.)

In sepulchrum speciosae.

[185]

and who needs no external defence.
 He carries all his own arms; himself
 his own quiver, arrow, and bow.
 Alone he possesses all the resources
 of war.

But if all human activities as they
 grow have had their source in
 imitation we may see here the
 exemplar of combat by means of
 missiles. It is from him that the
 Cretans learned to shoot and the
 Parthians to strike while in flight.
 These did but follow the example of
 the animal that is armed with arrows.

X. (XCII.)

Of Beaver's Overcoat. ^[67]

'Tis but the shadow of a name that is
 left. I cannot call it a coat of beaver,
 not though Beaver swear it is one. It
 cost six shillings. Now you know
 what it is like. If you don't believe
 me, believe the price.

XI. (XCI.)

On the Tomb of a Beauty.

Fate allows not beauty a long life:
 sudden is the end of all that is noble
 and pre-eminent. Here lies a lovely
 woman: hers was the beauty of
 Venus and hers the illwill of Heaven
 for a gift so rare.

Pulchris stare diu Parcarum lege
negatur.
magna repente ruunt; summa
cadunt subito.
hic formosa iacet: Veneris
sortita figuram
egregiumque decus invidiam
meruit.

XII. (LXXXIV.)

*De balneis Quintianis quae in via
posita erant.*

Fontibus in liquidis paulum
requiesce, viator,
atque tuum rursus carpe
refectus iter.

XII. (LXXXIV.)

Quintius' Baths.

Stay awhile and bathe in these
waters, traveller; then set forth again
upon thy journey refreshed.

[67] Claudian is, I think, punning on *castor*=a beaver, and Castor, the name of the owner of the coat. But *castor* in l. 2 might be taken to refer either to the god or to the animal.

[186]

lymptharum dominum nimium
miraberis, hospes,
inter dura viae balnea qui
posuit.

XIII. (LXXIX.)

*In podagrum qui carmina sua non
stare dicebat.*

Quae tibi cum pedibus ratio?
quid carmina culpas?
scandere qui nescis,
versiculos laceras?
“claudicat hic versus; haec”
inquit “syllaba nutat”;
atque nihil prorsus stare putat
podager

XIV. (LXXXII.)

Ad Maximum qui ei mel misit.

Dulcia dona mihi semper tu,
Maxime, mittis,
et, quidquid mittis, mella
putare decet.

XV. (LXXXIX.)

De paupere amante

Paupertas me saeva domat
dirusque Cupido:
sed toleranda fames, non
tolerandus amor.

XVI. (XC.)

[187]

An thou become its guest, warm will
be thy gratitude towards him that
built this bath and set it by the side
of this long dusty road.

XIII. (LXXIX.)

To a gouty Critic.

Canst thou talk of feet? Dost blame
my verses and criticize my lines,
thou whose own feet are so weak?
This couplet, you say, will scarcely
stand: the scansion is shaky. Dear
friend, a gouty man thinks nothing at
all can stand.

XIV. (LXXXII.)

*To thank Maximus for a Gift of
Honey.*

Thou dost ever send me sweet gifts,
Maximus; 'tis honey whatsoever
thou sendest, methinks.

XV. (LXXXIX.)

The Poor Lover.

Biting poverty and cruel Cupid are
my foes. Hunger I can endure; love I
cannot.

XVI. (XC.)

The Same.

De eodem.

Esuriens pauper telis incendor
amoris.
inter utrumque malum deligo
pauperiem.

A hungry pauper am I, a victim
fallen to love. Two ills; but poverty
is the lesser.

XVII. (L.)

*De piis fratribus et de statu eorum
quae sunt apud Catinam.*

XVII. (L.)

*On the Statues of Two Brothers at
Catina.* [\[68\]](#)

See these two brothers toiling
beneath a burden piety bade them
bear. They deserve the tribute of
divine honours at the hands of all
men: at the sight of them the
respectful flames ceased their
ravages and Etna in admiration
restrained his flooding lava. Seizing
their parents they set them upon their
shoulders and, with eyes raised to
heaven, hasten their steps. The aged
parents, thus carried aloft by their
two sons, impede their flight, but
dear to the children is that very
delay. See, the old man points to the
cruel flames; the aged mother's
trembling lips call upon the gods for
help. Fear has set their hair on end,
the bronze is terror-stricken and a
pale shiver runs over all the metal. In
the countenances of the sons is seen
courage in face of danger, and, if
fear, then fear for their burdens, none
for themselves. The wind has blown
back their cloaks. One raises his
right hand; his left is enough to
sustain his aged sire. But the other
needs must clasp his burden with
both arms, taking greater care for
that it is his mother, one of the
weaker sex, that he bears. This, too,

Adspice sudantes venerando
 pondere fratres,
 divino meritis semper
 honore coli,
iusta quibus rapidae cessit
 reverentia flammae
 et mirata vagas reppulit
 Aetna faces.
complexi manibus fultos
 cervice parentes 5
 attollunt vultus accelerantque
 gradus.
grandaevi gemina sublimes
 prole feruntur
 et cara natos implicuere
 mora.
nonne vides, ut saeva senex
 incendia monstret?
 ut trepido genetrix invocet
 ore deos? 10
erexit formido comam, perque
 omne metallum
 fusus in attonito palluit aere
 tremor.
in iuvenum membris animosus
 cernitur horror
 atque oneri metuens
 impavidusque sui.
reiectae vento chlamydes.
 dextram exerit ille 15
 contentus laeva sustinuisse
 patrem;
ast illi duplices in nodum
 colligit ulnas
 cautior in sexu debiliore
 labor.
hoc quoque praeteriens oculis
 ne forte relinquant

as thou passest by, leave not
unnoted, for well the craftsman's
dumb hands deserve such regard;
both he has moulded with a likeness
such as brothers bear, yet the one
resembles rather his mother, the
other his father.

[68] The story of the *pietas* of these brothers has often been told or referred to: the better known passages are Senec. *De benef.* iii. 37. 2; Martial vii. 24. 5; Sil. Ital. xiv. 197. Hyginus (*Fab.* 154) gives the story though with different names. The brothers' heads appear both on Sicilian and Roman coins, e.g. Head, *Hist. Num.* 117; *Brit. Mus. Cat. Sicily* 52, Nos. 70-79; Babelon, *Monn. de la répub.* i. 539, ii. 353.

ne forte remiquas,
artificis tacitae^[190] quod meruere
manus: 20
nam consanguineos eadem cum
forma figuret,
hic propior matri fit tamen,
ille patri.

[191]

The artist's cunning has succeeded in expressing a difference of age in their faces, though a likeness to either parent is apparent in the features of both the sons; while, to ensure a further dissimilarity in that resemblance, he has varied the tenderness that either countenance expresses.

Faithful were ye to Nature's law, bright example of divine justice, model for youth, fond hope of age! Wealth ye despised, and dashed into the flames to rescue nought save your venerable parents. Not undeservedly, methinks, did such piety quench the fires in Enceladus' jaws. Vulcan himself checked the flow of molten lava from Etna that it should not harm those patterns of filial duty. The very elements were influenced thereby: father air and mother earth did their best to lighten the burden.

If signal piety raised Castor and Pollux to the skies, if Aeneas won immortality by rescuing his sire from burning Troy, if ancient story has rendered famous the names of those Argive brothers, Cleobis and Biton, [\[69\]](#) who harnessed themselves to their mother's car, why does not Sicily dedicate a temple to the ageless memory of Amphinomos and Anapius? Though the three-cornered

dissimiles annos sollertia
 temperat artis:
 alter in alterius redditur ore
 parens,
et nova germanis paribus
 discrimina praebens 25
 divisit vultus cum pietate
 faber.
O bene naturae memores,
 documenta supernae
iustitiae, iuvenum numina,
 vota senum:
qui spretis opibus medios
 properastis in ignes
 nil praeter sanctam tollere
 canitiem. 30
haud equidem inmerito tanta
 virtute repressas
 Enceladi fauces obriguisset
 reor.
ipse redundantem frenavit
 Mulciber Aetnam,
 laederet exempli ne
 monumenta pii.
senserunt elementa fidem. pater
 adfuit aether 35
 terraque maternum sedula
 iuvit onus.
quodsi notus amor provexit in
 astra Laconas,
 Aenean Phrygio raptus ab
 igne pater,
si vetus Argolicos inlustrat
 gloria fratres,
 qui sua materno colla dedere
 iugo: 40
cur non Amphinomo, cur non
 tibi fortis Anani

isle has many titles to fame, let her
be sure that she has never given birth
to a nobler deed. Let her not weep
the destruction wrought by the
spreading flames nor lament the
houses burned down by the fire's
fury. The flames abating had never
put affection to the proof; the great
disaster purchased immortal fame.

[69] Herodotus tells their story in book
i. 31.

ubi, totus Anapi,
 aeternum Siculus templa
 dicavit honos?
 plura licet XVIII. (LI.) dederit
 Trinacria laudi,
De mulabus Gallicis.
 noverit hoc maius se genuisse
 nihil;
 nec doleat damnis, quae devius
 intulit ardor, 45
 nec gemat exustas igne
 furente domos.
 non potuit pietas flamma
 cessante probari:
 emptum est ingenti clade
 perenne decus.

[193]

XVIII. (LI.)

Of French Mules.

Behold the docile children of fast-flowing Rhone that at their master's word come together and at that word disperse. See how they go this way or that according to the different cries he utters, and, guided only by his voice, take the path he would have them take. Though each unguided by the rein takes his own course and no collar presses upon their necks they obey as though harnessed and, insensible to fatigue, hear and follow the directions shouted by their barbarous master. Though far away from their owner they nevertheless respect his commands, obeying the word of the muleteer as it were a bridle. It is his voice that even at a distance gathers them together when scattered or scatters them when gathered together; this that checks their haste or quickens their dragging steps. Does he shout "left," they turn them to the left: does he alter his cry to "right," to the right they go. Slaves, yet without bonds, free, but without licence, they go unbridled but obedient. Covered with tawny pelts they haul along the rumbling carts, each cheerfully doing his fair share. Dost thou wonder that Orpheus

Adspice morigeras Rhodani
torrentis alumnas
imperio nexus imperioque
vagas,
dissona quam varios flectant ad
murmura cursus
et certas adeant voce regente
vias.
quamvis quaeque sibi nullis
discurrat habenis 5
et pateant duro libera colla
iugo,
ceu constricta tamen servit
patiensque laborum
barbaricos docili concipit
aure sonos.
absentis longinqua valent
praecepta magistri,
frenorumque vicem lingua
virilis agit. 10
haec procul angustat sparsas
spargitque coactas:
haec sistit rapidas, haec
properare facit.
laeva iubet: laevo deducunt
limite gressum.
mutavit strepitum: dexteriora
petunt.
nec vinclis famulae nec libertate
feroces, 15
exutae laqueis, sub ditione
tamen
consensuque pares et fulvis
pellibus hirtae
essedae concordēs multisonora
trahunt.
miraris, si voce feras pacaverit
Orpheus

tamed the wild beasts with his song
when the words of a Gaul can guide
these swift-footed mules?

XIX. (XLIII.)

Letter to Gennadius, ^[70] *ex-*
Proconsul.

Glory of all Italy, who dwellest on
the pleasant banks of Rubicon,
ornament of the Roman bar

^[70] Gennadius was by birth a Syrian (Synesius, *Ep.* 30); prefect of Egypt in 396 (*Cod. Theod.* xiv. 27. 1). He seems to have lived at Ravenna (*Rubiconis incola*). Birt (praef. p. xviii) thinks that line 2 refers to Symmachus, Gennadius' contemporary, not to Cicero.

supra
XIX. (XLIII.)
cum pronas pecudes Gallica
~~Epistula ad Germanicum~~
exproconsule.

Italiae commune decus,
Rubiconis amoeni
incola, Romani fama secunda
fori,

[194]

Graiorum populis et nostro
cognite Nilo
(utraque gens fascēs horret
amatque tuos):
carmina ieiunas poscis solantia
fauces? 5
testor amicitiam nulla fuisse
domi.
nam mihi mox nidum pennīs
confisa relinquunt
et lare contempto non
reditura volant.

XX. (LII.)

*De sene Veronensi qui Suburbium
numquam egressus est.*

[195]

second only to Cicero, well known
to the peoples of Greece and to
Egypt, land of my birth (for both
have feared and loved thy rule), dost
thou ask for poems to appease thy
hungry throat?

By our friendship, I swear there are
none at home. My verses soon learn
to trust to their own wings and leave
the nest, flying far afield nor ever
returning to their humble home.

XX. (LII.)

*Of an old Man of Verona who never
left his home.*

Happy he who has passed his whole
life mid his own fields, he of whose
birth and old age the same house is
witness; he whose stick supports his
tottering steps o'er the very ground
whereon he crawled as a baby and
whose memory knows but of one
cottage as the scene where so long a
life was played out. No turns of
fortune vexed him with their sudden
storms; ^[71] he never travelled nor
drank the waters of unknown rivers.
He was never a trader to fear the seas
nor a soldier to dread the trumpet's
call; never did he face the noisy
wrangles of the courts. Unpractised
in affairs, unfamiliar with the
neighbouring town, he finds his
delight in a freer view of the sky

Felix, qui propriis aevum
transegit in arvis,
ipsa domus puerum quem
videt, ipsa senem;
qui baculo nitens in qua reptavit
harena
unius numerat saecula longa
casae.
illum non vario traxit fortuna
tumultu, 5
nec bibit ignotas mobilis
hospes aquas.
non freta mercator tremuit, non
classica miles,
non rauci lites pertulit ille
fori.
indocilis rerum, vicinae nescius
urbis
adspectu fruitur liberiore
poli. 10
frugibus alternis, non consule
computat annum:
autumnum pomis, ver sibi
flore notat.
idem condit ager soles idemque
reducit,
metiturque suo rusticus orbe
diem,
ingentem meminit parvo qui
germine quercum 15
aequaevumque videt
consenuisse nemus,

above him. For him the recurring seasons, not the consuls, mark the year: he knows autumn by his fruits and spring by her flowers. From the selfsame fields he watches the sun rise and set, and, at his work, measures the day with his own round of toils. He remembers yon mighty oak an acorn, and sees the plantation, set when he was born, grown old along

[71] This proves the poem to have been written before the Gothic irruption of 401. Abraham Cowley translated this poem (*Essays and Plays, etc.*, Camb. Press, 1906, p. 447).

[196]

proxima cui nigris Verona
remotior Indis
Benacumque putat litora
Rubra lacum.
sed tamen indomitae vires
firmisque lacertis
aetas robustum tertia cernit
avum. 20
erret et extremos alter scrutetur
Hiberos:
plus habet hic vitae, plus
habet ille viae.

XXI. (LXXX.)

De Theodoro et Hadriano.

Manlius indulget somno
noctesque diesque;
insomnis Pharius sacra
profana rapit.
omnibus hoc, Italae gentes,
exposcite votis,
Manlius ut vigilet, dormiat ut
Pharius.

XXII. (XXXIX.)

Deprecatio ad Hadrianum.

[197]

with him. Neighbouring Verona is,
for him, more distant than sun-
scorched India; Benacus he accounts
as the Red Sea. But his strength is
unimpaired and the third generation
see in him a sturdy, stout-armed
grandsire. Let who will be a
wanderer and explore farthest Spain:
such may have more of a journey; he
of Verona has more of a life. ^[72]

XXI. (LXXX.)

Of Theodore and Hadrian. ^[73]

Manlius Theodorus sleeps night and
day; the sleepless Egyptian steals
alike from gods and men. Peoples of
Italy, be this your one prayer—that
Manlius keep awake and the
Egyptian sleep.

XXII. (XXXIX.)

Apology to Hadrian.

Must the violence of thine anger last
so long? Are my tears never to cease
to flow? Dost thou thus suddenly
turn thy favour to hatred? Where,
then, is that leniency that knows not
to harm any, that loving-kindness?
Shall envy have such licence? Has
the clamour of calumny so
prevailed?

What though rash wrath, though
heedless youth tempted me, though

Usque adeone tuae producitur
impetus irae?
nullus erit finis lacrimis?
subitisque favorem
permutas odiis? quo mens
ignara nocendi,
quo sensus abiere pii?
tantumne licebit
invidiae? tantum strepitus
valuere maligni? 5
Me dolor incautus, me
lubrica duxerit aetas,
me tumor impulerit, me devius
egerit ardor:
te tamen haud decuit paribus
concurrere telis.
humanae superos numquam
tetigere querellae
nec vaga securum penetrant
convicia caelum. 10

pride urged, though passion led me
astray, yet shouldst *thou* be above
meeting me with like weapons.
Human murmurs never touch the
gods nor do the loose railings of man
disturb the peace of heaven. My
punishment has

[72] Claudian plays on the words *vitae*
and *viae*.

[73] For M. see xvi. and note (and
Introduction, p. xv). H. was *comes*
sacrarum largitionum in the East in
395, *magister officiorum* in 397,
praetorian prefect of Italy 401. This
epigram was probably written in 396:
the apology (next poem) perhaps the
same year.

[198]

[199]

been too severe; spare a fallen foe.
Behold me; I confess my faults and
ask pardon for my sin.

Fierce Achilles showed mercy to the
shade of Hector, Orestes appeased
his mother's avenging furies,
Hercules restored to Priam the cities
which he had taken. A king's
overthrow won the pity of Pella's
youthful monarch, who wept, men
say, for the death of Darius at a
slave's hand, and consoled his ghost
with a lofty mausoleum. To captive
Porus Alexander gave back an
ampler kingdom. 'Twas thus the
founder of our country^[74] spared his
conquered foes. Thine own nobility
demands that thou shouldst follow
his example. If it is one of the gods
that I have insulted let him send
down punishment upon me and sate
his anger.

Now that I have lost thy favour I am
become a prey to grinding poverty,
my house is desolate, my friends reft
from me. Death with torture is the
fate of one, exile of another. What
further losses can I suffer? What
more cruel plagues can befall me?

The power to despoil and kill softens
anger. Wild beasts turn away from
their stricken prey, and fierce lions,
eager to destroy, abandon the dead
victim, and with a nobler hunger riot

excessit iam poena modum.
concede iacenti.
en adsum; veniam confessus
crimina posco.
Manibus Hectoreis atrox
ignovit Achilles.
ultrices Furias matris placavit
Orestes.
reddidit Alcides Priamo, quas
ceperat, arces. 15
Pellaeum iuvenem regum
flexere ruinae:
Darium famulis manibus
doluisset peremptum
fertur et ingenti solatus fata
sepulchro;
tradita captivo spatiosior India
Poro.
conditor hic patriae; sic
hostibus ille pepercit; 20
hunc virtus tua digna sequi.
quemcumque deorum
laesimus, insultet iugulo
pascatur furorem.
Gratia defluxit, sequitur
feralis egestas;
desolata domus, caris spoliatur
amicis:
hunc tormenta necant, hic
undique truditur exul. 25
quid superest damnis? quae
saeva pericula restant?
Emollit rabiem praedae
mortisque facultas.
praetereunt subiecta ferae,
torvique leones,
quae stravisse calent, eadem
prostrata relinquunt

only in the flesh of the warlike steer.
Envy has snapped the thread of my
prosperity and turned my happiness
into mourning. I am fordone with
punishment and my pride is broken;
look on me again with favour. Is a
humble client worth so heavy a
weight of anger? Aeolus makes not
trial of himself where the sea's
waters are shallow; no lowly hill
encounters Boreas' blasts; 'tis the
Alps he shakes, the summit of
Rhodope he harasses. Never doth the
lightning

[74] Alexander is called the founder of
Claudian's country (Egypt) because the
first Ptolemy was one of his generals
and became king of Egypt on
Alexander's death.

prosuata remanent
 nec nisi bellantis gaudent
 cervice iuveni 30
 nobiliore fame. secuit nascentia
 vota
 livor et ingesto turbavit gaudia
 luctu:
 iamiam suppliciiis fessos
 humilesque serenus
 respice. quid tanta dignaris
 mole clientem?
 in brevibus numquam sese
 probat Aeolus undis, 35
 nec capit angustus Boreae
 certamina collis:
 Alpes ille quatit, Rhodopeia
 culmina lassat.
 incubuit numquam caelestis
 flamma salictis

[201]

strike the humble willows nor do the modest shrubs deserve the Thunder's angry bolt; lofty oaks and aged elms are his victims.

Instead of the suppliant's branch plucked from Minerva's sacred olive, instead of incense, I offer thee this poem. Have mercy on thy servant. Restore me, even me, to my former state, heal my cruel wounds, bid life and honour return to me. Do thou, who didst overthrow my fortune, build it up again. Telephus came back cured by the magic of Achilles.^[76] The same hand dealt death and healing—an enemy restoring him to health by the assuagement of the very pains he had inflicted.

But if neither my prayers nor my tears can soften thee, spurn the Muses with thy foot and take away my unlucky decorations, deprive me of my rank, cast me aside who was once thy companion. A noteworthy victory this thou hast won over a poor poet; redoubtable indeed the spoils that will grace such a triumph. Let a fellow-countryman's power overwhelm his wretched fellows.^[77] Be my fate told to our common fatherland and to Pharos, known of all who sail the distant seas, and let Father Nile raise his weeping head

nec parvi frutices iram meruere
 Tonantis:
 ingentes quercus, annosas
 fulminat ornos. 40
 Hoc pro supplicibus ramis,
 pro fronde Minervae,
 hoc carmen pro ture damus.
 miserere tuorum.
 me, precor, heu, me redde mihi
 gravibusque medere
 vulneribus vitamque iube
 famamque reverti.
 quae per te cecidit, per te
 fortuna resurgat. 45
 sanus Achilleis remeavit
 Telephus herbis,
 cuius pertulerat vires, et sensit
 in uno
 letalem placidamque manum;
 medicina per hostem
 contigit, et pepulit quos fecerat
 ipse dolores.
 Quodsi nec precibus fletu nec
 flecteris ullo, 50
 eripe calcatis non prospera
 cingula Musis,
 eripe militiam, comitem me
 pelle sodalis. [75]
 scilicet insignis de paupere vate
 triumphus.
 scilicet egregiis ornabere victor
 opimis.
 inruat in miseros cognata
 potentia cives; 55
 audiat haec commune solum
 longeque carinis
 nota Pharos, flentemque
 attollens curvato vultum

from out the flood and mourn my
 cruel case along the banks of all his
 seven mouths.

XXIII. (LXXIV.)

Apology to Alethius, the Quaestor. [78]

As I hope never to cross the plains of
 Ethiopia beneath a summer sun,
 never to pass a winter naked

[76] Telephus, wounded by Achilles' spear, could only be cured by his "wounder." In return for such information about Troy as should lead to its capture, Achilles cured Telephus by means of the rust on the spear that had inflicted the wound.

Herbis must here mean simply magic (cf. Prop. iv. 7. 72), but it is curious, and *hasta* (*e*) is tempting.

[77] Both Hadrian and Claudian were Egyptians.

[78] Nothing is known about this Alethius.

XXIII. (LXXXIV.)
nostra gemat Nilus numerosis
Deprecatio in Alethium quaestorem.

Sic non Aethiopum campos
aestate pererrem
nec Scythieo brumam sub
Iove nudus agam,

[75] *Birt sodali (EV AJ); sodalis R.*

[202]

sic non imbriferam noctem
ducentibus Haedis
Ionio credam turgida vela
mari,
sic non Tartareo Furiarum
verbere pulsus 5
irati relegam carmina
grammatici:
nulla meos traxit petulans
audacia sensus,
liberior iusto nec mihi lingua
fuit.
versiculos, fateor, non cauta
voce notavi,
heu miser! ignorans, quam
grave crimen erat. 10
Orpheos alii libros impune
laccessunt
nec tua securum te, Maro,
fama vehit;
ipse parens vatium, princeps
Heliconis, Homerus
iudicis excepit tela severa
notae.
sed non Vergilius, sed non
accusat Homerus: 15
neuter enim quaestor, pauper
uterque fuit.
en moveo plausus! en pallidus
omnia laudo
et clarum repeto terque
quaterque “sophos”!
ignoscat placidus tandem
flatusque remittat
et tuto recitet quod libet ore:
placet. 20

[203]

beneath the northern pole, never to
entrust my bellying sails to the
Ionian Sea what time the Kids bring
round the rainy nights, never, driven
by the Furies’ hellish blows, to re-
read the verses of an angry pedant,
[\[79\]](#) ’twas not, I swear, impudent
effrontery that moved me, nor did
my tongue exceed a just
outspokenness. I admit I incautiously
found fault with a few lines, not
realizing, luckless wight, the
heinousness of my offence. Others
attack the books of Orpheus and
nothing is said; nor does thy fame,
Maro, support thee in safety. The
very father of poetry, Homer, lord of
Helicon, knew the stigma of the
censor’s pen. Yet neither Vergil nor
Homer complains, for neither was a
quaestor and both were poor. See,
then, I applaud! See, in terror I
praise every word and loudly cry
again and again “bravo!” Let him be
appeased and pardon at last, let him
cease from wrath—and with secure
voice recite whate’er he will; I
applaud.

XXIV. (LXXXIII.)

The Lobster.

Long horns project from his head;
fierce eyes stand out from his
forehead; his back is protected by the

XXIV. (LXXXIII.)

De lucusta.

Horret apex capitis; medio fera
lumina surgunt
vertice; cognatus dorso durescit
amictus.
armavit natura cutem dumique
rubentes
cuspidibus parvis multos acuere
rubores.

armour of his self-grown shell.
Nature herself has rendered his skin
a sufficient defence, covering it with
small, red, pointed spikes.

[79] The “pedant” is doubtless Alethius himself and the “verses” the very poem which Claudian has already read once and criticized unfavourably.

XXV. (XXX., XXXI.)

*Epithalamium dictum Palladio V. C.
tribuno et notario et Celerinae.*

PRAEFATIO

XXV (XXX, XXXI)

*Epithalamium of Palladius and
Celerina.* [\[80\]](#)

PREFACE

Asked to improvise a song in honour of a marriage I find myself unwilling to refuse the bridegroom and unable to say no to his father-in-law. The former was my comrade-in-arms, the latter my general; at court the first is of equal rank with me, the second my superior. Similarity of age and pursuits made me a friend of Palladius; age and dignity set Celerinus far above me. The love I bear the one demands my good offices as a poet, the awe in which I hold the other a soldier's obedience: I must sing.

It chanced that Venus had one day retired into the bosom of a cave overgrown with vine to woo sleep mid its alluring cool, and had laid her goddess limbs on the thick grass, her head upon a heap of flowers. The vine branches stir gently in the breeze and sway the full-veined grapes. Slumber befits the disorder of her brow, the midday heat will none of coverings, and the leaves show through them the gleam of her bare breast. Round her lie the nymphs of Ida and hard by beneath a

Carmina per thalamum quamvis
 festina negare
 nec volui genero nec potui
 socero.
 hic socius, dux ille mihi
 nostrique per aulam
 ordinis hic consors emicat,
 ille prior.
 hunc mihi coniungit studiis
 communibus aetas; 5
 hunc mihi praeponit vel
 senium vel honos.
 carmen amor generi, soceri
 reverentia poscit
 officio vatis, militis obsequio.
 Forte Venus blando
 quaesitum frigore
 somnum
 vitibus intexti gremio
 successerat antri
 densaque sidereos per gramina
 fuderat artus
 adclinis florum cumulo;
 crispatur opaca
 pampinus et musto sudantem
 ventilat uvam. 5
 ora decet neglecta sopor;
 fastidit amictum
 aestus et exuto translucent
 pectore frondes.
 Idaliae iuxta famulae triplexque
 vicissim
 nexa sub ingenti requiescit
 Gratia quercu.
 pennati passim pueri quo
 quemque vocavit 10
 umbra iacent; fluitant arcus
 ramisque propinquis

lofty oak-tree the three Graces sleep
 with interlaced arms. Here and there,
 where'er the shade invites them,
 repose winged Cupids. Their bows
 are unstrung and their quivers hang
 from the branches of neighbouring
 trees, instinct with latent fire. Some

[\[80\]](#) This poem and the marriage it celebrates probably belong to the year 399. We know little of P. save that he was the friend and colleague (*tribunus et notarius*, cf. Introduction, p. xii) of Claudian. His father (l. 61) was probably prefect of Egypt in 382 (*Cod. Theod.* viii. 5. 37). Celerina's grandfather held the same post (l. 73); her father (ll. 82 *et sqq.*)—the *socer* of line 2 of the preface—was *primicerius notariorum* (so Godefroy on *Cod. Theod.* vi. 2).

ramisque propinquis
pendentes placido^[206] suspirant
igne pharetrae.

[207]

wake and play or wander through the thickets in search of birds' nests or take delight in plucking dewy apples as a gift for Venus or hunt the gadding vine for grapes, and, poised on their wings, climb its branches to the very tops of the elm-trees. Others keep guard over the wood and drive off the wanton, curious Dryads, the country gods and the woodland deities, discharging flaming darts at the amorous Fauns who try from a distance to catch a glimpse of Venus' bower. Suddenly there arose cries and shoutings from the neighbouring city; joyous acclamations of youth and the strains of the lyre accompanying dancing in the streets. Through all the hills of Italy the name of Celerina is chanted and every field re-echoes that of her husband Palladius.

The pleasant sound reached the goddess' ears; aroused by the noise she sat up and with her fair hands rubbed from her eyes the residue of sleep; then, just as she was, her hair disordered, her breasts uncovered, she leapt from her soft couch and summoned Hymen from among the unnumbered Loves that formed her bodyguard. (Him, son of the Muse, Cytherea chose out and made the patron god of marriage. Without his sanction is no entry into wedlock nor

pars vigiles ludunt aut per virgulta
 vagantes
scrutantur nidos avium vel roscida
 laeti
mala legunt donum Veneri
 flexusque sequuntur 15
palmitis et summas pennis librantur
 in ulmos;
defendunt alii lucum Dryadasque
 procaces
spectandi cupidas et rustica numina
 pellunt
silvestresque deos longeque
 tuentibus antrum
flammea lascivis intendunt spicula
 Faunis: 20
cum subito varius vicina clamor ab
 urbe
et fausti iuvenum plausus
 mixtaeque choreis
auditae per rura lyrae. Celerina per
 omnes
Italiae canitur montes omnisque
 maritum
Palladium resonabat ager.

Pervenit

 ad aures 25
vox iucunda deae strepituque excita
 resedit
et reliquum nitido deterisit pollice
 somnum
utque fuit, turbata comas, intacta
 papillas,
mollibus exurgit stratis interque
 suorum
agmen et innumeros Hymenaeum
 quaerit Amores 30

(hunc Musa genitum legit Cytherea)

is it lawful but with his leave to uplift the first wedding-torches.) At last he is found. There he lay stretched beneath a tall plane-tree joining with wax pipes of unequal length, seeking to repeat with his lips Maenalian measures and pastoral tunes, while, as his mouth ran over them, he varied his breathing upon the slender reed.

Seeing Venus he stopped; noiseless to the ground from out the nerveless grasp of his fingers fell the

(nam Musa gentium regis Cytherea
ducemque^[208]

praefecit thalamis; nullum iunxisse
cubile

hoc sine nec primas fas est attollere
taedas).

conspicitur tandem. platano

namque ille sub alta
fusus inaequales cera texebat
avenas 35

Maenaiosque modos et pastoralia
labris

murmura temptabat relegens
orisque recursu

dissimilem tenui variabat
harundine ventum.

Restitit ut vidit Venerem,
digitisque remissis
ad terram tacito defluxit fistula
flatu. 40

[209]

pipe. Affection lights up his eyes; a modest blush suffuses those sun-browned cheeks so snowy-white by nature, clothed, too, with the scarce seen down of youth where ceased the ne'er cut hair. Silent he stood and the goddess first addressed him. "Wilt thou, boy, never leave thy beloved song? Wilt thou never have enough of thy mother's gifts, ever devoted to the Muses' task and too eager to rival thy parent^[82]? What is it thou dost practise all alone in the midday heat? Dost thou now despise the lyre and seekest thou rather the woods of Lycaeus and the herds and Echo resounding from the rocks? Come hither and tell me the reason for this general rejoicing. What marriage is this that is attended with such ceremony and such demonstrations of joy? Who is the newly dowered bride? Of what country, what race are they that are wed? Tell me from what land they spring and what their parentage. Needs must thou know, for no marriage can take place without thee and by covenant with thee are wedlock's joys first tasted."

He replied: "Long have I been wondering, goddess, at thy delay, and marvelled that thou didst take no notice of so world-famed an union. They are no common folk that now submit them to thy laws. Two

dulce micant oculi; niveas infecerat if families are united illustrious with
solque pudorque genas; dubiam lanuginis ships, upheld by the highest
umbram offices, in whose veins flows the
caesaries intonsa tegit. prior ipsa silentest blood of all the world. What
compellat: island on whose coasts thunder the

“Numquam waves of the Red Sea, what tract of
puer, dilecta relinques Ethiopia, what land so far withdrawn
carmina? maternis numquam satiaberis from human intercourse but has
donis 45 heard the blessings that the affection
dedite Musarum studio nimiumque of his country calls down on the
parentis head of Palladius’ sire for his
aemule? quid medio tecum modularis lamency, his learning, his wit, his
aestu? genial age? He has trodden

iamne tibi sordent citharae? iam lustra [82] i.e. Calliope. Venus is in effect
Lycaei saying to him: attend to your own
atque pecus cordi redituraque rupibus business, play your own instrument
Echo? (the *cithara*)and do not seek the
haunts, and imitate the pipes, of Pan.

huc ades et tantae nobis edissere causas 50

laetitiae, cui pompa toro tam clara
resultet,

quae nova dotetur virgo: patriamque
genusque

pande, quibus terris orti, quo semine
ducti.

haud ignarus enim, nec te conubia fallunt

ulla; tuo primae libantur [81] foedere
noctes.” 55

Ille refert: “equidem dudum te, diva,
morantem

mirabar, quod adhuc tanti secura maneres

coniugii. non parva tibi mandatur origo.

fascibus insignes et legum culmine fultae

convenere domus et qui lectissimus orbi

60

sanguis erat. rubris quae fluctibus insula

latrat,

qui locus Aethiopum, quae sic impervia

famam

[\[81\]](#) *Birt* libantur (MSS.); *Delphin* ed.
cessit regio, quo non rumore secundo
Palladii penetravit amor mentisque
benigna
temperies doctique sales et grata
senectus? 65

every rung of the ladder of honours, has held every place at court, and reached the highest of all offices, directing the deliberations of the senate of the East with a sure authority. Such is the bridegroom's brilliance. The bride first saw the light in the old city of Tomi by the mouth of the Danube. She is descended on her mother's side from noble ancestors famed in war and enriched by war's spoils and derives especial glory from the renown of that stalwart Celerinus who, when appointed to the defence of Meroë and the Nile, and, after the death by lightning of Carus^[84] in Parthia, offered the throne and dominion of the world by his soldiers, paid no heed to their clamour and preferred repose to an empire. Of his own will he refused when it was offered that which men will use every sort of violence and outrage every sort of right to acquire. For the first time virtue was reckoned above a throne and sovereignty, making offer of herself, met with a refusal. Sadly did Fortune confess herself beaten by a mortal. Great it is to deserve high office, still greater to have despised it.

“Celerina's father has won every title that a warrior may. Step by step he has reached the highest of all ranks,

per cunctos iit ille gradus aulaeque that of commander-in-chief; it is he
labores who dispenses titles of honour,
emensus tenuit summae fastigia sedis settles the garrisons of the provinces,
Eoum stabili moderatus iure senatum unites the scattered forces of the
hic splendor iuveni. cunabula prima empire, and checks the disposition of
puellae its troops. He decides the defences of
Danuvius veteresque Tomi. Mavortia Sarmatia and the legions that are to
matris 70 face the wild Getae or keep Saxon
nobilitas spoliis armisque exultat avians and Scot in subjection. He knows
immensamque trahit Celerini robore how many cohorts fringe the shore
lucem, of Ocean, how great an army
qui quondam Meroën iussus Nilumque maintains peace along the banks of
tueri, the Rhine. In the family of Celerina
cum sibi post obitus et Parthica fulmina to be found unspotted

Cari^[83]

[84] Carus was struck by lightning (or murdered) during his Persian campaign, A.D. 283; (*cf.* Sidon. Apol. c. 23. 91).

sceptra daret miles rebusque imponere
vellet, 75
despexit fremitus et praetulit otia regno;
respuuit ingestum, quod vi, quod poscere
ferro

posthabita pietate solent. tum purpura
primum
inferior virtute fuit meruitque repulsam
obvia maiestas. doluit Fortuna minorem

80

se confessa viro. magnum delata
potestas,
maiores contempta probat.

“Cognomina

sumpsit
plena ducum genitor. paulatim vectus
ad altum
princeps militiae, qua non inlustrior
extat
altera, cunctorum tabulas adsignat
honorum, 85

regnorum tractat numeros, constringit

[83] *Birt Caro (the reading of E and V);*
parsa imperii vires cuneosque
recenset
dispositos: quae Sarmaticis custodia
ripis,
quae saevis obiecta Getis, quae Saxona
frenat
vel Scottum legio, quantae cinxere
cohortes 90
Oceanum, quanto pacatur milite
Rhenus.

virtue, unfeigned loyalty, and diligence guided by knowledge. She is Stilicho's choice; to such choice and judgement no praise can be added. It were a shame, Venus, shouldst thou not be present at the marriage of such a maid. Come, bring all thy train. Fain would I shake the withering wreaths, brandish the torches, and devote the night to pleasure. Now even this my pipe gives no dishonoured service answering the choirs' songs."

Scarce had Hymen spoken and she bathes her in the cool stream, gathers her flowing hair, and renews her charms, taking from out the press the wondrous garments spun by her mother Dione. Her chariot is heaped with flowers and the yoke thereof is fragrant with blossoms. Flowers entwine the reins that fetter her bright doves. From all sides the birds flock together, those that soothe with their song the roar of Athesis, those whom Larius hears, Benacus feeds, or Mincius welcomes with his quiet flood. Quiet are those waters now that the birds' plaintive notes resound there no more. The swans have flown away and left the banks of Eridanus and the sounding marshes of Padusa. Right glad are the wanton Loves; they catch and harness the birds and ride them

casta domus, sincera fides,
industria sollers.
elegit Stilicho; nihil ultra
laudibus addi
iudiciove potest. tali nubente
puella
nonne tibi cessare nefas? duc
protinus omnes, 95
duc age. marcentes cupio
quassare coronas
et vibrare faces et noctem
ducere ludo.
haec quoque non vilem iam
fistula commodat usum
responsura choris.”

Vix

haec Hymenaeus; at illa
fontibus abluitur gelidis
legemque capillo 100
reddit et ornatum formae
prelisque solutae
mira Dioneae sumit velamina
telae.
floribus extruitur currus; iuga
floribus halant;
floreas purpureas adnectunt
frena columbas.
undique concurrunt volucres,
quaecumque frementem
permulcent Athesin cantu, quas
Larius audit, 106
quas Benacus alit, quas excipit
amne quieto
Mincius: ereptis obmutuit unda
querellis.
Eridani ripas et raucae stagna
Padusae
diffugiens nudavit olor

through the clouds before the eyes of
Venus. There they join in noisy
battle, lean forward to strike one
another, and fall but suffer no hurt.
Fallen they overtake their steeds
with flight swifter than theirs, for the
charioteer is fleeter than the chariot.

Soon as they reached the doors of
the marriage-chamber they empty
baskets full of red spring flowers,
pouring forth showers of roses and
scattering from their laden quivers
violets gathered in Venus' meadow,
violets untouched e'en by the heat of
the

auriga iugales. 115

laetantur^[214] Amores 110
frenatisque truces avibus per
nubila vecti
ostentant se quisque deae
magnoque tumultu
confligunt pronique manus in
verbera tendunt
atque impune cadunt: lapsus
melior volatu
consequitur vincitque suos
auriga iugales. 115

Ut thalami tetigere fores, tum
vere rubentes
desuper invertunt calathos
largosque rosarum
imbres et violas plenis sparsere
pharetris
collectas Veneris prato, quibus
ipse pepercit

[215]

Dog-star who had tempered for their frail beauty his accustomed fires. Others throughout the palace poured forth from jewelled caskets unguents gathered by the banks of the Nile from trees whose bark, when wounded by the cruel finger-nail, oozed with rich gum. Cytherea approaches the bride, and, despite her tears, drew her from her mother's arms. Her swelling breast betokens maidenhood ripe for marriage, her skin is whiter than lilies or than snow, and her golden hair points to the Danube as her birthplace. Then, taking the hand of the bridegroom, Venus joins to it that of the bride and with these words blesses their union: "Live as one and fulfil all my rites. Give a thousand kisses, let arm be bruised with enfolding arm, and lips so join that soul may meet soul. And thou, husband, put not thy confidence in rude love-making; thy wife's love cannot be won by threats, but must be gained by entreaty. And do thou yield to thy husband nor seek to show anger; use not thy nails as weapons like the women of Scythia. I beg thee submit to conquest; so shalt thou be indeed a wife, so a mother. Why are there tears in thine eyes? Believe me, thou shalt love him whom now thou fearest."

Sirius et teneras clementi sidere
 fovit. 120
gemmatis alii per totum
 balsama tectum
effudere cadis, duro quae
 saucius ungue
Niliacus pingui desudat vulnere
 cortex.
adgreditur Cytherea nurum
 flentemque pudico
detraxit matris gremio. matura
 tumescit 125
virginitas superatque nives ac
 lilia candor
et patrium flavis testatur
 crinibus Histrum.
tum dextram complexa viri
 dextramque puellae
tradit et his ultro sancit conubia
 dictis:
 “Vivite concordēs et nostrum
 discite munus. 130
oscula mille sonent; livescant
 brachia nexu;
labra ligent animas. neu tu
 virtute proterva
confidas, iuvenis; non est
 terrore domanda,
sed precibus placanda tibi.
 concede marito
tu quoque neu Scythicas
 infensis unguibus iras
 135
exercere velis: vinci patiare,
 rogamus.
sic uxor, sic mater eris. quid
 lumina tinguīs,
virgo? crede mihi: quem nunc

So spake she, and chose from out her
winged attendants the two whose
bows were strongest and their aim
most sure. At once Aethon and
Pyrois leaped forward, their bright
wings tinged with purple. Dipping
their shafts in pure honey the one
aims his at the bride, the other his at
the bridegroom. They draw their
bows; the strings twang and the sure
arrows cleave the air with equal
speed and implant themselves at
equal depths in the hearts of the
twain.

virgo: crede mihi. quem nunc
horrescis,^[216] amabis.”

Dixit et aligera geminos
arctosque (XXVI) (XLIX)
praestantes e plebe vocat. puer
Aponus.
ilicet Aethon 140
et Pyrois rutilas respersi murice
plumas
prosiliunt puroque imbutis
melle sagittis
hic nuptam petit, ille virum.
sonuere reducta
cornua; certa notos pariter
sulcavit harundo
et pariter fixis haeserunt tela
medullis. 145

[217]

XXVI. (XLIX.)

Aponus.^[86]

Fount that longest life for the
dwellers in Antenor's city, banishing
by thy neighbouring waters all
harmful fates, seeing that thy
marvels stir utterance even in the
dumb, that a people's love bids poets
to honour thee in song, and that there
is no hand whose fingers have not
traced for thee some lines in thankful
witness of prayers granted, shall I
not be held guilty alike by the Muses
and the Nymphs if I alone sing not
thy praises? How can a spot whose
fame is on so many lips rightly be
passed over by me in slighting
silence?

Lower than a lofty hill yet higher
than the level plain rises a gentle
eminence, clear to see from all
around. Prolific is it in hot springs,
for wherever water penetrates its
recesses encountering fires drive it
forth. The crumbling ground exhales
vapours, and the water, closed down
in its prison of burning rock, forces
its way out by many a fissured
channel. 'Tis a region of liquid fire
where Vulcan's flames spring forth
from earth's breast, a land of burning
and of sulphur. Who would not think
it barren? Yet are those fiery fields

Fons, Antenoreae vitam qui
 porrigis urbi
 fataque vicinis noxia pellis
 aquis,
 cum tua vel mutis tribuant
 miracula vocem,
 cum tibi plebeius carmina
 dictet honos
 et sit nulla manus, cuius non
 pollice ductae 5
 testentur memores prospera
 vota notae:
 nonne reus Musis pariter
 Nymphisque tenebor,
 si tacitus soli praetereare
 mihi?
 ludibrium quid enim fas est a
 vate relinqui
 hunc qui tot populis pervolat
 ora locum? 10
 Alto colle minor, planis
 erectior arvis
 conspicuo clivus molliter
 orbe tumet
 ardentis fecundus aquae;
 quacumque cavernas
 perforat, offenso truditur igne
 latex.
 spirat putre solum, conclusaque
 subter anhelo 15
 pumice rimosas perfodit^[85]
 unda vias.
 umida flammaram regio:
 Vulcania terrae
 ubera, sulphureae fervida
 regna plagae.
 quis sterilem non credat
 humum? fumantis

green with verdure; grass grows o'er
 the burning marl and, though the
 very rocks melt at the heat, plants,
 mocking at the flames, boldly
 flourish.

Beyond this are vast furrows cut in
 the rock, scarring and cleaving it in
 long lines. Traces are

^[86] Aponus (mod. Abano) near Padua,
 famous for its hot mineral springs (*cf.*
 Mart. vi. 42. 4; Lucan, vii. 193; Sil.
 Ital. xii. 218, etc.). Padua (Patavinum)
 is said to have been founded by
 Antenor.

[85] periodit Koch, cond. (Birt)

perforat.vernant

pascua; luxuriat gramine

cocta silex 20

et, cum sic rigidae cautes

fervore liquescant,

contemptis audax ignibus

herba viret.

Praeterea grandes effosso

marmore sulci

saucia longinquo limite saxa

secant. 25

they—so tradition tells—of Hercules' plough, or else chance did the ploughshare's work. In the middle of the hill is what seems a broad, steaming sea, an azure lake of vast extent. Great is the space it covers, still greater its depth where it plunges down and loses itself beneath the rocky caverns. A thick pall of steam hangs over it; its waters cannot be touched nor drunk though they are transparent as crystal to the very bottom. Nature took counsel for herself and lest that lake should be entirely beyond our ken she let our eyes penetrate what, because of its heat, our bodies could not enter. When a breeze scatters the thick clouds of steam and clears the grey surface of the erstwhile vaporous water you can gaze with wonder on the valley floor below that glassy flood where glint old weapons, king's gifts^[87] of bygone days (between these a gulf of other hue, dark with the eddyings of black sand, swallows the hastening waters; below there opens a cavern into which the darkling flood pours, filling every nook and cranny with its swirling eddies); then are revealed the hidden places of the hill which, bent round in a bow, encircles the surface of the water with an overhanging rim.^[88]

in the lake stands motionless, filling it to the brim and fearing to o'erstep its appointed limit. The overflow runs in a stream down a sloping rock and seeks the undulating plain below. A natural but tortuous channel carries the water away and thence it flows into an open conduit of lead. These pipes, noiselessly impregnated with some powdery mineral that the water carries down, produce a snow-white distillation of salt. The streams branch off in all directions carrying with them this natural wealth whithersoever art has directed their going, flexing this way and that their errant courses, flowing in swift torrent below aqueducts and warming the arches with the heat of their rushing waters. Within the arches, amid the roarings of the echoing rock, issues forth fiercer steam and vapour as the water rushes out. Then the sick, weak with sweating, seek next the stagnant pools that long time has made pleasantly cool.

Hail to thee, stream, generous giver of the waters of healing, chief glory of the land of Italy, doctor of all that come to thee, common helper of all Aesculapius' sons; a very present deity for whose aid there is nought to pay. Whether it be that hell's fiery streams have burst their banks and

haerent stagna lacu plenas
 aequantia ripas
 praescriptumque timent
 transiluisse modum;
quod superat, fluvius devexa
 rupe volutus
 egerit et campi dorsa recurva
 petit,
devehit exceptum nativo
 spira^[90] meatu; 55
 in patulas plumbi labitur inde
 vias;
nullo cum strepitu madidis
 infecta favillis
 despumat niveum fistula cana
 salem.
multifidas dispergit opes
 artemque secutus,
 qua iussere manus, mobile
 torquet iter 60
et iunctos rapido pontes
 subtermeat aestu
 adflatasque vago temperat
 igne tholos.
acrior interius, rauci cum
 murmure saxi,
 spumeus eliso pellitur amne
 vapor.—
hinc pigras repetunt fessi sudore
 lacunas, 65
 frigora quis longae blanda
 dedere morae.
Salve Paeoniae largitor
 nobilis undae,
Dardanii salve gloria magna
 soli,
publica morborum requies,
 commune modentium

that Phlegethon gone astray bestows
his heat upon the upper world, or
that a river, originally of cold water,
sinks down into veins of sulphur and
rises thence afire (as one would think
from the smell), or that the mountain
in arbitration summons the two
elements to a treaty, balancing a
certain quantity of fire against a
similar amount of water that neither
yield to the other but under a just law
of equipoise each may withstand the
other's might—whatsoever

[90] commune nequissimum
spira Helmsius, Birt follows MSS.
auxilium, praesens numen,
[91] inempta salus 70
pari, probably a juristic formula (cf.
seu ruptis inferna ruunt incendia
aequa lance); cf. Symm. Epp. ii. 56. 1.
ripis

et nostro Phlegethon devius
orbe calet,
sulphuris in venas gelidus seu
decidit amnis
accensusque fluit (quod
manifestat odor),
sive pares [91] flammis undarum
lance rependens 75
arbiter in foedus mons
elementa vocat,
ne cedant superata sibi, sed
legibus aequis
alterius vires possit utrumque
pati:

shall prove to be the cause, whatever the origin, of this we may be sure—that thou flowest not without design. Who would dare to ascribe such a miracle to chance? Who could deny that the overruling gods have so ordained? Nature's lord, who measures the centuries by the stars, has given thee a place of honour among the works of his divinity, and, pitying the feebleness of our human bodies, has bidden pour forth healing waters for the earth, and from the riven hills burst forth streams that should win pardon from the Fates' relentless distaffs.

Happy ye whose lot it is to dwell by those banks and to possess Aponus for your own; you no plague of earth, no pestilence-fraught winds of the south, nor Sirius with his cruel fires can harm. Should Lachesis' fatal thread threaten death men find in thee a more propitious fate. If it chance that noxious humours swell their limbs or that excess of bile inflames their ailing bowels they need not to open their veins nor to cure one wound with another nor yet to drink medicine of bitter herbs. By thy water's aid they renew their lost strength without suffering; 'mid luxury the sick find relief from pain.

quidquid erit causae,
 quocumque emitteris
 ortu,
non sine consilio currere
 certa fides. 80
quis casum meritis adscribere
 talibus audet?
quis negat auctores haec
 statuisse deos?
ille pater rerum, qui saecula
 dividit astris,
inter prima poli te quoque
 sacra dedit
et fragilem nostri miseratus
 corporis usum 85
telluri medicas fundere iussit
 aquas,
Parcarumque colos exoratura
 severas
flumina laxatis emicuere
 iugis.
Felices, proprium qui te
 meruere, coloni,
fas quibus est Aponon iuris
 habere sui. 90
non illis terrena lues corrupta
 nec Austri
flamina nec saevo Sirius igne
 nocet,
sed quamvis Lachesis letali
 stamine damnet,
in te fata sibi prosperiora
 petunt.
quodsi forte malus membris
 exuberat umor 95
languida vel nimio viscera
 felle rubent,
non venas reserant nec vulnere

The Phoenix. ^[92]

There is a leafy wood fringed by
Ocean's farthest marge beyond the
Indes and the East where Dawn's
panting coursers first seek entrance;
it hears the lash close by, what time
the watery threshold echoes to the
dewy car; and hence comes forth the
rosy

^[92] C. follows Herodotus (ii. 73) fairly
closely.

non venas reserant nec vulnera sanant
XXVII. (XLIV.)

pocula ne Phrygiæ gramine
mixta bibunt:
Oceanum summo circumfluus
amissum lymphis reparant
aequore lucus
impune vigorem,
trans Indos Eurumque viret, qui
pacaturque aegro luxuriante
primus annelis
dolor. 100
sollicitatur equis vicinaque
verbera sentit,
umida roranti resonant cum
limina curru,

morn while night, illumined by those far-shining wheels of fire, casts off her sable cloak and broods less darkly. This is the kingdom of the blessed bird of the sun where it dwells in solitude defended by the inhospitable nature of the land and immune from the ills that befall other living creatures; nor does it suffer infection from the world of men. Equal to the gods is that bird whose life rivals the stars and whose renascent limbs weary the passing centuries. It needs no food to satisfy hunger nor any drink to quench thirst; the sun's clear beam is its food, the sea's rare spray its drink—exhalations such as these form its simple nourishment. A mysterious fire flashes from its eye, and a flaming aureole enriches its head. Its crest shines with the sun's own light and shatters the darkness with its calm brilliance. Its legs are of Tyrian purple; swifter than those of the Zephyrs are its wings of flower-like blue dappled with rich gold.

Never was this bird conceived nor springs it from any mortal seed, itself is alike its own father and son, and with none to recreate it, it renews its outworn limbs with a rejuvenation of death, and at each decease wins a fresh lease of life. For when a thousand summers have

unde rubet ventura dies
longeque coruscis 5
nox adflata rotis refugo pallescit
amictu:
haec fortunatus nimium
Titanius ales
regna colit solusque plaga
defensus iniqua
possidet intactas aegris
animalibus oras
saeva nec humani patitur
contagia mundi. 10
par volucer superis, stellas qui
vividus aequat
durando membrisque terit
redeuntibus aevum,
non epulis saturare famem, non
fontibus ullis
adsuetus prohibere sitim; sed
purior illum
solis fervor alit ventosaeque
pabula potat 15
Tethyos, innocui carpens
alimenta vaporis.
arcanum radiant oculi iubar.
igneus ora
cingit honos. rutilo cognatum
vertice sidus
attollit cristatus apex
tenebrasque serena
luce secat. Tyrio pinguntur
crura veneno. 20
antevolant Zephyros pinnae,
quas caerulus ambit
flore color sparsoque super
ditescit in auro.
Hic neque concepto fetu nec
semina surgit

passed far away, a thousand winters
gone by, a thousand springs in their
course given to the husbandmen that
shade^[93] of which autumn robbed
them, then at last, fordone by the
number of its years, it falls a victim
to the burden of age; as a tall pine on
the summit of Caucasus, wearied
with storms, heels over with its
weight and threatens at last to crash
in ruin; one portion falls by reason of
the unceasing winds, another breaks
away rotted by the rain, another
consumed by the decay of years.

[93] *i.e.* given leaves which in turn
supply shade.

semine surgit,
 sed pater est profusque sui [226]
 nulloque creante
 emeritos artus fecunda morte
 reformat 25
 et petit alternam totidem per
 funera vitam.
 namque ubi mille vias
 longinqua retorserit
 aestas,
 tot ruerint hiemes, totiens ver
 cursibus actum,
 quas tulit autumnus, dederit
 cultoribus umbras:
 tum multis gravior tandem
 subiungitur annis 30
 lustrorum numero victus: ceu
 lassa procellis
 ardua Caucasio nutat de
 culmine pinus
 seram ponderibus pronis
 tractura ruinam;
 pars cadit adsiduo flatu, pars
 imbre peresa
 rumpitur, abripuit partem
 vitiosa vetustas. 35

[227]

Now the Phoenix's bright eye grows
 dim and the pupil becomes palsied
 by the frost of years, like the moon
 when she is shrouded in clouds and
 her horn begins to vanish in the mist.
 Now his wings, wont to cleave the
 clouds of heaven, can scarce raise
 them from the earth. Then, realizing
 that his span of life is at an end and
 in preparation for a renewal of his
 splendour, he gathers dry herbs from
 the sun-warmed hills, and making an
 interwoven heap of the branches of
 the precious tree of Saba he builds
 that pyre which shall be at once his
 tomb and his cradle.

On this he takes his seat and as he
 grows weaker greets the Sun with his
 sweet voice; offering up prayers and
 supplications he begs that those fires
 will give him renewal of strength.
 Phoebus, on seeing him afar, checks
 his reins and staying his course
 consoles his loving child with these
 words: "Thou who art about to leave
 thy years behind upon yon pyre,
 who, by this pretence of death, art
 destined to rediscover life; thou
 whose decease means but the
 renewal of existence and who by
 self-destruction regainest thy lost
 youth, receive back thy life, quit the
 body that must die, and by a change
 of form come forth more beauteous
 than ever."

Iam breve decrescit lumen
 languetque senili
segnis stella gelu, qualis cum
 forte tenetur
nubibus et dubio vanescit
 Cynthia cornu.
iam solitae medios alae
 transcurrere nimbos
vix ima tolluntur humo. tum
 conscius aevi 40
defuncti reducisque parans
 exordia formae
arentes tepidis de collibus eligit
 herbas
et tumulum texens pretiosa
 fronde Sabaeum
componit, bustumque sibi
 partumque futurum.
Hic sedet et Solem blando
 clangore salutat 45
debilior miscetque preces ac
 supplice cantu
praestatura novas vires incendia
 poscit.
quem procul adductis vidit cum
 Phoebus habenis,
stat subito dictisque pium
 solatur alumnum:
“o senium positura rogo
 falsisque sepulcris 50
natales habiture vices, qui saepe
 renasci
exitio proprioque soles
 pubescere leto,
accipe principium rursus
 corpusque coactum
desere. mutata melior procede
 figura ”

So speaks he, and shaking his head
casts one of his golden hairs and
smites willing Phoenix with its life-
giving effulgence. Now, to ensure his
rebirth, he suffers himself to be
burned and in his eagerness to be
born again meets death with joy.
Stricken with the heavenly flame the
fragrant pile catches fire and burns
the aged body. The moon in amaze
checks her milk-white heifers and
heaven halts his revolving spheres,
while the pyre conceives the new
life; Nature takes care that the
deathless bird

ingua.

Haec fatus ^[228]propere flavis e
crinibus unum 55
concussa cervice iacit missoque
volentem
vitali fulgore ferit. iam sponte
crematur
ut redeat gaudetque mori
festinus in ortum.
fervet odoratus telis caelestibus
agger
consumitque senem. nitidos
stupefacta iuencos 60
luna premit pigrosque polus non
concitat axes
parturiente rogo: curis Natura
laborat,

[229]

perish not, and calls upon the sun,
mindful of his promise, to restore its
immortal glory to the world.

Straightway the life spirit surges
through his scattered limbs; the
renovated blood floods his veins.
The ashes show signs of life; they
begin to move though there is none
to move them, and feathers clothe
the mass of cinders. He who was but
now the sire comes forth from the
pyre the son and successor; between
life and life lay but that brief space
wherein the pyre burned.

His first delight is to consecrate his
father's spirit by the banks of the
Nile and to carry to the land of Egypt
the burned mass from which he was
born. With all speed he wings his
way to that foreign strand, carrying
the remains in a covering of grass.
Birds innumerable accompany him,
and whole flocks thereof throng his
airy flight. Their mighty host shuts
out the sky where'er it passes. But
from among so vast an assemblage
none dares outstrip the leader; all
follow respectfully in the balmy
wake of their king. Neither the fierce
hawk nor the eagle, Jove's own
armour-bearer, fall to fighting; in
honour of their common master a
truce is observed by all. Thus the
Parthian monarch leads his
barbarous hosts by yellow Tigris'

aeternam ne perdat avem,
 flammasque fideles
admonet, ut rerum decus
 inmortale remittant.
 Continuo dispersa vigor per
 membra volutus 65
aestuat et venas recidivus
 sanguis inundat.
victuri cineres nullo cogente
 moveri
incipiunt plumaque rudem
 vestire favillam.
qui fuerat genitor, natus nunc
 prosilit idem
succeditque novus: geminae
 confinia vitae 70
exiguo medius discrimine
 separat ignis.
 Protinus ad Nilum manes
 sacrare paternos
auctoremque globum Phariae
 telluris ad oras
ferre iuvat. velox alienum pergit
 in orbem
portans gramineo clausum
 velamine funus. 75
innumerae comitantur aves
 stipatque volantem
alituum suspensa cohors.
 exercitus ingens
obnubit vario late convexa
 meatu.
nec quisquam tantis e milibus
 obvius audet
ire duci, sed regis iter fragrantis
 adorant. 80
non ferus accipiter, non armiger
 inca Tonantis

banks, all glorious with jewels and
rich ornament and decks his tiara
with royal garlands; his horse's
bridle is of gold, Assyrian
embroidery embellishes his scarlet
robes, and proud with sovereignty he
lords it o'er his numberless slaves.

There is in Egypt a well-known city
celebrated for its pious sacrifices and
dedicated to the worship of the Sun.
Its temple rests on a hundred
columns hewn from the quarries of
Thebes. Here, as the

ipse Romanus
 bella movet: commune facit
 reverentia foedus.
 talis barbaricas flavo de Tigride
 turmas
 ductor Parthus agit: gemmis et
 divite cultu
 luxurians sertis apicem
 regalibus ornat; 85
 auro frenat equum, perfusam
 murice vestem
 Assyria signatur acu
 tumidusque regendo
 celsa per famulas acies ditione
 superbit.
 Clara per Aegyptum placidis
 notissima sacris
 urbs Titana colit, centumque
 adcline columnis 90
 invehitur templum Thebano
 monte revulsis.

[231]

story tells, the Phoenix is wont to
 store his father's ashes and, adoring
 the image of the god, his master, to
 entrust his precious burden to the
 flames. He places on the altar that
 from which he is sprung and that
 which remains of himself. Bright
 shines the wondrous threshold; the
 fragrant shrine is filled with the holy
 smoke of the altar and the odour of
 Indian incense, penetrating even as
 far as the Pelusiac marshes, fills the
 nostrils of men, flooding them with
 its kindly influence and with a scent
 sweeter than that of nectar perfumes
 the seven mouths of the dark Nile.

Happy bird, heir to thine own self!
 Death which proves our undoing
 restores thy strength. Thine ashes
 give thee life and though thou perish
 not thine old age dies. Thou hast
 beheld all that has been, hast
 witnessed the passing of the ages.
 Thou knowest when it was that the
 waves of the sea rose and o'erflowed
 the rocks, what year it was that
 Phaëthon's error devoted to the
 flames. Yet did no destruction
 overwhelm thee; sole survivor thou
 livest to see the earth subdued;
 against thee the Fates gather not up
 their threads, powerless to do thee
 harm.

XXVIII. (XLVII.)

illic, ut perhibent, patriam de
 more reponit
 congeriem vultumque dei
 veneratus erilem
 iam flammae commendat onus,
 iam destinat aris
 semina reliquiasque sui: mirata
 relucent 95
 limina; divino spirant altaria
 fumo,
 et Pelusiacas productus ad
 usque paludes
 Indus odor penetrat nares
 completque salubri
 tempestate viros et nectare
 dulcior aura
 ostia nigrantis Nili septena
 vaporat. 100
 O felix heresque tui! quo
 solvimur omnes,
 hoc tibi suppeditat vires;
 praebetur origo
 per cinerem, moritur te non
 pereunte senectus.
 vidisti quodcumque fuit; te
 saecula teste
 cuncta revolvuntur; nosti quo
 tempore pontus 105
 fuderit elatas scopulis
 stagnantibus undas,
 quis Phaëthonteis erroribus
 arserit annus,
 et clades te nulla rapit solusque
 superstes
 edomita tellure manes: non
 stamina Parcae
 in te dira legunt nec ius habuere
 nocendi 110

The Nile. ^[94]

Blessèd is the man who cleaves the
 soil of Egypt with his plough; he
 need not hope for clouds to shroud
 the heavens in darkness nor call
 upon the storm-winds that bring the
 chilling rain or the rainbow bright
 with its various colours.

^[94] Claudian again borrows from
 Herodotus (ii. 20-27).

XXVIII. (XLVII.)

Nilus.

Felix, qui Pharias proscindit
vomere terras:
nubila non sperat tenebris
condentia caelum
nec graviter flantes pluviali
frigore Cauros
invocat aut arcum variata luce
rubentem.

Fertile is Egypt without clouds; here alone is sunshine and yet rain. She regards not the sky, needs not the wind; enough for her the water she herself contains, Nile's overflow. This swiftly-flowing river rises in the mountainous country of the south where it suffers the heats of the torrid zone and of the scorching Crab and issues forth from regions unknown into our world. Whence it comes none knows, for vain has ever been the search after its springing nor has any ever seen that source. 'Tis said that, fashioned without witness, it pours forth waters that have known a clime other than ours. Thence with errant stream it stretches through all Libya, and through Ethiopia's thousand dusky kingdoms where it waters lands condemned to the sun's unceasing fires, saviour of thirsting peoples, and threads its course across Meroë and black Syene and through the country of the wild Blemyae. The unconquered Garamantes and the Gyrraei who can tame wild animals drink of its waters, as do those tribes who dwell in huge rocky caverns, gathering the wood of ebony-trees and robbing the elephant of his tusks of ivory, and the folk who wear arrows in their hair.

Aegyptus sine nube ferax
imbresque serenos 5
sola tenet; secura poli, non
indiga venti
gaudet aquis, quas ipsa vehit,
Niloque redundat:
qui rapido tractu mediis elatus
ab Austris,
flammi ferae patiens zonae
cancricae calentis,
fluctibus ignotis nostrum
procurrit in orbem 10
secreto de fonte cadens, qui
semper inani
quaerendus ratione latet, nec
contigit ulli
hoc vidisse caput: fertur sine
teste creatus
flumina profundens alieni
conscia caeli.
inde vago lapsu Libyam
dispersus in omnem 15
Aethiopum per mille ruit
nigrantia regna
et loca continuo solis damnata
vapores
inrorat populisque salus
sistentibus errat
per Meroën Blemyasque feros
atramque Syenem.
hunc bibit infrenis Garamas
domitorque ferarum 20
Gyrraeus, qui vasta colit sub
rupibus antra,
qui ramos ebeni, dentes qui
vellit eburnos,
et gens compositis crinem
velata sagittis

Neither the cause nor yet the season
of its overflow is the same as that of
other rivers. Its waters rise neither
because of melted snows nor by
reason of rains flooding its rocky
marge; for when dull winter giveth
increase to other rivers Nile keeps
within his banks; when other rivers
flow with diminished stream, Nile,
under other laws, rises. For of a truth
whatever toll summer has exacted
from all rivers Nature repays to the
Nile, and waters gathered together
from the whole world meet thus

veiaa sagittis.

Nec vero similes causas
quoque die tentibus undis
aut tempore pluviarum. glaci
et rapit illos adidos
nec circumspectis scopulis
compesent radiis que potentibus
nam cum aestatis hiems alias
Nilo bruma venit, undaria
tunc Nilum perit undae; cum
defectis languida cessant
flumina, cultoribus sequitur
effluit Aegaeo stagnantiore,
quippe quod ex alto
Ionio seque patet aestas, 30
hoc Nile expulsa refert, totumque
fluctuat per orbem;
collectas partes novales; 40
saepius, res novae, dea annem;
forte sopore,
cernit cum stabulis armenta
natantia pastor.

XXIX. (XLVIII.)

Magnes.

[235]

in one river. Then when the Dog-star
increases the heat of the sun and
sucks up all moisture, drying up
earth's veins and filling heaven with
its scorching rays, winter comes
upon the Nile, though elsewhere all
is summer. Then, bringing back to
the fainting husbandmen its
accustomed waters, it o'erflows
ampler than the Aegean, fiercer than
the deep Ionian, and spreads itself
over the low-lying country. All the
fields are aswim; plough-land sounds
to the beat of the oar, and full often
the shepherd, o'ercome with
summer's heat, wakes to see flocks
and fold carried away by the flood.

XXIX. (XLVIII.)

The Magnet.

Whosoever with anxious thought
examines the universe and searches
out the origin of things—the reason
of the sun's and moon's eclipse, the
causes of comets' red and baneful
fires, the source of the winds, the
motion that makes the earth to
quake, the force that splits the
heavens in twain, the noise of the
thunder, the brilliance of the
rainbow, let this man (if man's mind
has any power to conceive the truth)
explain to me something I would
fain understand.

Quisquis sollicita mundum
ratione secutus
semina rimatur rerum, quo luna
laborat
defectu, quae causa iubet
pallescere solem,
unde rubescentes ferali crine
cometae,
unde fluant venti, trepidae quis
viscera terrae 5
concutiat motus, quis fulgura
ducat hiatus,
unde tonent nubes, quo lumine
floreat arcus,
hoc mihi quaerenti, si quid
deprendere veri
mens valet, expediat.

Lapis est
cognomine magnes
decolor obscurus vilis. non ille
repexam 10
caesariem regum, non candida
virginis ornat
colla nec insigni splendet per
cingula morsu;
sed nova si nigri videas
miracula saxi,
tunc pulchros superat cultus et
quidquid Eois

There is a stone called the loadstone;
black, dull, and common. It does not
adorn the braided hair of kings nor
the snowy necks of girls, nor yet
shine in the jewelled buckles of
warriors' belts. But consider the
marvellous properties of this dull-
looking stone and you will see that it
is of more worth than lovely gems
and any pearl sought of

Indian amid the seaweed on the Red Sea's shores. It lives on iron and feeds on its inflexible nature; iron is its food and nourishment; from iron it recruits its strength. This seemingly inedible food, circulating throughout its body, renews its hidden powers. Without iron the loadstone dies; its bulk wastes away from lack of nourishment and thirst parches its emptied veins.

Mars, who strikes cities with his bloody spear, and Venus, who changes human cares to ease, share a common shrine and temple built of gold. Each deity has his own image; Mars, a polished iron statue, Venus, one fashioned of the loadstone. The priest duly celebrates their union. The nuptial torch precedes the choir; myrtle wreaths adorn the portals, the couches are piled with roses, while cloth of scarlet dye, as befits a marriage, adorns the bridal chamber. But, lo, a prodigy: Cytherea, without quitting her station, attracts her husband to her, and recalling the scene of which heaven was once witness, clasps Mars to her bosom with amorous breath. There she holds him suspended; her arms enfold the helmet of the god and clasp his whole body in a lifelike embrace. He, stirred by the far-compelling influence of her breath,

Indus litoribus Rubra scrutatur
in alga. 15
nam ferro meruit vitam ferrique
rigore
vescitur; hoc dulces epulas, hoc
pabula novit;
hinc proprias renovat vires; hinc
fusa per artus
aspera secretum servant
alimenta vigorem;
hoc absente perit: tristi
morientia torpent 20
membra fame, venasque sitis
consumit apertas.
Mavors, sanguinea qui
cuspidem verberat urbes,
et Venus, humanas quae laxat in
otia curas,
aurati delubra tenent communia
templi.
effigies non una deis: sed ferrea
Martis 25
forma nitet, Venerem magnetica
gemma figurat.
illis conubium celebrat de more
sacerdos.
ducit flamma choros; festa
frondentia myrto
limina cinguntur, roseisque
cubilia surgunt
floribus, et thalamum dotalis
purpura velat. 30
hic mirum consurgit opus:
Cytherea maritum
sponte rapit caelique toros
imitata priores
pectora lascivo flatu Mavortia
nectit

is drawn towards her by the secret chains of his jewel-bride. Nature presides over the divine marriage; a binding breath woos the steel to wedlock; suddenly two deities are mated in secret union.

What hidden warmth infuses mutual sympathy into these twin metals? What harmony makes one their stubborn souls? The stone sighs and burns, and smitten with love recognizes in the iron the object of its desire, while the iron experiences a

et tantum suspendit onus
 sic Venus, haec quoque lacubris
 implicat omnesque totum
 et vultum complexibus lambit,³⁵
 ille laceratus sine prope amnis
 aestuat et strictis mucronibus
 arcanis asperitur, gemma de
 sola feris coniuge nodis
 pronuba solvit. Natura deis
 pectoris ferulae praetor,⁴⁰
 aura tenax sebitis sociantur
 pax animi nomina fuit datur,

Quis calor infudit agenis
 deserit alternas declinat in
 foedera? quid duras iungit

Quae obliuiae mentes non est
 flagrat permissa proles, etiam
 tu magna sapientis fulmen
 materiae eloquioque chalybs
 fluctibus igne mediis cogis mugire

Tonantem.

iam gelidas rupes vivoque
 carentia sensu
 membra feris, iam saxa tuis
 obnoxia telis, 55
 et lapides suus ardor agit,
 ferrumque tenetur
 inlecebris; rigido regnant in
 marmore flammae.

XXX. (XXIX.)

Laus Serenae.

[239]

gentle attraction for the stone. It is thus that Venus often holds the fierce god of war in check and softens his fiery glance when the angry blood boils within him and with drawn sword he whets his wrath. She alone can face his fierce steeds and appease the tumult of his heart, calming his anger with gentle flame. Peace and quiet are restored within his soul; he abjures the heat of battle and bends his head, helmed with ruddy plumes, to kiss the goddess.

Cruel boy, is aught beyond thy powers? Thou dost master the mighty thunderbolt; thou canst force the Thunderer to leave the sky and bellow amid the waves. Now thou showest that thou canst smite cold rocks and shapes not instinct with feeling or life, that stone can be wounded by thine arrows. Rocks are stirred by a passion of their own; iron is obedient to thy blandishments; thy flames exercise dominion over hardest marl.

XXX. (XXIX.)

In praise of Serena. ^[95]

Say, my Muse, why tarriest thou so long to crown Serena's brows with the Pierian garland they so well deserve? Thinkest thou the gift too poor shouldst thou, a queen, deck but

Dic, mea Calliope, tanto cur
tempore differs
Pierio meritam serto redimire
Serenam?
vile putas donum, solitam
consurgere gemmis
et Rubro radiare mari si floribus
ornes
reginae regina comam? sed
floribus illis, 5
quos neque frigoribus Boreas
nec Sirius urit
aestibus, aeterno sed veris
honore rubentes

with flowers the head of a queen
accustomed rather to wear a tiara
bright with all the jewels of the Red
Sea? Nay, those flowers of thine are
such that neither Boreas' cold blast
nor Sirius' scorching heat can hurt
them; theirs is the bloom of
everlasting spring for they

[95] For Serena, niece and adoptive
daughter of Theodosius and wife of
Stilicho, *cf.* Introduction, p. xvi. I
follow Vollmer (in Pauly-Wissowa, art.
"Claudianus") rather than Birt in dating
this poem *circ.* 398 and XXXI. as 404.

have grown by Permessus' fount and been watered by Aganippe's wave. Those flowers have fed the holy bees that skim the meadows and transmit the honey of Helicon to coming generations.

Did ever the single theme of woman's worth more fitly stir other bards? The Greeks sing of Alcestis, that chaste Thessalian, who, to win her husband from death, freely offered herself in his stead, allowing him to enjoy her own span of life. The Latin Muse takes prophetic Tanaquil^[96] for her theme or Cloelia breasting Tiber's waves in her return to Rome or the maiden Claudia dragging with her own hair the ship which bore Cybele, what time it stuck fast in that same stream. Does old Homer's soaring soul essay aught else throughout his song? Dangers from Charybdis' gulf, from Scylla's dogs, from Circe's cup, the escape of Ulysses from the greed of Antiphate, the passage of the ship between the rocks where sat the Sirens to whose alluring voices the rowers were deaf, the blinding of Cyclops, the desertion of Calypso—all these do but redound to the glory of Penelope, and the whole scene is set to display her chastity alone. Toils by land and sea, ten years of war, ten years of wandering, all do

fons Aganippea Permessius
 educat unda:
 unde piaae pascuntur apes et
 prata legentes
 transmittunt saeculis Heliconia
 mella futuris. 10
 Dignius an vates alios
 exercuit unum
 femineae virtutis opus? quod
 sponte redempto
 casta maritali successit Thessala
 fato
 inque suos migrare virum non
 abnuat annos,
 hoc Grai memorant. Latius
 movet ora Camenis 15
 praescia fatorum Tanaquil
 rediensque per undas
 Cloelia Thybrinas et eodem
 flumine ducens
 Claudia virgineo cunctantem
 crine Cybeben.
 anne aliud toto molitur carminis
 actu
 Maeonii mens alta senis? quod
 stagna Charybdis 20
 armavit, quod Scylla canes,
 quod pocula Circe,
 Antiphatae vitata fames
 surdoque carina
 remige Sirenum cantus
 transvecta tenaces,
 lumine fraudatus Cyclops,
 contempta Calypso:
 Penelopae decus est atque uni
 tanta paratur 25
 scaena pudicitiae. terrae
 nesciaque labores

but illustrate the fidelity of a wife. Let Claudia rejoice in the goddess' witness and with heaven's help vindicate her claim to chastity, freeing at the same moment the vessel's stern and her own character from shame. Let Penelope by artful delays deceive the madness of the suitors and, ever faithful to Ulysses, delude their solicitations, ever winding up again by night the warp of her day-spun web. Yet shall not one of these heroines dare to vie with Serena.

[96] Tanaquil, sister of the elder Tarquin, wife of the Etruscan Lucumo; for her prophetic powers see Livy i. 34. 8. Cloelia, a hostage with Porsenna, swam back to Rome (Livy ii. 13. 6). When the image of Cybele was brought to Rome (204 B.C.) and the boat stuck in a shallow at the Tiber's mouth it was said that only a chaste woman could move it. Claudia, who had been accused of adultery, took hold of the rope and towed the vessel to shore.

et saevi totidem^[242] bellis quot
fluctibus anni
coniugii docuere fidem. sit
Claudia felix
teste dea castosque probet sub
numine mores
absolvens puppisque moras
crimenque pudoris: 30
Penelope trahat arte procos
fallatque furentes
stamina nocturnae relegens
Laërtia telae:
non tamen audebunt titulis
certare Serenae.

[243]

But if noble birth opens the first path to fame and all its causes are to be traced to ancestry, what blood more noble, what birth more gentle than that of royalty? Such majesty could not have flourished within the house of a mere commoner nor could glory so great have sprung from any simple home. Thou art famous for that thine uncle was an emperor, more famous by reason of the warlike deeds of thy grandsire^[97] who carried the Roman eagles across the British Channel and repulsed the armed bands of the Gaetulians. Cornelia, daughter of the Scipios, must cease to vaunt her high birth and to boast that she received for dower the spoils of Carthage. Thou canst point to ancestral triumphs in either hemisphere; on thy brow sit two crowns, the one won by thy sires from Scotland, the other from the South. Thou glory of the world, what time Lucina assisted at the birth of thee, our new star, thy house had not yet taken on itself the government of the whole earth; not till after Serena's birth did it know world-empire.

What human voice can worthily sing thy praises, Spain? Though India first bathes the new-born sun in her ocean yet when the light dies thou waterest his wearied steeds and in

Quodsi nobilitas cunctis
exordia pandit
laudibus atque omnes redeunt in
semina causae, 35
quis venerabilior sanguis, quae
maior origo
quam regalis erit? non hoc
privata dedere
limina nec tantum poterat
contingere nomen
angustis laribus; patruo te
principe celsam
bellipotens inlustrat avus, qui
signa Britanno 40
intulit Oceano Gaetulaque
reppulit arma.
claram Scipiadum taceat
Cornelia gentem
seque minus iactet Libycis
dotata trophaeis.
cardine tu gemino laurus
praetendis avitas:
inde Caledoniis, Australibus
inde parentum 45
cingeris exuviis. necdum
moderamina mundi
sumpserat illa domus, cum te
Lucina beatiss
adderet astrorum radiis, o
maxima rerum
gloria: post genitam didicit
regnare Serenam.
Quid dignum memorare tuis,
Hispania, terris 50
vox humana valet? primo lavat
aequore solem
India: tu fessos exacta luce
inagales

thy waves the stars find refreshment.
Rich in horses, bounteous in crops,
dowered with mines, prolific in good
emperors, to thee the world owes
Trajan, from thee sprang the
Aelian^[98] race. From thy land came
the brothers who now govern us and
their father. Other races whom Rome
has either received into alliance or
subdued by arms serve the varying
needs of empire: the corn of Egypt,
the harvests of Africa go to feed our
armies; Gaul recruits our powerful
legions;

^[97] For Theodosius the elder *cf.* note
on xv. 216.

^[98] Referring to Hadrian.

iugales
 proluis inque tuo^[244] respirant
 sidera fluctu.
 dives equis, frugum facilis,
 pretiosa metallis,
 principibus fecunda piis, tibi
 saecula debent 55
 Traianum; series his fontibus
 Aelia fluxit.
 hinc senior, pater, hinc iuvenum
 diademata fratrum.
 namque aliae gentes, quas
 foedere Roma recepit
 aut armis domuit, varios
 aptantur in usus
 imperii; Phariae segetes et
 Punica messis 60
 castrorum devota cibo; dat
 Gallia robur

[245]

Illyria produces stout horsemen for
 our cavalry. But Spain alone pays
 that rarest tribute—the gift of
 emperors. Corn, money, soldiers
 come from all the world over and are
 gathered together from every quarter
 of the globe; Spain gives us men to
 govern and direct all this. Nor was
 she content to be esteemed only for
 her famous heroes, did she not also
 excel in heroines, and, emulous to
 win glory from either sex, bestow
 upon us Flaccilla,^[99] Maria, and the
 fair Serena.

At thy^[100] birth they tell how
 swelling Tagus o'erflowed the rich
 fields with gold; Galicia laughed
 with flowers and on the rose-covered
 banks of Duria's fair stream the once
 white fleeces of the sheep were
 everywhere turned to purple grain.
 The Cantabrian main cast up jewels
 upon the shore, and the pale Asturian
 delves no more into the bowels of
 the mountain; on the day hallowed
 by thy birth earth poured forth gold
 as dross from her open veins.
 Beneath the caves of the Pyrenees
 the river Nymphs gather the fiery
 thunder-stones. The Nereids,
 yielding to the flowing tide, followed
 the flooding waves up the river's
 courses; there, in the sight of all,
 they acknowledged thee their queen
 by their applause and celebrated thy

militis; Illyricis sudant
 equitatibus alae:
 sola novum Latiis vectigal
 Hiberia rebus
 contulit Augustos. fruges,
 aeraria, miles
 undique conveniunt totoque ex
 orbe leguntur: 65
 haec generat qui cuncta regant.
 nec laude virorum
 censeri contenta fuit, nisi
 matribus aequae
 vinceret et gemino certatim
 splendida sexu
 Flaccillam Mariamque daret
 pulchramque Serenam.
 Te nascente ferunt per
 pinguia culta tumentem
 70
 divitiis undasse Tagum;
 Callaecia risit
 floribus et roseis formosus
 Duria ripis
 vellere purpureo passim mutavit
 ovile.
 Cantaber Oceanus vicino litore
 gemmas
 expuit; effossis nec pallidus
 Astur oberrat 75
 montibus: oblatum sacris
 natalibus aurum
 vulgo vena vomit, Pyrenaeisque
 sub antris
 ignea flumineae legere ceraunia
 Nymphae;
 quaeque relabentes undas
 aestumque secutae
 in refluxos venero palam

coming marriage in prophetic
 strains. And all the time beneath
 another sky grew the young Stilicho;
 he lived unwitting of his fortune, of
 the destined bride that awaited him
 afar, and in a distant world was the
 union of such high destinies
 prepared.

No mortal nurse was worthy to
 watch over thy cradle. First the
 Nymphs gave thee suck at their
 fragrant breasts; the three Graces
 held thee in their arms and breathing
 upon thee taught thee to speak.
 Roses sprang where'er thou didst
 creep over the

[\[99\]](#) Flaccilla, wife of Theodosius the
 Great (*cf.* x. 43).

[\[100\]](#) *i.e.* Serena's.

in tenuos venere palam

Nereides^[246] amnes 80

confessae plausu dominam

cecinere futuris

auspiciu thalamis. alio tum

parvus in axe

crescebat Stilicho votique

ignarus agebat,

debita cui longe coniunx,

penitusque remoto

orbe parabatur tanti concordia

fati. 85

Nec tua mortalis meruit

cunabula nutrix.

ubera prima dabant gremio

redolente Napaeae

ternaque te nudis innectens

Gratia membris

adflavit docuitque loqui.

quacumque per herbam

reptares, fluxere rosae,

candentia nasci 90

[247]

grass and white lilies blossomed there; didst thou close thine eyes in quiet sleep, there burgeoned the purple violet to adorn thy grassy couch with her imperial colour. Thy mother dared not tell of such great omens and, knowing her own secret vow, hides with eager hope the fulfilment she prays for.

Thy father Honorius held thee in a close embrace. Whenever Theodosius—not emperor then—came to his brother's house he covered thee with kisses and loved to take thee with him to his own home. Then turning to thy mother with gentle complaint, "Why," thou saidst, "take me from my own home? This man ever commands.

[\[101\]](#)" Prophetic was the sportive word and thine infant lips gave augury of empire. At the death of thy sire thine illustrious uncle adopted thee and to console thee for the bitterness of that loss, bestowed upon thee, his brother's child, more love than he could have bestowed on any child of his own. Leda's twin sons were not united with a bond of affection more sure. He gave his own son the name his brother had borne, hoping in some way to discover in that son the image of the brother he had loved and lost. Finally, when the people's choice had summoned him

lilia; si placido cessissent
lumina somno,
purpura surgebat violae, factura
cubile
gramineum, vernatque tori
regalis imago,
omina non audet genetrix tam
magna fateri
successusque suos arcani
conscia voti 95
spe trepidante tegit.

Gestabat
Honorius arto
te pater amplexu. quotiens ad
limina princeps
Theodosius privatus adhuc
fraterna veniret,
oscula libabat teque ad sua tecta
ferebat
laetior; in matrem teneris
conversa querellis: 100
“quid me de propriis auferre
penatibus?” inquis:
“imperat hic semper!” praesagia
luserat error
et dedit augurium regnis
infantia linguae,
defuncto genitore tuo sublimis
adoptat
te patruus magnique animo
solacia luctus 105
restituens propius quam si
genuisset amavit
defuncti fratris subolem; nec
carior olim
mutua Ledaeos devinxit cura
Lacones:
addidit et proprio germana

to take up the reins of empire,
Theodosius would not vouchsafe his
sons any proof of his affection for
them until he had summoned thee
and thy faithful sister from Spain to
the lands of morning.

So now they leave Tagus' banks and
the home of the west winds and
hasten towards the cities that
recognize the empery of the east.
They come, the maidens twain, his
brother's children, on this side
Serena the younger, on that
Thermantia^[102] the elder born,
strange as yet to love; nor has
Hymen bent

^[101] Claudian plays on the words
imperat and *imperator*.

^[102] This Thermantia is not to be
confused with her niece Thermantia,
daughter of Serena and Stilicho (x.
339).

addunt et proprio germana

vocabula nato

quaque datur fratris speciem
sibi reddit adepti. 110

denique cum rerum summas
electus habenas

susciperet, non ante suis
intendit amorem

pignoribus quam te pariter
fidamque sororem

litus ad Eoum terris acciret
Hiberis.

Deseritur iam ripa Tagi

Zephyrique relictis 115

sedibus Aurorae famulas
properatur ad urbes.

incedunt geminae proles
fraterna puellae:

inde Serena minor, prior hinc
Thermantia natu,

expertes thalami, quarum
Cythereia necdum

[249]

their snowy necks to the yoke of Venus. Spirited yet modest is the glance of each; of each the beauty fires the hearts of men. Such as are Diana and her sister, motherless child of Jove, when they visit the realm of their uncle, lord of the sea (the foaming waves grow smooth before them in honour of the approach of the chaste goddesses; Galatea ceases her mad frolics, bold Triton dares not clasp Cymothoë in his embrace; o'er the whole ocean the dictates of purity hold sway and Proteus prevents even Neptune's flocks from indulging in their shameless amours)—even such the daughters of Honorius enter the palace and view the home of their royal parent. Both did the prince embrace with a father's love but justly did affection turn more readily to thee. Often when, his heart troubled by the anxieties of public business, he returned home depressed or angered, when his own sons fled his presence and even Flaccilla feared to approach her exasperated husband, thou alone wert able to stay his wrath and bring healing with sweet converse. On thy words he would hang, to thee confess his secret thoughts.

Thy modesty, worthy of an earlier age, surpassed even that of modest

sub iuga cervices niveas
Hymenaeus adegit. 120
utraque luminibus timidum
micat, utraque pulchro
excitat ore faces. qualis Latonia
virgo
et solo Iove nata soror cum
forte revisunt
aequorei sortem patrui
(spumantia cedunt
aequora castarum gressus
venerata dearum; 125
non ludit Galatea procax, non
improbis audet
tangere Cymothoën Triton
totoque severos
indicit mores pelago pudor
ipsaque Proteus
arcet ab amplexu turpi Neptunia
monstra):
tales sceptriferi visurae tecta
parentis 130
limen Honoriades penetrant
regale sorores.
ambas ille quidem patrio
complexus amore,
sed merito pietas in te
proclivior ibat;
et quotiens, rerum moles ut
publica cogit,
tristior aut ira tumidus flagrante
redibat, 135
cum patrem nati fugerent atque
ipsa timeret
commotum Flaccilla virum, tu
sola frementem
frangere, tu blando poteras
sermone moderari

girlhood. Less chaste than thee was that daughter of Alcinous whom Homer, in his praises of her, compares to Diana; she who spread her clothes on the shore to dry and sported with her attendant maids, throwing a golden ball from hand to hand until she fled in alarm from Ulysses issuing forth from the thicket where he had been enjoying sleep after his shipwreck.

The study of the Muses and the songs of poets of olden time were thy delight. Turning the pages of Homer, bard of Smyrna, or those of Virgil,

[103] MSS. have *fideli*; *P* marks the
adlocuiis haerere tuis secreta
passage as corrupt. I adopt *fideli* here
and, with Heinsius and Buecheler,
fateri. [103]
suppose a line fallen out between 138
and 139.
Prisca puellares reverentia
transilit annos. 140
non talem Triviae confert
laudator Homerus
Alcinoo genitam, quae dum per
litora vestes
explicat et famulas exercet laeta
choreis,
auratam iaculata pilam post
naufraga somni
otia progressum foliis expavit
Ulixen. 145
Pierius labor et veterum tibi
carmina vatum
ludus erat: quos Smyrna dedit,
quos Mantua libros

poet of Mantua, thou findest fault
 with Helen nor canst approve of
 Dido. Thy chaste mind fastens upon
 examples more noble: Laodamia
 following Protesilaus as he returned
 to the shades; Euadne who cast
 herself on the flaming pyre whereon
 her husband Capaneus perished,
 wishing to mingle her ashes with his;
 grave Lucrece who fell upon a chaste
 sword, she who self-slain bore
 witness to the tyrant's crime, aroused
 to war her country's righteous wrath,
 drove Tarquin into exile and died
 gloriously, having avenged by her
 one sacrifice both chastity and
 freedom. Of such deeds thou dost
 read with joy, thyself not less in
 virtue though more blessed of
 fortune.

Now that thou art of an age for
 marriage the hopes of the young
 courtiers run high, but the prince
 hesitates to select the happy man
 who is to share thy couch and regal
 state.

The pages of the poets tell how
 ancient kings bade suitors contend
 on the hard terms of purchasing the
 bride at hazard of their lives, and
 rejoiced that death should be the
 wooer of their daughters. Pelops
 escaped the weapons of Pisa's king,
 thanks to the chariot Neptune gave
 him, for it was Myrtilus who tricked

percurrens damnas Helenam
 nec parcis Elissae.
 nobiliora tenent animos
 exempla pudicos:
 Laodamia sequens remeantem
 rursus ad umbras 150
 Phylaciden et prona ruens
 Capaneia coniunx
 communes ardente viro mixtura
 favillas,
 et gravis incumbens casto
 Lucretia ferro,
 vulnere quae proprio facinus
 testata tyranni
 armavit patriae iustos in bella
 dolores 155
 exule Tarquinio, memorandaque
 concidit uno
 ulta pudicitiam libertatemque
 cruore.
 talia facta libens non tu virtute
 minore,
 sed fato meliore legis.
 Iam nubilis
 aetas
 principe sollicito votis erexerat
 aulam 160
 incertis, quem tanta tori fortuna
 maneret.
 Antiquos loquitur Musarum
 pagina reges,
 quod dura sub lege procos
 certare iuberent,
 empturos thalamum dubii
 discrimine leti,
 et sua crudeles gauderent
 pignora mortis 165
 ambitione poti curru Disceat

King Oenomaus by withdrawing the
 lynch-pin from the chariot-wheel.
 Panting Hippomenes got the better
 of Atalanta, daughter of Schoeneus,
 who followed close on his traces, a
 sword in her hand, by means of the
 golden apples. The inhabitants of
 Calydon watched from their high
 battlements the struggle of Hercules
 with the river-god when, Deianira
 being the prize of victory, the
 panting hero shouted in triumph and
 Achelous paled and shrank away,
 shorn of his horn, the wound
 whereof the astonished river nymphs
 sought to heal.

ambitione per. cura i isaca
marino^[252]

fugit praeda Pelops; nam
perfidus obice regis
prodidit Oenomai deceptus
Myrtilus axem.
Hippomenes trepidus cursu
ferroque secutam
aurato volucrem flexit
Schoeneida pomo. 170
Herculeas vidit Fluvio luctante
palaestras
moenibus ex altis Calydon
pretiumque labori
Deianira fuit, cum pectore
victor anhelos
Alcides fremeret retroque
Acheloios iret
decolor: attonitae stringebant
vulnera Nymphae; 175
saucia truncato pallebant
flumina cornu.

[253]

But it is neither to the apples of the Hesperides nor to victory over a river nor to treacherous tampering with a chariot-wheel that Stilicho owes the winning of thy hand; the emperor himself adjudged him worthy thereof, for that his valour had been proved in countless wars; his own courage won him an empress to wife. Generals have often bestowed decorations on those who have deserved them in battle: one man wins the mural crown, another the civic wreath, a third, for having defeated an enemy's fleet, the naval decoration. Stilicho is the only warrior who, as the reward for signal services in war, has won from a grateful father's hand the crown of marriage.

Thermantia owes her uncle no lesser debt of gratitude: she too was married to a general. But how far inferior to thine, Serena, was thy sister's fortune! For thee with fairer promise Rome's guardian-angel kindles the torches, and glorious are the garlands that thy marriage brings. First to be set in his charge is the care of the horses reared in the royal stables, whose dams were Phrygian mares, or such as have pastured on Argos' plains, whose sires were Cappadocians. Soon he exercises a double command in the army^[105]

te non Hesperidum pomis, non
 amne subacto,
 non socerum fallente rota, sed
 iudice dignus
 Augusto variis Stilicho
 spectatus in armis
 accipit et regni dotes virtute
 paravit. 180
 saepe duces meritis bello
 tribuere coronas:
 hunc cingit muralis honos; hunc
 civica quercus
 nexuit; hunc domitis ambit
 rostrata carinis.
 solus, militiae mira mercede,
 iugalem
 promeruit Stilicho socero
 referente coronam. 185
 Agnovit patruī similem
 Thermantia curam;
 nupsit et illa duci; sed longe
 fata sororis
 inferiora tuis. alio tibi numine
 taedas
 accendit Romana Salus
 magnisque coronis
 coniugium fit causa tuum.
 dilectus equorum, 190
 quos Phrygiae matres
 Argaeaque gramina
 pastae
 semine Cappadocum sacris
 praesaepibus edunt,
 primus honor, gemino mox inde
 e germine^[104] duxit
 agmina commissosque labor sic
 gessit honores,
 ut compes meritis principis cum

and fulfils his functions with such
 energy and success that, howsoever
 great the honours heaped upon him
 by the emperor, his deserts are ever
 in excess of his reward. Whenever
 the cloud of war threatened thou
 mightest have seen experienced
 commanders of horse and foot give
 way to a leader younger and of less
 exalted rank and without more ado
 entrust to him the whole war. Neither
 rank nor age stays older men through
 shame from ready obedience to a
 youth. As when on a calm sea

[\[105\]](#) i.e. *magister utriusque militiae* in
 the East.

ut semper merito princeps cum
[104] ^{germine is the reading adopted}
^{by the *Magna* Edisset, 195. Birt}
^{conjectures ex ordine}
deberet maiora tamen. si bellica
nubes
ingrueret, quamvis annis et iure
minori
cedere grandaevos equitum
peditumque magistros
adspiceres totumque palam
permittere Martem,
nec gradus aetatisque pudor
senioribus obstat, 200
ne iuveni parere velint. ceu
flamine molli

every sailor maintains his right to manage the rudder, but if the blustering south wind comes upon them and the waves buffet them on either side, then contention ceases and the sailors accepting a more skilful hand admit their fear (for the storm has set a term to their jealousy), even so Stilicho when the storm of war broke out in Thrace was chosen as commander-in-chief over the heads of all. Fear, that surest of judges, won him the votes of all; regard for safety o'ermastered ambition and jealousy was overthrown by dread.

How thou didst tremble and weep when the cruel bugles summoned thy lord to arms! With a countenance wet with tears thou saw'st him leave thy home praying for his safe return after snatching the final hasty kiss from between the bars of his crested helmet's visor. But again what joy when at length he returned, preceded by the clarion of victory and thou couldst hold his still mailed form in thy loving arms once more! How sweet the long hours of the chaste night wherein thou badest him tell in safety the story of his battles. Whilst he was at the wars thou didst not comb thy shining hair nor wear the jewels that were wont to adorn thee. Thy time is spent in worship and in

tranquillisque fretis clavum sibi
 quisque regendum
vindicat; incumbat si turbidus
 Auster et unda
pulset utrumque latus, posito
 certamine nautae
contenti meliore manu seseque
 pavere 205
confessi (finem studiis fecere
 procellae):
haud aliter Stilicho, fremuit
 cum Thracia belli
tempestas, cunctis pariter
 cedentibus unus
eligitur ductor; suffragia quippe
 peregit
iudex vera timor; victus ratione
 salutis
 Quis tibi tunc per membra
 tremor quantaque
 cadebant
ubertim lacrimae, cum saeva
 vocantibus arma
iam lituis madido respectans
 lumina vultu
optares reducem galeaeque
 inserta minaci 215
oscula cristati raperes festina
 mariti!
gaudia quae rursus, cum post
 victricia tandem
classica sidereas ferratum
 pectus in ulnas
exciperes, castae tuto per dulcia
 noctis
otia pugnarum seriem narrare
 iuberes! 220
non illo nitidos umquam

prayer as thy suppliant tresses sweep
the temple floor; uncared for
perishes the gracious beauty that
shall return with thine own lord.

But love languishes not in idleness
and sloth; as far as it could a
woman's watchful care seconds his
deeds of glory. While he warred with
foreign nations thou keepest guard
lest mad envy or burning calumny
should dare aught against him while
far away, and lest, when war was
ended abroad, treachery should lie
secretly in wait to injure him

non illos unquam
 bellante capillos^[256]
 collidit, non solito gemmarum
 sedula quondam
 Rufino medicisque facas, cum
 supplicet aines
 verdis humum, teritur neglectae
 gratiae formae
 cum propter Greditur, in visorimata
 latentes 235 Nec
 mandatis desinebundas virum
 segnis marquet amon laudas.
 prudentia belli
 feminea pro parte subit. dum
 XXXI. (XL.)
 confliat, vigil tu prospicis
 omnia sensu,
 ne quid in absentem virtutibus
 obvia semper
 audeat invidiae rabies neu
 fervor iniquus, 230
 ne qua procul positus furto
 subsederit armis

[257]

at home. Thou didst indeed once
 show thy vigilance what time
 Rufinus, hatching his plots, sought
 means to destroy his master by
 traitorously stirring up the Getae
 against Rome, for thou didst search
 out his foul conspiracy and in fear
 for thy husband's safety, didst send
 him warning by letters and
 messages.

XXXI. (XL.)

Letter to Serena.

At the first kindling of Orpheus'
 marriage-torch when festive Hymen
 filled the countryside of Thrace the
 beasts and gay-plumaged birds
 strove among themselves what best
 gifts they could bring their poet.
 Mindful of the cave whose sounding
 rocks had offered a wondrous theatre
 for his tuneful lyre, the lynxes
 brought him crystal from the
 summits of Caucasus; griffins golden
 nuggets from regions of the north;
 doves wreaths of roses and other
 flowers which they had flown to
 gather from Venus' meadow; the
 swan bore from the stream of its
 native Padus amber broken from the
 boughs of the famed sisters^[106];
 while the cranes, after their war with
 the pygmies, recrossed the Nile and
 gathered in their mouths the precious

Orphea cum primae sociarent
numina taedae
ruraque compleret Thracia
festus Hymen,
certavere ferae picturataeque
volucres,
dona suo vati quae potiora
darent,
quippe antri memores, cautes
ubi saepe sonorae 5
praebuerant dulci mira
theatra lyrae.
Caucasio crystallae ferunt de
vertice lynces,
grypes Hyperborei pondera
fulva soli,
furatae Veneris prato per inane
columbae
floreae conexas sarta tulere
rosis, 10
fractaque nobilium ramis
electra sororum
cycnus oliviferi vexit ab
amne Padi,
et Nilo Pygmaea grues post
bella remenso
ore legunt Rubri germina
cara maris.
venit et extremo Phoenix
longaevus ab Euro 15
adportans unco cinnamomum
pede.
nulla avium pecudumque fuit,
quae ferre negaret
vectigal merita conubiale
lyrae.
Tunc opibus totoque
Heliconis sedula regno

pearls of the Red Sea. There came,
too, immortal Phoenix from the
distant East, bearing rare spices in
his curved talons. No bird nor beast
was there but brought to that
marriage-feast tribute so richly
deserved by Orpheus' lyre.

Busily Calliopea decked her son's
bride with her riches and all the
treasures of Helicon, and, moreover,

[106] *i.e.* of Phaëthon, who were
changed into poplars.

ITENCOMS SEQUA REGNO
[258]
ornabat propriam Calliopea
norum. 20

[259]

with a mother's pride dared to invite to her son's wedding the queen of starry heaven herself. The queen of the gods spurned not her request either out of respect for Calliopea herself or because she was drawn by a just affection for the pious poet who had so often in her honour chanted his songs before her altars, hymning Juno's godhead with his sweet voice and telling of the battles of her lord the Thunderer waged on the plains of Phlegra, and of the menace of Enceladus and the Titans there broken. Straightway, counting the marriage—night worthy of her presence, she brought heavenly gifts to deck the bridal, gifts such as stoop not to adorn mortals, gifts that the gods alone may possess. But as Juno showed herself gracious to Thracian Orpheus, so wilt thou, Serena, be favourable to my prayers. The stars, her slaves, obey the nod of her head; thee land and sea, subdued beneath thy feet, obey. I did not, as other suitors use, promise at my courtship fields where graze unnumbered flocks nor hills covered with countless vines, nor rich olive-trees waving in the breeze their grey foliage, nor harvests reaped by a thousand scythes, nor a lofty palace with golden pillars. Enough was the mandate of a goddess; thy letter, Serena, stands me in stead of flocks,

ipsam praeterea dominam
 stellantis Olympi
 ad nati thalamos ausa rogare
 parens.
 nec spreuit regina deum vel
 matris honore
 vel iusto vatis ducta favore
 pii,
 qui sibi carminibus totiens
 lustraverat aras 25
 Iunonis blanda numina voce
 canens
 proeliaque altisoni referens
 Phlegraea mariti,
 Titanum fractas Enceladique
 minas.
 ilicet adventu noctem dignata
 iugalem
 addidit augendis munera
 sacra toris, 30
 munera mortales non
 admittentia cultus,
 munera, quae solos fas
 habuisse deos.
 sed quod Threicio Iuno
 placabilis Orphei,
 hoc poteris votis esse,
 Serena, meis.
 illius expectent famulantia
 sidera nutum; 35
 sub pedibus regitur terra
 fretumque tuis.
 non ego, cum peterem, sollemni
 more procorum
 promisi gregibus pascua
 plena meis
 nec, quod mille mihi lateant sub
 palmitum colles

of harvests, of palace. The shadow of
 thy name has won over her parents
 and an imperial prayer concealed my
 poverty. When Serena writes, what
 with such words could not the
 empire's spirit or duteous love
 accomplish?^[107]

Would heaven had allowed me to
 solemnize the longed-for day in the
 light of thy presence, in thy

^[107] Claudian means that Serena's
 imperial position and his own respect
 therefor ensure his obedience. Serena
 had written (*littera*, l. 43) urging
 Claudian to marry, and the poet uses
 the letter to urge his suit (ll. 37-46).

panthe cones
 fluctuet et glauca pinguis
 optatum celebritate diem! me
 nec, quod nostra Gaeas
 purpura, me saefalo claberet
 aurataeque uelera culmina
 et mihi celsa trabibus
 suffecit mandata deam tua
 littellamobis
 et phagus et sedges pondus
 dupla fuitet.
 infleximedicum quomaiestate
 petendbas aequor 55
 taxidpaupEnlyae no dissidet
 umbratuae,
 saltem non perficeret, fave
 reditusque secundos
 xdhgenisideregna uel pietatis
 supercilio.
 Atque utipande uias, ce
 conlingetris
 aequogis pacastis prosperiora
 gēne, 60
 ut tibi Pierides doctumque
 fluens Aganippe
 debita servato vota cliente
 canant.

XXXII. (XCV.)

De salvatore.

[261]

lord's camp, before thy son-in-law's
 throne. The royal purple would have
 been a good omen for our union, the
 august assembly of the court would
 have graced the ceremony and the
 hand which, by writing that letter,
 promised me my bride would have
 kindled the torch to light her to the
 altar. Now that the envious sea
 deprives me of my fondest hopes and
 stretches between thee and the coasts
 of Libya, yet, though absent, be
 gracious unto me, O queen, and of
 thy goodness grant me a safe return
 as by a nod of thy head thou, a
 goddess, canst do. Make straight the
 paths of earth; bid but gentle breezes
 blow and a calm sea prosper my
 voyage, that the Muses and
 Aganippe's stream, the fount of
 song, may hymn thy praises in
 gratitude for the saving of their
 servant, the poet. [\[109\]](#)

XXXII. (XCV.)

Of the Saviour.

Christ, lord of the world, founder of
 a new age of gold, voice and wisdom
 of the Most High, proceeding from
 the Father's lofty mind and given by
 that Father a share in the governance
 of this great universe, thou hast
 overcome the sins of this our mortal
 life, for thou hast suffered thy

Christe potens rerum, redeuntis
conditor aevi,
vox summi sensusque dei,
quem fudit ab alta
mente pater tantique dedit
consortia regni,
impia tu nostrae domuisti
crimina vitae
passus corporea numen^[108]
vestire figura
adfarique palam populos
hominemque fateri;
quemque utero inclusum
Mariae mox numine
viso
virginei tumuere sinus,
innuptaque mater
arcano stupuit compleri viscera
partu

^[108] numen *Koch*; mundum *Birt*
(following the mss.); he suggests
mentem.

Godhead to be clothed in human
form and hath allowed mankind to
address thee face to face and confess
thee man. The swelling womb of the
Virgin Mary conceived thee after
that she had been visited by the
angel, and the unwed mother,
destined to give birth to her own
creator, was astonished at the unborn

^[109] The Muses themselves are to
hymn Serena for having by her prayers
(l. 60) secured the safe return of their
servant, Claudian.

auctorem paritura suum:
 mortalia corda 10
 artificem texere poli, mundique
 repertor
 pars fuit humani generis,
 latuitque sub uno
 pectore, qui totum late
 complectitur orbem,
 et qui non spatiis terrae, non
 aequoris unda
 nec capitur caelo, parvos
 confluxit in artus. 15
 quin et supplicii nomen
 nexusque subisti,
 ut nos subriperes leto
 mortemque fugares
 morte tua, mox aetherias
 evectus in auras
 purgata repetens laetum tellure
 parentem.
 Augustum foveas, festis ut
 saepe diebus 20
 annua sinceri celebret ieiunia
 sacri.

XXXIII.-XXXIX.

De crystallo cui aqua inerat.

XXXIII. (LVI.)

child that grew within her body. A
 mortal womb hid the artificer of the
 heavens: the creator of the world
 became a part of human nature. In
 one body was conceived the God
 who embraces the whole wide world,
 and he whom nor earth nor sea nor
 sky can contain was enclosed by the
 limbs of a little child. Thou wert
 punished and didst suffer too, for our
 sins, to save us from destruction, and
 didst by thy death overcome Death.
 Then didst Thou ascend into Heaven,
 returning to the Father who rejoiced
 at the salvation of the world.

Bless Thou our Emperor that at holy
 seasons he may for many years to
 come observe the fast-days of the
 calendar.

XXXIII-XXXIX

*On a Crystal enclosing a Drop of
Water.*

1. This piece of ice still shows traces
 of its original nature: part of it has
 become stone, part resisted the cold.
 It is a freak of winter's, more
 precious by reason of its incomplete
 crystallization, for that the jewel
 contains within itself living water.

2. Ye waters, who confine waters in a
 prison akin to them, ye that are
 liquid still and ye that were so, what
 wit has united you? By what trick of

Possedit glacies naturae signa
prioris
et fit parte lapis, frigora parte
negat.
sollers lusit hiems,
imperfectoque rigore
nobilior vivis gemma
tumescit aquis.

freezing is the marvellous stone at
once hard and wet? What containèd
heat has protected those enclosed
waters? what warm wind melted that
heart of ice? How comes it that the
jewel in whose heart the water ebbs
and flows was either made solid or
liquid by frost?

XXXIV. (LVII.)

Lymphae, quae tegitis cognato
carcere lymphas,
et, quae nunc estis quaeque
fuistis, aquae,
quod vos ingenium iunxit? qua
frigoris arte
torpuit et maduit prodigiosa
silex?
quis tepor inclusus securas
vindicat undas? 5
interior glacies quo liquefacta
Noto?
gemma quibus causis arcano
mobilis aestu
vel concreta fuit vel resoluta
gelu?

XXXV. (LVIII.)

Solibus indomitum glacies
 Alpina rigorem
 sumebat nimio iam pretiosa
 gelu
 nec potuit toto mentiri corpore
 gemmam,
 sed medio mansit proditor
 orbe latex.
 auctus honor; liquidi crescunt
 miracula saxi,
 et conservatae plus meruistis
 aquae.

XXXVI. (LIX.)

Adspice porrectam splendenti
 fragmine venam,
 qua trahitur limes lucidiore
 gelu.
 hic nullum Borean nec brumam
 sentit opacus
 umor, sed varias itque
 reditque vias.
 non illum constrinxit hiems,
 non Sirius axis, 5
 aetatis spatium non tenuavit
 edax.

XXXVII. (LX.)

3. Alpine ice was becoming so hard that the sun could not melt it, and this excess of cold was like to make it precious as diamond. But it could not imitate that stone in its entirety for at its heart lay a drop of water which betrayed its nature. As crystal its value is enhanced, for this liquid rock is accounted a miracle and the water enclosed within it increases its rarity.

4. See this vein which runs in a bright streak through the translucent ice. This hidden water fears not any blast of Boreas nor winter's chill but runs this way and that. It is not frozen by December's cold, nor dried up by July's sun, nor wasted away by all-consuming time.

5. Safely hidden away in this round covering is a stream, an errant spring, enclosed within frozen waters. Mark you not how the crystal is all awash in its cavernous heart where living waters surge this way and that, and how, when the sun penetrates its frozen depths, the hues of the rainbow are reflected in it? Wonderful stone, wonderful water: stranger than all rivers and all stones because it is a stone and yet fluid.

6. Children love to handle this shining crystal and turn its chilly mass over and over in their little

Clauditur immunis convexo
 tegmine rivus,
 duratisque vagus fons
 operitur aquis.
nonne vides, propriis ut spumet
 gemma lacunis
 et refluos ducant pocula viva
 sinus
 udaque pingatur radiis
 obstantibus Iris,
 secretas hiemes sollicitante
 die? 5
mira silex mirusque latex, et
 flumina vincit
 et lapides merito, quod fluit
 et lapis est.

XXXVIII. (LXI.)

Dum crystallae puer contingere
 lubrica gaudet
 et gelidum tenero pollice
 versat onus,
vidit perspicuo deprensas
 marmore lymphas,
 dura quibus solis parcere
 novit hiems,
et siccum relegens labris
 sistentibus orbem 5
 inrita quaesitis oscula fixit
 aquis.

hands; they see imprisoned in the
transparent rock the water which
alone winter forebore to freeze.
Placing the dry sphere against their
thirsty lips they press useless kisses
on that which guards the waters they
desire.

XXXIX. (LXII.)

Marmoreum ne sperne globum:
 spectacula transit
 regia nec Rubro vilior iste
 mari.
 informis glacies, saxum rude,
 nulla figurae
 gratia, sed raras inter habetur
 opes.

XL. (XLI.)

Epistula ad Olybrium.

7. Do not despise this sphere of rock-crystal. Kings' palaces contain no rarer jewel, nor are the Red Sea's pearls of greater value. It may be shapeless ice, unpolished rock, a rough, uncarven mass, yet is it accounted among the most precious of riches.

XL. (XLI.)

Letter to Olybrius.

What am I to think, that you send me no greeting, that no "Good wishes" traced by your fingers come back to me in turn? Is writing so difficult? Nay, who so eloquent as thou whether thou dost compose verses or, a second Cicero, thunder forth thy speeches? Greater even than thy riches is thy genius, greater thine eloquence even than thy wealth. Are the posts infrequent? Nay, couriers' feet never allow the dust to lie on the Flaminian Way. If, then, thou hast the power to write and messengers in plenty to carry thy letters what reason hast thou for thy silence unless indeed thou wish to slight me? I take it thou hast abandoned thy poet and wilt have none of him (though I can scarce believe it); or distance has made thy heart less fond. Dost thou forget me? Now shall Hydaspes lay the day to rest,

Quid rear, adfatus quod non
 mihi dirigis ullos
 nec redit alterno pollice ducta
 salus?
scribendine labor? sed quae tam
 prona facultas,
 carmina seu fundis seu
 Cicerone tonas?
cedere divitiis animi fortuna
 fatetur 5
et tantas oris copia vincit
 opes.
An rarus qui scripta ferat?
 quin tempore nullo
cessant Flaminiae
 pulverulenta viae.
cum fluat ingenium, cum sit qui
 dicta reportet,
 quae, nisi contemnor, causa
 relicta tibi? 10
despicias ergo tuum, si fas est
 credere, vatem
perfidus, et spatio debilitatur
 amor.
Excidimusne tibi? lucem iam
 condet Hydaspes,
et Tartesiaco, Sol, oriere
 vado,
candescet Geticis Meroë
 conversa pruinis 15
claraque se vetito proluet
 Ursa mari,
et, si iam nostros fastidit
 Olybrius ignes,
constat Oresteam nil valuisse
 fidem.

and thou, O sun, rise from out the
seas of Spain; now shall Egypt
change her nature and glisten with
Getic frost and the Bear bathe him in
forbidden waters. No, if Olybrius
now disdains my love then 'tis sure
Orestes' loyalty availed nought. Nay
come, banish

[268]

Quin age rumpe moras
solaturusque sodalem
absens eloquio fertilior
doce, 20
crebraque facundo festinet
littera cursu
libris atque animis
insinuanda meis.
dignatus tenui Caesar scripsisse
Maroni,
nec tibi dedecori Musa
futura. vale.

XLI. (XLII.)

Ad Probinum.

[269]

delay and to console thy friend speak
to him from far away with richer
eloquence; hither let many a letter
hasten with winged speech, to find
its way to my shelves and to my
heart. Augustus disdained not to
write to poor Vergil and my muse
shall never bring thee shame.
Farewell.

XLI.

Letter to Probinus. [\[110\]](#)

How long, pray, shall there be
silence between us? When shall a
welcome letter win a dear return? Is
it right to call me timid or rather thee
proud? Surely each shares the other's
fault. The days slip away and while
each is ashamed to be the first to
write our hesitation leads to an
unbroken silence. Yet what am I to
do? Respect forbids me to write first;
love encourages me to do so. Let
love have his way. Fortune favours
the brave, as the old poet sang.
Under her guidance I could not
hesitate to speak, though thou still
keep silence. If I shall seem overbold
or guilty of some grave fault, thou
mayst blame but I shall not bear the
burden of ingratitude. 'Twas when
thou wert consul that I first drank of
the stream of Latin song and that my
Muse, deserting Hellas, assumed the

Quem, precor, inter nos habitura
 silia finem?
 quando dabit caras littera
 grata vices?
me timidum vel te potius
 dixisse superbum
convenit? alterius crimen
 utrumque tenet.
transfluxere dies et, dum
 scripsisse priorem 5
 paenitet, aeternas itur in
 usque moras.
sed quid agam? coepisse vetat
 reverentia vestri;
 hinc amor hortatur scribere.
 vincat amor.
“fors iuvat audentes” prisci
 sententia vatis.
 hac duce non dubitem te
 reticente loqui; 10
audax aut si quid penitus
 peccasse videbor,
 arguar, ingrati non subiturus
 onus.
Romanos bibimus primum te
 consule fontes
 et Latiae accessit Graia
 Thalia togae,
incipiensque tuis a fascibus
 omina cepi 15
 fataque debebo posteriora
 tibi.
ergo laccessitus tandem rescribe
 roganti
 et patria florens sorte,
 Probine, vale.

Roman toga. ^[111] From thy
consulship my youth drew its omens
and to thee I shall owe my future
destiny. Be moved by my
importunity and after so long a delay
answer my letter. Farewell, Probinus;
be thy father's fortune thine.

^[110] See note on i. 8 and Introduction,
p. xiii.

^[111] See Introduction, p. xiii.

XLII. (LIIL.)

De apro et leone.

Torvus aper fulvusque leo
 coiere superbis
 viribus, hic saeta saevior, ille
 iuba;
 hunc Mars, hunc laudat Cybele.
 dominatur uterque
 montibus; Hercules sudor
 uterque fuit.

XLIII. (LXXV.)

In Curetium.

Fallaces vitreo stellas
 componere mundo
 et vaga Saturni sidera saepe
 queri
 venturumque Iovem paucis
 promittere nummis
 Cureti genitor noverat
 Uranius.
 in prolem dilata ruunt periuria
 patris 5
 et poenam merito filius ore
 luit.
 nam spurcos avidae lambit
 meretricis hiatus
 consumens luxu flagitiisque
 domum
 et, quas fallacis collegit lingua
 parentis,
 has eadem nati lingua
 refundit opes. 10

XLII. (LIIL.)

The Wild Boar and the Lion.

A dark boar and a tawny lion met
 once in battle, each exulting in his
 strength: the one shook his cruel
 bristles, the other his dreadful mane.
 One was Mars' favourite, the other
 Cybele's: both are kings of the
 mountains, both engaged the labours
 of Hercules.

XLIII. (LXXV.)

Against Curetius. [\[112\]](#)

Uranus, Curetius' father, could set
 deceptive stars in a sphere of glass,
 gloomily shake his head over the
 errant course of Saturn, or ensure for
 a trifle the favourable influence of
 Jupiter. The father's chicanery meets
 with its punishment, so long
 deferred, in the son whose mouth
 needs must pay the just penalty. For
 filthy are his delights and he wastes
 all his substance in wantoning and
 debauchery. And so the tongue of the
 son has squandered all the riches
 which that of his lying father
 gathered together.

XLIV. (LXXVI.)

The Same.

XLIV. (LXXVI.)

In eundem Curetium.

Si tua, Cureti, penitus
 cognoscere quaeris
sidera, patre tuo certius ipse
 loquar.
quod furis, adversi dedit
 inclementia Martis;
quod procul a Musis, debilis
 Arcas erat;

Wouldst thou, Curetius, have sure
knowledge of thy horoscope, I can
give it thee better than even thy
father. Thy madness thou owest to
the evil influence of Mars; thine
ignorance of poetry to

[\[112\]](#) We know nothing further of
Curetius.

[272]

quod turpem pateris iam cano
 podice morbum, 5
 femineis signis Luna
 Venusque fuit;
attrivit Saturnus opes. hoc
 prorsus in uno
haereo: quae cunnum
 lambere causa facit?

XLV. (LV.)

De concha.

Transferat huc liquidos fontes
 Heliconia Nais
 et patulo conchae divitis orbe
 fluat.
namque latex doctae qui laverit
 ora Serenae,
ultra Pegaseas numen habebit
 aquas.

XLVI. (LXXII.)

De chlamyde et frenis.

[273]

enfeebling Mercury; thy shameful
disease and premature decay to lady
Moon and lady Venus; Saturn has
robbed thee of thy property. But this
one fact is beyond me:—what causes
thy filthy ways?

XLV. (LV.)

The Shell.

Nymph, come from Helicon and
pour herein thy limpid waters; fill all
the vast extent of this wondrous
shell. Surely the water that has
bathed the face of the poetess Serena
will have more virtue than all the
streams of Castalia.

XLVI. (LXXII.)

On a Cloak and a Bridle.

His loving mother did not always
fashion for her dear son Achilles
those round shields that did affright
the world; she did not constantly
approach the fiery caverns of the god
of Lemnos, begging a plumèd helmet
for her son. She gave him, besides
these, garments of peace and
unwarlike adornments wherewith,
after the toils of war, he might shine
conspicuous among the chiefs of the
Achaeans. With her own hand she
wove him cloaks of purple and gold
and with patient care studded with

Non semper clipei
metuendum gentibus
orbem
dilecto studiosa parens
fabricabat Achilli,
Lemnia nec semper supplex
ardentis adibat
antra dei nato galeam factura
comantem,
sed placidos etiam cinctus et
mitia pacis 5
ornamenta dabat, bello quibus
ille peracto
conspicuus reges inter fulgeret
Achivos.
ipsa manu chlamydes ostro
texebat et auro,
frenaque, quae volucrem
Xanthum Baliumque
decerent,
aequore quaesitis onerabat
sedula gemmis. 10
At tibi diversis, princeps
altissime, certant
obsequiis soceri. Stilicho
Mavortia confert
munera, barbaricas strages
Rhenique triumphos.
reginae contenta modum
servare Serena
in tua sollicitas urget velamina
telas. 15

ocean gems bridles to adorn his fleet
steeds, Xanthus and Balius.

On thee, most puissant emperor, thy
wife's parents bestow diverse
presents. Stilicho gives thee warlike
gifts—slaughter of barbarians and
victories on the Rhine; Serena,
content to do such work as befits a
queen, plies her busy loom to weave
thee raiment.

XLVII. (LXXIII.)

De equo dono dato.

O felix sonipes, tanti cui frena
 mereri
 numinis et sacris licuit servire
 lupatis,
 seu tua per campos vento iuba
 lusit Hiberos,
 seu te Cappadocum gelida sub
 valle natantem
 Argaeae lavere nives, seu laeta
 solebas 5
 Thessaliae rapido perstringere
 pascua cursu:
 accipe regales cultus et crine
 superbus
 erecto virides spumis perfunde
 smaragdos.
 luxurient tumido gemmata
 monilia collo,
 nobilis auratos iam purpura
 vestiat armos, 10
 et medium te zona liget variata
 colorum
 floribus et castae manibus
 sudata Serenae,
 Persarum gentile decus. sic
 quippe laborat
 maternis studiis nec dedignatur
 equestres
 moliri phaleras genero latura
 decorem. 15

XLVIII. (LXX.)

XLVII. (LXXIII.)

On a Gift to a Horse.

Happy steed, whose good fortune it
 is to obey the directing hand of a god
 and to be guided by a sacred bit.
 Whether on the plains of Spain the
 wind tossed thy mane in sport, or
 thou didst bathe in the melted snows
 of Mount Argaeus, in some fertile
 valley of Cappadocia, or thou didst
 scour the rich pasture-lands of
 Thessaly in wind-swift course,
 receive this royal harness and,
 tossing thy proud mane, fleck with
 foam the bridle studded with
 emeralds. Arch thy haughty neck
 beneath its collar of pearls; let cloth
 of purple and gold clothe thy
 shoulders and a belt of many colours
 worked by Serena's chaste hands
 pass beneath thy belly. 'Tis an
 ornament worthy the kings of Persia.
 Such is her motherly love that to
 enhance her son-in-law's glory she
 disdains not to embroider the very
 harness of his horses.

XLVIII. (LXX.)

*On a Strap embroidered by Serena
 for Honorius' Horse.*

Receive at a sister's hand a small
 gift, revered prince, a gift
 embroidered by her own hand; the

*De zona equi regii missa Honorio
Augusta a Serena.*

Accipe parva tuae, princeps
venerande, sororis
munera, quae manibus texuit
ipsa suis,
dumque auro phalerae, gemmis
dum frena renident,
hac uterum zona cinge
fremetis equi,
sive illum Armeniis aluerunt
gramina campis
turbidus Argaea seu nive lavit
Halys,
sanguineo virides morsu vexare
smaragdos
et Tyrio dignum terga rubere
toro.

bridle of thy champing steed is of gold, his head-harness studded with jewels; use now this strap to pass beneath his belly. Whether his home was the grassy plain of Armenia, or by the Halys, swollen with the melted snows of Mount Argaeus wherein he was wont to bathe, he well deserves an emerald-encrusted bit to champ in his blood-flecked mouth and cloth of Tyrian purple to adorn his back. How

[276]

o quantum formae sibi conscius
erigit armos
spargit et excussis colla
superba iubis! 10
augescit brevis doni pietate
Serena,
quae volucres etiam fratribus
ornat equos.

XLIX. (XLVI.)

De torpedine.

[277]

conscious he is of his own beauty as
he steps high and shakes his flowing
mane over his proud neck! The slight
nature of the present is dignified by
the affection of Serena who for her
brothers decks even their swift
steeds.

XLIX. (XLVI.)

The Electric Ray.

Who has not heard of the invincible
skill of the dread torpedo and of the
powers that win it its name?

Its body is soft and its motion slow.
Scarcely does it mark the sand o'er
which it crawls so sluggishly. But
nature has armed its flanks with a
numbing poison and mingled with its
marrow chill to freeze all living
creatures, hiding as it were its own
winter in its heart. The fish seconds
nature's efforts with its own
guilefulness; knowing its own
capabilities, it employs cunning, and
trusting to its power of touch lies
stretched full length among the
seaweed and so attacks its prey. It
stays motionless; all that have
touched it lie benumbed. Then, when
success has crowned its efforts, it
springs up and greedily devours
without fear the living limbs of its
victim.

Quis non indomitam dirae
torpedinis artem
audiit et merito signatas nomine
vires?

Illa quidem mollis segnique
obnixa natatu
reptat et attritis vix languida
serpit harenis.
sed latus armavit gelido natura
veneno, 5
et frigus, quo cuncta rigent
animata^[113], medullis
miscuit et proprias hiemes per
viscera duxit.

naturam iuvat ipsa dolis et
conscia sortis
utitur ingenio longeque extenta
per algas
attactu confisa subit. immobilis
haeret: 10
qui tetigere iacent. successu
laeta resurgit
et vivos impune ferox
depascitur artus.

Si quando vestita cibus
incautior aera
hauserit et curvis frenari
senserit hamis,
non fugit aut vano conatur
vellere morsu, 15
sed proprius nigrae iungit se
callida saetae
et meminit captiva sui longeque
per undas
pigra venenatis effundit flamina
venis.

per saetam vis alta meat
fluctibusque relinquit

Should it carelessly swallow a piece
of bait that hides a hook of bronze
and feel the pull of the jagged barbs,
it does not swim away nor seek to
free itself by vainly biting at the line;
but artfully approaches the dark line
and, though a prisoner, forgets not its
skill, emitting from its poisonous
veins an effluence which spreads far
and wide through the water. The
poison's bane leaves the sea and
creeps up the line; it will soon prove
too much for the distant fisherman.

[113] ~~luciusque fenum~~
MSS. armata which Birt prints,
~~absentem auctura virum~~
Scaliger's emendation animata is
metuendus ab imis 20

[278]

emicat horror aquis et pendula
fila secutus
transit harundineos arcano
frigore nodos
victricemque ligat concreto
sanguine dextram.
damnosum piscator onus
praedamque rebellem
iactat et amissa redit exarmatus
avena. 25

L. (LXXVII.)

In Iacobum magistrum equitum.

[279]

The dread paralysing force rises
above the water's level and climbing
up the drooping line, passes down
the jointed rod, and congeals, e'er he
is even aware of it, the blood of the
fisherman's victorious hand. He
casts away his dangerous burden and
lets go his rebel prey, returning home
disarmed without his rod.

L. (LXXVII.)

*Against James Commander of the
Cavalry.* [\[114\]](#)

By the ashes of S. Paul and the
shrine of revered S. Peter, do not pull
my verses to pieces, General James.
So may S. Thomas prove a buckler
to protect thy breast and S.
Bartholomew bear thee company to
the wars; so may the blessed saints
prevent the barbarians from crossing
the Alps and Suzanna [\[115\]](#) endow
thee with her strength; so, should
any savage foe seek to swim across
the Danube, let him be drowned
therein like the swift chariots of
Pharaoh; so may an avenging javelin
strike the Getic hordes and the
favour of Thecla [\[116\]](#) guide the
armies of Rome; so may thy guests
dying in their efforts to out-drink
thee assure thy board its triumph of
hospitality and the broached casks
o'ercome thy thirst; so may thy hand

Per cineres Pauli, per cani
 limina Petri,
 ne laceres versus, dux Iacobe,
 meos.
 sic tua pro clipeo defendat
 pectora Thomas
 et comes ad bellum
 Bartholomaeus eat;
 sic ope sanctorum non barbarus
 inruat Alpes, 5
 sic tibi det vires sancta
 Susanna suas;
 sic quicumque ferox gelidum
 transnaverit Histrum,
 mergatur volucres ceu
 Pharaonis equi;
 sic Geticas ultrix feriat
 romphaea catervas
 Romanasque regat prospera
 Thecla manus; 10
 sic tibi det magnum moriens
 conviva triumphum
 atque tuam vincant dolia fusa
 sitim;
 sic numquam hostili maculetur
 sanguine dextra:
 ne laceres versus, dux Iacobe,
 meos.

LI. (LXVIII.)

In sphaeram Archimedis.

Iuppiter in parvo cum cerneret
 aethera vitro,
 risit et ad superos talia dicta
 dedit:

ne'er be red with an enemy's blood
 —do not, I say, pull my verses to
 pieces.

LI. (LXVIII.)

Archimedes' Sphere.

When Jove looked down and saw the
 heavens figured in a sphere of glass
 he laughed and said to

[114] Nothing is known of this man.
Birt dates the poem 401.

[115] Suzanna was martyred under
Diocletian.

[116] There were several virgins,
saints, and martyrs of this name.
Claudian probably means the proto-
martyr of Iconium, the friend and
companion of S. Paul.

[280]

“hucine mortalis progressa
 potentia curae?
 iam meus in fragili luditur
 orbe labor?
iura poli rerumque fidem
 legesque deorum 5
 ecce Syracusius transtulit arte
 senex.
inclusus variis famulatur
 spiritus astris
 et vivum certis motibus urget
 opus.
percurrit proprium mentitus
 Signifer annum,
 et simulata novo Cynthia
 mense redit, 10
iamque suum volvens audax
 industria mundum
 gaudet et humana sidera
 mente regit.
quid falso insontem tonitru
 Salmonea miror?
 aemula naturae parva reperta
 manus.”

LII. (XXXVII.)

Gigantomachia.

[281]

the other gods: “Has the power of mortal effort gone so far? Is my handiwork now mimicked in a fragile globe? An old man of Syracuse has imitated on earth the laws of the heavens, the order of nature, and the ordinances of the gods. Some hidden influence within the sphere directs the various courses of the stars and actuates the lifelike mass with definite motions. A false zodiac runs through a year of its own, and a toy moon waxes and wanes month by month. Now bold invention rejoices to make its own heaven revolve and sets the stars in motion by human wit. Why should I take umbrage at harmless Salmoneus and his mock thunder? Here the feeble hand of man has proved Nature’s rival.”

LII. (XXXVII.)

The Battle of the Giants.

Once upon a time mother Earth, jealous of the heavenly kingdoms and in pity for the ceaseless woes of the Titans, filled all Tartarus with a monster brood, thus giving birth to that which proved a very bane. Her womb swollen with this monstrous birth she opened Phlegra’s side and brought forth foes against heaven. With a noise as of thunder they burst

Terra parens quondam
 caelestibus invida regnis
Titanumque simul crebros
 miserata dolores
omnia monstrifero complebat
 Tartara fetu
invisum genitura nefas
 Phlegramque retexit
tanta prole tumens et in aethera
 protulit hostes. 5
fit sonus: erumpunt crebri
 necdumque creati
iam dextras in bella parant
 superosque lacessunt
stridula volventes gemino
 vestigia lapsu.
pallescunt subito stellae
 flectitque rubentes
Phoebus equos docuitque timor
 revocare meatus. 10
Oceanum petit Arctos
 inocciduique Triones
occasum didicere pati. tum
 fervida natos
talibus hortatur genetrix in
 proelia dictis:
 “O pubes domitura deos,
 quodcumque videtis,

forth in profusion and, scarce born,
prepare their hands for war, as with
twofold trail^[117] they writhe their
hissing course. Suddenly the stars
grow pale, Phoebus turns his rosy
steeds and, impelled by fear, retraces
his steps. The Bear takes refuge in
the Ocean, and the unsetting Triones
learned to endure setting. Then their
angry mother stirred up her sons to
war with words such as these:
“Children, ye shall conquer

^[117] They were twiform; cf. l. 81.

heaven: all that ye see is the prize of victory; win, and the universe is yours. At last shall Saturn's son feel the weight of my wrath; shall recognize Earth's power. What! can any force conquer me? Has Cybele born sons superior to mine? Why has Earth no honour? Why is she ever condemned to bitter loss? Has any form of injury passed me by? There hangs luckless Prometheus in yon Scythian vale, feeding the vulture on his living breast; yonder, Atlas supports the weight of the starry heavens upon his head, and his grey hair is frozen stiff with cruel cold. What need to tell of Tityus whose liver is ever renewed beneath the savage vulture's beak, to contend with his heavy punishment? Up, army of avengers, the hour is come at last, free the Titans from their chains; defend your mother. Here are seas and mountains, limbs of my body, but care not for that. Use them as weapons. Never would I hesitate to be a weapon for the destruction of Jove. Go forth and conquer; throw heaven into confusion, tear down the towers of the sky. Let Typhoeus seize the thunderbolt and the sceptre; Enceladus, rule the sea, and another in place of the sun guide the reins of dawn's coursers. Porphyryon, wreath thou thy head with Delphi's

pugnando dabitur; praestat
victoria mundum. 15
sentiet ille meas tandem
Saturnius iras,
cognoscet, quid Terra potest, si
viribus ullis
vincor, si Cybele nobis meliora
creavit!
cur nullus Telluris honos? cur
semper acerbis
me damnis urgere solet? quae
forma nocendi 20
defuit? hinc volucrem vivo sub
pectore pascit
infelix Scythica fixus convalle
Prometheus;
hinc Atlantis apex flammantia
pondera fulcit
et per canitiem glacies
asperrima durat.
quid dicam Tityon, cuius sub
vulture saevo 25
viscera nascuntur gravibus
certantia poenis?
sed vos, o tandem veniens
exercitus ultor,
solvite Titanas vinclis, defendite
matrem.
sunt freta, sunt montes: nostris
ne parcite membris;
in Iovis exitium telum non esse
recuso. 30
ite, precor, miscete polum,
rescindite tures
sidereas. rapiat fulmen
sceptrumque Typhoeus;
Enceladi iussis mare serviat;
alter habenas

laurel and take Cirrha for thy
sanctuary.”

This exhortation filled their minds
with vain hopes. They think
themselves already victors o’er the
gods, imagine they have thrown
Neptune into chains and dragged
him a prisoner from Ocean’s bed.
One thinks to lay Mars low, one to
tear Phoebus’ locks from his head;
one assigns Venus to himself,
another anticipates in thought his
marriage with Diana, and another is
all aflame to do violence to chaste
Minerva.

Aurorae pro Sole^[284] regat: te
 Delphica laurus
 stringet, Porphyriion,
 Cirrhaeaeque templa
 tenebis.” 35
 His ubi consiliis animos
 elusit inanes,
 iam credunt vicisse deos
 mediisque revinctum
 Neptunum traxisse fretis; hic
 sternere Martem
 cogitat, hic Phoebi laceros
 divellere crines;
 hic sibi promittit Venerem
 speratque Dianae 40
 coniugium castamque cupit
 violare Minervam.

Meanwhile Iris, messenger of the gods, summons the immortal council. There come the deities of river and lake; the very ghosts were there in heaven’s defence. Hell’s shady portals could not hold Proserpine afar; the king of the silent himself advances in his Lethaeon chariot. His horses fear the light which hitherto their astonished eyes have never looked upon and, swerving this way and that, they breathe forth thick vapour from their soot-black nostrils. As, when an enemy’s siege-engine affrights a town, the citizens run together from all sides to defend their citadel, so gods of all shapes and forms came together to protect their father’s home. Them Jove thus addressed: “Deathless army, whose dwelling-place is, and must ever be, the sky, ye whom no adverse fortune can ever harm, mark ye how Earth with her new children conspires against our kingdom and undismayed has given birth to another brood? Wherefore, for all the sons she bore, let us give back to their mother as many dead; let her mourning last through the ages as she weeps by as many graves as she now has children.”

The clouds echo the blast of heaven’s trumpets; on this side

Interea superos praenuntia
convocat Iris.
qui fluvios, qui stagna colunt,
cinguntur et ipsi
auxilio Manes; nec te,
Proserpina, longe
umbrosae tenuere fores; rex
ipse silentum 45
Lethaeo vehitur curru lucemque
timentes
insolitam mirantur equi
trepidoque volatu
spissas caeruleis tenebras e
naribus efflant.
ac velut hostilis cum machina
terrui urbem,
undique concurrunt arcem
defendere cives: 50
haud secus omnigenis coeuntia
numina turmis
ad patris venere domos. tum
Iuppiter infit:
“O numquam peritura cohors,
o debita semper
caelo progenies, nullis obnoxia
fatis:
cernitis ut Tellus nostrum
coniuret in orbem 55
prole nova dederitque alios
interrita partus?
ergo, quot dederit natos, tot
funera matri
reddamus: longo maneat per
saecula luctu
tanto pro numero paribus
damnata sepulcris.”
Iam tuba nimborum sonuit,
iam signa ruendi 60

Heaven, on that Earth, sounds the
attack. Once more Nature is thrown
into confusion and fears for her lord.
The puissant company of the giants
confounds all differences between
things; islands abandon the deep;
mountains lie hidden in the sea.
Many a river is left dry or has altered
its ancient course. One giant
brandishes Thessalian Oeta in his
mighty hand, another gathers all his
strength and hurls Pangaeus at the
foe, Athos with his snows arms
another; this one roots up Ossa, that
tears out Rhodope and Hebrus’
source, dividing the

iam signa tuenda bo
 his Aether, his ^[286]Terra dedit
 confusaque rursus
 pro domino Natura timet.
 discrimina rerum
 miscet turba potens: nunc insula
 deserit aequor,
 nunc scopuli latuere mari. quot
 litora restant
 nuda! quot antiquas mutarunt
 flumina ripas! 65
 hic rotat Haemonium praeduris
 viribus Oeten;
 hic iuga conixus manibus
 Pangaea coruscat;
 hunc armat glacialis Athos; hoc
 Ossa movente
 tollitur; his Rhodopen Hebri
 cum fonte revellit

[287]

waters that before were one;
 Enipeus, gathered up with its
 beetling crags, scatters its waters
 over yon giant's shoulders: robbed of
 her mountains Earth sank into level
 plains, parted among her own sons.

On all sides a horrid din resounds
 and only the air divides the rival
 armies. First impetuous Mars urges
 against the horrid band his Thracian
 steeds that oft have driven in rout
 Getae or Geloni. Brighter than flame
 shines his golden shield, high towers
 the crest of his gleaming helmet.
 Dashing into the fray he first
 encounters Pelorus and transfixes
 him with his sword, where about the
 groin the two-bodied serpent unites
 with his own giant form, and thus
 with one blow puts an end to three
 lives. Exulting in his victory he
 drives his chariot over the dying
 giant's limbs till the wheels ran red
 with blood.

Mimas ran forward to avenge his
 brother. He had torn Lemnos and
 with it Vulcan's fiery house from out
 the foaming main, and was on the
 point of hurling it when Mars'
 javelin prevented him, scattering the
 brain from his shattered skull. What
 was giant in him died, but the
 serpent legs still lived, and, hissing
 vengeance, sought to attack the
 victor after Mimas' death.

et socias truncavit aquas summaque	Minerva rushed forward presenting
levatus 70	her breast whereon glittered the
rupe Giganteos umeros inrorat	Gorgon's head. The sight of this, she
Enipeus:	knew, was enough: she needed not to
subsedit patulis Tellus sine culmine	use a spear. One look sufficed. Pallas
campis	drew no nearer, rage as he might, for
in natos divisa suos.	he was the first to be changed into a
	Horrendus shock. When, at a distance from his
ubique	foe, without a wound, he found
it fragor et pugnae spatium	himself rooted to the ground, and felt
discriminat aër.	the murderous visage turn him, little
primus terrificum Mavors non segnibus	by little, to stone (and all but stone
in agmen 75	he was) he called out, "What is
Odrysius impellit equos, quibus ille	happening to me? What
Gelonos	
sive Getas turbare solet: splendentior	
igni	
aureus ardescit clipeus, galeamque	
nitentes	
adrexere iubae. tum concitus ense	
Pelorum	
transigit adverso, femorum qua fine	
volutus 80	
duplex semifero conectitur ilibus	
anguis,	
atque uno ternas animas interficit	
ictu.	
tum super insultans avidus languentia	
curru	
membra terit multumque rotae	
sparsere cruorem.	
Occurrit pro fratre Mimas	
Lemnumque calentem 85	
cum lare Vulcani spumantibus eruit	
undis	
et prope torsiisset, si non Mavortia	
cuspis	
ante revelato cerebrum fudisset ab	

“quae serpit per membra silex?
qui torpor inertem
marmorea me peste ligat?” vix
pauca locutus, 100
quod timuit, iam totus erat;
saevusque Damastor,
ad depellendos iaculum cum
quaereret hostes,
germani rigidum misit pro rupe
cadaver.
Hic vero interitum fratris
miratus Echion
inscius, auctorem dum vult
temptare nocendo, 105
te, Dea, respexit, solam quam
cernere nulli
bis licuit. meruit sublata
audacia poenas
et didicit cum morte deam. sed
turbidus ira
Palleneus, oculis aversa
tuentibus atrox,
ingreditur caecasque manus in
Pallada tendit. 110
hunc mucrone ferit dea
comminus; ac simul
angues
Gorgoneo riguere gelu
corpusque per unum
pars moritur ferro, partes
periere videndo.
Ecce autem medium spiris
delapsus in aequor
Porphyryon trepidam conatur
rumpere Delon, 115
scilicet ad superos ut torqueat
improbis axes.
horruit Aegeus: stagnantibus

The summit of Cynthus rang with
the cries of the gentle nymphs who
had taught Phoebus' unpractised
hand to shoot at the wandering
beasts with his bow, they who first
had prepared the bed for weeping
Latona when, in labour with the
lights of heaven, she blessed the
world with twin offspring. Delos in
terror called her lord Phoebus to help
her and begged him for aid. “In
remembrance of the

nonnulli Aegaeus, stagnantibus
 exilit antris
 longaevo cum patre Thetis
 desertaque precant
 regie Neptuni fons alicor.”
 veneranda profundis.
 exclamant placidae Cynthi de
 vertice Nymphae, 120
 Nymphae, quae rudibus
 Phoebum docuere
 sagittis
 errantes agitare feras
 primumque gementi
 Latonae struxere torum, cum
 lumina caeli
 parturiens geminis ornaret
 fetibus orbem.
 implorat Paeana suum
 conterrita Delos 125
 auxiliumque rogat: “si te
 gratissima fudit

[291]

time when Latona entrusted thine
 infant life to my care, help me who
 thus call upon thee. Behold, once
 more they seek to uproot me....”^[118]

^[118] Like the *De raptu Proserpinae*,
 the *Gigantomachia* was probably never
 completed. S. Jerome in his
 commentary on Isaiah (viii. 27) quotes
 from a *Gigantomachia*, not giving the
 name of its author. It is possible that
 the lines, which do not occur in
 Claudian’s poem as we possess it,
 belong to a final portion which has
 been lost. But it is more likely that they
 come from some other poet’s work and
 that the abrupt end of Claudian’s poem
 is due not to loss but to the poet’s
 sudden death.

DE RAPTU PROSERPINAE**LIBRI PRIMI PRAEFATIO**

(XXXII.)

Inventa secuit primus qui nave
 profundum
 et rudibus remis sollicitavit
 aquas,
 qui dubiis ausus committere
 flatibus alnum
 quas natura negat praebuit
 arte vias:
 tranquillis primum trepidus se
 credidit undis 5
 litora securo tramite summa
 legens;
 mox longos temptare sinus et
 linquere terras
 et leni coepit pandere vela
 Noto.
 ast ubi paulatim praeceps
 audacia crevit
 cordaque languentem
 dedidicere metum, 10
 iam vagus inrumpit pelagus
 caelumque secutus
 Aegaeas hiemes Ioniumque
 domat.

LIBER PRIMUS

(XXXIII.)

RAPE OF PROSERPINE**BOOK I PREFACE**

(XXXII.)

He who first made a ship and clave
 therewith the deep, troubling the
 waters with roughly hewn oars, who
 first dared trust his alder-bark to the
 uncertain winds and who by his skill
 devised a way forbidden of nature,
 fearfully at the first essayed smooth
 seas, hugging the shore in an
 unadventurous course. But soon he
 began to attempt the crossing of
 broad bays, to leave the land and
 spread his canvas to the gentle south
 wind; and, as little by little his
 growing courage led him on, and as
 his heart forgot numbing fear, sailing
 now at large, he burst upon the open
 sea and, with the signs of heaven to
 guide him, passed triumphant
 through the storms of the Aegean
 and the Ionian main.

BOOK I

(XXXIII.)

My full heart bids me boldly sing the
 horses of the ravisher from the
 underworld and the stars darkened
 by the shadow of his infernal chariot

Inferni raptoris equos
adflataque curru
sidera Taenario caligantesque
profundae
Iunonis thalamos audaci
promere cantu

and the gloomy chambers of the queen of Hell. Come not nigh, ye uninitiate. Now has divine madness driven all mortal thoughts from my breast, and my heart is filled with Phoebus' inspiration; now see I the shrine reel and its foundations totter while the threshold glows with radiant light telling that the god is at hand. And now I hear a loud din from the depths of the earth, the temple of Cecrops re-echoes and Eleusis waves its holy torches. The hissing snakes of Triptolemus raise their scaly necks chafed by the curving collar, and, uptowering as they glide smoothly along, stretch forth their rosy crests towards the chant. See from afar rises Hecate with her three various heads and with her comes forth Iacchus smooth of skin, his temples crowned with ivy. There clothes him the pelt of a Parthian tiger, its gilded claws knotted together, and the Lydian thyrsus guides his drunken footsteps.

Ye gods, whom the numberless host of the dead serves in ghostly Avernus, into whose greedy treasury is paid all that perishes upon earth, ye whose fields the pale streams of intertwining Styx surround, while Phlegethon, his rapids tossed in spray, flows through them with steaming eddies—do you unfold for

mens congesta iubet. gressus
removete profani.
iam furor humanos nostro de
pectore sensus 5
expulit et totum spirant
praecordia Phoebum;
iam mihi cernuntur trepidis
delubra moveri
sedibus et claram dispergere
limina lucem
adventum testata dei; iam
magnus ab imis
auditur fremitus terris
templumque remugit 10
Cecropium sanctasque faces
extollit Eleusis.
angues Triptolemi strident et
squamea curvis
colla levant attrita iugis
lapsuque sereno
erecti roseas tendunt ad carmina
cristas.
ecce procul ternis Hecate
variata figuris 15
exoritur, levisque simul procedit
Iacchus
crinali florens hedera, quem
Parthica velat
tigris et auratos in nodum
colligit ungues:
ebria Maeonius firmat vestigia
thyrsus.
Di, quibus innumerum vacui
famulatur Avernii 20
vulgus iners, opibus quorum
donatur avaris
quidquid in orbe perit, quos
Styx liventibus ambit

me the mysteries of your sacred
story and the secrets of your world.
Say with what torch the god of love
overcame Dis, and tell how
Proserpine was stolen away in her
maiden pride to win Chaos as a
dower; and how through many lands
Ceres, sore troubled, pursued her
anxious search; whence corn was
given to man whereby he laid aside
his acorn food, and the new-found
ear made useless Dodona's oaks.

Once on a time the lord of Erebus
blazed forth

Styx horrendus amor
 interfusa vadis et quos fumantia^[296]
 torquens
 aequora gurgitibus Phlegethon
 perlustrat anhelis—
 vos mihi sacrarum penetralia
 pandite rerum 25
 et vestri secreta poli: qua
 lampade Ditem
 flexit Amor; quo ducta ferox
 Proserpina raptu
 possedit dotale Chaos
 quantasque per oras
 sollicito genetrix erraverit anxia
 cursu;
 unde datae populis fruges et
 glande relictas 30
 cesserit inventis Dodonia
 quercus aristis.
 Dux Erebi quondam tumidas
 exarsit in iras

[297]

in swelling anger, threatening war
 upon the gods, because he alone was
 unwed and had long wasted the years
 in childless state, brooking no longer
 to lack the joys of wedlock and a
 husband's happiness nor ever to
 know the dear name of father. Now
 all the monsters that lurk in Hell's
 abyss rush together in warlike bands,
 and the Furies bind themselves with
 an oath against the Thunderer.
 Tisiphone, the bloody snakes
 clustering on her head, shakes the
 lurid pine-torch and summons to the
 ghostly camp the armed shades.
 Almost had the elements, once more
 at war with reluctant nature, broken
 their bond; the Titan brood, their
 deep prison-house thrown open and
 their fetters cast off, had again seen
 heaven's light; and once more
 bloody Aegaeon, bursting the
 knotted ropes that bound his huge
 form, had warred against the
 thunderbolts of Jove with hundred-
 handed blows.

But the dread Fates brought these
 threats to naught, and, fearing for the
 world, gravely laid their hoary locks
 before the feet and throne of the lord
 of Hell, and with suppliant tears
 touched his knees with their hands—
 those hands beneath whose rule are
 all things set, whose thumbs twist
 the thread of fate and spin the long

proelia moturus superis, quod
solus egeret
conubiis sterilesque diu
consumeret annos
impatiens nescire torum
nullasque mariti 35
inlecebras nec dulce patris
cognoscere nomen.
iam quaecumque latent ferali
monstra barathro
in turmas aciemque ruunt
contraque Tonantem
coniurant Furiae, crinitaque
sontibus hydris
Tesiphone quatiens infausto
lumine pinum 40
armatos ad castra vocat
pallentia Manes,
paene reluctatis iterum
pugnantia rebus
rupissent elementa fidem
penitusque revulso
carcere laxatis pubes Titania
vinclis
vidisset caeleste iubar rursusque
cruentus 45
Aegaeon positis aucto de
corpore nodis
obvia centeno vexasset fulmina
motu.
Sed Parcae vetuere minas
orbique timentes
ante pedes soliumque ducis
fudere severam
canitiem genibusque suas cum
supplice fletu 50
admovere manus, quarum sub
iura tenentur

ages with their iron spindles. First Lachesis, her hair unkempt and disordered, thus called out upon the cruel king: “Great lord of night, ruler over the shades, thou at whose command our threads are spun, who appointest the end and origin of all things and ordainest the alternation of birth and destruction; arbiter thou of life and death—for whatsoever thing comes anywhere into being it is by thy gift that it is created and owes its life to thee, and after a fixed

omnia, quae seriem fatorum
 pollice ducunt
 longaque ferratis evolvunt
 saecula fusis.
 prima fero Lachesis clamabat
 talia regi
 incultas dispersa comas:
 “O
 maxime noctis 55
 arbiter umbrarumque potens,
 cui nostra laborant
 stamina, qui finem cunctis et
 semina praebes
 nascendique vices alterna morte
 rependis,
 qui vitam letumque regis (nam
 quidquid ubique
 gignit materies, hoc te donante
 creatur 60
 debeturque tibi certisque
 ambagibus aevi

[299]

cycle of years them sendest souls
 once more into mortal bodies—seek
 not to break the stablished treaty of
 peace which our distaffs have spun
 and given thee, and overturn not in
 civil war the compact fixed 'twixt
 thee and thy two brothers. Why
 raisest thou unrighteous standards of
 war? Why freest the foul band of
 Titans to the open air? Ask of Jove;
 he will give thee a wife.”

Scarce had she spoken when Pluto
 stopped, shamed by her prayer, and
 his grim spirit grew mild though
 little wont to be curbed: even so
 great Boreas, armed with strident
 blasts and tempestuous with
 congealed snow, his wings all frozen
 with Getic hail as he seeks battle,
 threatens to overwhelm the sea, the
 woods, and the fields with sounding
 storm; but should Aeolus chance to
 bar against him the brazen doors idly
 his fury dies away and his storms
 retire baulked to their prison-house.

Then he bids summon Mercury, the
 son of Maia, that he may carry these
 flaming words to Jove. Straightway
 the wingèd god of Cyllene stands at
 his side shaking his sleepy wand, his
 herald cap upon his head. Pluto
 himself sits propped on his rugged
 throne, awful in funereal majesty;
 foul with age-long dust is his mighty
 sceptre; boding clouds make grim

rursus corporeos animae
mittuntur in artus):
ne pete firmatas pacis
dissolvere leges,
quas dedimus nevitque colus,
neu foedera fratrum
civili converte tuba. cur impia
tollis 65
signa? quid incestis aperis
Titanibus auras?
posce Iovem; dabitur coniunx.”
Vix

illa^[119]: pepercit
erubuitque preces, animusque
relanguit atrox
quamvis indocilis flecti: ceu
turbine rauco
cum gravis armatur Boreas
glacieque nivali 70
hispidus et Getica concretus
grandine pennas
disrumpit pelagus, silvas
camposque sonoro
flamine rapturus; si forte
adversus aënos
Aeolus obiecit postes, vanescit
inanis
impetus et fractae redeunt in
claustra procellae. 75
Tunc Maia genitum, qui
fervida dicta reportet,
imperat acciri. Cyllenius adstitit
ales
somniaferam quatiens virgam
tectusque galero.
ipse rudi fultus solio nigraque
verendus
maiestate cadenti aequale

his lofty head; unpitying is the
stiffness of his dread shape; rage
heightened the terror of his aspect.
Then with uplifted head he thunders
forth these words, while, as the
tyrant speaks, his halls tremble and
are still; the massy hound, guardian
of the gate, restrains the barking of
his triple head, and Cocytus sinks
back repressing his fount of tears;
Acheron is dumb with silent wave,
and the banks of Phlegethon cease
their murmuring.

in the state seget: sublimi
[119] ma ζ; Birt reads the with the
better MS inmania foedo 80

sceptra situ; sublime caput
 maestissima nubes
asperat et dirae riget
 inclementia formae;
terrorem dolor augebat. tunc
 talìa celso
ore tonat (tremefacta silent
 dicente tyranno
atria: latratum triplicem
 compescuit ingens 85
ianitor et presso lacrimarum
 fonte resedit
Cocytos tacitisque Acheron
 obmutuit undis
et Phlegethonteae requierunt
 murmura ripae):

“Grandchild of Atlas, Arcadian-born,
deity that sharest hell and heaven,
thou who alone hast the right to
cross either threshold, and art the
intermediary between the two
worlds, go swiftly, cleave the winds,
and bear these my behests to proud
Jove. ‘Hast thou, cruel brother, such
complete authority over me? Did
injurious fortune rob me at once of
power and light? Because day was
reft from me, lost I therefore strength
and weapons? Thinkest thou me
humble and cowed because I hurl not
bolts forged by the Cyclops and fool
not the empty air with thunder? Is it
not enough that deprived of the
pleasant light of day I submit to the
ill-fortune of the third and final
choice and these hideous realms,
whilst thee the starry heavens adorn
and the Wain surrounds with
twinkling brilliance—must thou also
forbid our marriage? Amphitrite,
daughter of Nereus, holds Neptune
in her sea-grey embrace; Juno, thy
sister and thy wife, takes thee to her
bosom when wearied thou layest
aside thy thunderbolts. What need to
tell of thy secret love for Lato or
Ceres or great Themis? How
manifold a hope of offspring was
thine! Now a crowd of happy
children surrounds thee. And shall I
in this empty palace, sans joy, sans
fame, know no child’s love to still

“Atlantis Tegeae nepos,
commune profundis
et superis numen, qui fas per
limen utrumque 90
solus habes geminoque facis
commercia mundo,
i celer et proscinde Notos et
iussa superbo
redde Iovi: ‘tantumne tibi,
saevissime frater,
in me iuris erit? sic nobis noxia
vires
cum caelo Fortuna tulit? num
robur et arma 95
perdidimus, si rapta dies? an
forte iacentes
ignavosque putas, quod non
Cyclopia tela
stringimus aut vanas tonitru
deludimus auras?
nonne satis visum, grati quod
luminis expers
tertia supremae patior dispendia
sortis 100
informesque plagas, cum te
laetissimus ornet
Signifer et vario cingant
splendore Triones;
sed thalamis etiam prohibes?
Nereia glauco
Neptunum gremio complectitur
Amphitrite;
te consanguineo recipit post
fulmina fessum 105
Iuno sinu. quid enim narrem
Latonia furta,
quid Cererem magnamque
Themis? tibi tanta

instant care? I will not brook so dull
a life. I swear by elemental night and
the unexplored shallows of the
Stygian lake, if thou refuse to
hearken to my word I will throw
open Hell and call forth her
monsters, will break Saturn’s old
chains, and shroud the sun in
darkness. The framework of the
world shall be loosened and the
shining heavens mingle with
Avernus’ shades.’”

THEM: ubi tanta
creandi^[302]

copia; te felix natorum turba
coronat.
ast ego deserta maerens
inglorius aula
implacidas nullo solabor
pignore curas? 110
non adeo toleranda quies.
primordia testor
noctis et horrendae stagna
intemerata paludis:
si dicto parere negas, patefacta
ciebo
Tartara, Saturni veteres laxabo
catenas,
obducam tenebris solem,
compage soluta 115
lucidus umbroso miscebitur
axis Averno.’”

[303]

Scarce had he spoken when his messenger trod the stars. The Father heard the message and, communing with himself, debated long who would dare such a marriage, who would wish to exchange the sun for the caves of Styx. He would fain decide and at length his fixed purpose grew.

Ceres, whose temple is at Henna, had but one youthful daughter, a child long prayed for; for the goddess of birth granted no second offspring, and her womb, exhausted by that first labour, became unfruitful. Yet prouder is the mother above all mothers, and Proserpine such as to take the place of many. Her mother's care and darling is she; not more lovingly does the fierce mother cow tend her calf that cannot as yet scamper over the fields and whose growing horns curve not yet moonwise over her forehead. As the years were fulfilled she had grown a maiden ripe for marriage, and thoughts of the torch of wedlock stir her girlish modesty, but while she longs for a husband she yet fears to plight troth. The voice of suitors is heard throughout the palace; two gods woo the maiden, Mars, more skilled with the shield, and Phoebus, the mightier bowman. Mars offers Rhodope, Phoebus would give

Vix ea fatus erat, iam nuntius
astra tenebat.
audierat mandata Pater
secumque volutat
diversos ducens animos, quae
tale sequatur
coniugium Stygiosque velit pro
sole recessus. 120
certa requirenti tandem
sententia sedit.
Hennaeae Cereri proles
optata virebat
unica, nec tribuit subolem
Lucina secundam
fessaque post primos haeserunt
viscera partus
infecunda quidem; sed cunctis
altior extat 125
matribus et numeri damnum
Proserpina pensat.
hanc fovet, hanc sequitur:
vitulam non blandius
ambit
torva parens, pedibus quae
nondum proterit arva
nec nova lunatae curvavit
germina frontis.
iam matura toro plenis
adoleverat annis 130
virginitas, tenerum iam pronuba
flamma pudorem
sollicitat mixtaque tremit
formidine votum.
personat aula procis: pariter pro
virgine certant
Mars clipeo melior, Phoebus
praestantior arcu;
Mars donat Rhodonen, Phoebus

Amyclae, and Delos and his temple
at Claros; in rivalry Juno and Latona
claim her for a son's wife. But
golden-haired Ceres disdains both,
and fearing lest her daughter should
be stolen away (how blind to the
future!) secretly entrusts her jewel to
the land of Sicily, confident in the
safe nature of this hiding-place.

Trinacria was once a part of Italy but
sea and tide changed the face of the
land. Victorious Nereus broke his
bounds and interflowed the cleft
mountains

victor et abscissos interluit
aequore montes, 145

with his waves whereby a narrow channel now separates these kindred lands. Nature now thrusts out into the sea the three-cornered island, cut off from the mainland to which it once belonged. At one extremity the promontory of Pachynum hurls back with jutting crags the furious waves of the Ionian main, round another roars the African sea that rises and beats upon the curving harbour of Lilybaeum, at the third the raging Tyrrhenian flood, impatient of restraint, shakes the obstacle of Cape Pelorus. In the midst of the island rise the charred cliffs of Aetna, eloquent monument of Jove's victory over the Giants, the tomb of Enceladus, whose bound and bruised body breathes forth endless sulphur clouds from its burning wounds. Whene'er his rebellious shoulders shift their burden to the right or left, the island is shaken from its foundations and the walls of tottering cities sway this way and that.

The peaks of Aetna thou must know by sight alone; to them no foot may approach. The rest is clothed with foliage but the summit no husbandman tills. Now it sends forth native smoke and with pitch-black cloud darkens and oppresses the day, now with awful stirrings it threatens

parvaeque cognatas prohibent
discrimina terras.
nunc illam socia ruptam tellure
trisulcam
opposuit Natura mari: caput
inde Pachyni
respuit Ionias praetentis rupibus
iras;
hinc latrat Gaetula Thetis
Lilybaeaeque pulsatur 150
brachia consurgens; hinc
indignata teneri
concutit objectum rabies
Tyrrhena Pelorum.
in medio scopulis se porrigit
Aetna perustis,
Aetna Giganteos numquam
tacitura triumphos,
Enceladi bustum, qui saucia
terga revinctus 155
spirat inexhaustum flagranti
vulnere sulphur
et, quotiens detractat onus
cervice rebeli
in laevum dextrumque latus,
tunc insula fundo
vellitur et dubiae nutant cum
moenibus urbes.
Aetnaeos apices solo
cognoscere visu, 160
non aditu temptare licet, pars
cetera frondet
arboribus; teritur nullo cultore
cacumen.
nunc movet indigenas nimbos
piceaeque gravatum
foedat nube diem, nunc motibus
astra lacessit

the stars and feeds its flame with the
dread fruit of its own body. But
though it boils and bursts forth with
such great heat yet it knows how to
observe a truce with the snow, and
together with glowing ashes the ice
grows hard, protected from the great
heat and secured by indwelling cold,
so that the harmless flame licks the
neighbouring frost with breath that
keeps its compact. What huge engine
hurls those rocks; what vast force
piles rock on

asua accessit
 [306]
 terrificis damnisque suis
 incendia nutrit. 165
 sed quamvis nimio fervens
 exuberet aestu,
 scit nivibus servare fidem
 pariterque favillis
 durescit glacies tanti segura
 vaporis,
 arcano defensa gelu, fumoque
 fideli
 lambit contiguas innoxia
 flamma pruinas. 170
 quae scopulos tormenta rotant?
 quae tanta cavernas

[307]

rock? Whence flows forth that fiery
 stream? Whether it be that the wind,
 forcing its way past hidden barriers,
 rages amid the fissured rocks that
 seek to bar its passage and, seeking a
 way of escape, sweeps the crumbling
 caverns with its wandering blasts in
 its bid for freedom, or that the sea,
 flowing in through the bowels of the
 sulphurous mountain, bursts into
 flame when its waters are
 compressed and casts up great rocks,
 I know not.

When the loving mother had
 entrusted her charge to the secret
 keeping of Henna she went freed
 from care to visit tower-crowned
 Cybele in her Phrygian home,
 driving a car drawn by twining
 serpents which cleave the pervious
 clouds on their wingèd course and
 fleck the bit with harmless poison.
 Their heads are crested and spots of
 green mottle their backs while
 sparkling gold glints amid their
 scales. Now they swim circling
 through the air, now they skim the
 fields with low-driven course. The
 passing wheels sow the plough-land
 with golden grain and their track
 grows yellow with corn. Sprouting
 stalks cover their traces and
 attendant crops clothe the path of the
 goddess.

vis glomerat? quo fonte ruit
Vulcanius amnis?
sive quod obicibus discurrens
ventus opertis
offenso rimosa furit per saxa
meatu,
dum scrutatur iter,
libertatemque reposcens

175

putria multivagis populatur
flatibus antra;
seu mare sulphurei ductum per
viscera montis
oppressis ignescit aquis et
pondera librat.

Hic ubi servandum mater
fidissima pignus
abdidit, ad Phrygios tendit
secura penates 180
turrigeramque petit Cybelen
sinuosa draconum
membra regens, volucris qui
pervia nubila tractu
signant et placidis umectant
frena venenis:
frontem crista tegit; pingunt
maculosa virentes
terga notae; rutilum squamis
intermicat aurum. 185
nunc spiris Zephyros tranant;
nunc arva volatu
inferiore secant, cano rota
pulvere labens
sulcatam fecundat humum:
flavescit aristas
orbita; surgentes condunt
vestigia fruges;
vestit iter comitata sedes

Now is left behind Aetna, and all
Sicily sinks lessening into the
distance. Ah, how often,
foreknowing of coming ill, did she
mar her cheek with welling tears;
how often look back upon her home
with words like these: "Be happy,
dear land, dearer than heaven to me,
into thy safe keeping I commend my
daughter, my sole joy, loved fruit of
my labour. No despicable reward
shall be thine, for thou shalt suffer
no hoe nor shall the cruel iron of the
ploughshare know thy soil. Untilled
thy fields shall bear fruit, and though
thine oxen plough not, a richer

vesit nec commata seges.

[308]

Iam

linquitur Aetna 190
totaque decrescit refugo
Trinacria visu.
heu quotiens praesaga mali
violavit oborto
rore genas! quotiens oculos ad
tectata retorsit
taliam voce movens: "salve,
gratissima tellus,
quam nos praetulimus caelo,
tibi gaudia nostri 195
sanguinis et caros uteri
commendo labores.
praemia digna manent: nullos
patiere ligones
et nullo rigidi versabere
vomere ictu.
sponte tuus florebit ager;
cessante iuvenco

[309]

husbandman shall view with wonder
the self-sown harvest." So spake she
and reached Mount Ida, drawn by
her yellow serpents.

Here is the queenly seat of the
goddess and in her holy temple the
sacred statue, o'ershadowed by the
thick leaves of the pine wood which,
though no storm wind shakes the
grove, gives forth creakings with its
cone-bearing branches. Within are
the dread bands of the initiate with
whose wild chantings the shrine
rings; Ida is loud with howlings and
Gargarus bends his woods in fear. As
soon as Ceres appears the drums
restrain their rattle; the choirs are
silent and the Corybantes stay the
flourish of their knives. Pipes and
cymbals are still, and the lions sink
their manes in greeting. Cybele^[121]
rejoicing runs forth from the shrine
and bends her towered head to kiss
her guest.

Long had Jove seen this, watching
from his lofty seat, and to Venus he
thus enfolded the secrets of his heart:
"Goddess of Cythera, I will impart to
thee my hidden troubles; long ago I
decided that fair Proserpine should
be given in marriage to the lord of
Hell; such is Atropos' bidding, such
old Themis' prophecy. Now that her
mother has left her is the time for
action. Do thou visit the confines of

ditior oblatas mirabitur incola
 messes.” 200
 sic ait et fulvis tetigit
 serpentibus Idam.
 Hic sedes augusta deae
 templique colendi
 relligiosa silex, densis quam
 pinus obumbrat
 frondibus et nulla lucos agitante
 procella
 stridula coniferis modulatur
 carmina ramis. 205
 terribiles intus thiasi vesanaque
 mixto
 concentu delubra gemunt;
 ululatibus Ide
 bacchatur; timidas inclinant
 Gargara silvas.
 postquam visa Ceres, mugitum
 tympana frenant;
 conticuere chori; Corybas non
 impulit ensem; 210
 non buxus, non aera sonant
 blandasque leones
 summisere iubas. adytis gavisa
 Cybebe
 exilit et pronas intendit ad
 oscula turre.
 Viderat haec dudum summa
 speculatus ab arce
 Iuppiter ac Veneri mentis
 penetralia pandit: 215
 “curarum, Cytherea, tibi secreta
 fatebor.
 candida Tartareo nuptum
 Proserpina regi
 iam pridem decreta dari: sic
 Ἀτροπος ὀρᾷ·

Sicily, and armed with thy wiles,
 lead Ceres' daughter to sport in the
 level meads what time to-morrow's
 light has unfolded the rosy dawn;
 employ those arts with which thou
 art wont to inflame all things, often
 even myself. Why should the nether
 kingdoms know not love? Let no
 land be free and no breast even amid
 the shades unfired by Venus. At last
 let the gloomy Fury

[\[121\]](#) Cybele and Cybebe are
 alternative forms in Latin. The normal
 English form is Cybele.

sic cecinit longaeva Themis.
 nunc matre remota
 rem peragi tempus. fines invade
 Sicinos 220
 et Cereris prolem patulis
 inludere campis,
 crastina puniceos cum lux
 detexerit ortus,
 coge tuis armata dolis, quibus
 urere cuncta,
 me quoque, saepe soles, cur
 ultima regna quiescunt?
 nulla sit immunis regio
 nullumque sub umbris
 225
 pectus inaccensum Veneri. iam
 tristis Erinys

[311]

feel the sting of passion and Acheron
 and the steely heart of stern Dis
 grow tender with love's arrows."

Venus hastes to do his bidding; and
 at their sire's behest there join her
 Pallas and Diana whose bent bow
 affrights all Maenalus' slopes. Neath
 her divine feet the path shone bright,
 even as a comet, fraught with augury
 of ill, falls headlong, a glowing
 portent of blood-red fire; no sailor
 may look on it and live, no people
 view it but to their destruction; the
 message of its threatening tail is
 storm to ships and an enemy's attack
 to cities. They reached the place
 where shone Ceres' palace, firm-
 built by the Cyclops' hands; up
 tower the iron walls, iron stand the
 gates, and steel bars secure the
 massy doors. Neither Pyragmon nor
 Steropes e'er builded a work with
 toil so great as that, nor ever did
 bellows breathe forth such blasts nor
 the molten mass of metal flow in a
 stream so deep that the very furnaces
 were weary of heating it. The hall
 was walled with ivory; the roof
 strengthened with beams of bronze
 and supported by lofty columns of
 electron.

Proserpine herself, soothing the
 house with sweet song, was sewing
 all in vain a gift against her mother's
 return. In this cloth she embroidered

sentiat ardores; Acheron
Ditisque severi
ferrea lascivis mollescant corda
sagittis.”

Accelerat praecepta Venus;
iussuque parentis
Pallas et inflexo quae terret
Maenala cornu 230
addunt se comites. divino
semita gressu
claruit, augurium qualis laturus
iniquum
praepes sanguineo dilabitur
igne cometes
prodigiale rubens: non illum
navita tuto,
non impune vident populi, sed
crine minaci 235
nuntiat aut ratibus ventos aut
urbibus hostes.
devenere locum, Cereris quo
tectata nitebant
Cyclopum firmata manu: stant
ardua ferro
moenia, ferrati postes,
inmensaque nequit
claustra chalybs. nullum tanto
sudore Pyragmon 240
nec Steropes construxit opus:
non talibus umquam
spiravere Notis animae nec
flumine tanto
incoctum maduit lassa cervice
metallum.
atria cingit ebur; trabibus
solidatur aënis
culmen et in celsas surgunt
electra columnas 245

with her needle the concourse of
atoms and the dwelling of the Father
of the gods and pictured how mother
Nature ordered elemental chaos, and
how the first principles of things
sprang apart, each to his proper place
—those that were light being born
aloft, the heavier ones falling to a
centre. The air grew bright and fire
chose the pole as its seat. Here
flowed the sea; there hung the earth
suspended. Many were the colours
she employed, tricking the stars with
gold and flooding the sea

Ipsa domum^[312] tenero mulcens
 Proserpina cantu
 inrita texebat rediturae munera
 matri.
 hic elementorum seriem
 sedesque paternas
 insignibat acu, veterem qua lege
 tumultum
 discrevit Natura parens et
 semina iustis 250
 discessere locis: quidquid leve,
 fertur in altum;
 in medium graviora cadunt;
 incanduit aër;
 legit flamma polum; fluxit
 mare; terra pependit.
 nec color unus erat: stellas
 accendit in auro,

with purple. The shore she embossed with precious stones and cunningly employed raised threadwork to imitate the swelling billows. You might have thought you saw the seaweed dashed against the rocks and heard the murmur of the hissing waves flooding up the thirsty sands. Five zones she added; indicating that the centre was the torrid zone by embroidering it with red yarn: its desert confines are parched and the thread she used was dried by the sun's unfailing heat. On either side lay the two habitable zones, blessed with a mild climate fit for the life of man. At the top and bottom she set the two frozen zones, portraying eternal winter's horror in her weaving and the gloom of never-ceasing cold. Further she embroidered the accursed seat of her uncle, Dis, and the nether gods, her destined fellows. Nor did the omen pass unmarked, for prophetic of the future her cheeks grew wet with sudden tears.

Next she began to trace Ocean's glassy shallows at the tapestry's farthest edge, but at that moment the doors opened, she saw the goddesses enter, and left her work unfinished. A glowing blush that mantled to her clear cheeks suffused her fair countenance and lit the torches of

ostro fundit aquas, attollit litora
 gemmis 255
filaque mentitos iamiam
 caelantia fluctus
arte tument: credas inlidi
 cautibus algam
et raucum bibulis inserpere
 murmur harenis.
addit quinque plagas: mediam
 subtegmine rubro
obsessam fervore notat;
 squalebat inustus 260
limes et adsiduo sitiebant
 stamina sole.
vitales utrimque duas, quas
 mitis oberrat
temperies habitanda viris; in
 fine supremo
torpentes traxit geminas
 brumaque perenni
foedat et aeterno contristat
 frigore telas. 265
nec non et patrui pingit sacraria
 Ditis
fatalesque sibi Manes; nec
 defuit omen,
praescia nam subitis maduerunt
 fletibus ora.
 Cooperat et vitreis summo
 iam margine texti
Oceanum sinuare vadis; sed
 cardine verso 270
cernit adesse deas
 imperfectumque
 laborem
deserit et niveos infecit purpura
 vultus
per liquidas succensa genas

stainless purity. Not so beautiful
even the glow of ivory which a
Lydian maid has stained with
Sidon's scarlet dye.

Now the sun was dipped in Ocean
and misty night scattering sleep had
brought for mortals ease and leisure
in her black two-horsed chariot;
when Pluto, warned by his brother,
made his way to the upper air. The
dread fury Allecto yokes to the
chariot-pole the two fierce pairs of
steeds that grace Cocytus' banks and
roam the dark meads of Erebus, and,

per iniquas succensa genas

castaeque pudoris

indignae facies, non si decus

ardetida Leues

logia Sidorius spumantia oblivio

linguis; ostro. 275

Orpheus unde diem sparsa

Aethumida sagina

languida Scyllis linxerat

Nyx teigs 285

iamque Dans Pluto subegras

Alastor, ad auras

germaniam foret omni invisa

iugales

Allecto temone ligat, quinque

mandant, aedae.

Cocytus praeque Erebi

LIBRI SECUNDI PRAEFATIO

(XXXIV.)

[315]

drinking the rotting pools of sluggish
Lethe, let dark oblivion drip from
their slumbrous lips—Orphnaeus,
savage and fleet, Aethon, swifter
than an arrow, great Nyctaeus, proud
glory of Hell's steeds, and Alastor,
branded with the mark of Dis. These
stood harnessed before the door and
savagely champed the bit all eager
for the morrow's enjoyment of their
destined booty.

BOOK II PREFACE

(XXXIV.)

When Orpheus sought repose and,
lulling his song to sleep, had long
laid aside his neglected task, the
Nymphs complained that their joy
had been reft from them and the sad
rivers mourned the loss of his tuneful
lays. Nature's savagery returned and
the heifer in terror of the lion looked
in vain for help from the now
voiceless lyre. The rugged mountains
lamented his silence and the woods
that had so often followed his
Thracian lute.

But after that Hercules, setting forth
from Inachian Argos, reached the
plains of Thrace on his mission of
salvation, and destroying the stables
of Diomedes, fed the horses of the
bloody tyrant on grass, then it was

Otia sopitis ageret cum cantibus
Orpheus
neglectumque diu
deposuisset opus,
lugebant erepta sibi solacia
Nymphae,
quaerebant dulces flumina
maesta modos.
saeva feris natura redit
metuensque leonem 5
implorat citharae vacca
tacentis opem.
illius et duri flevire silentia
montes
silvaeque Bistoniam saepe
secuta chelyn.
Sed postquam Inachiis
Alcides missus ab Argis
Thracia pacifero contigit arva
pede 10
diraque sanguinei vertit
praesaepia regis
et Diomedeos gramine pavit
equos,
tunc patriae festo laetatus
tempore vates
desuetae repetit fila canora
lyrae

that the poet, o'erjoyed at his
country's happy fate, took up once
more the tuneful strings of his lute
long laid aside, and touching its

idle chords with the smooth quill,
 plied the famed ivory with festal
 fingers. Scarce had they heard him
 when the winds and waves were
 stilled; Hebrus flowed more
 sluggishly with reluctant stream,
 Rhodope stretched out her rocks all
 eager for the song, and Ossa, his
 summit less exalted, shook off his
 coat of snow. The tall poplar and the
 pine, accompanied by the oak, left
 the slopes of treeless Haemus, and
 even the laurel came, allured by the
 voice of Orpheus, though erstwhile it
 had despised Apollo's art. Molossian
 dogs fawned playfully on fearless
 hares, and the lamb made room for
 the wolf by her side. Does sported in
 amity with the striped tiger and hinds
 had no fear of the lion's mane.

He sang the stings of a step-dame's
 ire^[122] and the deeds of Hercules,
 the monsters overcome by his strong
 right arm; how while yet a child he
 had shown the strangled snakes to
 his terrified mother, and had
 laughed, fearlessly scorning such
 dangers. "Thee nor the bull that
 shook with his bellowing the cities
 of Crete alarmed, nor the savagery of
 the hound of Hell; thee not the lion,
 soon to become a constellation in the
 heavens, nor the wild boar that
 brought renown to Erymanthus'
 height. Thou hast stripped the

et resides levi modulatus
pectine nervos 15
pollice festivo nobile duxit
ebur.
vix auditus erat: venti frenantur
et undae,
pigrior adstrictis torpuit
Hebrus aquis,
porrexit Rhodope sitientes
carmina rupes,
excussit gelidas pronior Ossa
nives; 20
ardua nudato descendit populus
Haemo
et comitem quercum pinus
amica trahit,
Cirrhæasque dei quamvis
despexerit artes,
Orpheis laurus vocibus acta
venit.
securum blandi leporem fovere
Molossi 25
vicinumque lupo praebuit
agna latus.
concordes varia ludunt cum
tigride dammae;
Massylam cervi non timuere
iubam.
Ille novercales stimulos
actusque canebat
Herculis et forti monstra
subacta manu, 30
quod timidæ matri pressos
ostenderit angues
intrepidusque fero riserit ore
puer:
“te neque Dictæas quatiens
mugitibus urbæ

Amazons of their girdles, shot with
thy bow the birds of Stymphalus,
and driven home the cattle of the
western clime. Thou hast o’erthrown
the many limbs of the triple-headed
monster and returned thrice
victorious from a single foe. Vain the
falls of Antæus, vain the sprouting
of the Hydra’s new heads. Its winged
feet availed not to save Diana’s deer
from thy hand. Cacus’ flames were
quenched and Nile ran rich with
Busiris’ blood. Pholoë’s slopes
reeked with the slaughter of the

[122] Juno is called the stepmother of
Hercules.

magnus taurus nec Stygii terruit ira
 te Libycas casu puere sinus, te
 non leonem sicca Tethys editurus
 horruit, axosq; non Erymanthe gloria
 non firmior Heraclea mundus
 solvis Amazonis pendit,
 lustrat Symphelidas Proetus et
 adpetit accidit ducis ab
 Thracibus greges. sed tu
 tergeminis Nereus humerosos
 Florentinus, tu mea
 et tota praenove ab hoste
 antraque Musarum longo
 non cadere Antaeo non
 excutere proci proci hydrae;
 nec corve phryges eripere
 pedes.
 Caci flamma arsit, ubi
 Busiride Nilus;
 prostratis maduit nubigenis
 Phloe.

LIBER SECUNDUS

(XXXV.)

[319]

cloud-born Centaurs. Thee the
 curving shore of Libya held in awe;
 thee the mighty Ocean gazed at in
 amaze when thou laidst the world's
 bulk on thy back; on the neck of
 Hercules the heaven was poised
 more surely; the sun and stars
 coursed over thy shoulders."

So sang the Thracian bard. But thou,
 Florentinus, art a second
 Hercules to me. 'Tis thou causest my
 quill to stir, 'tis thou disturbest the
 Muses' cavern long plunged in sleep
 and ledest their gentle bands in the
 dance.

BOOK II

(XXXV.)

Not yet had bright day with herald
 beams struck the waves of the Ionian
 main; the light of dawn shimmered
 on the waters and the straying
 brilliance flickered over the deep
 blue sea. And now bold Proserpine,
 forgetful of her mother's jealous care
 and tempted by the wiles of Venus,
 seeks the stream-fed vale. Such was
 the Fates' decree. Thrice did the
 doors sound a warning note as the
 hinges turned; thrice did prophetic
 Aetna rumble mournfully with awful
 thunders. But her can no portent, no

Impulit Ionios praemisso
lumine fluctus
nondum pura dies; tremulis
vibratur in undis
ardor et errantes ludunt per
caerula flammae.
iamque audax animi fidaeque
oblita parentis
fraude Dionaëa riuos
Proserpina saltus 5
(sic Parcae iussere) petit. ter
cardine verso
praesagum cecinere fores; ter
conscia fati
flebile terrificis gemit
mugitibus Aetna,
nullis illa tamen monstris
nulloque tenetur
prodigio. comites gressum
iunxere sorores. 10
Prima dolo gaudens et tanto
concita voto
it Venus et raptus metitur corde
futuros,
iam dirum flexura chaos, iam
Dite subacto
ingenti famulos Manes ductura
triumpho.

omen detain. The sister goddesses
bore her company.

First goes Venus exulting in her
trickery and inspired by her great
mission. In her heart she takes
account of the coming rape; soon she
will rule dread Chaos, soon, Dis
once subdued, she will lead the
subject ghosts. Her hair, parted into
many

[123] See Introduction, p. xiv.

locks, is braided round her head and secured by a Cyprian pin, and a brooch cunningly fabricated by her spouse Vulcan supports her cloak thick studded with purple jewels.

Behind her hasten Diana, fair queen of Arcadian Lycaeus, and Pallas who, with her spear, protects the citadel of Athens—virgins both; Pallas, cruel goddess of war, Diana bane of wild creatures. On her burnished helmet the Triton-born goddess wore a carved figure of Typhon, the upper part of his body lifeless, the lower limbs yet writhing, part dead, part quick. Her terrible spear, piercing the clouds as she brandished it, resembled a tree; only the Gorgon's hissing neck she hid in the spread of her glittering cloak. But mild was Diana's gaze and very like her brother looked she; Phoebus' own one had thought her cheeks and eyes, her sex alone disclosed the difference. Her shining arms were bare, her straying locks fluttered in the gentle breeze, and the chord of her unstrung bow hung idle, her arrows slung behind her back. Her Cretan tunic, gathered with girdles twain, flows down to her knees, and on her waving dress Delos wanders and stretches surrounded by a golden sea.

illi multifidos crinis sinuatur in
orbes 15
Idalia divisus acu; sudata marito
fibula purpureos gemma
suspendit amictus.
Candida Parrhasii post hanc
regina Lycae
et Pandionias quae cuspidem
protegit arces,
utraque virgo, ruunt: haec
tristibus aspera bellis, 20
haec metuenda feris. Tritonia
casside fulva
caelatum Typhona gerit, qui
summa peremptus
ima parte viget, moriens et parte
superstes;
hastaque terribili surgens per
nubila ferro
instar habet silvae; tantum
stridentia colla 25
Gorgonis obtentu pallae
fulgentis inumbrat.
at Triviae lenis species et
multus in ore
frater erat, Phoebique genas et
lumina Phoebi
esse putes, solusque dabat
discrimina sexus.
brachia nuda nitent; levibus
proiecerat auris 30
indociles errare comas, arcuque
remisso
otia nervus agit; pendent post
terga sagittae.
crispatur gemino vestis
Gortynia cinctu
non lite fusa tenus, motoque in

Between the two Ceres' child, now
her mother's pride, so soon to be her
sorrow, treads the grass with equal
pace, their equal, too, in stature and
beauty; Pallas you might have
thought her, had she carried a shield,
Diana, if a javelin. A brooch of
polished jasper secured her girded
dress. Never did art give happier
issue to the shuttle's skill; never was
cloth so beautifully made nor
embroidery so lifelike. In it she had
worked the birth of the sun from the
seed of Hyperion, the birth, too, of
the moon,

popule rursus, moloque in
 stamine Delos^[333]
 errat et aurato trahitur
 circumflua ponto. 35
 Quas inter Cereris proles,
 nunc gloria matris,
 mox dolor, aequali tendit per
 gramina passu
 nec membris nec honore minor
 potuitque videri
 Pallas, si clipeum ferret, si
 spicula, Phoebe.
 collectae tereti nodantur iaspide
 vestes. 40
 pectinis ingenio numquam
 felicior artis
 contigit eventus; nulli sic
 consona telae
 fila nec in tantum veri duxere
 figuras.
 hic Hyperionio Solem de
 semine nasci

[323]

though diverse was her shape—of
 sun and moon that bring the dawning
 and the night. Tethys affords them a
 cradle and soothes in her bosom their
 infant sobs; the rosy light of her
 foster-children irradiates her dark
 blue plains. On her right shoulder
 she carried the infant Titan, too
 young as yet to vex with his light,
 and his encircling beams not grown;
 he is pictured as more gentle in those
 tender years, and from his mouth
 issues a soft flame that accompanies
 his infant cries. The moon, his sister,
 carried on Tethys' left shoulder,
 sucks the milk of that bright breast,
 her forehead marked with a little
 horn.

Such is the wonder of Proserpine's
 dress. The Naiads bear her company
 and on either side crowd around her,
 those who haunt thy streams,
 Criniseus, and Pantagia's rocky
 torrent and Gela's who gives his
 name to the city; those whom
 Camerina, the unmoved, nurtures in
 her shallow marshes, whose home is
 Arethusa's flood or the stream of
 Alpheus, her foreign lover; tallest of
 their company is Cyane. So move
 they as the beauteous band of
 Amazons, brandishing their moon-
 shaped shields what time the maiden
 warrior Hippolyte, after laying waste
 the regions of the north, leads home

fecerat et pariter, forma sed
dispare, Lunam, 45
aurorae noctisque duces;
cunabula Tethys
praebet et infantes gremio
solatur anhelos
caeruleusque sinus roseis
radiatur alumnis.
invalidum dextro portat Titana
lacerto
nondum luce gravem nec
pubescentibus alte 50
cristatum radiis: primo
clementior aevo
fingitur et tenerum vagitu
despuat ignem.
laeva parte soror vitrei libamina
potat
uberis et parvo signatur tempora
cornu.
Tali luxuriat cultu.
comitantur euntem 55
Naides et socia stipant utrimque
caterva,
quae fontes, Crinise, tuos et
saxa rotantem
Pantagiam nomenque Gelam
qui praebuit urbi
concelebrant, quas pigra vado
Camerina palustri,
quas Arethusaei latices, quas
advena nutrit 60
Alpheus; Cyane totum
supereminet agmen:
qualis Amazonidum peltis
exultat aduncis
pulchra cohors, quotiens Arcton
populata virago

her fair army after battle, whether
they have o'erthrown the yellow-
haired Getae or cloven frozen Tanais
with the axe of their native
Thermodon; or as the Lydian
Nymphs celebrate the festivals of
Bacchus—the Nymphs whose sire
was Hermus along whose banks they
course, splashed with his golden
waters: the river-god rejoices in his
cavern home and pours forth the
flooding urn with generous hand.

Henna, mother of blossoms, had
espied the goddess' company from
her grassy summit and thus
addressed

populata viago
Hippolyte niveas^[324] ducit post
 proelia turmas,
seu flavos stravere Getas seu
 forte rigentem 65
Thermodontiaca Tanaim fregere
 securi;
aut quales referunt Baccho
 sollemnia Nymphae
Maeoniae, quas Hermus alit,
 ripasque paternas
percurrunt auro madidae:
 laetatur in antro
amnis et undantem declinat
 prodigus urnam. 70
Viderat herboso sacrum de
 vertice vulgus
Henna parens florum curvaque
 in valle sedentem

[325]

Zephyrus, lurking in the winding vale: "Gracious father of the spring, thou who ever rulest over my meads with errant breeze and bringest rain upon the summer lands with thine unceasing breath, behold this company of Nymphs and Jove's tall daughters who deign to sport them in my meadows. Be present to bless, I pray. Grant that now all the trees be thick with newly-grown fruit, that fertile Hybla may be jealous and admit her paradise surpassed. All the sweet airs of Panchaea's incense-bearing woods, all the honied odours of Hydaspes' distant stream, all the spices which from furthest fields the long-lived Phoenix gathers, seeking new birth from wished for death—spread thou all these through my veins and with generous breath refresh my country. May I be worthy to be plundered by divine fingers and goddesses seek to be decked with my garlands."

So spake she, and Zephyrus shook his wings adrip with fresh nectar and drenches the ground with their life-giving dew. Wheresoe'er he flies spring's brilliance follows. The fields grow lush with verdure and heaven's dome shines cloudless above them. He paints the bright roses red, the hyacinths blue and the sweet violets purple. What girdles of Babylon,

compellat Zephyrum: "pater o
 gratissime veris,
qui mea lascivo regnas per prata
 meatu
semper et adsiduis inroras
 flatibus annum, 75
respice Nympharum coetus et
 celsa Tonantis
germina per nostros dignantia
 ludere campos.
nunc adsis faveasque, precor;
 nunc omnia fetu
pubescant virgulta velis, ut
 fertilis Hybla
invideat vincique suos non
 abnuat hortos. 80
quidquid turiferis spirat
 Panchaia silvis,
quidquid odoratus longe
 blanditur Hydaspes,
quidquid ab extremis ales
 longaeva colonis
colligit optato repetens exordia
 letu, [\[124\]](#)
in venas disperge meas et
 flamine largo 85
rura fove. merear divino pollice
 carpi
et nostris cupiant ornari numina
 sertis."

Dixerat; ille novo madidantes
 nectare pennas
concutit et glaebas fecundo rore
 maritat,
quaque volat vernus sequitur
 rubor; omnis in herbas
turgit humus medioque patent

meet cincture of a royal breast, are
adorned with such varied jewels?
What fleece so dyed in the rich juice
of the murex where stand the brazen
towers of Tyre? Not the wings of
Juno's own bird display such
colouring. Not thus do the many-
changing hues of the rainbow span
young winter's sky when in curved
arch its rainy path glows green amid
the parting clouds.

Even more lovely than the flowers is
the country. The plain, with gentle
swell and gradual slopes, rose into a
hill; issuing from the living rock
gushing

[124] ^{letō} ^{Hemstus,} ^{Birt} ⁹¹ saeclo
sanguineo splendore rosas,
vaccinia nigro
imbuit et dulci violas ferrugine
pingit.
Parthica quae tantis variantur
cingula gemmis
regales vinctura sinus? quae
vellera tantum 95
ditibus Assyrii spumis fucantur
aëni?
non tales volucer pandit
Iunonius alas,
nec sic innumeros arcu mutante
colores
incipiens redimitur hiems, cum
tramite flexo
semita discretis interviret umida
nimbis. 100
Forma loci superat flores:
curvata tumore
parvo planities et mollibus edita
clivis
creverat in collem; vivo de
pumice fontes

streams bedewed their grassy banks. With the shade of its branches a wood tempers the sun's fierce heat and at summer's height makes for itself the cold of winter. There grows the pine, useful for seafaring, the cornel-tree for weapons of war, the oak, friendly to Jove, the cypress, sentinel of graves, the holm filled with honeycombs, and the laurel foreknowing of the future; here the box-tree waves its thick crown of leaves, here creeps the ivy, here the vine clothes the elm. Not far from here lies a lake called by the Sicani Pergus, girt with a cincture of leafy woods close around its pallid waters. Deep down therein the eye of whoso would can see, and the everywhere transparent water invites an untrammelled gaze into its oozy depths and betrays the uttermost secrets of its pellucid gulfs. [Hither came their company well pleased with the flowery climb.]

Venus bids them gather flowers. "Come, sisters, while yet the morning sun shines through the moist air, and while Lucifer, my harbinger of dawn, yet drives his dewy steeds and waters the flower-bright field." So spake she and gathered the flower that testifies to her own woe.^[126] Her companions ranged the various vales. You could

roscida mobilibus lambebant
 gramina rivis,
 silvaque torrentes ramorum
 frigore soles 105
 temperat et medio brumam sibi
 vindicat aestu:
 apta fretis abies, bellis
 accommoda cornus,
 quercus amica Iovi, tumulos
 tectura cupressus,
 ilex plena favis, venturi
 praescia laurus;
 fluctuat hic denso crispata
 cacumine buxus, 110
 hic hederæ serpunt, hic
 pampinus induit ulmos.
 haud procul inde lacus (Pergum
 dixere Sicani)
 panditur et nemorum frondoso
 margine cinctus
 vicinis pallescit aquis: admittit
 in altum
 cernentes oculos et late pervius
 umor 115
 ducit inoffensos liquido sub
 flumine visus
 imaque perspicui prodit secreta
 profundi.
 [huc elapsa cohors gaudet per
 florida rura.]^[125]
 Hortatur Cytherea legant.
 “nunc ite, sorores,
 dum matutinis praesudat solibus
 aër, 120
 dum meus umectat flaventes
 Lucifer agros
 roranti praevectus equo.” sic
 fata delosio

have believed a swarm of bees was
 on the wing, eager to gather its
 sweetness from Hyblæan thyme,
 where the king bees lead out their
 wax-housed armies and the honey-
 bearing host, issuing from the beech-
 tree's hollow bole, buzzes around its
 favourite flowers. The meadows are
 despoiled of their glory; this goddess
 weaves lilies with dark violets,
 another decks herself with pliant
 marjoram, a third steps forth rose-
 crowned, another wreathed with
 white privet. Thee also, Hyacinthus,

^[126] Traditionally said to be the
 anemone, which is supposed to have
 sprung up red from the spot where
 Adonis was killed by the boar.

[125] ~~capit signa inuipolariosolum~~ ^{capit signa inuipolariosolum} such
 erased in C. It anticipates the saltus
 Cetera saltus
 invasere cohors: credas
 examina fundi
 Hyblaeum raptura thymum,
 cum cerea reges 125
 castra movent fagique cava
 dimissus ab alvo
 mellifer electis exercitus
 obstrepit herbis.
 pratorum spoliatur honos: haec
 lilia fuscis
 intexit violis; hanc mollis
 amaracus ornat;
 haec graditur stellata rosis, haec
 alba ligustris. 130
 te quoque, flebilibus maerens
 Hyacinthe figuris,

they gather, thy flower inscribed
 with woe, and Narcissus too—once
 lovely boys, now the pride of
 flowering spring. Thou, Hyacinthus,
 wert born at Amyclae, Narcissus was
 Helicon's child; thee the errant
 discus slew; him the amorous water-
 nymphs beguiled; for thee weeps
 Delos' god with sorrow-weighted
 brow; for him Cephissus with his
 broken reeds.

But beyond her fellows she, the one
 hope of the corn-bearing goddess,
 burned with a fierce desire to gather
 flowers. Now she fills with the spoil
 of the fields her laughing baskets,
 osier-woven; now she twines a
 wreath of flowers and crowns herself
 therewith, little seeing in this a
 foreshadowing of the marriage fate
 holds in store for her. E'en Pallas
 herself, goddess of the trumpets and
 of the weapons of war, devotes to
 gentler pursuits the hand wherewith
 she o'erwhelms the host of battle and
 throws down stout gates and city
 walls. She lays aside her spear and
 wreaths her helmet with soft flowers
 —strange aureole! The iron peak is
 gay, o'ershadowed the fierce martial
 glint, and the plumes, erstwhile levin
 bolts, now nod with blossoms. Nor
 does Diana, who scours Mount
 Parthenius with her keen-scented
 hounds, disdain this company but

Narcissumque metunt, nunc
 inclita germina veris,
praestantes olim pueros: tu
 natus Amyclis,
hunc Helicon genuit; disci te
 perculit error,
hunc fontis decepit amor; te
 fronte retusa 135
Delius, hunc fracta Cephisus
 harundine luget.
 Aestuat ante alias avido
 fervore legendi
frugiferae spes una deae: nunc
 vimine texto
ridentes calathos spoliis
 agrestibus implet;
nunc sociat flores seseque
 ignara coronat, 140
augurium fatale tori. quin ipsa
 tubarum
armorumque potens dextram,
 qua fortia turbat
agmina, qua stabiles portas et
 moenia vellit,
iam levibus laxat studiis
 hastamque reponit
insuetisque docet galeam
 mitescere sertis; 145
ferratus lascivit apex horrorque
 recessit
Martius et cristae pacato fulgure
 vernant.
nec, quae Parthenium canibus
 scrutatur odorem,
aspernata choros libertatemque
 comarum
iniecta voluit tantum frenare
 corona 150

would fain bind her free-flowing
tresses with a flowery crown.

But while the maidens so disport
themselves, wandering through the
fields, a sudden roar is heard, towers
crash and towns, shaken to their
foundations, totter and fall. None
knows whence comes the tumult;
Paphus' goddess alone recognized
the sound that set her companions in
amaze, and fear mixed with joy fills
her heart. For now the king of souls
was pricking his way through the
dim labyrinth of the underworld and
crushing Enceladus, groaning

Talia virgineo^[330] passim dum
 more geruntur,
 ecce repens mugire fragor,
 confligere turre
 pronaque vibratis radicibus
 oppida verti.
 causa latet; dubios agnovit sola
 tumultus
 diva Paphi mixtoque metu
 perterrita gaudet. 155
 iamque per anfractus animarum
 rector opacos
 sub terris quaerebat iter
 gravibusque gementem

beneath the weight of his massy
 steeds. His chariot-wheels severed
 the monstrous limbs, and the giant
 struggles, bearing Sicily along with
 Pluto on his burdened neck, and
 feebly essays to move and entangle
 the wheels with his weary serpents;
 still o'er his blazing back passes the
 smoking chariot. And as sappers
 seek to issue forth upon their
 unsuspecting enemy and, following a
 minèd path beneath the foundations
 of the tunnelled field, pass unmarked
 beyond the foe-invested walls of the
 city to break out, a victorious party,
 into the citadel of the outwitted
 enemy, seeming sprung from earth,
 even so Saturn's third son scours the
 devious darkness whithersoever his
 team hurries him, all eager to come
 forth beneath his brother's sky. No
 door lies open for him; rocks bar his
 egress on every side and detain the
 god in their escapeless prison. He
 brooked not the delay but wrathfully
 smote the crags with his beam-like
 staff. Sicily's caverns thundered,
 Lipare's isle was confounded,
 Vulcan left his forge in amaze and
 the Cyclops let drop their
 thunderbolts in fear. The pent-up
 denizens of the frozen Alps heard the
 uproar and he who then swam thy
 wave, father Tiber, thy brows not as
 yet graced with the crown of Italy's

Enceladum calcabat equis:
 inmania findunt
membra rotae pressaque Gigas
 cervice laborat
Sicaniam cum Dite ferens
 temptatque moveri 160
debilis et fessis serpentibus
 impedit axem:
fumida sulphureo praelabitur
 orbita dorso.
ac velut occultus securum pergit
 in hostem
miles et effossi subter
 fundamina campi
transilit inclusos arcano limite
 muros 165
turbaque deceptas victrix
 erumpit in arces
terrigenas imitata viros: sic
 tertius heres
Saturni latebrosa vagis rimatur
 habenis
devia, fraternum cupiens exire
 sub orbem.
ianua nulla patet; prohibebant
 undique rupes 170
oppositae duraque deum
 compage tenebant:
non tulit ille moras
 indignatusque trabali
saxa ferit sceptro. Sicalae
 sonuere cavernae;
turbatur Lipare; stupuit fornace
 relicta
Mulciber et trepidus deiecit
 fulmina Cyclops. 175
audiit et si quem glacies Alpina
 coërcet

triumphs; there heard it he who rows
his bark down Padus' stream.

So when the rock-encircled lake, ere
Peneus' wave rolled seaward,
covered all Thessaly and allowed not
its submerged fields to be tilled,
Neptune smote the imprisoning
mountain with his trident. Then did
the peak of Ossa, riven with the
mighty blow, spring apart from
snowy Olympus; a passage was
made and the waters were released,
whereby the sea won back her
feeding streams and the husbandman
his fields.

et qui te, Latii^[332] nondum
 praecincte tropaeis
 Thybri, natat missamque Pado
 qui remigat alnum.
 Sic, cum Thessaliam scopulis
 inclusa teneret
 Peneo stagnante palus et mersa
 negaret 180
 arva coli, trifida Neptunus
 cuspidem montes
 impulit adversos: tunc forti
 saucius ictu
 dissiluit gelido vertex Ossaëus
 Olympo;
 carceribus laxantur aquae
 factoque meatu
 redduntur fluviusque mari
 tellusque colonis. 185

[333]

When Trinacria beneath Pluto's
 stroke loosed her rocky bonds and
 yawned wide with cavernous cleft,
 sudden fear seized upon the sky. The
 stars deserted their accustomed
 courses; the Bear bathed him in
 forbidden Ocean; terror hurried
 sluggish Boötes to his setting; Orion
 trembled. Atlas paled as he heard the
 neighing coursers; their smoky
 breath obscures the bright heavens
 and the sun's orb affrighted them, so
 long fed on darkness. They stood
 biting the curb astonished at the
 brighter air, and struggle to turn the
 chariot and hurry back to dread
 Chaos. But soon, when they felt the
 lash on their backs and learned to
 bear the sun's brightness, they gallop
 on more rapidly than a winter torrent
 and more fleet than the hurtling
 spear; swifter than the Parthian's
 dart, the south wind's fury or nimble
 thought of anxious mind. Their bits
 are warm with blood, their death-
 bringing breath infects the air, the
 polluted dust is poisoned with their
 foam.

The Nymphs fly in all directions;
 Proserpine is hurried away in the
 chariot, imploring aid of the
 goddesses. Now Pallas unveils the
 Gorgon's head, Diana strings her
 bow and hastes to help. Neither
 yields to her uncle's violence; a

Postquam victa manu duros
Trinacria nexus
solvit et inmenso late discessit
hiatu,
adparet subitus caelo timor;
astra viarum
mutavere fidem; vetito se
proluit Arctos
aequore; praecipitat pigrum
formido Booten; 190
horruit Orion. audito palluit
Atlas
hinnitu: rutilos obscurat
anhelitus axes
discolor et longa solitos caligine
pasci
terrui orbis equos; pressis
haesere lupatis
attoniti meliore polo rursusque
verendum 195
in chaos obliquo certant temone
reverti.
mox ubi pulsato senserunt
verbera tergo
et solem didicere pati, torrentius
amne
hiberno tortaque ruunt pernicious
hasta:
quantum non iaculum Parthi,
non impetus Austri, 200
non leve sollicitae mentis
discurrit acumen.
sanguine frena calent;
corrumpit spiritus auras
letifer; infectae spumis vitiantur
harenae.
Diffugiunt Nymphae: rapitur
Drosopina curru

common virginity compels them to
fight and enrages them at the crime
of the fierce ravisher. Pluto is like a
lion when he has seized upon a
heifer, the pride of the stall and the
herd, and has torn with his claws the
defenceless flesh and has sated his
fury on all its limbs, and so stands all
befouled with clotted blood and
shakes his tangled mane and scorns
the shepherds' feeble rage.

"Lord of the strengthless dead," cries
Pallas,

et Proserpina curat
 imploratque deas.^[334] iam Gorgonis
 ora revelat 205
 Pallas et intento festinat Delia
 telo
 nec patruo cedunt: stimulat
 communis in arma
 virginitas crimenque feri
 raptoris acerbat.
 ille velut stabuli decus
 armentique iuvencam
 cum leo possedit nudataque
 viscera fodit 210
 unguibus et rabiem totos exegit
 in armos:
 stat crassa turpis sanie
 nodosque iubarum
 excutit et viles pastorum
 despicit iras.
 “Ignavi domitor vulgi,
 deterime fratrum,”

[335]

“wickedest of thy brothers, what
 Furies have stirred thee with their
 goads and accursed torches? Why
 hast thou left thy seat and how darest
 thou pollute the upper world with thy
 hellish team? Thou hast the hideous
 Curses, the other deities of Hell, the
 dread Furies—any of them would be
 a worthy spouse for thee. Quit thy
 brother’s realm, begone from the
 kingdom allotted to another. Get thee
 hence; let thine own night suffice
 thee. Why mix the quick with the
 dead? Why treadest thou our world,
 an unwelcome visitant?”

So exclaiming she smote with her
 threatening shield the horses who
 sought to advance and barred their
 way with the bulk of her targe,
 thrusting them back with the hissing
 snake-hair of Medusa’s head and
 o’ershadowing them with its
 outstretched plumes. She poised for
 throwing her beechen shaft whose
 radiance met and illumed Pluto’s
 black chariot. Almost had she cast it
 had not Jove from heaven’s height
 hurled his red thunderbolt on
 peaceful wings, acknowledging his
 new son; mid the riven clouds
 thunders the marriage-paeon and
 attesting fires confirm the union.

All unwilling the goddesses yielded,
 and weeping Diana laid aside her
 weapons and thus spake: “Fare well,

Pallas ait “quae te stimulis
 facibusque profanis 215
Eumenides movere? tua cur
 sede relictā
audes Tartareis caelum incestare
 quadrigis?
sunt tibi deformes Dirae, sunt
 altera Lethes
numina, sunt tristes Furiae, te
 coniuge dignae.
fratris linque domos, alienam
 desere sortem; 220
nocte tua contentus abi. quid
 viva sepultis
admisces? nostrum quid
 proteris advena
 mundum?”
 Talia vociferans avidos
 transire minaci
cornipedes umbone ferit
 clipeique retardat
obice Gorgoneisque premens
 adsibilat hydris 225
praetentaque operit crista;
 libratur in ictum
fraxinus et nigros inluminat
 obvia currus
missaque paene foret, ni
 Iuppiter aethere summo
pacificas rubri torsisset fulminis
 alas
confessus socerum: nimbis
 hymenaeus hiulcis 230
intonat et testes firmant conubia
 flammae.
 Invitae cessere deae.
 compescuit arcum
cum gemitu talesque dedit

a long farewell; forget us not.
Reverence for our sire forbade our
help, and against his will we cannot
defend thee. We acknowledge defeat
by a power greater than our own.
The Father hath conspired against
thee and betrayed thee to the realms
of silence, no more, alas! to behold
the sisters and companions who
crave sight of thee. What fate hath
reft thee from the upper air and
condemned the heavens to so deep
mourning? Now no more

cum gemitu talesque deum

Latonia^[336] voces:

“Sis memor o longumque
vare. reverentia patris
obstitit auxilio, nec nos
defendere contra 235
possumus: imperio vinci maiore
fatemur.
in te coniurat genitor populoque
silenti
traderis, heu! cupidus non
adspectura sorores
aequalemque chorum. quae te
fortuna supernis
abstulit et tanto damnavit sidera
luctu? 240

[337]

can we rejoice to set Parthenius’
steep with nets nor wear the quiver;
at large as he lists let the wild boar,
raven and the lion roar savagely with
none to say him nay. Thee, Taygetus’
crest, thee Maenalus’ height shall
weep, their hunting laid aside. Long
shalt thou be food for weeping on
sorrowing Cynthus’ slopes. E’en my
brother’s shrine at Delphi shall speak
no more.”

Meanwhile Proserpine is borne away
in the winged car, her hair streaming
before the wind, beating her arms in
lamentation and calling in vain
remonstrance to the clouds: “Why
hast thou not hurled at me, father,
bolts forged by the Cyclops’ hands?
Was this thy will to deliver thy
daughter to the cruel shades and
drive her for ever from this world?
Does love move thee not at all? Hast
thou nothing of a father’s feeling?
What ill deed of men has stirred such
anger in thee? When Phlegra raged
with war’s madness I bore no
standard against the gods; ’twas
through no strength of mine that ice-
bound Ossa supported frozen
Olympus. For attempt of what crime,
for complicity with what guilt, am I
thrust down in banishment to the
bottomless pit of Hell? Happy girls
whom other ravishers have stolen;
they at least enjoy the general light

iam neque Partheniis innectere
retia lustris
nec pharetram gestare libet:
securus ubique
spumet aper saevique fremant
impune leones.
te iuga Taygeti, posito te
Maenala flebunt
venatu maestoque diu lugebere
Cyntho. 245
Delphica quin etiam fratris
delubra tacebunt.”
Interea volucris fertur
Proserpina curru
caesariem diffusa Noto
planctuque lacertos
verberat et questus ad nubila
tendit inanes:
“Cur non torsisti manibus
fabricata Cyclopum 250
in nos tela, pater? sic me
crudelibus umbris
tradere, sic toto placuit
depellere mundo?
nullane te flectit pietas
nihilumque paternae
mentis inest? tantas quo crimine
movimus iras?
non ego, cum rapido saeviret
Phlegra tumultu, 255
signa deis adversa tuli; non
robore nostro
Ossa pruinosa vexit glacialis
Olympum.
quod conata nefas aut cuius
conscia culpae
exul ad inmanes Erebi detrudor
hiatus?

of day, while I, together with my
virginity, lose the air of heaven;
stolen from me alike is innocence
and daylight. Needs must I quit this
world and be led a captive bride to
serve Hell's tyrant. Ye flowers that I
loved in so evil an hour, oh, why did
I scorn my mother's warning? Too
late did I detect the wiles of Venus.
Mother, my mother, whether in the
vales of Phrygian Ida the dread pipe
sounds about thine ears with Lydian

matris:

o fortunatas alii^[338] quascumque
tulere 260
raptores! saltem communi sole
fruuntur.
sed mihi virginitas pariter
caelumque negatur,
eripitur cum luce pudor,
terrisque relictis
servitum Stygio ducor captiva
tyranno.
o male dilecti flores
despectaque matris 265
consilia! o Veneris deprensae
serius artes!
mater, io! seu te Phrygiis in
vallibus Idae
Mygdonio buxus circumsonat
horrida cantu,

[339]

strains, or thou hauntest mount
Dindymus, ah! with self-mutilated
Galli, and beholdest the naked
swords of the Curetes, aid me in my
bitter need; frustrate Pluto's mad lust
and stay the funereal reins of my
fierce ravisher."

Her words and those becoming tears
mastered e'en that rude heart as
Pluto first learned to feel love's
longings. The tears he wiped away
with his murky cloak, quieting her
sad grief with these soothing words:
"Cease, Proserpine, to vex thy heart
with gloomy cares and causeless
fear. A prouder sceptre shall be thine,
nor shalt thou face marriage with a
husband unworthy of thee. I am that
scion of Saturn whose will the
framework of the world obeys,
whose power stretches through the
limitless void. Think not thou hast
lost the light of day; other stars are
mine and other courses; a purer light
shalt thou see and wonder rather at
Elysium's sun and blessed habitants.
There a richer age, a golden race has
its home, and we possess for ever
what men win but once. Soft meads
shall fail thee not, and ever-
blooming flowers, such as thy Henna
ne'er produced, breathe to gentler
zephyrs. There is, moreover, a
precious tree in the leafy groves
whose curving branches gleam with

seu tu sanguineis ululantia
Dindyma Gallis
incolis et strictos Curetum
respicis enses: 270
exitio succurre meo! compesce
furentem!
comprime ferales torvi
praedonis habenas!”
Talibus ille ferox dictis
fletuque decoro
vincitur et primi suspiria sensit
amoris.
tunc ferrugineo lacrimas
deterget amictu 275
et placida maestum solatur voce
dolorem:
“Desine funestis animum,
Proserpina, curis
et vano vexare metu. maiora
dabuntur
sceptra nec indigni taedas
patiere mariti.
ille ego Saturni proles, cui
machina rerum 280
servit et inmensum tendit per
inane potestas.
amissum ne crede diem: sunt
altera nobis
sidera, sunt orbes alii, lumenque
videbis
purius Elysiumque magis
mirabere solem
cultoresque pios; illic pretiosior
aetas, 285
aurea progenies habitat,
semperque tenemus
quod superi meruere semel. nec
mollia desunt

living ore—a tree consecrate to thee.
Thou shalt be queen of blessed
autumn and ever enriched with
golden fruit. Nay more; whatsoe’er
the limpid air embraces, whatever
earth nourishes, the salt seas sweep,
the rivers roll, or the marsh-lands
feed, all living things alike shall
yield them to thy sway, all, I say, that
dwell beneath the orb of the moon
that is the seventh of the planets and
in its ethereal journey separates
things mortal from the deathless

prata tibi; Zephyris illic
 melioribus halant
 perpetui flores, quos nec tua
 protulit Henna.
 est etiam lucis arbor praedives
 opacis 290
 fulgentes viridi ramos curvata
 metallo:
 haec tibi sacra datur
 fortunatumque tenebis
 autumnum et fulvis semper
 ditabere pomis.
 parva loquor: quidquid liquidus
 complectitur aër,
 quidquid alit tellus, quidquid
 maris aequora verrunt,
 295
 quod fluvii volvunt, quod
 nutrivere paludes,
 cuncta tuis pariter cedent
 animalia regnis
 lunari subiecta globo, qui
 Septimus auras
 ambit et aeternis mortalia
 separat astris.

[341]

stars. To thy feet shall come purple-
 clothed kings, stripped of their
 pomp, and mingling with the
 unmoneyed throng; for death renders
 all equal. Thou shalt give doom to
 the guilty and rest to the virtuous.
 Before thy judgement-throne the
 wicked must confess the crimes of
 their evil lives. Lethe's stream shall
 obey thee and the Fates be thy
 handmaidens. Be thy will done."

So speaking he urges on his
 triumphant steeds and enters Tartarus
 in gentler wise. The shades
 assemble, thick as the leaves the
 stormy south wind shakes down
 from the trees, dense as the
 rainclouds it masses, countless as the
 billows it curls or the sand it scatters.
 The dead of every age throng with
 hastening foot to see so illustrious a
 bride. Soon Pluto himself enters with
 joyful mien submitting him to the
 softening influence of pleasant
 laughter, all unlike his former self.
 At the incoming of his lord and
 mistress huge Phlegethon rises; his
 bristly beard is wet with burning
 streams and flames dart o'er all his
 countenance.

There hasten to greet the pair slaves
 chosen from out the number. Some
 put away the lofty chariot, take the
 bits from the mouths of the toil-freed
 horses and turn them out to graze in

sub tua purpurei venient vestigia
reges 300
deposito luxu turba cum
paupere mixti
(omnia mors aequat); tu
damnatura nocentes,
tu requiem latura piis; te iudice
sontes
improba cogentur vitae
commissa fateri.
accipe Lethaeo famulas cum
gurgite Parcas, 305
sitque ratum quodcumque
voles.”

Haec

fatus ovantes
exhortatur equos et Tartara
mitior intrat.
conveniunt animae, quantas
violentior Auster
decutit arboribus frondes aut
nubibus imbres
colligit aut frangit fluctus aut
torquet harenas; 310
cunctaque praecipiti stipantur
saecula cursu
insignem visura nurum. mox
ipse serenus
ingreditur facili passus
mollescere risu
dissimilisque sui. dominis
intranibus ingens
adsurgit Phlegethon:
flagrantibus hispida rivis
315
barba madet totoque fluunt
incendia vultu.
Occurrunt properi lecta de

their accustomed pastures. Some
hold back the curtains, others
decorate the doorway with branches
and fasten brodered hangings in the
bridal chamber. In chaste bands the
matrons of Elysium throng their
queen, and with sweet converse
banish her fear; they gather and braid
her dishevelled hair and place the
wedding-veil upon her head to hide
her troubled blushes.

Joy fills that grey land, the buried
throng holds

Occurrunt propere lecta de
plebe ministri:
pars altos revocant currus
frenisque solutis
vertunt emeritos ad pascua nota
iugales;
pars aulaea tenent; alii
praetexere ramis 320
limina et in thalamum cultas
extollere vestes.
reginam casto cinxerunt agmine
matres
Elysiae teneroque levant
sermone timores
et sparsos religant crines et
vultibus addunt
flammea sollicitum praevelatura
pudorem. 325
Pallida laetatur regio
gentesque sepultae

[343]

high festival, and the ghosts sport them at the nuptial feast. The flower-crowned Manes sit at a joyous banquet and unwonted song breaks the gloomy silence; wailing is hushed. Hell's murk gladly disperses and suffers the darkness of age-long night to grow less impenetrable. Minos' urn of judgement throws no ambiguous lots; the sound of blows is stilled, and Tartarus, the prison of the wicked, is hushed and still, for punishments are intermitted. No longer is Ixion tortured by the ever-turning wheel to which he is bound; from Tantalus' lips no more is the flying water withdrawn. Ixion is freed, Tantalus reaches the stream, and Tityus at length straightens out his huge limbs and uncovers nine acres of foul ground (such was his size), and the vulture, that burrows lazily into the dark side, is dragged off from his wearied breast sore against its will, lamenting that no longer is the devoured flesh renewed for it.

The Furies, forgetful of crimes and dread wrath, make ready the wine-bowl and drink therefrom for all their snaky hair. Nay, with gentle song, their threatenings laid aside, they stretch out their snakes to the full cups and kindle the festal torches with unusual flame. Then, too, the

luxuriant epulisque vacant
 genialibus umbrae.
grata coronati peragunt
 convivia Manes;
rumpunt insoliti tenebrosa
 silentia cantus;
sedantur gemitus. Erebi se
 sponte relaxat 330
squalor et aeternam patitur
 rarescere noctem,
urna nec incertas versat Minoia
 sortes.
verbera nulla sonant nulloque
 fremenia luctu
impia dilatis respirant Tartara
 poenis:
non rota suspensum praeceps
 Ixiona torquet; 335
non aqua Tantaleis subducitur
 invida labris.
solvitur Ixion et Tantalus
 invenit undas
et Tityos tandem spatiosos erigit
 artus
squalentisque novem detexit
 iugera campi
(tantus erat), laterisque piger
 sulcator opaci 340
invitus trahitur lasso de pectore
 vultur
abreptasque dolet iam non sibi
 crescere fibras.
 Oblitae scelerum
 formidatique furoris
Eumenides cratera parant et
 vina feroci
crine bibunt flexisque minis iam
 longa canentes 345

birds flew unhurt over the now
appeased stream of poisonous
Avernus, and Lake Amsanctus
checked his deadly exhalations; the
stream was stayed and the whirlpool
grew still. They say that then the
springs of Acheron were changed
and welled up with new milk, while
Cocytus, enwreathed with ivy,
flowed along in streams of sweet
wine. Lachesis slit not the thread of
life nor did funeral dirge sound in
challenge to the holy chant. Death
walked not

extendunt socios ad pocula
 in terris plaudique togum
 et festas plinxe pendunt lumine
 navita tandem oritur fluctu, non
 tunc et pestiferi palat, um flumen
 oppida Averni pollent inmunia
 innocua le transistis, aves,
 impexanturque repressit
 Amsandrus finem fronte
 portitor vorago 350 egit cum
 tunc Acheronte remota 360

Iam surgit fontes processerat
 lacte non Mospenus obli-
 ducitur hechalque mirantem stat
 Cocytum pondus perhibent
 stellantes Nasse Ixionus
 stamina nec nupte Lucie
 omina per turbida sacris
 obstrepentia laments choris.
 exultant cum voce pigritus 365
 sub aula 365

talia pervigili sumunt exordia
 plausu:
 “Nostra potens Iuno tuque o
 germane Tonantis
 et gener, unanimi consortia
 discite somni
 mutuaque alternis innectite vota
 lacertis.
 iam felix oritur proles; iam laeta
 futuros 370
 expectat Natura deos. nova
 numina rebus
 addite et optatos Cereri proferte
 nepotes.”

on earth and no parents wept beside
 the funeral pyre. The wave brought
 not destruction to the sailor nor the
 spear to the warrior. Cities flourished
 and knew not death, the destroyer.
 Charon crowned his uncombed locks
 with sedge and singing plied his
 weightless oars.

And now its own evening-star had
 shone upon the underworld. The
 maiden is led into the bridal
 chamber. Night, clad in starry
 raiment, stands by her as her
 brideswoman; she touches the couch
 and blesses the union of marriage
 with a bond that cannot be broken.
 The blessed shades raise their voices
 and beneath the palace roof of Dis
 thus begin their song with sleepless
 acclaim: “Proserpine, queen of our
 realm, and thou, Pluto, at once the
 brother and the son-in-law of Jove,
 the Thunderer, be it yours to know
 the alliance of conjoined sleep;
 pledge mutual troth as ye hold each
 other in intertwining arms. Happy
 offspring shall be yours; joyous
 Nature awaits gods yet to be born.
 Give the world a new divinity and
 Ceres the grandchildren she longs
 for.”

BOOK III

(XXXVI.)

LIBER TERTIUS

(XXXVI.)

Iuppiter interea cinctam
 Thaumantida nimbis
ire iubet totoque deos arcessere
 mundo.
illa colorato Zephyros illapsa
 volatu
numina conclamat pelagi
 Nymphasque morantes
increpat et Fluvios umentibus
 evocat antris. 5

Meanwhile Jove bids cloud-girt Iris
go gather the gods from the whole
universe. She, outstripping the
breezes in her rainbow flight, calls to
the sea-deities, chides the Nymphs
for their delay, and summons forth
the river-gods from their moist

caverns. Out they haste in doubt and fear what this disturbance of their peace may signify or what has caused so great an upheaval. The starry heaven is thrown open and the gods are bidden take their seats as merit, not chance, dictates. The first places are accorded to the heavenly powers, next come the ocean-deities, calm Nereus and grey-haired Phorcus, last twiform Glaucus and Proteus, for once of unvarying shape. The agèd river-gods, too, are privileged to take their seats; the other rivers, a thousand strong, stand as stands the youth of an earthly assembly. Dripping water-nymphs lean on their moist sires and Fauns in silence marvel at the stars.

Then the grave Father from his seat on high Olympus thus began: "Once more the affairs of men have won care from me, affairs long neglected since I looked upon the repose of Saturn's reign and knew the torpor of that stagnant age, when I had fain urged the race of man, long sunk in lethargy by reason of my sire's sluggish rule, with the goads of anxious life, whereby their crops should no more grow to maturity of their own accord in the untilled fields nor yet the forest trees drip with honey nor wine flow from springs nor every stream course

ancipites trepidique ruunt, quae
causa quietos
excierit, tanto quae res agitata
tumultu.
ut patuit stellata domus,
considerare iussi,
nec confusus honor: caelestibus
ordine sedes
prima datur; tractum proceres
tenuere secundum 10
aequorei, placidus Nereus
reverendaque Phorci
canities; Glaucum series
extrema biformem
accipit et certo mansurum
Protea vultu.
nec non et senibus Fluviis
concessa sedendi
gloria; plebeio stat cetera more
iuventus, 15
mille Amnes. liquidis
incumbunt patribus udae
Naides et taciti mirantur sidera
Fauni.
Tum gravis ex alto genitor sic
orsus Olympo:
“abduxere meas iterum mortalia
curas
iam pridem neglecta mihi,
Saturnia postquam 20
otia et ignavi senium
cognovimus aevi;
sopitosque diu populos torpore
paterno
sollicitae placuit stimulis
impellere vitae,
incultis ne sponte seges
grandesceret arvis

sounding into cups. 'Twas not that I
grudged their blessings—gods may
not envy nor hurt—but because
luxury is a foe to a godly life, and
plenty dulls the mind of men;
therefore I bade necessity,
invention's mother, provoke their
sluggish spirits and little by little
search out the hidden tracks of
things; bade industry give birth to
civilization and practice nourish it.

“Nature now with ceaseless
complaint bids me

grandesceret arvis,
 undaret neu silva^[348] favis, neu vina
 tumerent 25
 fontibus et totae fremerent in
 pocula ripae
 (haud equidem invideo—neque
 enim livescere fas est
 vel nocuisse deos—sed, quod
 dissuasor honesti
 luxus et humanas oblimat copia
 mentes),
 provocet ut segnes animos
 rerumque remotas 30
 ingeniosa vias paulatim
 exploret egestas
 utque artes pariat sollertia,
 nutriat usus.
 “Nunc mihi cum magnis
 instat Natura querellis

[349]

succour the race of man, calls me
 cruel and implacable tyrant, calls to
 mind the centuries of my sire's
 empery and dubs me miser of her
 riches, for that I would have the
 world a wilderness and the land
 covered with scrub and would
 beautify the year with no fruits. She
 complained that she, who was
 erstwhile the mother of all living
 things, had suddenly taken upon her
 the hated guise of a stepmother. ‘Of
 what avail that man derived his
 intelligence from above, that he has
 held up his head to heaven, if he
 wander like the beasts through
 trackless places, if with them he
 crushes acorns for food? Can such a
 life as this bring him happiness, hid
 in the forest glades, indistinguishable
 from the life of animals?’ Since I
 bore so often such complaints from
 the lips of mother Nature, at length I
 took pity on the world and decided
 to make man to cease from his oak-
 tree food; wherefore I have decreed
 that Ceres, who now, ignorant of her
 loss, lashes the lions of Mount Ida,
 accompanying her dread mother,
 should wander over sea and land in
 anxious grief, until, in her joy at
 finding the traces of her lost
 daughter, she grant man the gift of
 corn and her chariot is borne aloft
 through the clouds to scatter among
 the people ears before unknown and

humanum relevare genus,
durumque tyrannum
inmitemque vocat regnataque
saecula patri 35
commemorat parcumque Iovem
se divite clamat,
qui campos horrere situ
dumisque repleti
rura velim, nullis exornem
fructibus annum.
se iam, quae genetrix
mortalibus ante fuisset,
in dirae subito mores transisse
novercae; 40
‘quid mentem traxisse polo,
quid profuit altum
erexisse caput, pecudum si
more pererrant
avia, si frangunt communia
pabula glandes?
haecine vita iuvat silvestribus
abditā^[127] lustris,
indiscreta feris?’ tales cum
saepe parentis 45
pertulerim questus, tandem
clementior orbi
Chaonio statui gentes avertere
victu:
atque adeo Cererem, quae nunc
ignara malorum
verberat Idaeos torva cum matre
leones,
per mare, per terras avido
discurrere luctu 50
decretum, natae donec laetata
repertae
indicio tribuat fruges, currusque
foetibus

the steel-blue serpents submit them
to the Attic yoke.^[128] But if any of
the gods dare inform Ceres who is
the ravisher, I swear by the
immensity of mine empire, by the
firm-established peace of the world,
be he son or sister, spouse or
daughter, vaunt he his birth as from
mine own head, he shall feel afar the
wrath of mine arms, the
thunderbolt’s blow, and be sorry he
was born a god and pray for death.
Then, sore wounded, he shall be
handed

^[128] Attic, because Ceres in her
wanderings came to Eleusis where she
instructed Triptolemus, son of Celeus,
King of Eleusis, in the art of
agriculture.

[127] addita, Birt reads addita,
notibus ignotas populis
sparsurus aristas
et iuga caerulei subeant Actaea
dracones.
quodsi quis Cereri raptorem
prodere divum 55
audeat, imperii molem
pacemque profundam
obtestor rerum, natus licet ille
sororve
vel coniunx fuerit natarumve
agminis una,
se licet illa meo conceptam
vertice iactet:
sentiet iratum procul aegide,
sentiet ictum 60
fulminis et genitum divina sorte
pigebit
optabitque mori: tunc vulnere
saucius ipsi

over to my son-in-law, Pluto himself, for punishment in those regions he had fain betray. There he shall learn whether Hell is true to her own monarch's cause. Such is my will; thus let the unchangeable fates fulfil my decree." He spake and shook the stars with his dread nod.

But, far from Sicily, no uncertain suspicions of the loss she had suffered alarmed Ceres, where long she had dwelt peaceful and secure beneath the rocky roof of the cave resounding with arms. Dreams doubled her dread and a vision of Proserpine lost troubled her every sleep. Now she dreams that an enemy's spear is piercing her body, now (oh horror!) that her raiment is changed and is become black, now that the infecund ash is budding in the midst of her house. Moreover, there stood a laurel, loved above all the grove, that used with maiden leaf to o'ershadow the virgin bower of Proserpine. This she saw hewn down to the roots, its straggling branches fouled with dust, and when she asked the cause of this disaster weeping dryads told her that the Furies had destroyed it with an axe of Hell.

Next her very image appeared in the mother's dreams, announcing her fate in no uncertain manner. She saw

tradetur genero, passurus
 prodita regna,
et sciet an propriae conspirent
 Tartara causae.
hoc sanctum; mansura fluant
 hoc ordine fata.” 65
dixit et horrendo concussit
 sidera motu.
 At procul armisoni Cererem
 sub rupibus antri
securam placidamque diu iam
 certa peracti
terrebant simulacra mali,
 noctesque timorem
ingeminant omnique perit
 Proserpina somno. 70
namque modo adversis invadi
 viscera telis,
nunc sibi mutatas horret
 nigrescere vestes,
nunc steriles mediis frondere
 penatibus ornos.
stabat praeterea luco dilectior
 omni
laurus, virgineos quondam quae
 fronde pudica 75
umbrabat thalamos: hanc imo
 stipite caesam
vidit et inemptos foedari
 pulvere ramos
quaesivitque nefas. Dryades
 dixere gementes
Tartarea Furias debellavisse
 bipenni.
 Sed tunc ipsa sui iam non
 ambagibus ullis 80
nuntia materno facies ingesta
 sonori.

Proserpine shut in the dark confines
of a prison-house and bound with
cruel chains. Yet not so had she
entrusted her to the fields of Sicily,
not so had the wondering goddesses
beheld her in Etna's flowery
meadows. Foul was now that hair,
more beauteous erstwhile than gold;
night had dimmed the fire of her
eyes and frost banished the roses
from her pale cheeks. The gracious
flush of her skin and those limbs
whose whiteness matched the hoar-
frost are alike turned to hell-
tinctured

solum.
 namque videbatur^[352] tenebroso
 oblecta recessu
 carceris et saevis Proserpina
 vincta catenis,
 non qualem Siculis olim
 mandaverat arvis
 nec qualem roseis nuper
 convallibus Aetnae 85
 suspexere deae: squalibat
 pulchrior auro
 caesaries et nox oculorum
 infecerat ignes
 exhaustusque gelu pallet rubor,
 ille superbi
 flammeus oris honos, et non
 cessura pruinis
 membra colorantur picei
 caligine regni. 90

[353]

grain. When, therefore, she was at last able to recognize her daughter, albeit with doubtful gaze, she cried: "What crime hath merited these many punishments? Whence comes this dreadful wasting away? Who hath power to wreak such cruelty upon me? How have thy soft arms deserved fetters of stubborn iron, scarce fitted for beasts? Art thou my daughter or does a vain shadow deceive me?"

Thus she answered: "Cruel mother, forgetful of thy daughter's fate, more hard of heart than the tawny lioness! Could'st thou be so heedless of me? Didst thou hold me cheap for that I am thy sole daughter? Dear indeed to thee must be the name of Proserpine who now, shut in this vast cavern, as thou seest, am plagued with torment! Hast thou heart to dance, cruel mother? Canst thou revel through the cities of Phrygia? If thou hast not banished the mother from thy breast, if thou, Ceres, art really my mother and 'twas no Hyrcanian tiger gave me birth, save me, I pray thee, from this prison and restore me to the upper world. If the fates forbid my return come thou down at least and visit me."

So spake she and strove to hold out her trembling hands. The iron's ruthless strength forbade it, and the

ergo hanc ut dubio vix tandem
agnoscere visu
evaluit: “cuius tot poenae
criminis?” inquit
“unde haec informis macies?
cui tanta potestas
in me saevitiae? rigidi cur
vincula ferri
vix aptanda feris molles
meruere lacerti? 95
tu mea, tu proles? an vana
fallimur umbra?”
Illa refert: “heu dira parens
nataeque peremptae
immemor! heu fulvas animo
transgressa leaenas!
tantane te nostri tenuere
oblivia? tantum
unica despicior? certe
Proserpina nomen 100
dulce tibi, tali quae nunc, ut
cernis, hiatu
suppliciis inclusa terror! tu saeva
choreis
indulges? Phrygias vel nunc
interstrepis urbes?
quodsi non omnem pepulisti
pectore matrem,
si tua nata, Ceres, et non me
Caspia tigris 105
edidit, his, oro, miseram
defende cavernis
inque superna refer, prohibent si
fata reverti,
vel tantum visura veni.”

Sic

fata trementes
tendere conatur palmas vix

clangour of the chains awoke her
sleeping mother. Ceres lay stiff with
terror at the vision, rejoices that it
was not true, but grieves that she
cannot embrace her daughter.
Maddened with fear she rushes out
of the cavern and thus addresses
Cybele: “No longer now will I tarry
in the land of Phrygia, holy mother;
the duty of protecting my dear
daughter calls me back after so long
an absence, for she is of an age that
is exposed to many dangers. I put not

tenet conatui pallas. vis
 improba^[354] ferri
 impedit et motae somnum
 solvere catenae. 110
 obrigit visis; gaudet non vera
 fuisse;
 complexu caruisse dolet.
 penetralibus amens
 prosilit et tali compellat voce
 Cybeben:
 “Iam non ulterius Phrygia
 tellure morabor,
 sancta parens: revocat tandem
 custodia cari 115
 pignoris et cunctis obiecti
 fraudibus anni.

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complete trust in my palace, though
 built with iron from the Cyclops’
 furnace. I fear lest rumour disclose
 her hiding-place and Sicily too
 lightly guard my trust. The fame of
 that place too widely bruited abroad
 alarms me; needs must I find
 elsewhere some obscurer abode. Our
 retreat must be on all men’s tongues
 by reason of the groanings of
 Enceladus and the neighbour flames.
 Ill-omened dreams, too, with diverse
 visions often give me pause, and no
 day passes but brings some
 inauspicious hap. How often has my
 crown of golden ears fallen of itself!
 How often blood flowed from my
 breast! In mine own despite streams
 of tears course down my cheeks and
 unbidden my hands beat my
 astonished breast. Would I blow up
 the flute, funereal is the note; do I
 shake the cymbals, the cymbals echo
 a sound of mourning. Alas! I fear
 there is some trouble in these
 portents. This long sojourn, has
 wrought me woe.”

“May the wind carry far away thy
 vain words,” replies Cybele; “not
 such the Thunderer’s want of care
 that he would not hurl his bolt in his
 daughter’s defence. Yet go and
 return, dismayed by no evil hap.”

This said, Ceres left the temple; but
 no speed is enough for her haste; she

nec mihi Cyclopum quamvis
 extructa caminis
culmina fida satis. timeo ne fama
 latebras
prodiderit leviusque meum
 Trinacria celet
depositum. terret nimium vulgata
 locorum 120
nobilitas. aliis sedes obscurior oris
exquirenda mihi; gemitu
 flamisque propinquis
Enceladi nequeunt umbracula
 nostra taceri.
somnia quin etiam variis infausta
 figuris
saepe monent, nullusque dies non
 triste minatur 125
augurium. quotiens flaventia sarta
 comarum
sponte cadunt! quotiens exundat
 ab ubere sanguis!
larga vel invito prorumpunt
 flumina vultu
iniussaeque manus mirantia
 pectora tundunt.
si buxus inflare velim, ferale
 gemiscunt; 130
tympana si quatiam, planctus mihi
 tympana reddunt.
ah vereor, ne quid portendant
 omina veri!
hae longae nocuere morae!”

“Procul

 inrita venti
dicta ferant” subicit Cybele; “nec
 tanta Tonanti
segnities, ut non pro pignore
 fulmina mittat 135

complains that her sluggish dragons
scarce move, and, lashing the wings
now of this one and now of that
(though little they deserved it), she
hopes to reach Sicily e’er yet out of
sight of Ida. She fears everything
and hopes nothing, anxious as the
bird that has entrusted its unfledged
brood to a low-growing ash and
while absent gathering food has
many fears lest perchance the wind
has blown the fragile nest from the
tree, lest her young ones be exposed
to the theft of man or the greed of
snakes.

i tamen et nullo^[356] turbata revertere
casu.”

Haec ubi, digreditur templis. sed
nulla ruenti
mobilitas: tardos queritur non ire
dracones
inmeritasque movens alterno
verbere pennas
Sicaniam quaerit, cum necdum
absconderit Idam. 140
cuncta pavet speratque nihil. sic
aestuat ales,
quae teneros humili fetus
commiserit orno
adlatura cibos, et plurima cogitat
absens:
ne gracilem ventus decusserit
arbore nidum,
ne furtum pateant homini, ne
praeda colubris. 145

When she saw the gate-keepers fled,
the house unguarded, the rusted
hinges, the overthrown doorposts,
and the miserable state of the silent
halls, pausing not to look again at the
disaster, she rent her garment and
tore away the shattered corn-ears
along with her hair. She could not
weep nor speak nor breathe and a
trembling shook the very marrow of
her bones; her faltering steps
tottered. She flung open the doors
and wandering through the empty
rooms and deserted halls, recognized
the half-ruined warp with its
disordered threads and the work of
the loom broken off. The goddess’
labours had come to naught, and
what remained to be done, that the
bold spider was finishing with her
sacrilegious web.

She weeps not nor bewails the ill;
only kisses the loom and stifles her
dumb complaints amid the threads,
clasping to her bosom, as though it
had been her child, the spindles her
child’s hand had touched, the wool
she had cast aside, and all the toys
scattered in maiden sport. She scans
the virgin bed, the deserted couch,
and the chair where Proserpine had
sat: even as a herd, whose drove the
unexpected fury of an African lion or
bands of marauding beasts have
attacked, gazes in amaze at the

Ut domus excubiis
incustodita remotis
et resupinati neglecto cardine
postes
flebilis et tacitae species
adparuit aulae,
non expectato respectu cladis
amictus
conscidit et fractas cum crine
avellit aristas. 150
haeserunt lacrimae; nec vox aut
spiritus oris
redditur, atque imis vibrat
tremor ossa medullis;
succidui titubant gressus;
foribusque reclusis,
dum vacuas sedes et desolata
pererrat
atria, semirutas confuso stamine
telas 155
atque interceptas agnoscit
pectinis artes.
divinus perit ille labor,
spatiumque relictum
audax sacrilego supplebat
aranea textu.
Nec deflet plangitve malum;
tantum oscula telae
figit et abrumpit mutas in fila
querellas; 160
attritosque manu radios
proiectaque pensa
cunctaque virgineo sparsa
oblectamina ludo
ceu natam pressat gremio;
castumque cubile
desertosque toros et, sicubi
sederat olim

vacant stall, and, too late returned,
wanders through the emptied
pastures, sadly calling to the
unreplying steers.

And there, in the innermost parts of
the house, she saw lying Electra,
loving nurse of Proserpine, best
known among the old Nymphs of
Ocean; she who loved Proserpine as
did Ceres. 'Twas she who, when
Proserpine had left her cradle, would
bear her in her loving bosom and
bring the little girl to mighty Jove
and set her to play on her father's

seculat omni,
 perlegit: attonitus stabulo ceu
 pastor inani, 165
 cui pecus aut rabies Poenorum
 inopina leonum
 aut populatrices infestavere
 catervae;
 serus at ille redit vastataque
 pascua lustrans
 non responsuros ciet
 imploratque iuencos.
 Atque ibi secreta tectorum in
 parte iacentem 170
 conspicit Electram, natae quae
 sedula nutrix
 Oceani priscas inter notissima
 Nymphas.
 par Cereri pietas; haec post
 cunabula dulci
 ferre sinu summoque Iovi
 deducere parvam
 sueverat et genibus ludentem
 aptare paternis. 175

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knee. She was her companion, her guardian, and could be deemed her second mother. There, with torn and dishevelled hair, all foul with grey dust, she was lamenting the rape of her divine foster-child.

Ceres approached her, and when at length her grief allowed her sighs free rein: "What ruin is here?" she said. "Of what enemy am I become the victim? Does my husband yet rule or do the Titans hold heaven? What hand hath dared this, if the Thunderer be still alive? Have Typhon's shoulders forced up Inarime or does Alcyoneus course on foot through the Etruscan Sea, having burst the bonds of imprisoning Vesuvius? Or has the neighbouring mountain of Etna oped her jaws and expelled Enceladus? Perchance Briareus with his hundred arms has attacked my house? Ah, my daughter, where art thou now? Whither are fled my thousand servants, whither Cyane? What violence has driven away the winged Sirens? Is this your faith? Is this the way to guard another's treasure?"

The nurse trembled and her sorrow gave place to shame; fain would she have died could she so escape the gaze of that unhappy mother, and long stayed she motionless, hesitating to disclose the suspected

haec comes, haec custos, haec
proxima mater haberi.
tunc laceras effusa comas et
pulvere cano
sordida sidereae raptus lugebat
alumnae.

Hanc adgressa Ceres,
postquam suspiria
tandem
laxavit frenosque dolor: “quod
cernimus” inquit 180
“excidium? cui praeda feror?
regnatne maritus
an caelum Titanes habent? quae
taliam vivo
ausa Tonante manus? rupitne
Typhoia cervix
Inarimen? fractane iugi
compage Vesevi
Alcyoneus Tyrrhena pedes per
stagna cucurrit? 185
an vicina mihi quassatis
faucibus Aetna
protulit Enceladum? nostros an
forte penates
adpetiit centum Briareia turba
lacertis?
heu, ubi nunc es, nata, mihi?
quo, mille ministrae,
quo, Cyane? volucres quae vis
Sirenas abegit? 190
haecine vestra fides? sic fas
aliena tueri
pignora?”

Contremuit nutrix,
maerorque pudori
cedit, et adspectus miserae non
ferre parentis

criminal and the all too certain death.
Scarce could she thus speak: “Would
that the raging band of Giants had
wrought this ruin! Easier to bear is a
common lot. ’Tis the goddesses, and,
though thou wilt scarce credit it, her
own sisters, who have conspired to
our undoing. Thou seest the devices
of gods and wounds inflicted by
sisters’ jealousy. Heaven is a more
cruel enemy than Hell.

“All quiet was the house, the maiden
dared not

iene patiens
 emptum morte^[360] velit longumque
 inmotam moratur
 auctorem dubium certumque
 expromere funus. 195
 vix tamen haec:
 “Acies utinam
 vesana Gigantum
 hanc dederit cladem! levius
 communia tangunt.
 sed divae, multoque minus
 quod rere, sorores
 in nostras (nimium!)
 coniuravere ruinas.
 insidias superum, cognatae
 vulnera cernis 200
 invidiae. Phlegra nobis
 infensor aether.
 “Florebat tranquilla domus;
 nec limina virgo

[361]

o'erstep the threshold nor visit the
 grassy pastures, close bound by thy
 commands. The loom gave her work,
 the Sirens with their song relaxation
 —with me she held pleasant
 converse, with me she slept; safe
 delights were hers within the halls.
 Then suddenly Cytherea came (who
 showed her the way to our hid abode
 I know not), and, that she might not
 rouse our suspicions, she brought
 with her Diana and Minerva,
 attending her on either side.
 Straightway with beaming smiles she
 put on a pretence of joy, kissed
 Proserpine many a time, and
 repeated the name of sister,
 complaining of that hard-hearted
 mother who chose to condemn such
 beauty to imprisonment and
 complaining that by forbidding her
 intercourse with the goddesses she
 had removed her far from her
 father's heaven. My unwitting
 charge rejoiced in these evil words
 and bade a feast be spread with
 plentiful nectar. Now she dons
 Diana's arms and dress and tries her
 bow with her soft fingers. Now
 crowned with horse-hair plumes she
 puts on the helmet, Minerva
 commending her, and strives to carry
 her huge shield.

“Venus was the first with guileful
 suggestion to mention fields and the

linquere nec virides audebat
visere saltus
praeceptis obstricta tuis. telae
labor illi;
Sirenes requies. sermonum
gratia mecum, 205
mecum somnus erat cautique
per atria ludi:
cum subito (dubium quonam
monstrante latebras
rescierit) Cytherea venit
suspectaque nobis
ne foret, hinc Phoeben comites,
hinc Pallada iunxit.
protinus effuso laetam se
fingere risu 210
nec semel amplecti nomenque
iterare sororis
et dura de matre queri, quae tale
recessu
maluerit damnare decus
vetitamque dearum
colloquio patriis procul
amandaverit astris.
nostra rudis gaudere malis et
nectare largo 215
instaurare dapes. nunc arma
habitumque Dianae
induitur digitisque attemptat
mollibus arcum,
nunc crinita iubis galeam,
laudante Minerva,
implet et ingentem clipeum
gestare laborat.
“Prima Venus campos
Aetnaeaeque rura
maligno 220
ingerit adflatu, vicinos callida

vale of Henna. Cunningly she harps upon the nearness of the flowery mead, and as though she knew it not, asks what merits the place boasts, pretending not to believe that a harmless winter allows the roses to bloom, that the cold months are bright with flowers not rightly theirs, and that the spring thickets fear not there Boötes’ wrath. So with her wonderment, her passion to see the spot, she persuades Proserpine. Alas! how easily does youth err with its weak ways! What tears did I not shed to no purpose, what vain

ingent adhaerent. vicinos canna
flores [362]

ingeminat meritumque loci
velut inscia quaerit
nec credit, quod bruma rosas
innoxia servet,
quod gelidi rubeant alieno
genuine menses
verna nec iratum timeant
virgulta Booten. 225
dum loca miratur, studio dum
flagrat eundi,
persuadet; teneris heu lubrica
moribus aetas!
quos ego nequidquam planctus,
quas inrita fudi

[363]

entreaties did my lips not utter!
Away she flew, trusting to the
sisters' protection; the scattered
company of attendant nymphs
followed after her.

“They went to the hills clothed with
undying grass and gather flowers
'neath the twilight of dawn, when
the quiet meads are white with dew
and violets drink the scattered
moisture. But when the sun had
mounted to higher air at noon,
behold! murky night hid the sky and
the island trembled and shook
beneath the beat of horses' hoofs and
the rumble of wheels. Who the
charioteer was none might tell—
whether he was the harbinger of
death or it was Death himself.
Gloom spread through the meadows,
the rivers stayed their courses, the
fields were blighted, nor did aught
live, once touched with those horses'
breath. I saw the bryony pale, the
roses fade, the lilies wither. When in
his roaring course the driver turned
back his steeds the night it brought
accompanied the chariot and light
was restored to the world. Proserpine
was nowhere to be seen. Their vows
fulfilled, the goddesses had returned
and tarried not. We found Cyane half
dead amid the fields; there she lay, a
garland round her neck and the
blackened wreaths faded upon her

ore preces! ruit illa tamen
 confisa sororum
praesidio; famulae longo post
 ordine Nymphae. 230
 “Itur in aeterno vestitos
 gramine colles
et prima sub luce legunt, cum
 rore serenus
albet ager sparsosque bibunt
 violaria sucos.
sed postquam medio sol altior
 institit axi,
ecce polum nox foeda rapit
 tremefactaque nutat 235
insula cornipedum pulsu
 strepituque rotarum.
nosse nec aurigam licuit: seu
 mortifer ille
seu Mors ipsa fuit. livor
 permanat in herbas;
deficiunt rivi; squalent rubigine
 prata
et nihil adflatum vivit: pallere
 ligustra, 240
expirare rosas, decrescere lilia
 vidi.
ut rauco reduces tractu detorsit
 habenas,
nox sua prosequitur currum, lux
 redditur orbi.
Persephone nusquam. voto
 rediere peracto
nec mansere deae. mediis
 invenimus arvis 245
exanimem Cyanen: cervix
 redimita iacebat
et caligantes marcebant fronte
 coronae

forehead. At once we approached her
and inquired after her mistress's
fortune, for she had been a witness
of the disaster. What, we asked, was
the aspect of the horses; who their
driver? Naught said she, but
corrupted with some hidden venom,
dissolved into water. Water crept
amid her hair; legs and arms melted
and flowed away, and soon a clear
stream washed our feet. The rest are
gone; the Sirens, Achelous'
daughters, rising on rapid wing, have
occupied the coast of Sicilian
Pelorus, and in wrath

coronae.
 adgredimur subito et casus
 scitamus eriles
 (nam propior cladi steterat):
 quis vultus equorum?
 quis regat? illa nihil, tacito sed
 laesa veneno 250
 solvitur in laticem: subrepat
 crinibus umor;
 liquitur in roremque pedes et
 brachia manant
 nostraque mox lambit vestigia
 perspicuus fons.
 discedunt aliae. rapidis
 Acheloides alis
 sublatae Siculi latus obsedere
 Pelori 255

[365]

at this crime now turned their lyres
 to man's destruction, tuneful now for
 ill. Their sweet voices stay ships, but
 once that song is heard the oars can
 move no more. I alone am left in the
 house to drag out an old age of
 mourning."

Ceres is still a prey to anxiety; half
 distraught she fears everything as
 though all were not yet
 accomplished. Anon she turns her
 head and eyes to heaven and with
 raging breast inveighs against its
 denizens; even as lofty Niphates
 shakes to the roaring of the Hyrcan
 tigress whose cubs the terrified
 horseman has carried off to be the
 playthings of Persia's king. Speedier
 than the west wind that is her
 paramour^[129] rushes the tigress,
 anger blazing from her stripes, but
 just as she is about to engulf the
 terrified hunter in her capacious
 maw, she is checked by the mirrored
 image of her own form^[130]: so the
 mother of Proserpine rages over all
 Olympus crying: "Give her back; no
 wandering stream gave me birth; I
 spring not from the Dryad rabble.
 Towered Cybele bare me also to
 Saturn. Where are the ordinances of
 the gods, where the laws of heaven?
 What boots it to live a good life?
 See, Cytherea dares show her face
 (modest goddess!) even after her

Have ye so changed your counsel?
Do ye now go allied with Venus and
her accomplice ravishers? Worthy
each of you to be worshipped in
Scythian temples and at altars that
lust after human blood. What hath
caused such great anger? Which of
you has my Proserpine wronged
even in her slightest word?
Doubtless she drove thee, Delian
goddess, from thy loved woods, or
deprived thee, Triton-born, of some
battle thou hadst joined. Did she
plague you with talk? Break rudely
upon your dances? Nay, that she
might be no burden to you, she dwelt
far away in the solitudes of Sicily.
What good hath her retirement done
her? No peace can still the madness
of bitter jealousy.”

Thus she upbraids them all. But they,
obedient to the Father’s word, keep
silence or say they know nothing,
and make tears their answer to the
mother’s questionings. What can she
do? She ceases, beaten, and in turn
descends to humble entreaty. “If a
mother’s love swelled too high or if I
have done aught more boldly than
befitted misery, oh forgive! A
suppliant and wretched I fling me at
your feet; grant me to learn my
doom; grant me at least this much—
sure knowledge of my woes. Fain
would I know the manner of this ill;

virginitatis honos? tantum mutata voluntas? 280	whatsoever fortune ye have visited upon me that will I bear and account
iam Veneri iunctae, sociis raptoribus itis?	it fate, not injustice. Grant a parent the sight of her child; I ask her not
o templis Scythiae atque hominem sistentibus aris	back. Whosoever thou art, possess in peace what thine hand has taken. The
utraque digna coli! tanti quae causa furoris?	prey is thine, fear not. But if the ravisher has thwarted me, binding
quam mea vel tenui dicto Proserpinayou laesit?	you by some oath, yet do thou, at least, Latona, tell me his name; to
scilicet aut caris pepulit te, Delia, silvis 285	thee mayhap Diana hath confessed her knowledge. Thou hast known
aut tibi commissas rapuit, Tritonia, pugnas.	childbirth, the anxiety
an gravis eloquio? vestros an forte petebat	
importuna choros? atqui Trinacria longe,	
esset ne vobis oneri, deserta colebat.	
quid latuisse iuvat? rabiem livoris acerbi 290	
nulla potest placare quies."	

His

increpat omnes
 vocibus. ast illae (prohibet sententia
 patris)
 aut reticent aut nosse negant
 responsaque matri
 dant lacrimas. quid agat? rursus se
 victa remittit
 inque humiles devecta preces:
 "Ignoscite,
 si quid 295
 intumuit pietas, si quid flagrantius
 actum
 quam miseros decuit. supplex
 miserandaque vestris
 advolver genibus: liceat cognoscere

advolvitur grembus. liceat cognoscere
sortem.^[368]

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hoc tantum liceat—certos habuisse
dolores.
scire peto, quae forma mali;
 quamcumque dedistis 300
fortunam, sit nota: feram fatumque
 putabo,
non scelus. adspectum, precor,
 indulgete parenti;
non repetam. quaesita manu securus
 habeto
quisquis es; adfirmo praedam; desiste
 vereri.
quodsi nos aliquo praevenit foedere
 raptor, 305
tu certe, Latona, refer; confessa Diana
forte tibi. nosti quid sit Lucina, quis
 horror

and love for children; to offspring
twain hast thou given birth; this was
mine only child. So mayest thou ever
enjoy Apollo's locks, so mayest thou
live a happier mother than I."

Plenteous tears then bedewed her
cheeks. She continued: "Why these
tears? why this silence? Woe is me;
all desert me. Why tarriest thou yet
to no purpose? Seest thou not 'tis
open war with heaven? were it not
better to seek again thy daughter by
sea and land? I will gird myself and
scour the world, unwearied I will
penetrate its every corner, nor ever
stay my search, nor rest nor sleep till
I find my reft treasure, though she lie
whelmed in the Spanish Ocean bed
or hedged around in the depths of the
Red Sea. Neither ice-bound Rhine
nor Alpine frosts shall stay me; the
treacherous tides of Syrtes shall not
give me pause. My purpose holds to
penetrate the fastnesses of the North
and to tread the snowy home of
Boreas. I will climb Atlas on the
brink of the sunset and illumine
Hydaspes' stream with my torches.
Let wicked Jove behold me
wandering through towns and
country, and Juno's jealousy be sated
with her rival's ruin. Have your sport
with me, triumph in heaven, proud
gods, celebrate your illustrious

pro genitis et quantus amor,
partusque tulisti
tu geminos: haec una mihi. sic
crine fruaris
semper Apollineo, sic me
felicior aevum 310
mater agas.”

Largis tunc
imbribus ora madescunt.
“quid? tantum dignum fleri
dignumque taceri?
hei mihi, discedunt omnes. quid
vana moraris
ulterius? non bella palam
caelestia sentis?
quin potius natam pelago
terrisque requiris? 315
accingar lustrare diem, per
devia rerum
indefessa ferar. nulla cessabitur
hora,
non requies, non somnus erit,
dum pignus ademptum
inveniam, gremio quamvis
mergatur Hiberæ
Tethyos et Rubro iaceat vallata
profundo. 320
non Rheni glacies, non me
Riphaea tenebunt
frigora; non dubio Syrtis
cunctabitur aestu.
stat finem penetrare Noti
Boreaeque nivalem
vestigare domum; primo
calcabitur Atlas
occasu facibusque meis lucebit
Hydaspes. 325
impius errantem videat per rura

victory o'er Ceres' conquered
daughter.”

So spake she and glides down upon
Etna's familiar slopes, there to
fashion torches to aid her night-
wandering labours.

There was a wood, hard by the
stream of Acis, which fair Galatea
oft chooses in preference to Ocean
and cleaves in swimming with her
snowy breast—a wood dense with
foliage that closed in Etna's summit
on all sides with interwoven
branches. “Tis there that Jove is said
to have laid down his

impus errantem videat per rura,
per urbē^[370]

Iuppiter; extincta satietur
paelice Iuno.
insultate mihi, caelo regnate
superbi,
ducite praeclarum Cereris de
stirpe triumphum!”

Haec fatur notaeque iugis
inlabitur Aetnae 330
noctivago taedas informatura
labori.

Lucus erat prope flumen
Acin, quod candida
praeferat
saepe mari pulchroque secat
Galatea natatu,
densus et innexis Aetnaea
cacumina ramis
qua licet usque tegens. illic
posuisse cruentam 335

[371]

bloody shield and set his captured
spoil after the battle. The grove
glories in trophies from the plain of
Phlegra and signs of victory clothe
its every tree. Here hang the gaping
jaws and monstrous skins of the
Giants; affixed to trees their faces
still threaten horribly, and heaped up
on all sides bleach the huge bones of
slaughtered serpents. Their stiffening
sloughs smoke with the blow of
many a thunderbolt, and every tree
boasts some illustrious name. This
one scarce supports on its down-
bended branches the naked swords
of hundred-handed Aegaeon; that
glories in the murky trophies of
Coeus; this bears up the arms of
Mimas; spoiled Ophion weighs
down those branches. But higher
than all the other trees towers a pine,
its shady branches spread wide, and
bears the reeking arms of Enceladus
himself, all powerful king of the
Earth-born giants; it would have
fallen beneath the heavy burden did
not a neighbouring oak-tree support
its wearied weight. Therefore the
spot wins awe and sanctity; none
touches the aged grove, and 'tis
accounted a crime to violate the
trophies of the gods. No Cyclops
dares pasture there his flock nor hew
down the trees, Polyphemus himself
flies from the hallowed shade.

aegida captivamque pater post
 proelia praedam
advexisse datur. Phlegraeis silva
 superbit
exuviis totumque nemus
 victoria vestit.
hic patuli rictus et prodigiosa
 Gigantum
tergora dependent, et adhuc
 crudele minantur 340
adfixae truncis facies,
 inmaniaque ossa
serpentum passim cumulis
 exanguibus albet,
et rigidae multo suspirant
 fulmine pelles;
nullaque non magni iactat se
 nominis arbor:
haec centumgemini strictos
 Aegaeonis enses 345
curvata vix fronde levat;
 liventibus illa
exultat Coei spoliis; haec arma
 Mimantis
sustinet; hos onerat ramos
 exutus Ophion.
altior at cunctis abies
 umbrosaue late
ipsius Enceladi fumantia gestat
 opima, 350
summi terrigenum regis,
 caderetque gravata
pondere, ni lassam fulciret
 proxima quercus.
inde timor numenque loco,
 nemorisque senectae
parcitur, aetheriisque nefas
 noquisse trojaeis

Not for that did Ceres stay her steps;
the very sanctity of the place
inflames her wrath; with angry hand
she brandishes her axe, ready to
strike Jove himself. She hesitates
whether to cut down pines or lay low
knotless cedars, scans likely trunks
and lofty trees and shakes their
branches with vigorous hand. Even
so when a man, fain to carry
merchandise over distant seas, builds
a ship on dry land and makes ready
to expose his life to the tempest, he
hews down

nocturnis uopacis.
pascere nullus^[372] oves nec robora
laedere Cyclops 355
audet et ipse fugit sacra
Polyphemus ab umbra.
Non tamen hoc tardata Ceres.
accenditur ultro
relligione loci vibratque infesta
securim
ipsum etiam feritura Iovem:
succidere pinus
aut magis enodes dubitat
prosternere cedros 360
exploratque habiles truncos
rectique tenorem
stipitis et certo pertemptat
brachia nisu.
sic, qui vecturus longinqua per
aequora merces
molitur tellure ratem vitamque
procellis
obiectare parat, fagos metitur et
alnos 365

[373]

beech and elm and marks the diverse utility of the yet growing forest; the lofty tree he selects as yardarms for the swelling sail; the strong he prefers as a mast; the pliant will make good oars; the waterproof is suitable for the keel.

Two cypresses in the grass hard by raised their inviolate heads to heaven; Simois looks not on such in amaze amid the crags of Ida, nor does Orontes water their like, Orontes that feeds Apollo's grove and harbours rich cities on his banks. You would know them for sisters for they tower equal in height and look down upon the wood with twin tops. These she would have as torches; she attacks each with vigorous blows, her gown girt back, her arms bared and armed with the axe. First one she strikes, then the other, and rains blows upon their trembling trunks with might and main. Together they crash to the ground, lay their foliage in the dust and lie upon the plain, wept of Fauns and wood-nymphs. She seizes both just as they are, uplifts them and, with hair out-streaming behind her, climbs panting the slopes of the mountain, passes beyond the flames and inaccessible precipices, and treads the lava that brooks no mortal footstep: even as the grim Megaera hastens to kindle

et varium rudibus silvis
 accommodat usum:
quae longa est, tumidis
 praebebit cornua velis;
quae fortis, clavo potior; quae
 lenta, favebit
remigio: stagni patiens aptanda
 carinae.

 Tollebant geminae capita
 inviolata cupressus 370
caespite vicino: quales non
 rupibus Idae
miratur Simois, quales non
 divite ripa
lambit Apollinei nemoris
 nutritor Orontes.
germanas adeo credas; sic
 frontibus aequis
adstant et socio despectant
 vertice lucum. 375
hae placuere faces. pernix
 invadit utramque
cincta sinus, exerta manus,
 armata bipenni
alternasque ferit totisque obnixa
 tremantes
viribus impellit. pariter traxere
 ruinam
et pariter posuere comas
 campoque recumbunt,
380

Faunorum Dryadumque dolor.
 complectitur ambas,
sicut erant, alteque levat
 retroque solutis
crinibus ascendit fastigia montis
 anheli

exuperataque aestus et nulli

yew-trees to light her to crime,
speeding her journey to the walls of
Cadmus' city or meaning to work her
devilment in Thyestean Mycenae;
darkness and the shades give her
passage, and Hell rings to her iron
tread, till she halts beside
Phlegethon's wave and fires her
torch from its brimming waves.

When she had climbed to the mouth
of the burning rock, straightway,
turning aside her head, she thrust the
kindling cypresses into its inmost
depths, thus closing in the cavern on
all sides and stopping up the

exuperatque aestus et num
 pervia ^[374]saxa
 atque indignantes vestigia
 calcat harenas: 385
 qualis pestiferas animare ad
 crimina taxos
 torva Megaera ruit, Cadmi seu
 moenia poscat
 sive Thyesteis properet saevire
 Mycenis:
 dant tenebrae manesque locum
 plantisque resultant
 Tartara ferratis, donec
 Phlegethontis ad undam
 390
 constitit et plenos excepit
 lampade fluctus.
 Postquam perventum scopuli
 flagrantis in ora,
 protinus arsuras aversa fronte
 cupressus
 faucibus iniecit mediis lateque
 cavernas
 textit et undantem flammaram
 obstruxit hiatum. 395

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blazing exit of the flames. The mountain thunders with repressed fire and Vulcan is shut in a grievous prison; the enclosed smoke cannot escape. The cone-bearing tops of the cypresses blaze and Etna grows with new ashes; the branches crackle, kindled with the sulphur. Then, lest their long journey should cause them to fail, she bids the flames never die nor sleep and drenches the wood with that secret drug^[132] wherewith Phaëthon bedews his steeds and the Moon her bulls.

Silent night had now in her turn visited upon the world her gift of sleep. Ceres, with her wounded breast, starts on her long journey and, as she sets out, speaks as follows: "Little thought I, Proserpine, to carry for thee such torches as these. I had hoped what every mother hopes; marriage and festal torches and a wedding-song to be sung in heaven—such was my expectation. Are we divinities thus the sport of fate? does Lachesis vent her spleen on us as on mankind? How lofty was but now mine estate, surrounded with suitors innumerable for my daughter's hand! What mother of many children but would have owned her my inferior by reason of my only daughter! Thou wast my first joy and my last; I was

compresso mons igne tonat
 claususque laborat
 Mulciber: obducti nequeunt
 exire vapores.
 coniferi micuere apices
 crevitque favillis
 Aetna novis: strident admisso
 sulphure rami.
 tum, ne deficerent tantis
 erroribus, ignes 400
 semper innocidos insopitosque
 manere
 iussit et arcano perfudit robora
 suo,
 quo Phaëthon inrorat equos,
 quo Luna iuvenco.
 Iamque soporiferas nocturna
 silentia terris
 explicuere vices: laniato pectore
 longas 405
 incohat illa vias et sic ingressa
 profatur:
 “Non tales gestare tibi,
 Proserpina, taedas
 sperabam; sed vota mihi
 communia matrum
 et thalami festaeque faces
 caeloque canendus
 ante oculos hymenaeus erat. sic
 numina fatis 410
 volvimur et nullo Lachesis
 discrimine saevit?
 quam nuper sublimis eram
 quantisque procorum
 cingebar studiis! quae non mihi
 pignus ob unum
 cedebat numerosa parens! tu
 prima voluntas

called prolific for that I bare thee.
 Thou wert my glory, my comfort,
 dear object of a mother's pride; with
 thee alive I was goddess indeed, with
 thee safe I was Juno's equal. Now
 am I outcast, beggared. 'Tis the
 Father's will. Yet why make Jove
 answerable for my tears? 'Twas I
 who so cruelly undid thee, I confess
 it, for I deserted thee and heedlessly
 exposed thee to threatening foes. Too
 deeply was I enmeshed in careless
 enjoyment of shrill-voiced revel,
 and, happy amid the din of arms,

[\[132\]](#) A magic drug or herb on which
 the sun is said to have fed his horses in
 order to render them non-inflammable.
 Ovid tells how Phaëthon was treated by
 his father in a like way (*Met.* ii. 122).

prima voluptas,
 tu postrema mihi, ^[376]per te
 fecunda ferebar. 415
 o decus, o requies, o grata
 superbia matris,
 qua gessi florente deam, qua
 sospite numquam
 inferior Iunone fui: nunc
 squalida, vilis.
 hoc placitum patri. cur autem
 adscribimus illum
 his lacrimis? ego te, fateor,
 crudelis ademi, 420
 quae te deserui solamque
 instantibus ultro
 hostibus exposui. raucis secura
 fruebar
 nimirum thiasis et laeta
 sonantibus armis

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I was yoking Phrygian lions whilst
 thou wast being carried off. Yet see
 the punishment visited upon me. My
 face is seared with wounds and long
 gashes furrow my bloody breast. My
 womb, forgetful that it gave thee
 birth, is beaten with continual blows.

“Where under heaven shall I find
 thee? Beneath what quarter of the
 sky? Who shall point the way, what
 path shall lead me? What chariot was
 it? Who was that cruel ravisher? A
 denizen of earth or sea? What traces
 of his wingèd wheels can I discover?
 Whithersoever my steps lead me or
 chance direct, thither will I go. Even
 so may Dione be deserted and seek
 for Venus!

“Will my labours be successful?
 Shall I ever again be blest with thine
 embrace, my daughter? Art thou still
 fair; still glows the brightness of thy
 cheeks? Or shall I perchance see thee
 as thou cam’st in my nightly vision;
 as I saw thee in my dreams?”

So spake she and from Etna first she
 drags her steps, and, cursing its
 guilty flowers and the spot whence
 Proserpine was ravaged, she follows
 the straying tracks of the chariot-
 wheels and examines the fields in the
 full light of her lowered torch. Every
 rut is wet with her tears; she weeps
 at each trace she espies in her

iungebam Phrygios, cum tu
 raperere, leones.
accipe quas merui poenas. en
 ora fatiscunt 425
vulneribus grandesque rubent in
 pectore sulci.
immemor en uterus crebro
 contunditur ictu.
“Qua te parte poli, quo te sub
 cardine quaeram?
quis monstrator erit? quae me
 vestigia ducent?
qui currus? ferus ipse quis est?
 terraene, marisne 430
incola? quae volucrum
 deprendam signa
 rotarum?
ibo, ibo quocumque pedes,
 quocumque iubebit
casus; sic Venerem quaerat
 deserta Dione.
“Efficietne labor? rursus te,
 nata, licebit
amplecti? manet ille decor,
 manet ille genarum 435
fulgor? an infelix talem fortasse
 videbo,
qualis nocte venis, qualem per
 somnia vidi?”
Sic ait et prima gressus
 molitur ab Aetna
exitiique reos flores ipsumque
 rapinae
detestata locum sequitur
 dispersa viarum 440
indicia et pleno rimatur lumine
 campos
inclinataque faces omnis madet

wanderings over the plain. She
glides a shadow o’er the sea and the
farthest ray of her torches’ gleam
strikes the coasts of Italy and Libya.
The Tuscan shore grows bright and
the Syrtes gleam with kindled wave.
The light reaches the distant cave of
Scylla, of whose dogs some shrink
back and are still in dumb amaze,
others, not yet horrified into silence,
continue to bark. ^[135]

^[135] For the unfinished state of the
poem see Introduction, p. xiv.

in omni facies, omnis in
 [133] *Birt* omnibus admugit.
 quocumque in aequore, fulvis
 adnatat.
 omnibus admugit, [133]
 [134] sulcis c. fulvis FSV, silvis W.
 quocumque in
 aequore, sulcis. [134]
 adnatat umbra fretis extremaque
 [378] lucis imago
 Italiam Libyamque ferit:
 clarescit Etruscum 445
 litus et accenso resplendent
 aequore Syrtes.
 [379] antra procul Scyllaea petit
 canibusque reductis
 pars stupefacta silet, pars
 nondum exterrita latrat.

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